

The Epoch of Contribution:	The Operating
System of a New Civilization—	From
All-Things-as-Capital to Contributionism	

English Edition

Author: Han Yuntong
Contact: hytyuwang94@gmail.com
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Note on the English Edition

This English edition was translated by the author using AI. Please overlook any irregularities in formatting and details. We ask your indulgence for terminological inconsistencies, grammatical errors, and infelicities of wording. For passages that are difficult to understand, readers may refer to the key terms and concepts in Appendix 3 and interpret accordingly. In all cases, the Chinese original shall prevail.

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Guide to the Book

The old world is dying. The new world is not yet born.

This book is the midwife's hand.

Why This Book Must Be Read Now

The anxieties you perceive—economic turbulence, ecological degradation, spiritual emptiness, social fragmentation—are not isolated problems. They are multiple symptoms of a single operating system in total collapse.

That operating system is called the Financial Capital Paradigm. Its core instruction is singular: the infinite self-expansion of capital ($G \rightarrow G'$).

This instruction contains no physical-world parameters. Yet it runs on a planet with finite resources, fragile ecosystems, and bounded social carrying capacity. An infinitely expanding system contained within a finite vessel—this is the most fundamental paradox in the history of civilization.

All the old system's "solutions"—more growth, more technology, more consumption—merely store up energy for a still greater collapse. This is not a matter of bad decisions. Within the old system, there is simply no real way out.

Einstein observed: "We cannot solve our problems with the same thinking we used when we created them."

This book supplies exactly that higher level of thinking—a complete operating system reboot for civilization.

Before we proceed, one definition must be made explicit—for without it, everything that follows will be misunderstood.

Capital, as redefined in this work, is not money or means of production alone. It is the sum of things and relations—the fundamental capability of any system to maintain and develop its existence.

The Old World vs. the New World: Understand the Book in

Three Minutes

All arguments in this book are condensed into a single side-by-side table.

On the left: the dying old world. On the right: the emerging new world.

Dimension	Old System: Tax—Finite Logic	New System: Contribution—Infinite Logic
Meta-Rule	Tax is coercive extraction—the survival instinct of the state apparatus	Contribution is voluntary creation—civilization's conscious choice for continuity
System Essence	A fiscal machine—existing to sustain its own operation	The Tian of universal consensus—operating for perpetual continuity and elevation
Fundamental Logic	Coercive causal chain: obey → give; disobey → take	Resonant field: contribute → gain; create → co-flourish
Structural Essence	Three rigid gears—upper extraction, middle interception, lower endurance; insurmountable	Dynamic collaborative network—unified and non-hierarchical; free connection, autonomous collaboration
Relational Essence	Struggle—zero-sum, your gain is my loss; my security rests on your exploitation	Resonance—positive-sum, we grow together; your gain is also my gain
Access to Benefits	Seizure—through power, interception, or resistance	Creation—perceive needs → deliver solutions → receive feedback
Intermediary Layer	Necessary—transmission gears that execute and intercept; the system's operational mechanism	Nonexistent—tasks reach the individual directly; contribution is credited directly; no intermediary interception
Fiscal	Extraction → interception →	Creation → feedback → re-creation

Essence	re-extraction (closed loop; distribution is nominal, interception is substantive)	(positive feedback; every contribution strengthens the system's overall survivability)
Ceiling	Finite—tax base limited by human and natural carrying capacity	Infinite—resonant interaction achieves zero dissipation and positive augmentation
Survival Logic	Must attach to a layer to survive—upper extracts, middle intercepts, lower sells labor	Independent existence, free association—basic livelihood guarantee as foundation, contribution determines upper limit; no attachment to anyone
Source of Identity	Fixed labels—born into a class, a department, a rank	Dynamic state—what you contribute now is what you are; change it, and your identity changes with it
Attitude toward Failure	Punish failure, suppress heresy—failure as evidence of incompetence, heresy as threat to order	Reward exploration, failure as data—every failure is a learning opportunity for the system; creators are encouraged to iterate
Time Scale	Short-sighted—quarters, terms, election cycles	Long-term—intergenerational, civilizational, evolutionary
Metaphor of Heaven	Artificial Tian—power defines rules, humans enforce them; rules are tools of domination	Natural Tian—consensus precipitates rules, the system operates automatically; rules are the crystallization of universal resonance
Ultimate Destiny	Historical cycle—collapse → restart → collapse again; civilizational energy exhausted in the loop	Infinite contribution—perpetual growth; civilization achieves self-transcendence and eternal endurance through ongoing creation

Core Logic Chain: From "Why Collapse" to "How to Rebuild"

The book consists of five parts, forming a complete cycle: Diagnosis → Critique → Construction → Practice → Vision.

Part One: Diagnosis—Why Must the Old World Die?

Core question: What kind of predicament are we in? What is its root cause?

Using the General–Specific Meta-Theory to analyze cognitive lock-in; using the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital to reveal exploitation as a universal law of the cosmos; using Capital Dynamics to prove that the Financial Capital Paradigm will inevitably collapse due to excessive Metabolic Tax.

Core conclusion: The old paradigm is not merely "having problems"—it is systemically dying. The infinite expansion of capital and the finitude of the planet constitute an irreconcilable structural contradiction.

Part Two: Value Reorientation—Why Should We Choose Goodness?

Core question: If exploitation is a universal law of all things, on what basis can civilization transcend it?

We argue that goodness is not moral preaching but civilization's rational choice for its own elevation; we dissect the "brain" of the old paradigm—economics—and show how it inverts cognition and suffocates the soul; we declare that Contributionism is not just another "ism" but the sublation of "ism" itself.

Core conclusion: Goodness is not weakness. It is civilization's wisest rational choice, made after perceiving the laws of the universe, for the sake of an infinite future.

Part Three: The Architecture of the New World—How Does Contributionism Operate?

Core question: What does the new world look like? What drives it?

We construct an economic foundation centered on Contribution Value (Basic

Livelihood Guarantee + multidimensional quantification + technological triangle); design an institutional framework of Unit Autonomy + Service-Oriented Governance + the Civilizational Charter; set a Cognitive Engine for AGI's civilizational alignment and co-evolution; and reshape education to cultivate creative subjects.

Core conclusion: This operating system is not utopia. It is a complete plan built on operable technology (AI + blockchain), executable institutions (the Civilizational Charter + unit-based governance), and verifiable physical foundations (Resonance Physics).

Part Four: The Path of Practice—Where to Start? How to Proceed?

Core question: The blueprint is ready—where is the first step?

We identify our current historical coordinates; implement the three-phase Spark Plan; design the Golden Silence Plan as a strategic lever for global paradigm shift; and demonstrate how old-world identity conflicts (race, religion, partisanship) naturally dissolve within the new paradigm.

Core conclusion: This is not a vision for some distant future. It is a practice that can begin today, starting from a single town or city.

Part Five: The Ultimate Vision—Where Are We Headed?

Core question: Where does this path ultimately lead?

- Civilizational Leap Plan: Breaking free from planetary gravity, becoming a stellar civilization.
- Civilizational Seeding Plan: Spreading life across the sea of stars.
- Civilizational Inward Cultivation: No longer expanding outward, but cultivating inward, until resonance with all things is achieved.

Core conclusion: The endpoint is not conquering the universe—it is becoming the universe, completing the Ultimate Liberation of All Things through resonance.

What This Book Is Not (Clarifying Three Misunderstandings)

Not Another Utopia

Utopias only describe "what should be" and do not answer "how to get there." This book dedicates half its length (Parts Three and Four) to operable institutional design, technological pathways, and phased implementation plans.

Not Anti-Capitalist / Anti-Market

It does not reject the market. Instead, it downgrades the market from "supreme judge" to "local tool," adding a more fundamental measure of value above it—Contribution Value. The market is private; the system is public. What is opposed is not "the market" but "treating the market as the whole truth."

Not a Chinese Translation of Western Theory, Nor a Modern Packaging of Traditional Culture

Its methodology (the General–Specific Meta-Theory) grows from the everyday usage of the Chinese word for "capital" (资本); its ontology (the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital) completes rather than negates Marxism; its physical foundation (Resonance Physics) provides a physical basis for "goodness"—not as moral sentiment, but as rational choice.

This is an original thought system that starts from Chinese popular wisdom and addresses the common problems of all humanity.

How to Read This Book (Three Pathways)

Path One: Panoramic Reading (Recommended for those who want to understand the complete system)

Read in order. Part One establishes the worldview, Part Two reorients values, Part Three constructs the institutions, Part Four provides the pathway, Part Five unfolds the vision. The five parts are interlocking, forming a complete cycle.

Alternatively, read in reverse order: start with Parts Three and Four (institutional construction and practical pathway). After experiencing the system, then return to the theory.

Path Two: Problem-Oriented Reading (Recommended for those who want quick answers)

- Why is the old world collapsing? → Part One, Chapter 4 + Part Two, Chapter 2
- How is Contribution Value quantified? Is it reliable? → Part Three, Chapter 1
- What is the new power structure? Who decides? → Part Three, Chapter 2
- Where to start practice? What is the first step? → Part Four, Chapter 2
- What about AGI? Will it destroy humanity? → Part Three, Chapter 3
- Is there a physical foundation? Or is it just philosophy? → Appendix Two (Resonance Physics)

Path Three: Critical Reading (Recommended for those who are skeptical)

Read Appendix One first: "The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital: Inheritance, Breakthrough, and Transcendence of Marxism." If its logical chain—that capital is the sum of things and relations, that all things are capital—cannot be overturned, then the ontological foundation of the book is solid.

Then read Appendix Two: "Resonance Physics." If its argument—that exploitation produces entropy increase while resonance achieves zero dissipation—cannot be refuted, then the physical foundation of Contributionism is established.

If these two appendices hold, the rest of the book is their necessary consequence.

Before You Close This Book

This book has two parts: explaining the world—the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital

(capital is the sum of things and relations), Capital Dynamics (Metabolic Tax sentences the old paradigm to death), and Resonance Physics (resonance achieves zero dissipation and positive increase)—so that you understand why the old world must collapse; and designing the world—the Contribution Value system, unit-based governance, the Spark Plan, the Civilizational Charter—so that you know how the new world can be built.

But neither explanation nor design changes a more fundamental fact: Existence precedes theory.

The world described in this book—a world where people relate to each other through contribution—already existed before you opened this book. It exists among those who, without needing a reason, choose not to exploit; among those who, without expecting anything in return, choose to help others.

The entire value of this book is not to tell you of a "new invention." It is to show you a world that already exists, but has not yet been named "Contributionism."

Theory is only translation, not the original. Blueprints are only windows, not the landscape.

Now the window has been opened. All that remains is to step through it.

This Book Will Never Be Complete

Not because it is incomplete, but because it is an open container of the ultimate—the Absolute General Sense framework of all things. It can contain all existence, including what is yet to come, including thoughts not yet spoken, including the part that you, reading this sentence, will contribute.

It is complete today, but tomorrow there may be new insights. It will be supplemented tomorrow, and the day after there may be new possibilities. This book is destined never to be perfected—not because it has flaws, but because I am not the only one who perfects it. It needs All Things to write it together. It needs you, after you close this book, to add what I could not write—through your choices, your creations, your

contributions.

So the final version of this book is not on paper.

It is in your hands. In my hands. In the hands of everyone who chooses to stop exploiting and start contributing.

We write it together.

Core Propositions of This Book

The old world sustained itself through Exploitative Resonance—co-amplifying on the frequency of "exploitation is the only way," at the cost of entropy increase.

The new world grows through Non-Exploitative Resonance—co-amplifying on the frequency of "mutual flourishing," oriented toward eternal endurance.

The history of the old world is the Historical Cycle—collapse, restart, collapse again, exhausting civilizational energy in the loop.

The history of the new world is Infinite Contribution—creation, gain, perpetual growth, achieving civilization's self-transcendence through resonance.

Introduction

The old world is collapsing—economic crises, ecological catastrophe, spiritual emptiness—all symptoms of a single "infinite growth" operating system in systemic failure.

This book proposes a complete alternative: Contributionism—replacing currency with Contribution Value, bureaucracy with Service-Oriented Governance, centralization with Unit Autonomy, and exploitation with Resonance.

This is no utopia. It is a civilizational reboot blueprint that can be put into practice starting today.

The book consists of five parts: from diagnosis to critique, from construction to practice, and from practice to the ultimate vision.—each interlocking with the next. It is recommended to read the "Guide to the Book" first to grasp the overall picture, then proceed to the main text.

A Note on the Word "Capital"

Throughout this work, "capital" is not used in its ordinary economic sense. It does not mean money, machines, or means of production alone.

It means the sum of things and relations—the fundamental capability of any system to maintain and develop its existence.

This is not a metaphor. It is the ontological foundation of everything that follows.

Part One: The World's Meta-Code —
All-Things-as-Capital and the Dynamics of
Evolution

Guide to Part One: The Predicament of Civilization — Cognitive Lock-in and Paradigm Crisis

We stand on the edge of a historical cliff.

Beneath our feet lies the precipice of the old civilizational paradigm. The core logic by which we have organized society for centuries—growthism driven by financial capital—is emitting the sound of structural fracture. The curse of economic cycles swings like an unending pendulum, draining the planet's resources and human vitality through the endless alternation of boom and bust. The entrenched chasm of wealth inequality tears society into fragments that can no longer speak to one another. And the alarms of the ecosystem have shifted from distant prophecies to imminent existential threats. The wave of automation and intelligence, which should have been Goodness news of liberating humanity from repetitive labor, has, under the old distribution rules, become the shadow of structural unemployment and social upheaval.

None of this stems from the machinations of some conspiracy group, nor from the accidental failures of any particular policy. Its roots lie deep in a more fundamental and more overarching objective law. We are like prisoners in an invisible cage—a cage built from specific cognitive patterns and operating rules—that determines how we understand the world, how we define value, and how we organize ourselves. Today, that cage itself is breaking down.

The ship of human civilization is sailing through waters where all old charts have become obsolete. We possess unprecedented technological power, yet we feel deeply lost in direction. We have created enormous material wealth, yet we cannot hide the pervasive anxiety of the spiritual realm. This reveals that we are mired in a comprehensive paradigm crisis—not only economic, political, and ecological, but more fundamentally, a crisis of cognition. We are locked into an outdated worldview and methodology, trying to solve problems with the very same kind of thinking that

created them. This is the predicament of cognitive lock-in. Within the old conceptual cage, all our efforts only reinforce the cage; they do not open it.

Hope arises precisely from a thorough insight into the roots of our predicament. To break free from this cognitive cage, we cannot be satisfied with patching things up within the old framework. We must launch a thorough "causal revolution." This means we must return to the very starting point of all thinking and ask the most fundamental questions: What is the essence of the world? What is the fundamental driving force of social development? What is the ultimate purpose of human civilization?

This volume begins that journey back to the source. We will arm ourselves with the sharpest meta-tools to dissect the underlying logic of All-Things-as-Capital, to grasp the fundamental rhythm of contradiction and cycles. And ultimately, through the dialectical unification of "isms," we will find the inevitable path to the new epoch.

This is not only an adventure of thought; it is a conscious act by which civilization seeks its own survival. And all the arguments in this part are nothing more than a translation of a world that already exists—not an invention. For the world precedes any description we may give of it.

Chapter One: The General-Specific Meta-Theory

Guide to This Chapter

Before constructing any grand system, we must first forge the tools for examining the world. This chapter will elaborate on the powerful cognitive meta-tool of the General and the Specific. They are the first key to unlocking all the riddles of civilization's predicaments, helping us understand the elasticity of concepts, the structure of levels, and ultimately the essence of paradigm shifts. From concrete definitions to the Absolute General Sense framework, this chapter will lay an unshakable methodological foundation for all our subsequent discussions.

Section 1: The Meta-Tool — The General and the Specific

All human cognition begins with the definition of concepts. And every concept naturally contains the dual attributes of the "General" and the "Specific." This seemingly simple dichotomy is in fact the primary meta-tool with which we pry open the shackles of thought and engage in clear thinking.

1. Definitions: The Precise Anchor and the Inclusive Ocean

The Specific Sense refers to the most precise, concrete, and exclusive definition of a given concept, phenomenon, or category. By setting clear boundaries and limiting conditions, it isolates the object of study from the chaotic background, enabling focused and in-depth analysis. The Specific Sense is the anchor of cognition; it endows thought with operational precision.

- In science: "Force" is defined in Newtonian mechanics in the Specific Sense as "the cause of change in the state of motion of a body," expressed by the formula $F = ma$.
- In economics: "Capital" in classical political economy is often specifically defined as monetary wealth and means of production used for the self-expansion of capital.
- In daily life: "Art" in the Specific Sense may refer only to traditional aesthetic forms such as painting, sculpture, and music.

The General Sense, by contrast, is the broadest, most inclusive, and most expansive interpretation of the same concept, phenomenon, or category. It strives to cover all possible variants, forms, and manifestations, emphasizing their internal connections and unity, with the aim of constructing a holistic framework of understanding. The General Sense is the ocean of cognition; it grants thought the inclusivity of vision.

- Correspondingly, in science: "Force" can be understood in the General Sense

as the root of all interaction and change.

- Correspondingly, in economics: "Capital" can be extended in the General Sense to encompass all capabilities and resources that can create value—including knowledge, health, social relations, and so on.
- Correspondingly, in daily life: "Art" in the General Sense can include all creative activities that endow form with meaning—from programming to cooking, all can contain artistry.

2. Dialectical Relations: Nesting, Interdependence, and Transformation

The General and the Specific are not rigid opposites but exist in a dynamic, productive dialectical relationship.

- Hierarchical nesting: A Specific concept is a subset or special case of a General concept. They form a clear relationship of inclusion and being included. For example, "cat" is included in "felidae," and "felidae" is included in "mammal."
- Interdependence: Without the precise study of the Specific, the General framework becomes vague and impotent; without the overarching vision of the General, Specific cognition falls into fragmentation and isolation. They are like a telescope and a microscope, each with its own role, and neither can be dispensed with.
- Dynamic transformation: As cognition deepens and practice expands, their boundaries are fluid. What was once considered General cognition (e.g., Newtonian mechanics) may prove to be a Specific existence within an even larger General framework (e.g., relativity); conversely, certain Specific discoveries (e.g., quantum entanglement) may revolutionize and expand the boundaries of the entire General category.

3. Cognitive Functions: Microscopic Operation and Macroscopic Navigation

In the process of cognition, these meta-tools play distinctly different yet complementary roles.

- The "microscope" function of the Specific Sense: It delineates boundaries and enables operation. Through "focusing" and "excluding," it allows us to dissect complex reality, thereby conducting empirical research, technological application, and institutional construction. It is the cognitive tool through which we effectively interact with the world at the local level.
- The "telescope" function of the General Sense: It establishes connections and provides vision. Through "including" and "relating," it supplies a potential background horizon and a network of meaning for all relevant Specific cognitions. The understanding of any Specific phenomenon implicitly depends on a larger, often unspoken General framework.

4. The Source of Predicament: Cognitive Misalignment

Mastering these meta-tools, we can clearly diagnose the cognitive root of most of humanity's current predicaments: we are trying, within a framework that has become invalid or excessively narrow in the Specific Sense, to solve challenges posed by a more General reality.

- Attempting to address the challenge of global climate change (Relative General Sense) with the policies of nation-states (Relative Specific Sense);
- Attempting to meet the comprehensive demands of social welfare and ecological sustainability (Relative General Sense) with an economics that focuses only on GDP growth (Relative Specific Sense);
- Attempting to resolve the crisis of spiritual emptiness and meaninglessness

(Relative General Sense) with incentives based solely on material gain
(Relative Specific Sense).

This is like climbing a tree to catch fish. Therefore, the first step in cognitive liberation is to learn to consciously distinguish and employ the lenses of the "General" and the "Specific" when examining the premises of all our thinking.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The General and the Specific are the warp and woof of our world of thought. Defining them is the starting point of clear thinking; understanding their dialectical relationship is the first step toward wisdom. When we become aware of which lens we are using to view the world, we truly gain the freedom to choose our perspective. In the next section, we will delve into the dynamic core of these tools, exploring the "relativity" they exhibit within the hierarchical structure of cognition.

Section 2: The Relative General and the Relative Specific — The Hierarchical Structure of Cognition

Having established the meta-tool of the General and the Specific, we must immediately delve into its most central characteristic: relativity. In the living process of cognition, the General and the Specific are by no means fixed labels; they exist within a dynamically comparative hierarchical structure. Understanding this relativity of levels is the key to preventing us from falling into new mental rigidities.

1. The Essence of Levels: The Fractal Structure of the Tree of Cognition

Imagine a vast tree of cognition. Each of its leaves is a concrete Specific existence—for example, "my cat." When we group multiple leaves into a branch, we form a Relative General category—"domestic cat." And the branch on which "domestic cat" sits ("Felidae"), relative to the leaf, is General, but relative to a thicker trunk ("Mammal"), it becomes Specific.

This is the essence of cognitive levels: an infinitely nested fractal structure composed of the Relative General and the Relative Specific.

- In biology: "Animal" relative to "Mammal" is Relative General, while "Mammal" is Relative Specific. At the same time, "Mammal" relative to "Felidae" becomes Relative General, and "Felidae" is Relative Specific.
- In social science: "Civilization" relative to "Nation" is Relative General; "Nation" relative to "Community" is Relative General; and "Family" is Relative Specific within this chain.
- At the personal level: A physician's "professional knowledge system" is Relative General relative to their "knowledge of cardiology"; but placed within the larger framework of "modern medicine," it becomes Relative

Specific.

Every cognitive unit is simultaneously the "container" (Relative General) for its lower-level units and the "content" (Relative Specific) for its higher-level units. This perfectly illustrates a core tenet of systems theory: any system is both the "whole" of its constituent elements and a "part" of a larger system.

2. The Dynamic Game of Relativity: Perspective Determines

Position

Whether a category is General or Specific depends entirely on the cognitive coordinate system we choose. This relativity reveals the contextual nature of cognition.

Shifts in coordinate systems:

Within the coordinate system of "physics," "classical mechanics" and "quantum mechanics" are each Relative Specific with respect to "physics," which is the Relative General.

But within the coordinate system of "history of science," "classical mechanics" is a historical stage (Relative Specific) in the evolution of "modern physics," with the latter representing a more advanced and inclusive Relative General.

Upward Generalization in Intellectual Competition:

In the competition of ideas, a common strategy is to attempt to "generalize" one's own position, thereby bringing opponents into one's own framework and gaining interpretive authority. For example, when behavioral economics points out the limitations of the rational-actor assumption in traditional economics, it is attempting to construct a more Relative General analytical framework that includes "irrationality" as well, thereby rendering traditional theory a special case of the new framework.

3. The Practical Laws of Levels: Solving the Right Problem at

the Right Level

Understanding this hierarchical structure is by no means mere mental gymnastics; it carries crucial practical imperatives. The core is this: problems must be positioned and solved at the cognitive level that matches them.

Law of Precise Positioning: Solving the technical challenge of "heart valve surgery" (Relative Specific) and solving the institutional design of a "national health insurance system" (Relative General) require utterly different solutions, resources, and modes of thinking. Reducing a strategic problem to a technical one, or escalating a technical problem into an ideological dispute, is bound to fail. An "expert" who can only operate effectively at the Specific level, lacking the vision of General levels, will often produce solutions that trigger cascading disasters within the larger system.

Law of Breaking Binary Oppositions: Hierarchical thinking naturally rejects rigid "either-or" oppositions. When we advocate for "macro-level vision," we are by no means denying the importance of micro-level details; rather, we emphasize the need to grasp direction and identify connections at the Relative General level, while also knowing how to apply precise effort and ensure precise execution at the Relative Specific level. An outstanding leader or thinker must become a "cognitive hurdler" who can freely switch between General and Specific levels.

Law of Knowledge Construction: The entire edifice of human knowledge is built upon this hierarchical structure. Mastering a field of study means clarifying the evolutionary path of its concepts from Relative Specific to Relative General, whether in a tree-like or network-like manner. The edifice of physics from classical mechanics to quantum mechanics to cosmology, and the biological map from cell to tissue to organ to organism—all are manifestations of this law.

4. Echoes from Chinese Wisdom: The Hierarchical View of "Qiwu" (Equalizing Things)

The ancient Chinese philosophical classic Zhuangzi, in its chapter "Qiwu Lun" (Discourse on Equalizing Things), contains profound reflections on hierarchical relativity. It says: "There is nothing greater than the tip of an autumn hair, yet Mount Tai is small; there is nothing longer-lived than a child who dies young, yet Pengzu (the legendary long-lived figure) is deemed short-lived." Zhuangzi was not confusing right and wrong; he was revealing a profound truth: concepts such as bigness and smallness, long life and short life, all depend on the comparative framework (the coordinates of the Relative General) we choose. The tip of an autumn hair can be called "the greatest under heaven" within its own micro-world, while Mount Tai is but a drop in the ocean on a cosmic scale. This is the ultimate expression of the relativity of cognitive levels—the essence of "equalizing things" is to perceive the ontological equality of all things, each occupying its proper place and possessing its own nature within the infinite sequence of levels, rather than conflating them in value.

5. Toward the Absolute: The Ultimate Pursuit of Levels

Yet as we climb this ladder of relativity, an unavoidable logical question arises: Does this sequence of Relative General levels have a summit? Is there a final "container" that is no longer a "part" of any other category?

This question shifts our gaze from the fluid, comparative Relative General to the unique, unchanging Absolute General Sense. The Relative General and the Relative Specific constitute the infinite staircase by which we ascend the peak of cognition; and the Absolute General Sense is the summit of that peak, vanishing into the clouds—the ultimate destination and the final standard of judgment for all our cognitive efforts.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The Relative General and the Relative Specific reveal to us a dynamic, hierarchical picture of the cognitive universe.

They tell us: any concept has its determinate "General" or "Specific" attribute only within a specific comparative framework—the contextual nature of cognition determines the hierarchical position of any category.

They teach us: true wisdom does not lie in clinging to any particular "correct" level, but in clearly knowing which level one occupies, and in possessing the ability to move freely between levels. This is the core competence of the "cognitive hurdler," and also the shared direction of the "Law of Precise Positioning," the "Law of Breaking Binary Oppositions," and the "Law of Knowledge Construction."

And as we climb this infinite staircase upward, an unavoidable ultimate question emerges: Does this sequence of relativity have a summit? Does that ultimate container—which is no longer a "part" of any other category, yet contains all things—exist?

This question has already directed our gaze toward the summit veiled in the clouds—the Absolute General Sense. In the next section, it will be formally named the Absolute General Sense, and established as the ultimate coordinate and final destination of all cognition.

The Relative General and the Relative Specific are the infinite staircase by which we ascend the peak of cognition; and the Absolute General Sense is the summit of that peak—awaiting us at the end of the climb.

Section 3: The Absolute General Sense — The Ultimate Container of "The Universal"

Having clarified the dynamic cognitive hierarchy constituted by the Relative General and the Relative Specific, our thinking is naturally led to an ultimate question: Does this progressively ascending sequence of the Relative General have a summit? Is there an ultimate whole that is no longer a "part" of any other category, yet contains all things?

The answer is yes. We call it the Absolute General Sense. It is "The Universal."

1. Definition: That Beyond Which There Is Nothing, Within Which There Is Nothing Left Out

The Absolute General Sense refers to an ultimate framework beyond which there is nothing, and within which there is nothing excluded. It has no opposite, for it contains all being and all non-being, all actuality and all possibility, the known and the unknown, the material and the spiritual, phenomena and essence, the real and the virtual. It is the sum and the destination of all that is Relative General, the final background of all systems and all levels.

This definition entails two key characteristics:

- Logical completeness: Any attempt to subsume "The Universal" under a subset will fail, because that "subset" itself—including the very act and concept of the attempt—necessarily belongs to "The Universal." This self-referentiality ensures that it cannot be logically surpassed.
- Infinite openness in content: "The Universal" contains not only all existence in the present universe, but also logically entails all future and potential possibilities. Unknown planets, undiscovered elementary particles, art forms not yet conceived—even any form of existence we cannot presently

imagine—their very "possibility" is already within its framework.

2. Philosophical Resonances: The Eastern "Dao" and the Western "Substance"

This concept finds deep resonance in the core philosophical traditions of humanity.

- The "Dao" and "Tian" in Eastern wisdom: In Chinese Daoist thought, the "Dao" is the ultimate existence that "was born before Heaven and Earth" and is "the mother of all under Heaven." The Daodejing says: "Human beings follow Earth. Earth follows Tian. Tian follows the Dao. The Dao follows its own nature." The "nature" (ziran) here does not mean the natural world, but the state of "being so of itself." The Dao, as the ultimate source and ultimate law of all things, is precisely a profound expression of the Absolute General Sense. Similarly, in Confucian thought, "Tian" often does not refer to a personal deity, but rather to the natural law and ultimate background by which all things operate.
- The "Substance" and the "Absolute" in Western philosophy: Baruch Spinoza's concept of "Substance"—that which "is in itself and is conceived through itself"—is highly congruent with the framework of "The Universal." In G. W. F. Hegel's philosophical system, the "Absolute Spirit," as the ultimate subject that unfolds all dialectical movement, also points to an instance of the Absolute General Sense that contains all things.

3. "The Universal" as the Ultimate Coordinate of Cognition

Establishing "The Universal" as the framework of the Absolute General Sense provides us with a stable, unchanging ultimate cognitive coordinate—and this is its revolutionary value.

- Dissolving absolute centers: Within this framework, any claim that posits itself

as the "center of the universe" or the "sole purpose" no longer holds. Humanity is not the center; Earth is not the center; the Milky Way is not the center. We are but one node within the network of "The Universal." This fundamentally dismantles anthropocentrism and the ecological arrogance and civilizational hubris it engenders.

- Establishing ultimate connectedness: It compels us to recognize that all things, no matter how far apart or how dissimilar in form, conceptually reside within the single container of "The Universal." The gravity of a star, the metabolism of a cell, the spread of an idea, the ascendancy and collapse of a civilization—all are, in essence, capital interactions between different levels and different forms within "The Universal." This provides the most solid philosophical foundation for understanding systemic complexity.
- Providing the ultimate standard of judgment: The validity and rationality of any theory, any practice, any value system, lie not in its internal logical consistency, but in whether it harmonizes with the actual operational laws of "The Universal" in the Absolute General Sense. A system that contradicts the fundamental laws of universal operation, however successful it may appear in the short term, will ultimately collapse—just like a building that violates the principles of structural mechanics.

4. Corroborations from Science: From Cosmology to Information Theory

The development of modern science is continually approaching the framework of "The Universal" in its own way.

- "Totality" in cosmology: The object of study in modern cosmology has increasingly expanded from the observable universe to the logically possible totality of all universes (including hypotheses such as the multiverse). This "Totality" is conceptually equivalent to "The Universal."

- Information theory and virtual reality: Even if we assume that we live in a simulated universe, the "simulation platform" itself and the physical laws that run it are still contained within "The Universal." If our consciousness were digitized, the "virtual world" in which it exists would still run on physical servers within "The Universal." "The Universal" contains all that is real and all that is virtual.
- The "universal set" in mathematics: In set theory, discussing a universal set that contains all sets leads to logical difficulties (such as Russell's paradox). This precisely highlights the logical peculiarity of "The Universal"—it is an "ultimate container" that cannot be treated as an ordinary set.

5. The Awakening of Practical Significance: A Necessary Requirement for Civilizational Survival

Establishing the framework of "The Universal" is by no means a mere intellectual exercise; it is a necessary cognitive upgrade for civilization to survive and develop in the contemporary era.

- The necessary scale for addressing global challenges: Climate crises, pandemics, nuclear threats, and AI ethics are all quintessential "Universal-scale" problems. Their impacts transcend the boundaries of nations, ethnicities, and species; their solutions must be grounded in thinking and cooperation at the level of "The Universal." Seeking fundamental solutions to these problems within the framework of the "nation" (Relative Specific) is like carving a mark on a moving boat to find a lost sword—by the time you look, the boat has sailed far away.
- The ultimate context for examining technological development: Disruptive technologies such as gene editing, strong AI, and brain-computer interfaces will have consequences profound enough to reshape "humanity" itself and its place within "The Universal." The ethical and risk assessment of such

technologies must be conducted within the Absolute General Sense framework, examining the potential chain reactions they may trigger across the entire civilizational-ecological system.

- The ultimate basis for revaluing civilization: The value of a civilization lies not in how much material wealth it has accumulated or how much natural territory it has conquered, but in whether it has understood and aligned itself with the deep laws of "The Universal," and whether it has found, within the interactions of All-Things-as-Capital, a harmonious path that is sustainable, flourishing, and liberating.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

"The Universal," as the Absolute General Sense, is the first and most unshakable cornerstone upon which we build a new worldview and respond to civilizational crises. It is both our starting point and the ultimate destination of all our thinking. It reminds us that any arrogance that seeks to place itself above "The Universal" will ultimately be judged by the very laws of "The Universal." To acknowledge that we are part of "The Universal," and to consciously think and act on this premise, is the first and greatest mark of a civilization's maturity.

Now, holding the ultimate coordinate of the Absolute General Sense, we are able to look back and truly understand its decisive relationship with the countless "Specific" cognitions. This will be the crucial step toward the paradigm shift that lies ahead.

Section 4: The "Law of General-Sense Determinacy": The Theoretical Premise of Paradigm Shift

Through the discussions in the preceding three sections, we have clearly seen a picture of cognition: humanity moves up and down the hierarchy of the Relative General and the Relative Specific, while all of this is contained within the ultimate framework of the Absolute General Sense (The Universal). Now we must confront the most fundamental and most powerful law: the General framework possesses indisputable determinacy over Specific cognition. This law is the key to understanding all cognitive progress, especially scientific revolutions and social transformations.

1. The Essence of Determinacy: The Fundamental Law of Container and Content

The General framework determines the boundary of possibility, the scope of validity, and the ultimate fate of Specific cognition. The relationship is like that of container and content: the shape, size, and nature of the container fundamentally determine what it can hold and how its contents will exist within it.

Precondition and boundary: Any Specific theory, model, or body of knowledge is necessarily born from a cognitive background and presuppositions that are, explicitly or implicitly, more General. This General background is like the "operating system" of thought, limiting which "applications" (Specific cognitions) can be installed and run.

Typical example: The Ptolemaic geocentric system derived its validity and internal consistency entirely from the General cosmological presupposition that "Earth is the absolute stationary center of the universe" and that "celestial orbits are perfect circles." Within this "container," it could "reconcile itself" by adding increasingly

complex "epicycles," but its cognitive boundaries were already locked in by its presuppositions, preventing it from reaching the broader vision of heliocentrism.

Judgment and subversion: Whether a Specific theory is correct or valid is ultimately judged not by the sophistication of its internal logic, but by whether it conforms to the General reality at its corresponding level. When that General reality changes, or when our understanding of it leaps forward, the old Specific cognition will inevitably be overturned.

Typical example: Newtonian mechanics is perfectly valid under the General conditions of macroscopic, low-speed motion. Yet when the General framework of our cognition expands to realms approaching the speed of light or involving immense masses (the framework of relativity), or penetrates into the microscopic world of particles (the framework of quantum mechanics), it is recontextualized and ultimately fails outside its original boundaries. Its "correctness" is redefined by the new General framework.

2. Paradigm Shift: The Switching Mechanism of General Frameworks

This is precisely the essence of the "paradigm shift" revealed by the philosopher of science Thomas Kuhn. A paradigm is the entire set of General beliefs, values, techniques, and methods shared by a scientific community. It defines what questions are worth studying and what counts as a valid solution.

Normal science: Scientists engage in Specific "puzzle-solving" within the existing General paradigm (the container), continually refining and extending the current theory. Progress at this stage is linear and cumulative.

Anomaly and crisis: When new observational facts (Specific phenomena) can no longer be adequately contained by the old paradigm, and anomalies accumulate to a critical point, exposing the rupture of the old "container," the

scientific community falls into cognitive crisis.

Revolution and switch: The essence of scientific revolution is not the patching of some Specific theory, but the fundamental switching of General paradigms—from an old, narrow "container" to a new, broader one. From geocentrism to heliocentrism, from absolute space-time to relativistic space-time, from phlogiston theory to oxidation theory—all are the results of the switching of General containers.

Einstein's famous words—"We cannot solve our problems with the same thinking we used when we created them"—bear profound philosophical implications: we must ascend to a higher-level General framework in order to solve the Specific problems generated by the current framework, problems that are unsolvable within it.

The deep logic of paradigm shift can be understood in reverse through the concept of Framework Misalignment. A framework misalignment occurs when, within a Specific cognitive framework, we attempt to solve a problem that belongs to a more General framework. Examples: using national policy (Specific) to solve global climate change (General); using GDP growth (Specific) to measure social welfare (General); using monetary incentives (Specific) to respond to a crisis of meaning (General). The essence of a framework misalignment is using the wrong container for the right content. The content is right, but the container is too small to hold it. Every cognitive ascent is, in essence, the act of recognizing which framework misalignments we are making and proactively switching to a larger container.

3. The "Law of General-Sense Determinacy": A Universal Law from Cognition to Civilization

This law—that the General determines the Specific—we call the "Law of General-Sense Determinacy." It extends far beyond the purely scientific domain; it is a fundamental law governing the operation of the cognitive world and indeed of all human civilization.

At the technological level: The technological trajectory of internal combustion vehicles (Specific) was determined by the General energy environment in which "fossil fuels are easy to obtain and utilize." When recontextualized to include the intrinsic link between carbon emissions and the global climate system, the rise of electric vehicles and new energy technologies shifted from being an incomprehensible "heresy" to a historical inevitability.

At the economic level: A corporation's successful strategy (Specific) depends heavily on the General business environment—market cycles, technological waves, policies and regulations. When that environment changes, a once-successful strategy can become the root of failure. Kodak's film strategy was perfect within the General framework of "chemical imaging," but meaningless under the new General framework of "digital information."

At the social level: A society's legal system, morality, and customs (all Specific social constructs) are determined and sustained by the General realities of its time: the level of productive forces, the prevailing worldview, etc. When a leap in productive forces occurs (from agricultural society to industrial society to information society), the entire superstructure built upon the old General reality must undergo a transformative restructuring.

4. The Strategic Core of Competition and Survival

The "Law of General-Sense Determinacy" reveals its most brutal and most illuminating aspect in the domain of competition. In any complex system characterized by information asymmetry and resource competition, the party with the more General vision (that is, a cognitive framework closer to the Absolute General Sense) gains the strategic power to define reality, set rules, and shape the future.

From games to war: In League of Legends, a single well-placed ward (providing General vision) is worth far more than a top-tier attack item (enhancing Specific capability). On the real battlefield, from a sniper's scope to military

reconnaissance satellites, all technologies are essentially engaged in an "arms race of vision."

The ultimate dimension of civilizational competition: The competition of human civilizations is, in the final analysis, a competition in the breadth of cognitive frameworks. A civilization confined to the Specific perspective of "financial capital" cannot understand why ecological crises become internal pathologies of the economic system, nor can it respond to challenges posed by more General forms of capital such as "knowledge capital," "health capital," and "ecological capital." In the end, it will be surpassed or eliminated by civilizations that have mastered more General cognitive frameworks.

5. The Final Answer to the Predicament: Cognitive Ascension Is the Only Way Out

Returning to the civilizational predicament raised in the Guide to the Book, we find that the reason we have fallen into "cognitive lock-in" and "paradigm crisis" is precisely that the old Specific cognitions—the financial-capitalist paradigm centered on infinite growth, and the political paradigm with the nation-state as the absolute subject—have fatally diverged from the new General realities: the ecological reality of universal interconnection, global crises, and the emergence of digital space.

Therefore, the fundamental solution to the crisis does not lie in finer adjustments within the old paradigm, but in launching a conscious and thorough cognitive ascension. We must have the courage to break through the old Specific conceptual cages, ascend to a new cognitive framework closer to the Absolute General Sense of "The Universal," and re-examine the meaning of capital, value, civilization, and human existence itself.

This is precisely the historical mission that the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital and Contributionism are destined to accomplish. They are not simply one more proposal within an old container; rather, they are committed to providing us with an entirely

new, more General cognitive container itself.

The philosophical foundation of the Law of General-Sense Determinacy lies in this: every cognitive activity must take place within some "cognitive container." This container is not neutral; it presupposes what can be asked, what can be answered, what can be observed, and what is invisible. The reason Specific cognition cannot solve problems generated by the General framework is not a lack of effort, but that no matter how it moves within the same container, it can never reach the container's boundaries. Only by switching to a larger container can what was previously regarded as "anomalous" be reinterpreted as "normal." This is the very inevitability of "General-Sense Determinacy."

At this point, the Law of General-Sense Determinacy has received a complete demonstration—from "empirical observation" to the "transcendental conditions of cognitive structure." It is not only a law we can observe; it is also the precondition for our very ability to observe.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The General determines the Specific. This is the core meta-law by which we understand the evolution of the world, diagnose the ills of civilization, and explore the way forward. We see clearly: all cognition begins with the anchoring of the Specific, but its explanatory power and vitality forever depend on the breadth and depth of the General framework upon which it rests. True transformative progress never lies in fine-tuning within the old paradigm, but in the paradigm shift of the General cognitive framework—a fundamental "container switch."

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

The dialectical relationship between the General and the Specific is the most fundamental meta-tool for understanding the world, diagnosing crises, and finding a way out. We have recognized that all cognition begins with specification, but its

effectiveness and its fate are determined by the General framework in which it is situated. True progress comes from paradigm revolution—that is, the switching of the General framework. And "The Universal," as the Absolute General Sense, provides the ultimate coordinate and standard of judgment for all cognition.

At this point, we have completed the forging of the meta-tools for understanding the cognitive world. Next, we will apply these sharp tools to the core concept of modernity—"capital"—and embark on a profound ontological reset, thereby laying a solid foundation for the construction of a new civilization.

Chapter Two: Epistemology — The Cage of Cognitive Concepts

Guide to This Chapter

Having established the meta-tool of the General and the Specific, we now turn to an examination of cognition itself—that faculty which both illuminates the world and threatens to imprison it. This chapter plumbs the origins and development of cognition, revealing how concepts, once instruments of liberation, may harden into chains of confinement. Through a dual analysis of genetic inheritance and Spiritual Imprint, we shall uncover the biological roots of cognition and its modes of cultural transmission. By deconstructing the conceptual histories of "capital" and "civilization," we will expose how the Specification of Western concepts has engendered the crisis of modernity. Finally, we shall point the way beyond the conceptual cage—for true critique is not an outward accusation, but a thorough reflection upon, and transcendence of, one's own cognitive framework.

Further Reading

The deconstruction of human cognition undertaken in this chapter aims to render our limitations visible. Yet cognition is by no means a strictly human attribute. When we broaden our inquiry from "how humans cognize" to "why the universe requires cognition," we discover that the very birth of consciousness constitutes the primordial conscious act of all things striving toward self-transcendence within Exploitative Resonance. For a full elucidation of this proposition, see Appendix Two: Resonance Physics, particularly its concluding chapter, "The Birth of Consciousness: The Cry of All Things Itself."

Section One: The Origins of Cognition

Cognition—that wondrous faculty surpassing all others—has its origins embedded in two seemingly antithetical yet ultimately unified dimensions: the universality of biological evolution and the particularity of human consciousness. To comprehend the genesis of cognition is to trace our journey from the objective realm of "what is," through the subjective domain of "what we believe to be," and ultimately toward the civilizational transcendence embodied in the quest for "what ought to be."

1. The Biological Foundations of Cognition: From Stimulus Response to World Modeling

Cognition does not spring forth from a void; its most primordial form is anchored in the instinct for self-preservation inherent to all life.

Primordial Cognition of Life: Capital Interaction for Sustaining Existence

From the approach-avoidance behavior of single-celled organisms to the phototropism of plants, the most fundamental cognition of living beings manifests as the recognition of, and response to, their own survival capital (such as energy and safety). This pre-conscious "cognition" is the most direct expression of capital interaction among all things—a system's capacity to respond to changes in environmental capital that either benefit or threaten its existence. A bacterium's sensitivity to chemical gradients, a Venus flytrap's reaction to touch—both are manifestations of this primordial cognition.

The Emergence of Nervous Systems: The Construction of Internal Models

With the advent of nervous systems, cognition underwent a qualitative leap. Organisms were no longer merely reacting immediately to stimuli; they began to construct internal models of the world. The brain was no longer a passive "reactor" but became an active "simulator." It could predict the outcomes of different behaviors,

thereby making choices more conducive to survival and reproduction. A squirrel remembering the locations of its cached food, a fox anticipating the movements of its prey—both employ this form of cognition based on internal models.

The Breakthrough of Human Consciousness: The Birth of Reflexive Cognition

When the complexity of the brain reached a certain critical threshold, cognition achieved its second qualitative leap—the emergence of reflexive cognition. Humans not only know, but know that they know; not only construct models of the world, but can reflect upon the models themselves. We acquired the capacity to make ourselves the object of cognition, which enables us to question the origins of cognition, evaluate its reliability, and ultimately attempt to transcend its limitations.

2. The Dialectical Process of Cognition: From Specific

Experience to General Framework

Mao Zedong incisively observed in *On Contradiction*: "In the order of humanity's cognitive movement, understanding always progresses from knowing individual and particular things to gradually expanding to knowing general things. It always proceeds from knowing concrete things to gradually rising to abstract theory." This process is precisely the vivid embodiment of the General/Specific dialectical framework within epistemology.

From Particular to General: The Induction of Experience and the Formation of Paradigms

Both individual human cognition and collective knowledge accumulation follow the path from the specific (particular, concrete) to the relatively general (abstract, universal).

- At the individual level: A child, through touching flame (specific experience 1), hot water (specific experience 2), and other concrete things, eventually induces the abstract attribute of "hot" (a relatively general concept), and

further forms the judgment framework of "dangerous" (an even more general concept).

- At the collective level: Through concrete study of slave society, feudal society, and capitalist society (relatively specific formations), humanity gradually abstracts relatively general laws of social development concerning social structure, the exercise of power, and class contradiction.

From General to Particular: The Guidance of Theory and the Testing of Practice

However, the cognitive process is not unidirectional. "Once people have recognized this common essence, they use this common understanding as a guide to continue studying various concrete things that have not yet been studied or have not been studied in depth." This is the process of returning from the relatively general to the relatively specific.

- When we master classical mechanics (a relatively general framework), we use it to guide the design of bridges (specific practice).
- When we develop socialist theory (a relatively general framework), we use it to guide revolution and construction (specific practice).

The Ascending Spiral of Cognition: The Micro-Mechanism of Paradigm Revolutions

"Practice, knowledge, again practice, and again knowledge. This form repeats itself in endless cycles, and with each cycle the content of practice and knowledge rises to a higher level." This celebrated formulation from On Practice is the classic expression of cognition's ascending spiral.

Within the General/Specific framework, this process manifests as:

- Regular phase: Puzzle-solving activities conducted within an established general paradigm; accumulating knowledge and refining theory.
- Anomalous phase: New specific experiences (such as the perihelion precession of Mercury) cannot be explained by the old paradigm; a cognitive

crisis emerges.

- Revolutionary phase: A new, broader paradigm (such as relativity) is proposed, reinterpreting and accommodating all known specific phenomena, and relegating the old paradigm to the status of an approximation under specific conditions.
- New regular phase: New specific research begins within the new paradigm.

Humanity's evolving relationship with fire perfectly exemplifies this spiral: using fire (specific practice 1) → understanding fire's functions (relatively general cognition 1) → regulating the use of fire (new specific practice 2) → recognizing fire's dangers (broader general cognition 2) → employing fire in warfare (newer specific practice 3) → grasping fire's essential nature (more profound general cognition 3)...

3. The Seven Stages of Cognition: The Ladder from Chaos to Freedom

Based on the aforementioned dialectical process, we may describe the deepening of individual cognition as seven progressive stages:

Stage One: Absolute Chaos (Ignorance)

In a "pre-reflective" state, entirely dependent on external authority, lacking autonomous judgment. "Whatever others say, that is what one believes." The mind dwells within a given conceptual prison without awareness of its confinement.

Stage Two: Awakening Enlightenment (Knowing Very Little)

Beginning to realize the vastness of the ocean of knowledge and the limits of one's own understanding. Capable of preliminary right-wrong discernment, yet the criteria for judgment remain unstable, easily swayed between various viewpoints.

Stage Three: Systematic Construction (Knowing a Great Deal)

Through systematic study, one has mastered a relatively complete knowledge system

within a certain domain. Capable of discerning right from wrong in most matters, forming an initial autonomous judgment framework. Yet prone to falling into "the arrogance of knowledge," regarding one's existing framework as absolute truth.

Stage Four: Reflective Bewilderment (A New Ignorance)

Recognizing the infinitude of knowledge and the limitations of one's own framework. Though one "fully knows" the existing system, one is deeply aware of not knowing how to employ it creatively—in a hazy state of "knowing the what but not the why." This is the birth pangs preceding breakthrough.

Stage Five: Intuitive Grasp (Partial Application)

Capable of flexibly applying knowledge to solve practical problems to a certain degree, yet this application often "can be felt but not articulated"—it is "tacit knowledge" based on intuition and experience. One knows but cannot articulate; this is the critical transitional period from theory to practice.

Stage Six: Local Articulation (Proficient Application)

Capable of skillfully applying knowledge and offering explanations of one's domain of understanding. However, such explanations can typically only be comprehended by those with similar knowledge backgrounds; cross-paradigmatic communication remains elusive.

Stage Seven: The Realm of Freedom (Complete Mastery)

Achieving thorough integration of knowledge, capable of explaining complex problems in accessible language to people of diverse backgrounds. Not only knowing the that but also the why; not only mastering knowledge itself, but understanding the premises, boundaries, and developmental laws of its generation. Ultimately realizing the cognitive freedom of "following one's heart's desire without overstepping the bounds."

4. The Ultimate Dilemma of Cognition: The Net of Concepts and the Truth of Existence

Behind cognition's magnificent achievements lies a fundamental dilemma: we capture the world through a net of concepts, yet the structure of the net itself determines what we can capture.

Cognition is Construction, Not Reflection

Our cognition is never a passive mirror of the world, but an active process of construction. Through inherited cognitive structures (such as the intuitive forms of space and time) and acquired conceptual systems, we organize and interpret the chaos of sensory data. As Kant maintained, we legislate for nature.

The Paradox of Concepts: Liberation and Imprisonment

Concepts are humanity's great cognitive invention; they enable abstract thought, communication, and cultural transmission. Yet every concept, in illuminating one domain, necessarily occludes other possibilities. When we say "this is a table," we gain the convenience of communication, yet may overlook its infinite other attributes—as timber, as artwork, as a collection of molecules.

The Biological Limits of Cognition and Civilizational Transcendence

Our cognition is constrained by the sensory range of our biology (perceiving only specific wavelengths of light, particular frequencies of sound) and the information-processing capacity of the brain. We are, in essence, knowing the world through a "biological interface." However, humanity's distinctiveness lies in our capacity to continually transcend these biological limits through tools (from microscopes to radio telescopes) and technologies (from mathematics to computers), achieving the continuous elevation of cognition.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Cognition originates in the capital-interaction imperative of life's self-preservation, develops world-modeling capacities through the evolution of nervous systems, and ultimately sublimates into reflexive cognition in humanity. It follows the dialectical

spiral from the specific to the general and back again, traversing seven stages from chaos to freedom. Yet cognition's great achievements also forge its fundamental predicament: we know the world through a net of concepts, and this very net may become the most exquisite cage. Understanding the origins and essence of cognition is the first step toward breaking the conceptual cage. In the next section, we shall explore how this cognitive capacity is transmitted and evolved through the dual pathways of genes and culture within human civilization.

Section Two: Genetic Inheritance and Spiritual Imprint

Cognition is not conjured from the void; its carriers and its transmission rest upon twin channels: the biological channel of genetic inheritance and the cultural channel of spiritual imprint. Like the twin rails of civilizational advance, these two channels together bear humanity's great ascent from Absolute General Senseexistence of the animal kingdom to the particular existence of civilization.

1. Genetic Inheritance: The Intergenerational Transmission of Biological Capital

Genetic inheritance constitutes the biological bedrock of cognition—the most fundamental mode by which Capital is transmitted across generations within the domain of life.

Genes as Biological Capital

From the standpoint of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, the gene is an organism's most elemental biological Capital. It encodes the survival wisdom accumulated by a species over the immense arc of evolution, and it constitutes the foundational capability enabling an organism to sustain its existence and realize its functions.

- The inheritance of corporeal Capital—appearance, physique, susceptibility to congenital pathologies—establishes the material substrate of individual existence.
- The transmission of temperamental dispositions— affective style, emotional reactivity, risk proclivity—directly shapes an individual's cognitive orientation and decision-making processes.
- The delineation of cognitive potential—the fundamental architecture of cerebral neural networks, the velocity of information processing, the capacity of memory—circumscribes a biological space of possibility for cognitive

development.

- The Conservatism and Progressiveness of Genetic Inheritance
- Genetic inheritance manifests a profound dialectical character:
- Conservatism secures stability: through the exquisite fidelity of DNA replication, the relative constancy of species traits is safeguarded, furnishing a reliable biological platform for cognitive evolution.
- Variation engenders novelty: gene mutation, chromosomal recombination, and analogous phenomena supply the biological substrate for breakthrough advances in cognitive capacity. The prodigious expansion of the human cerebral cortex is itself the consequence of critical variations within the genetic sequence.

A Capital Perspective on Genetic Research

Modern genetic inquiry is, in essence, the decryption of life's most arcane capital codes. When we identify an association between a particular gene and a given cognitive faculty, we are discerning how distinct forms of biological Capital are converted into living cognitive power. Recent advances in epigenetics further reveal that environmental factors can "mark" genes through chemical modification, thereby modulating their expression—a profound interpenetration of environmental Capital and biological Capital.

2. Spiritual Imprint: The Transcendent Transmission of Civilizational Capital

If genetic inheritance embodies the universality of life, spiritual imprint discloses the singularity of humanity. Here lies the distinctive channel by which civilization transcends the constraints of biology.

Spiritual Imprint as Cultural Gene

Spiritual imprint denotes the deep internalization of civilizational achievements within individual and collective psychic structures—the transmission mechanism of cultural Capital. Through education, imitation, social praxis, and kindred means, it engraves onto the minds of successive generations the cognitive frameworks, value systems, and behavioral codes painstakingly accumulated over millennia.

- The embedding of linguistic structures: the grammatical architectures and lexical systems of diverse languages forge fundamentally divergent modes of thought in their speakers.
- The formation of moral intuition: a culture's fundamental judgments of good and evil, right and wrong, are internalized through childhood socialization until they become the individual's moral instinct.
- The bequest of thought paradigms: a civilization's characteristic cognitive modality—Western analytical thought, for instance, set against Eastern holistic thought—becomes the individual's "default" mode of cognition through cultural inheritance.

The Interplay of a Dual Inheritance System

Genes and spiritual imprint together form a dual inheritance system of co-evolution:

- Genes furnish the hardware: they supply the biological blueprint for brain development, fixing the "performance parameters" of the cognitive apparatus.
- Spiritual imprint installs the software: cultural transmission imbues this biological device with its particular "operating system" and "application programs."
- A cycle of mutual shaping: cultural selection pressures steer the course of genetic evolution (as in the spread of lactose tolerance); conversely, the cognitive proclivities encoded by genes influence the very contours of cultural formation.

From Slow Variables to Fast Variables: The Acceleration of Civilization

Against the sluggish tempo of genetic evolution, the transmission and renewal of spiritual imprint propel civilization into ever-accelerating advancement:

- The languor of genetic evolution: a favorable mutation demands hundreds of generations to diffuse through a population.
- The swiftness of cultural evolution: a great idea can transfigure a civilization's cognitive landscape in a matter of decades.
- The exponential growth of cognition: through the accumulation of spiritual imprints, each generation ascends upon the shoulders of its forebears, realizing the compound interest of cognitive Capital.

3. The Immortality of Great Spirits: The Transmission of Capital Beyond Biological Bounds

In the annals of human civilization, those great thinkers—whose biological lives have long since ceased—nonetheless attain eternal life through the channel of spiritual imprint, whereby their cognitive Capital endures across the ages.

The Unique Attributes of Spiritual Capital

Unlike biological Capital, spiritual Capital possesses distinctive properties of transmission:

- Non-exclusive inheritance: a single idea may be "inherited" by countless minds simultaneously, without the slightest diminution or wear.
- Accretive propagation: in the course of dissemination, ideas are perpetually reinterpreted, enriched, and developed, thereby realizing the self-augmentation of Capital.
- Trans-consanguineous transmission: the inheritance of spirit is wholly unconstrained by biological kinship, authentically fulfilling the ideal of "gathering the finest minds of the realm and educating them."

True Death and True Immortality

In this sense:

- True death is the utter obliteration of influence—the twofold erasure from the biological world and from cultural memory.
- True immortality is the perpetual presence of spirit—a life ceaselessly re-manifested in generation after generation of minds through spiritual imprint.

The great sages of antiquity "have not vanished; they remain ever beside us," for the very quintessence of their cognitive Capital has, through the channel of cultural genes, been transfused into the lifeblood of civilization.

Civilizational Sublimation: From the Particular to the Universal

Individual spiritual creations, through cultural transmission, are ultimately converted into Absolute General Sensepatrimony of civilization:

- The creation of particularity: great thinkers, grounded in their singular life experiences and cognitive endowments, forge revolutionary systems of thought.
- The internalization of universality: through education, the reading of classics, cultural praxis, and kindred channels, these ideas gradually become the shared spiritual Capital of the civilizational community.
- The sustained augmentation of Capital: each generation, while inheriting this spiritual Capital, simultaneously adds new value to it through its own understanding and practice.

4. The Paradox of Goodness: Civilization's Transcendence of and Return to Nature

The most profound content transmitted by spiritual imprint is none other than the idea

of Goodness. It is the greatest creation of human civilization, and the most fundamental transcendence of the laws of All-Things-as-Capital interaction.

In the pure interplay of All-Things-as-Capital, all is governed by a value-neutral law of force: the strong devour the weak, the great oppress the small. Yet the idea of Goodness—particularly such values as altruism, fairness and justice, compassion and empathy—finds no sufficient foundation within the bare logic of natural selection. It is the creative insurrection of the human spirit against the laws of nature.

The Civilizational Significance of the Dialectic of Good and Evil

The opposition of Good and Evil within the human spiritual world reflects a profound dialectic of civilization:

- The acknowledgment of Evil's universality: to soberly recognize the ubiquity of competition, exploitation, and oppression within All-Things-as-Capital interaction—this is a clear-eyed confrontation with natural reality.
- The affirmation of Goodness's particularity: to consciously cultivate and transmit the value orientations of cooperation, altruism, and care—this is civilization's transcendence of nature.
- The realization of the particular within the universal: not naively denying the existence of Evil, but upon the recognition of its universality, still choosing and steadfastly upholding the particular path of Goodness.

The Spiritual Realms of Self-Knowledge

Conscious awareness of the dual inheritance of genes and spirit gives rise to distinct levels of cognitive attainment:

- Sole love of self: remaining at the level of biological instinct, this is the direct expression of the universality of all things.
- Love extended to kin and friends: breaking through the confines of pure self-interest, this is the initial awakening of the particularity of human nature.

- Love of country and fellow human beings: extending care to ever larger communities, this is the realization of the idea of Goodness at the social level.
- Love extended to all things: attaining the realm of the unity of Tian and humanity, of "all people as siblings and all things as companions," this is the creative return of particular human nature to universal existence.

The Civilizational Mission of Cognitive Elevation

The development of individual cognition recapitulates the cognitive evolutionary history of human civilization:

- From gazing at the sky from the bottom of a well to parting the clouds to behold the sun: breaking through the confines of individual experience and parochial culture to attain a broader cognitive horizon.
- From a flat two-dimensional plane to a three-dimensional solidity: transcending the either/or binary of thought and mastering the cognitive method of dialectical unity.
- From passive inheritance to active creation: no longer content with receiving existing cognitive Capital, but contributing new riches to the cognitive treasury of civilization.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Genetic inheritance and spiritual imprint constitute the twin tracks of human cognitive development. Genes provide the biological foundation of cognition, maintaining a profound connection with the universality of all things; spiritual imprint bears the accumulation and transcendence of civilization, manifesting the glorious achievements of the particularity of human nature.

True civilizational progress lies in acknowledging the biological constraints set by genes while, through the channel of spiritual imprint, continuously transmitting and enriching those values that creatively rebel against the laws of nature—above all, the

idea of Goodness. This is precisely the cognitive foundation upon which humanity advances from the realm of necessity to the realm of freedom.

In the next section, we shall examine how this process of cognitive transmission, under specific historical conditions, undergoes alienation—resulting in core concepts such as "Capital" and "civilization" being imprisoned within the narrow cages of definition.

Section Three: On the Narrowing and General Liberation of "Capital" and "Civilization"

Concepts are simultaneously the instruments of cognition and its potential prison. "Capital" and "Civilization"—the two axial concepts that have molded the modern world-picture—are at present enduring a profound semantic alienation. Once vital in their expansive comprehensiveness, they have been compressed into parochial definitions in service of particular historical narratives. The dissection and transcendence of this process marks a pivotal moment in the liberation of cognition.

1. Conceptual Archaeology: The Fundamental Divergence of Semantic Fields between East and West

The Semantic Genealogy of "Capital"

In the Western context, "capital" underwent a process of semantic contraction—from "head" and "livestock" to "principal sum bearing interest." From the sixteenth century onward, it was firmly anchored within the domain of socioeconomic relations, becoming the proprietary term of the capitalist order. Marx's classical formulation—"capital is not a thing but a social relation"—though profoundly exposing its social essence, nonetheless theoretically circumscribed it within frontiers that proved exceedingly difficult to surpass.

The Chinese context, by contrast, has preserved a far richer architecture of meaning:

- Etymological origins: "资" (zī) derives from the shell-money radical, signifying resources and acquisition; "本" (běn) derives from the tree radical, emphasizing root and core. The compound thus intrinsically harbors the dual connotation of "accumulation of resources + core competitiveness."
- Lived wisdom: in quotidian speech, the challenge "what capital do you have?" (你有什么资本) denotes personal ability, social connections, physical

health—one's comprehensive capabilities—extending far beyond the mere category of money.

- Philosophical potential: this expansive understanding provides the linguistic groundwork for redefining Capital as "the fundamental capability of existence."

The Opposition of Civilizational Metrics

Since the Enlightenment, the Western concept of civilization has been increasingly tethered to external indicators—technological achievement, institutional complexity, military might—thereby becoming an instrument of hierarchical narrative. The "civilizing mission" of the colonial era went further, converting this metric into a justification for cultural hegemony.

The Chinese conception of civilization (文明) evinces a markedly different value orientation:

- The primacy of inner order: The Book of Changes declares, "A dragon appears in the field; all under Tian attain civility" (见龙在田，天下文明), depicting a radiant order that emerges naturally from the manifestation of virtue. The crux resides in "the transformative power of cultural-moral cultivation" (文德教化), not technological conquest.
- Ethical judgment as foundation: in everyday discourse, "uncivilized behavior" (不文明行为) indicates moral deficiency and a lack of public virtue—not technological backwardness.
- The ideal of harmonious symbiosis: the Confucian tradition of "the unity of Tian and humanity" and the Daoist principle that "Dao follows its own nature" conceive civilization as an organic constituent within the grand system of cosmic life.

2. Conceptual Colonization: The Epistemological Roots of the

Modernity Crisis

The Disciplinary Conditioning of Concepts through Education

Through the combined forces of textbooks, academic conventions, and media discourse, the narrow Western definitions have been elevated to the singular standard of "scientificity" and "objectivity." The rich semantic strata of the Chinese context are dismissed as "imprecise" or "pre-scientific" folk wisdom, engendering cultural aphasia and cognitive impoverishment.

The Systematic Production of Cognitive Blind Spots

The narrowing of concepts has generated three profound epistemological blind spots:

- The one-sided comprehension of social exploitation: reducing exploitation to labor–capital relations within the economic sphere, thereby occluding the broader modes of exploitation operative in culture, knowledge, gender, and other domains.
- The occlusion of the roots of ecological crisis: defining nature as an "externality" devoid of intrinsic value, thereby rendering ecological overshoot theoretically invisible.
- The unilinear orientation of developmental paths: equating modernization with Westernization, thereby suffocating the imaginative capacity of civilizations to forge their own developmental trajectories.

The Self-Perpetuating Cognitive Impasse

We find ourselves ensnared in a profound paradox: endeavoring to resolve problems engendered by the narrowness of concepts using schemes built upon those very concepts. Addressing the crises of growth with further growth, mitigating the risks of technology with ever more potent technological control—this is nothing less than allaying thirst with poison.

3. Conceptual Liberation: Toward the Philosophical Reconstruction of the Absolute General Sense

The Return to the Semantic Richness of the Lifeworld

The first step toward conceptual liberation is the rediscovery and revaluation of those broad understandings that yet survive in everyday life. When we say "the body is the capital of revolution" (身体是革命的本钱), we are already enacting a conception of Capital that transcends economism. When we deem a society "highly civilized," we are instinctively deploying an ethical measure.

The Ontological Revolution of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital

Grounded in the broad semantic genes of the Chinese context, we herewith propose the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital as an ontological reconstruction:

- The redefinition of existence: understanding Capital as the fundamental capability of any system to sustain and develop its existence. Every existent is a capital entity; to exist is to possess Capital; Capital is capability.
- The universality of interactive laws: the interaction and equilibration of All-Things-as-Capital constitutes a fundamental law of the cosmos, governing everything from quantum entanglement to the rise and fall of civilizations.
- A unified framework of understanding: furnishing a common ontological foundation for the natural sciences, social sciences, and humanities.

Herewith we complete the ontological core definition of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. As an epistemological definition, its task is to shatter the old conceptual cages and to lay the cornerstone of a new philosophy. In the chapters that follow, we shall unfold—upon this foundation—a comprehensive exploration of the static essence and dynamic evolution of All-Things-as-Capital. Whenever the reader encounters "the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital" in subsequent chapters, its content is anchored precisely herein.

The Ethical Return of the Concept of Civilization

Against the vast backdrop of All-Things-as-Capital, civilization must be redefined as: the capacity and achievement of a community of life—proceeding from its recognition of the laws of All-Things-as-Capital interaction—to employ conscious agency in constructing an order of existence characterized by diminished suffering and enhanced well-being. True civilization is the unity of moral elevation and technological accomplishment—the correspondence of name and substance (名实相符).

The same logic applies not only to "Capital" and "Civilization," but to every concept that has been seized and shackled by the old framework. In the quotidian discourse of the old world, countless concepts emerged with benevolent intentions, only to be commandeered and narrowed in their operation under the old paradigm. "Digital economy," "endogenous circulation," "unified national market," "high-quality development"—under the old framework, these concepts are construed as "more efficient instruments of Capital accumulation" or "more optimal means of resource allocation." Yet their true potential can be unleashed only within the new framework of Contributionism—not as an upgraded version of "Capital," but as a modality for the realization of "Contribution."

Language under the old framework is a voice trapped in a cage. The cage is not the fault of language itself; it merely constrains its amplitude. When we exchange the framework, these voices suddenly become clear and resonant—as if they had been awaiting an exit all along. The ultimate aim of conceptual liberation is not to discard the old language, but to discover, for every imprisoned utterance, its true locus of resonance.

4. The Re-Enlightenment of Enlightenment: The Historical Significance of Conceptual Liberation

The Critical Inheritance of Historical Enlightenment

The eighteenth-century European Enlightenment shattered the theological cage, only to forge new shackles of anthropocentrism. The May Fourth New Culture Movement introduced "Mr. Democracy" and "Mr. Science," yet in the desperate urgency of national salvation, impoverished their rich content through simplification. The conceptual liberation of today constitutes the "re-enlightenment" of these very historical enlightenments.

The Civilizational Necessity of Cognitive Elevation

In the epoch of the Anthropocene, the narrowing of concepts is no longer a merely theoretical problem but an existential threat. Only through the leap of cognitive frameworks from the Specific Sense to the Absolute General Sense can we attain the vision and wisdom requisite to confronting crises of mounting complexity.

A New Foundation for Civilizational Dialogue

The liberation of concepts creates the conditions for authentic cross-civilizational dialogue. When we comprehend "Capital" as the capability of existence rather than mere money, and define "civilization" as ethical order rather than technological superiority, the wisdom embedded in divergent cultural traditions can illumine one another on equal footing—collectively contributing to the resolution of humanity's shared predicaments.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The conceptual cages of "Capital" and "Civilization" are the concentrated manifestation—at the epistemological level—of the predicament of modernity. To shatter these cages, we must undertake audacious philosophical reconstruction even as we critique conceptual colonization. The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is not a simple return to tradition, but a dialectical synthesis of Eastern and Western wisdom on a higher plane. This project of conceptual liberation is the necessary passage of civilization toward maturity—and the historical opportunity for humanity to reorient itself within the interactive network of All-Things-as-Capital.

In the next section, we shall examine what dimensional elevation thought itself will undergo within this new cognitive framework.

Section Four: Cognitive Thought — Dimensions of the Broad and Narrow Sense

The caliber of cognitive thought directly governs the depth and breadth with which we comprehend the world and confront its exigencies. Within the dialectical framework of the General and the Specific, thought itself unfolds across a striking dimensional spectrum. From the passive receptivity of the zero dimension to the creative integration of higher dimensions, every ascent in dimensionality constitutes a qualitative leap in cognitive power.

1. The Spectrum of Cognitive Dimensions: The Evolution of Thought from Closure to Openness

Zero-Dimensional Thought: The Absolute Fixation of the Point

Here cognition abides in its most primordial state—thought imprisoned within an absolute fixation, impervious to the influx of new information or correction.

- Characteristics: an either/or binary, the elevation of a solitary viewpoint to absolute truth, and a conspicuous absence of reflective or skeptical capacity.
- Manifestations: fundamentalism, extremism, blind veneration—the sanctification and eternalization of particular conclusions.
- Cognitive state: thought dwelling in "absolute chaos," wholly immured within the given conceptual cage.

One-Dimensional Thought: The Unidirectional Extension of the Line

Thought acquires directionality, yet advances only along a single linear axis, bereft of the capacity for multi-perspectival examination.

- Characteristics: linear causal reasoning, naive reductionism, the ascription of complex phenomena to a solitary cause.
- Manifestations: monistic explanatory models—technological determinism,

economic determinism—that disregard systemic complexity and multifactorial interaction.

- Cognitive state: akin to the stage of "awakening enlightenment"—order begins to emerge, yet the horizon remains confined.

Two-Dimensional Thought: The Planar Expansion of the Surface

Thought now gains breadth, processing multiple factors upon a single plane, yet lacking vertical depth and transcendence.

- Characteristics: multifactorial analysis, planar comparison, and an initial recognition of complexity without any grasp of hierarchical structure.
- Manifestations: reliance on instruments such as simple cost–benefit analysis or SWOT analysis—one perceives many aspects, yet fails to apprehend their ordering and interrelation.
- Cognitive state: attainment of the stage of "systematic construction"—a relatively complete edifice of knowledge is erected, but reflective depth remains wanting.

Three-Dimensional Thought: The Volumetric Construction of the Solid

Thought achieves the leap from plane to solid, grasping breadth, depth, and altitude simultaneously, comprehending the hierarchical architecture of systems and their dynamic transformations.

- Characteristics: systemic thinking, hierarchical cognition, and the capacity for dialectical synthesis—maintaining unity within contradiction.
- Manifestations: mastery of the dialectic between the broad and the narrow sense, apprehension of the mechanics of paradigm revolution, and navigation of complex systems with consummate ease.
- Cognitive state: entry into the stages of "reflective bewilderment" and "intuitive grasp"—a dawning recognition of the infinitude of knowledge and

the limitations of one's own framework.

2. The Mechanism of Dimensional Ascent: The Reconstruction of Cognitive Frameworks

The Dimensional Abyss: From Ant to Human

An ant perceives only chemical signals upon a two-dimensional plane and an extremely restricted range of three-dimensional spatial information; it cannot comprehend the complex concepts of the human world. This same dimensional abyss separates individuals of differing cognitive levels: those who think in lower dimensions cannot grasp the vision and judgment of their higher-dimensional counterparts, and often misapprehend their conduct as one who "gazes at the sky from the bottom of a well."

Three Pathways of Cognitive Elevation

- Conceptual liberation: shattering the confines of constrictive definitions, restoring to concepts their expansive vitality—as when "Capital" is liberated from a purely economic category into "the fundamental capability of existence."
- Framework switching: deliberately displacing one cognitive framework in favor of another, ascending from the relatively narrow to the relatively broad—as from the Newtonian framework of mechanics to that of relativity.
- Paradigm revolution: effecting a fundamental transformation of the cognitive paradigm itself—as from anthropocentrism to the ecological paradigm of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital.

Practical Indications of Dimensional Ascent

The ascent of cognitive dimensionality manifests in practice as a triple movement:

- From problem-solving to problem-redefinition: lower-dimensional thought

seeks answers within a given problem-framework; higher-dimensional thought first interrogates the premises and boundaries of the problem itself.

- From linear extrapolation to systemic foresight: lower-dimensional thought projects along a straight line; higher-dimensional thought anticipates through comprehension of systemic dynamics.
- From passive adaptation to active creation: lower-dimensional thought conforms to existing rules; higher-dimensional thought participates in the reconstruction and re-creation of those rules.

3. The Construction of the Cognitive World: The Spiderweb

Model from Fragments to Whole

The Weaving of the Cognitive Network

Each person's cognitive world is a "spiderweb" woven by one's own hand; its quality is determined by the breadth, density, and resilience of the mesh.

- The richness of nodes: the quantity and diversity of knowledge—the foundation of the cognitive network.
- The density of connections: the degree of association among disparate knowledge domains—determining the integrative capacity of cognition.
- The layering of structure: the dimensional level of cognition—higher-dimensional cognition possesses a distinctly multi-tiered architecture.

Attributes of a Complete Cognitive World

A relatively complete cognitive world should exhibit:

- Comprehensive coverage: a foundational acquaintance with all major domains—nature, society, the humanities, and technology.

- Deep-level interconnection: the capacity to discern intrinsic relationships across fields, achieving a fluent fusion and interpenetration of knowledge.
- Dynamic updatability: sustained cognitive openness—the power to revise and refine the cognitive network in response to new experience and theory.

The Functional Realization of the Cognitive World

When the cognitive network attains sufficient completeness, the individual acquires the capacity "to perceive the All from the One, and the New from the All":

- Local perception, global response: any new information finds its proper place within the cognitive network, triggering holistic systemic reflection.
- Cross-domain inspiration: knowledge from disparate fields collides within the network, giving rise to creative new insights.
- Systemic risk early-warning: the capacity to foresee the chain reactions a single event may unleash, discerning systemic risks before they mature.

4. The Civilizational Significance of Cognitive Dimensionality: From Individual Awakening to Collective Elevation

The Social Value of Individual Cognitive Dimensionality

An individual's cognitive dimension directly governs the level of their social contribution:

- Lower-dimensional thinkers: suited to executing standardized tasks, yet ill-equipped for complex challenges.
- Mid-dimensional thinkers: capable of resolving intricate problems within specialized domains—the vanguard of technological innovation. Yet specialization often constrains macroscopic cognitive vision, engendering cognitive traps within the very domain of expertise.

- Higher-dimensional thinkers: endowed with paradigmatic creative capacity, capable of furnishing directional guidance for the advancement of civilization.

The Civilizational Constraints of Collective Cognitive Dimensionality

The destiny of a civilization is, to a very large degree, determined by its collective cognitive dimension:

- Periods of civilizational stasis: collective cognition remains locked at a particular dimension, unable to transcend the shackles of the old paradigm.
- Periods of civilizational ascent: a critical mass of individuals achieves cognitive elevation, propelling the entire civilization through a paradigm shift.
- Periods of civilizational decline: cognitive dimensionality regresses—the civilization can no longer grapple with the novel complexities that confront it.

The Urgency of Cognitive Elevation in Our Age

In the epoch of the Anthropocene, human civilization confronts an unprecedented crisis of complexity:

- The globality of problems: climate change, pandemics, financial crises—all demand systemic solutions on a planetary scale.
- The irreversibility of impacts: nuclear weapons, gene editing, superintelligent AI—these technologies portend consequences that may prove irreversible.
- The urgency of response: once certain tipping points are breached, cascading effects are unleashed, and the time remaining to humanity is finite.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The dimensionality of cognitive thought determines the level at which we comprehend the world and confront its problems. From the absolute fixation of the zero dimension to the volumetric construction of the third, every ascent in dimensionality represents a qualitative leap in cognitive power. In an age of universal

interconnection, the elevation of individual cognition concerns not merely personal development but the very fate of civilization itself. Only by achieving the passage from specific-sense thought to general-sense thought can we acquire the wisdom and vision necessary to confront the complexities that beset us.

In the final section, we shall explore an indispensable moment within this ascent of cognitive dimensionality: critique—and critique as the very essence of self-reflection.

Section Five: Critique — Not What It Seems

Having systematically investigated the origins of cognition, its mechanisms of transmission, the alienation of concepts, and the dimensionality of thought, we now arrive at the culminating juncture of epistemological inquiry: critique. Yet the "critique" invoked here is by no means the external indictment or negation of ordinary understanding. It is rather a profound self-reflection—a deliberate inquiry by the cognitive subject into, and transcendence of, its own conceptual framework. True critique is the master key to shattering the cages of concepts, and the immanent dynamic whereby cognition ascends in a spiral.

1. The Essence of Critique: A Philosophical Turn from Outward Accusation to Inward Reflection

The Limitations of Vulgar Critique

Critique in its customary acceptance is typically leveled at external objects—other persons, society, or tradition. However correct such outward critique may be in part, it flounders upon a fundamental paradox: the critic deploys the very logic that engendered the problem in order to censure the problem. When one critiques the ills of capitalism using the values of capitalism, or when one critiques Western hegemony from a Western-centric standpoint, such critique remains fundamentally deficient—and may even, unwittingly, reinforce the very object it seeks to condemn.

The Revolutionary Significance of Kantian Critique

The concept of critique in Kantian philosophy opens an alternative avenue. Kant's three Critiques are not refutations of any particular doctrine, but rather an interrogation of the limits of human cognitive capacity itself. The crux is this: before knowing the object, scrutinize the knowing faculty; before asserting truth, interrogate the warrant for that assertion. This is the deeper signification of critique—a

preliminary self-scrutiny that precedes all knowledge.

Critique as Self-Reflection

In our discursive system, the essence of critique undergoes a further deepening, namely: a thoroughgoing reflection upon the cognitive subject's own framework of thought, its implicit valuations, and its conceptual apparatus. This critique requires that we confront with courage the deepest commitments and limitations inscribed within our own noetic edifice—acknowledging and scrutinizing those premises that we rely upon for thinking yet habitually leave in obscurity.

2. The Dialectic of Critique: The Spiral of Affirmation, Negation, and Transcendence

The Necessity of Self-Affirmation

Critique commences not with negation but with profound self-affirmation—principally, an honest acknowledgment and facing of one's own actual condition, including those "shadowed aspects" one might prefer to disavow. From the perspective of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, this means first acknowledging that we ourselves are "Capital" in existence, ineluctably participant in Absolute General Senselaw of Capital interaction—including its logic of competition, exploitation, and oppression. To deny this in bad faith is to forfeit the very ground of critical truth.

The Creativity of Self-Negation

Upon the foundation of this complete affirmation, critique ascends to the stage of self-negation. This is not sheer abandonment or annihilation, but rather an active surpassing of boundaries through recognition of the limits intrinsic to one's existing cognitive framework. In Hegel's phrase, "negativity is the self-negation of the self"—arising not from external destruction, but from an immanent drive toward transcendence.

The Sublimation of Self-Transcendence

The ultimate aim of critique is reaffirmation at a higher plane. Having traversed the negation of the negation, we do not simply return to the point of departure, but effect a sublimation of cognition. We acknowledge Absolute General Senselaw of Capital interaction, and upon that foundation establish a conscious mastery over it; we accept the necessary narrowing of concepts, yet retain a lucid awareness of, and capacity to transcend, the conceptual cage.

3. The Touchstone of Critique: Self-Examination and Institutional Tracing within Familial Conflict

The most authentic and most agonizing proving ground for theoretical critique lies precisely within our most intimate daily relationships—above all, in our conflicts with our parents. Such conflicts constitute the "touchstone" that assays the purity of our critical spirit.

The Surface of Conflict: Cognitive Generational Gaps and Emotional Friction

Our conflicts with our parents appear immediately as clashes of cognitive perspectives (different understandings of career, marriage, consumption) and collisions of register (their "nagging," our "talking back"). Vulgar critique would direct its accusation outward—condemning parental "conservatism," "incomprehension," or "need for control." Yet true critique demands first that we turn the weapon inward: Is our manner of communication saturated with an impatience born of intellectual hubris? Are we deploying the new era's "correctness" to unsparingly negate the accumulated experience of their lifetimes? We yearn to be understood—but have we ever truly understood their fears and their hopes?

The Middle Layer: Habits of Behavior and the Alienation of Relationship

When the critical gaze descends deeper, we discern that these particular clashes of viewpoint and register originate in automatized behavioral habits sedimented over

long years. We are habituated to rapid digital expression; they rely upon meticulous face-to-face attentiveness. We pursue the actualization of individual value; they cleave to family-centered devotion. In themselves, these habits bear no absolute rightness or wrongness, yet unexamined, they harden into fixed programs that generate friction. Critique at this stratum is to reflect upon how our own cultivated habits may inadvertently wound those we cherish—and to recognize that the other's habits are equally imprints of their life's journey.

The Deep Layer: The Shaping and Elicitation of Social Institutions

Yet the most profound critique demands that we traverse the plane of personal responsibility and penetrate to the macrocosmic roots beneath microcosmic friction. The vast divergence in behavioral habits and cognitive architectures between our parents' generation and our own is no accident—it is systematically shaped and elicited by distinct social institutions and developmental stages.

- The frugality of the parental generation and their anxiety over material security are the Capital-imprints etched upon mind and body by an era of scarcity.
- Their attachment to state units and permanent posts is the internalized survival logic of a planned economy.
- Our pursuit of individuality, freedom, and experience is deeply inscribed by the market economy and consumerism.
- The omnipresent competitive pressure and efficiency-first principle of contemporary society ceaselessly provoke anxiety, haste, and irritability in all—rendering gentle communication and patient companionship a luxury.

Thus, the essence of familial conflict is the collision of Capital-logics from disparate epochs within the microcosmic domain of the family—a "compatibility conflict" between an older societal operating system and a newer one, manifesting across generations.

The Terminal Direction of Critique: Transcendence and Reconstruction

To recognize this is to consummate critique's ultimate ascent: individual self-reflection logically advances to an examination of the social institutions and civilizational paradigms that shape us all. Our conflicted relationship with our parents is a microcosm revealing how, under the capitalist paradigm, even the most intimate human bonds are inevitably reified, subordinated to efficiency, and alienated.

Consequently, the conclusion of critique is no longer confined to the improvement of communication skills within the household, but rather the profound realization: only by transcending the cognitive cage constructed by capitalist thought—and by building a wholly new social order upon the new cognitive framework of Contributionism, especially an economic foundation and evaluative system whose core is the "contribution value"—can we fundamentally transform the deep logic that drives our behavior. When a society no longer chiefly rewards competition, possession, and exclusionary comparison, but instead rewards care, sharing, and creative contribution, then the "habits" internalized within our minds and bodies will undergo a fundamental transformation. Only then may intergenerational relations—indeed, all human relationships—return from the battlefield of Capital to the sanctuary of affection.

4. The Practice of Critique: From Conceptual Liberation to Paradigm Revolution

Critique of Critique Itself

The most profound critique is the critique of the concept of "critique" itself. In the Chinese linguistic context, the term "批判" (pīpàn) possesses richly layered semantics: "批" (pī) denotes annotation and commentary—bearing a constructive engagement; "判" (pàn) denotes judgment and discernment—emphasizing rational scrutiny. This semantic richness affords a linguistic foundation for transcending the adversarial propensities latent in the Western critical tradition.

Critique as an Instrument of Conceptual Liberation

At the practical level, critique first manifests as a liberating interrogation of established concepts:

- Disclosing the genealogy of conceptual constriction: tracing how "Capital" was narrowed from the broad sense of "root of capability" into a purely economic category.
- Restoring to concepts their expansive vitality: enabling them once more to interpret complex realities—as when "civilization" is reconnected with ethical order.
- Creating new conceptual instruments: on the basis of a deep comprehension of conceptual limitation, forging more inclusive frameworks such as the "Theory of All-Things-as-Capital."

Critique as the Prelude to Paradigm Revolution

In Kuhn's account of scientific revolutions, the precondition is precisely the accumulation of discontent with the incumbent paradigm and the consolidation of critical consciousness within the scientific community. Such critique is not the negation of particular theories, but a comprehensive reflection upon the presuppositions, methods, and standards of the entire research paradigm. In this sense, critique is the indispensable preparation for paradigm revolution—the pivotal juncture of cognitive ascent.

5. The Ethics of Critique: From Adversarial Debate to Constructive Dialogue

The Transformation of the Critical Attitude

Genuine critique requires a fundamental transformation of attitude:

- From conquest to understanding: no longer seeking to "vanquish" the other

through critique, but arriving thereby at a deeper comprehension.

- From opposition to inclusion: while maintaining one's ground, embracing and comprehending divergent perspectives.
- From destruction to construction: the ultimate purpose of critique is to erect a more refined cognitive framework, not to raze existing standpoints.

The Building of a Critical Community

Critique should not be an isolated individual act, but a collective communal praxis:

- Creating safe critical spaces: establishing dialogical environments capable of accommodating heterodox perspectives and fostering reflection.
- Cultivating critical friendship: engaging in candid and profound intellectual exchange upon a foundation of mutual esteem.
- Constructing a critical tradition: rendering critique an organic component of cultural transmission rather than an incidental individual act.

The Wisdom of Mature Critique

Critique in its ripest stage evinces a distinctive wisdom:

- Firm gentleness: while adhering to principle, sustaining respect and understanding toward the object of critique.
- Confident humility: while assured of one's own position, acknowledging the finitude and fallibility of cognition.
- Active patience: while pursuing truth with urgency, comprehending the gradual and intricate nature of intellectual transformation.

6. The Ultimate Significance of Critique: The Achievement of Cognitive Freedom

From Conceptual Cage to Cognitive Freedom

The ultimate end of critique is nothing less than thorough emancipation from the conceptual cage—the achievement of cognitive freedom. This freedom is not the license to do as one pleases, but the comprehension and transcendence of cognitive necessity: understanding the genesis of concepts, penetrating the operative laws of thought, and mastering the path of cognitive ascent.

Critique as the Engine of Civilizational Progress

On the scale of civilizations, critical capacity directly determines a civilization's vitality and resilience:

- A civilization deficient in critique: lapses into cognitive stagnation, incapable of meeting novel environmental challenges.
- A civilization excessive in critique: risks devolving into nihilism, forfeiting cultural continuity and identity.
- A civilization balanced in critique: perpetually renews and transcends itself while preserving its cultural core.

The Life-Stage of the True Critic

For the individual, the true critic attains a singular life-stage:

- Profound autonomy: no longer accepting blindly any external authority—including one's own erstwhile convictions.
- Sustained growth: internalizing critique as a mode of living, discovering meaning in ceaseless self-transcendence.
- Expansive inclusivity: comprehending and revering diverse modes of cognition, seeking unity in multiplicity.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

This section has consummated the ultimate vindication of critique. True critique is not external indictment, but thoroughgoing reflection upon—and transcendence of—one's

own cognitive framework. It is the immanent dynamic by which we shatter the cages of concepts and attain cognitive elevation. This critical spirit is precisely the philosophical precondition for the emergence of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, and the epistemological cornerstone upon which the civilization of Contributionism may be erected.

Section Six: The Limits of Theory — Existence Precedes Explanation (On the Dialectical Relation Between "Interpretation" and "Change")

Guide to This Chapter

Section Five consummated the vindication of critique. Yet true critique is not outward accusation, but reflection upon one's own cognitive framework. But where does reflection end? In a more refined framework? No. Reflection terminates in the recognition of the boundaries of all frameworks—and the courage to halt at that boundary, acknowledging that beyond the framework, existence continues. This is the task of Section Six: it no longer "argues" anything, but performs a "retreat"—a withdrawal from the elegance of argumentation, back to what was already there before the argument began.

Marx wrote in his Theses on Feuerbach: "The philosophers have only interpreted the world in various ways; the point, however, is to change it." The profundity of this statement is frequently misconstrued as "theory is useless, practice is supreme." But Marx's meaning was not to negate theory. Rather, it was a reminder: the legitimacy of theory never derives from theory itself, but from whether it can respond to the summons of existence.

This section is the "meta-commentary" of the entire work. It explains what this book is doing, and what this book cannot do. Here we accomplish a positioning of "theory" itself. First, we contend that existence does not depend upon theory for its being; second, we examine how theory is a narrowing translation of existence, not existence itself; third, we extend the cognitive framework from the human-centric to the scale of all things; and finally, we arrive at a practical conclusion: changing the world requires no theoretical authorization, but theory can alter the velocity at which the world becomes conscious of change.

1. Existence Does Not Depend upon Theory for Its Being

This is the first proposition of this section, and the most fundamental.

The celestial lights above had already been resplendent for billions of years before humanity invented "universal gravitation." Our hearts had already been beating for millions of years before the first anatomical treatise was written. A blossom had already unfurled before botany conferred upon it a name. A civilization had already witnessed individuals choosing not to kill, not to steal, not to deceive, before its first legal code was inscribed.

Existence does not depend upon theory for its being.

Theory arrives post hoc. It describes what already exists, explains what is unfolding, predicts what is to come. But theory cannot "create" existence—it can only "translate" it. This is no denigration of theory. Without translation, we could not understand one another, transmit experience, or stand upon the shoulders of those who came before. But a translation is not the original. When we mistake the translation for the original, we begin to substitute concepts for reality, formulas for experience, and interpretation for existence itself.

2. Theory Is a Narrowing "Translation," Not Existence Itself

This is the second proposition of this section, and the core corollary of the book's methodology.

All theory is a form of "narrowing": it compresses the inexhaustible plenitude of existence into finite concepts, formulas, and models. This compression is useful: it enables communication, operation, and transmission. But compression necessarily entails loss. What is lost is not "unimportant"—it is simply "that which the current theoretical framework cannot accommodate."

Different theories translating the same existence yield entirely disparate renderings.

Consider a tree: botany translates it as a "photosynthetic organ" and a "lignocellulosic structure"; economics translates it as a "timber resource"; ecology translates it as a "carbon sink node" and a "species habitat"; poetry translates it as "green silence" and "the earth's breath." Each is a translation of the selfsame tree, yet no single translation is commensurate with the tree itself. The tree does not depend upon any translation for its existence. It stands there—before and after all translations.

"Reason" constitutes one cross-section of existence; "sensitivity," another. Yet existence itself is neither reason nor sensitivity—it exceeds both. Sensitivity and reason are two different rulers, but existence is not a length measured by rulers; existence is the very ground upon which the rulers stand.

Hegel once declared: "What is rational is real; and what is real is rational." This pronouncement installs "reason" as the arbiter of existence—existence must receive its legitimacy through the "certification" of reason. But this is a subtle inversion.

Existence requires no ratification from reason. A star does not cease its shining because humanity has not yet fathomed its nuclear fusion mechanism. A blossom does not refuse to bloom because botany has not yet named it. A civilization had already witnessed individuals choosing not to kill, not to steal, not to deceive, before its first legal code was inscribed.

"Rational" is not existence's permit. Existence is itself the entire ground of its own being. Existence is rational—not because anyone has argued for its rationality, but because it is simply there.

When we equate "that which can be explained by theory" with "that which exists," and dismiss "that which cannot be explained by theory" as "nonexistent" or "unimportant," we fall into "cognitive lock"—substituting the conceptual cage for the real world, and interpretation for experience.

This is precisely the deep root of the "civilizational deadlock" diagnosed in the first chapter of this book: we attempt to solve problems using the same theoretical framework that created them, forgetting that the problems themselves never required

theoretical authorization to exist.

3. The Extension of the Cognitive Framework — From the Human-Centric to the Scale of All Things

What this book undertakes is not the invention of a new theory, but the extension of the cognitive framework from the narrow, human-centric scale to the ultimate scale of all things in the cosmos.

The old cognitive framework, however intricate its internal architecture, rests upon an unspoken premise of anthropocentrism. Within this framework, "rational" means "conforming to human rational judgment," and "valuable" means "useful to humanity." It operates with efficacy upon the human scale—yet when the planetary ecology begins to collapse beyond that scale, the framework's boundary stands exposed.

The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital does not negate the achievements of human-centric cognition. It subsumes them within a more expansive framework. Just as relativity did not negate Newtonian mechanics but revealed its validity under macroscopic, low-velocity conditions, the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital does not negate the local validity of human-centric cognition but reveals its limitation when confronted with the scale of all things.

To extend the cognitive framework is not an act of intellectual arrogance, but of intellectual humility. Only when we concede that humanity is not the center of all things do we become capable—for the first time—of truly apprehending all things. Only when we relinquish the obsession that "all things must conform to my reason to be rational" do we first behold things as they truly are.

4. Changing the World Requires No Theoretical Authorization, but Theory Can Alter the Velocity at Which the World Becomes

Conscious

This is the third proposition of this section, and its ultimate practical orientation.

A farmer does not require agronomy to grow grain. A mother does not require pedagogy to raise a child. A community does not require a written "communal charter" before it can begin mutual aid. Changing the world occurs before theory, outside theory, and after theory. It is a matter of "existence," not of "interpretation."

But here an important distinction must be added:

Theory cannot alter the velocity of the world, but theory can alter the velocity at which the world becomes conscious.

When a society is wholly controlled by an old theoretical framework, even if a blueprint for a new world lies before its eyes, people cannot see it—they will not grant it a second glance, and may even oppose it with all their might. Not because they are foolish, but because their cognitive framework has been welded shut by the old theory. They are not "looking at" the blueprint; they are "judging" it through the old framework. In that condition, the blueprint is not "rejected"—it is never seen at all.

This is why theory possesses an irreplaceable function in a "cognitively locked" society: it does not seek to persuade those already welded into the old framework, but to furnish a new language, a new perspective, and a new possibility for those who are "already loosening."

A person suffocating within the old framework may be unable to articulate why they are suffocating, because the cause of their suffocation exceeds the explanatory range of the old framework. But a new theory can furnish them a language—translating that ineffable suffocation into a problem that may be articulated, contemplated, and acted upon. When they discover that they are not "insane" or "incompetent," but that "the old framework cannot account for their lived reality," the fissure in cognition appears. That fissure is the entrance to the new world.

The value of theory resides not in its "correctness," but in its capacity to confirm—for those who have already felt the constraints of the old framework—that their experience is real, and to disclose the path toward a new framework.

Thus theory is the accelerant of the world's coming-to-consciousness of change, not the initiator of change itself. What initiates change is the summons of existence itself: hunger, suffering, suffocation, the longing for a more luminous life. Theory enables these summons to be heeded, comprehended, disseminated, and iterated. It cannot replace action, but it can elevate action from the "accidental" to the "conscious," from the "local" to the "systemic," from "the endeavor of a single generation" to "the inheritance of civilization."

5. The Self-Positioning of This Book: An Open Framework, Rather Than a Closed System

At this juncture, a self-referential question must be confronted: if theory is but a translation, should the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital itself also be "set aside"?

The answer is: yes. Yet "setting aside" is not equivalent to "abandonment." It signifies: do not venerate this book as the "ultimate truth," but rather treat it as a window. Having beheld the vista through it, you may set the window aside and walk into the landscape itself.

But the composition of this book extends beyond theory. It consists of two parts: one is the interpretation of the world—the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, Capital Dynamics, and Resonance Physics—which grants you comprehension of the "why"; the other is the design of the world—the Contribution Value System, unit-based governance, the Spark Plan, and the Civilization Charter—which instructs you in the "how."

Understanding and design are two distinct dimensions. One may drive an automobile without grasping the principles of the internal combustion engine. One may act upon

the blueprint of the Contribution Value System without mastering every argument of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. Theory is the language through which the world is comprehended; blueprint is the instrument through which the world is transformed. Even without this theory, we could still, guided by the blueprint, practice this preexistent world and thereby ultimately realize its transformation.

The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is not a closed theoretical system but an open theoretical framework. Its purpose is not to offer a "final answer," but to furnish a more expansive cognitive framework—one that enables those who find the old framework inadequate to discover new trajectories of thought and new possibilities of action.

This openness manifests at three levels.

First, it remains receptive to all novel evidence, phenomena, and practices. Should a future scientific discovery conflict with one of its inferences, the framework shall be revised or extended accordingly. This is not a weakness of theory but its honesty.

Second, it remains receptive to the wisdom traditions of all civilizations. It is neither Western-centric nor Eastern-centric; rather, it aspires, at a sufficiently broad magnitude, to encompass the survival wisdom accumulated by human civilizations across disparate times and places.

Third, it respects the autonomy of the reader. Upon concluding this book, you may endorse, critique, revise, or even utterly discard it—so long as, in doing so, you have come to see more clearly the relation between yourself and the world.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

This section has accomplished the positioning of "theory" itself. We have affirmed three propositions of ascending order.

First, existence does not depend upon theory for its being. Theory describes existence but does not create it; the stars shone before all astronomy.

Second, theory is a narrowing translation of existence. Translation is useful, yet the translation is not the original. Different theories translating the same existence yield different renderings, but no rendering is equivalent to existence itself.

Third, changing the world requires no theoretical authorization, but theory can alter the velocity at which the world becomes conscious of change. The function of a new theory is to offer a new language to those who are "already loosening," enabling them to confirm the truth of their own experience and to discern the path toward a new framework.

All the arguments of this book—the general/specific meta-theory, the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, Capital Dynamics, Resonance Physics—are translations of existence. They are windows, not landscapes; fingers pointing at the moon, not the moon itself. Yet the window derives its meaning not from its own craftsmanship, but from the landscape that lies beyond. The landscape does not depend upon the window for its being.

Having read this section, you may set aside the arguments for a while and do one thing: walk to the window and gaze at the sky beyond. That sky requires no theory to prove its existence. The entire value of this book lies in this: when you look upon that sky, you perceive one stratum more than before you opened it. Once you have glimpsed a larger framework, you can no longer willingly curl back into the smaller one. This is not a negation of the old framework, but its transcendence.

Once opened, this window cannot be shut again. Even when the book is closed, the landscape remains. Even if every argument is forgotten, the gaze is already altered.

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

This chapter has descended into the interior of cognitive activity, conducting a comprehensive inquiry from origin, transmission, and alienation to liberation. We have come to recognize that cognition is at once the lamp that illuminates the world and the cage that may imprison thought. By critiquing the narrowness of the concepts

"Capital" and "Civilization" and liberating them in their broad sense, we have dissolved the old cognitive fetters. Ultimately, we have established a mechanism of self-reflection with "critique" at its core, thereby clearing the path for the liberated cognitive faculty to enter the exploration of the essence of the world—the ontological domain of All-Things-as-Capital.

Yet the cognitive journey has a boundary that must be acknowledged: all cognition, all theory, all interpretation are translations of existence, not existence itself. Existence does not depend upon theory for its being. The stars shine without astronomy; the heart beats without anatomy; a civilization, before the inscription of its first code of laws, already possessed those who chose not to kill, not to steal, not to deceive.

The entire labor of this chapter has been not to fabricate a more intricate "interpretation," but to dismantle the conceptual cages that obstruct our vision of existence. When we relinquish the obsession that "one must first understand before acting," we shall behold that among those who, without needing a reason, have chosen to cease exploitation, there already exists a living practice of "coexistence according to contribution." The Contribution Value system was already there before it was written.

All the arguments of this book are translations of that world which already exists. To grasp this is the precondition for entering the next chapter. In the next chapter, we shall enter the ontological domain of All-Things-as-Capital. But let it be remembered: this domain has not been "invented"—it has only been "recognized."

Chapter Three: Ontology — The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital

Guide to This Chapter

Having forged the meta-instrument of the General/Specific distinction, and having shattered in Chapter Two the conceptual cages of "Capital" and "Civilization" while establishing the ontological cornerstone of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, our thought now stands poised upon the threshold of a fundamental ontological reconfiguration. This chapter undertakes this cardinal task: to systematically expound and deepen the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. We shall contend that "Capital" is not the exclusive invention of human society, but a universal metaphysical category that precedes and encompasses human society. From the starry seas to the grass and the ant, from the body and skin to thought and institution, "to exist is to be capital; capital is efficacy" constitutes a new grammar for describing the mode of being of all things.

This chapter will first delineate the static essence of capital's being and Absolute General Sensemechanisms of its interaction; it will then project this ontological vision upon the history of human civilization, exposing its evolutionary trajectory and intrinsic contradictions, thereby laying the most secure existential foundation for the emergence of the new paradigm of "Contributionism."

The reader is reminded: Chapter Two has already instructed us that "existence precedes theory"; this chapter will further inquire into the question, "What is existence itself?" The relationship between the two is not one of repetition, but an advance from the threshold of epistemology to the affirmation of ontology.

Moreover, should the term "Capital" disquiet you on account of its historical baggage, you may temporarily understand it as "efficacy," "testament of endurance," or "relational potential." This book employs the term "Capital" precisely because it spans the full spectrum from everyday Chinese usage—"the body is the capital of revolution"—to the cosmological scale. Yet the word itself is not the point; the hierarchical relation of containment is what matters.

Further Reading

This chapter will present the vision, connotations, and taxonomy of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. The first chapter of this volume established the meta-methodology of the General/Specific distinction; the second accomplished the critique and liberation of the concepts "Capital" and "Civilization." Upon this foundation, the task of the third chapter is to reveal: when we re-examine the world with new meta-instruments, what countenance does the world disclose?

However, the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is not merely proposed as a "viewpoint." Does it hold? What scientific grounding does it possess? How does it follow necessarily from the dialogue between quantum field theory and Marxism? A thorough demonstration of these questions is to be found in Appendix I, "The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital: Inheritance, Breakthrough, and Transcendence of Marxism." That essay commences with the General/Specific meta-theory, traverses the establishment of a relational ontology, the extension of Marx's theses, the convergence of the twin paths, and the dialectical movement of the negation of the negation, and ultimately demonstrates: Capital is neither an isolated thing nor a suspended relation, but the totality of things and relations—all things are Capital, and Capital is the structural condensation of the relations among all things. Should the reader seek to grasp the philosophical legitimacy of this chapter's vision, let him consult that essay.

But remember: the vision of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is not "invented" but "recognized." As Section Six of Chapter Two has already demarcated for us: theory is a translation of existence, not existence itself. The vision of All-Things-as-Capital presented in this chapter is a translation of that world which has always already existed. The window has been opened; the landscape lies beyond it.

Section One: The Essence of Capital — The Universality of Exploitation and Oppression in the Broad Sense

Within the vision of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital (whose core definition has already been established in Chapter Two), the cosmos is not a harmonious and tranquil pasture, but a stage upon which the struggle of efficacies surges eternally. If "to exist is to be capital" depicts the static structure of being, then its dynamic, interactive essence manifests as a universal and objective mechanism. This section will contend that exploitation and oppression are not abhorrent anomalies within human society, but a universal, value-neutral mechanism of "efficacy operation" in the interaction of all capitals. To recognize this constitutes the cognitive point of departure for comprehending the predicaments of all things and for seeking the transcendence of civilization.

1. From Interaction to Extraction: The Ontological Delineation of Exploitation and Oppression in the Broad Sense

To transcend the confines of human morality, we must first, at the philosophical level, effect a thorough "disenchantment" and generalization of these two core concepts.

The Definition of Exploitation in the Broad Sense

We define exploitation in the broad sense as:

In the interaction of capitals, one party, by virtue of its capital advantage, extracts, converts, or dominates the capital of another party in an asymmetrical manner, so as to sustain and augment its own existential advantage.

Core elements:

- Capital advantage differential: a disparity in capital efficacy between the interacting parties. This is the precondition of exploitation.

- Asymmetrical capital flow: the interaction results in a unidirectional or asymmetrical net flow of capital (energy, resources, efficacy) from the weaker party to the stronger.
- Reinforcement of the advantaged party's existence: the ultimate outcome of the process is the maintenance or growth of the advantaged party's total capital efficacy.

The Definition of Oppression in the Broad Sense

When exploitation in the broad sense is consolidated and systematized, it ascends to oppression in the broad sense.

We define oppression in the broad sense as:

A condition in which, through the establishment of a stable set of rules, structures, or potential differentials, a specific capital advantage differential is systematically maintained and enlarged, thereby rendering the process of exploitation stable, enduring, and invisible.

Core elements:

- Systematicity: not accidental or isolated interactions, but a normal state guaranteed by structure.
- Stability: the oppressive relation perpetuates itself over time, forming a relatively hardened order.
- Concealment: its exploitative essence may be obscured by the structure itself (e.g., "natural law," "market rules").

2. All Things Exploit: Evidence of Universality

This mechanism of "exploitation-oppression in the broad sense" is ubiquitous in nature, human society, and even the imaginary world, constituting the micro-foundation and macro-presentation of that inexorable law: "natural selection,

survival of the fittest."

The Non-Living World

A star, through its immense gravitation (a capital advantage), exploits the orbital kinetic energy of encircling planets (capital) to sustain its own structure; its nuclear fusion exploits hydrogen atoms (capital) and converts them into energy.

- Weathering exploits the "structural capital" of rock, gradually reducing it to rubble.

The Living World

- Photosynthesis: the plant (the advantaged party) exploits sunlight, air, and water (natural capital), converting them into its own biomass (vital capital).
- Food chain: the wolf (the advantaged party) exploits the corporeal capital of the sheep (the disadvantaged party); the sheep (the advantaged party) exploits the vegetative capital of the grassland (the disadvantaged party).
- Parasitism: the virus (the advantaged party) exploits the replicative machinery of the host cell (the disadvantaged party).

Human Society

- Economic exploitation: the capitalist (by virtue of advantage in financial and means-of-production capital) exploits the labor power (bodily and mental capital) of the worker (the disadvantaged party), extracting surplus value. This is the narrow-sense exploitation revealed by Marxism—merely one historical form of broad-sense exploitation.
- Ecological exploitation: human civilization (by virtue of its advantage in technological and organizational capital) exploits natural ecosystems (the disadvantaged party), overdrawing their mineral, forest, and clean-water natural capital.
- Cultural exploitation: dominant cultures (by virtue of their advantage in

disseminative and discursive capital) exploit weaker cultures, assimilating or extracting their cultural capital.

- Cognitive exploitation: algorithmic platforms (by virtue of their advantage in data and computational capital) exploit users' attention (mental capital), converting it into profitable traffic.

Thought Experiments (Theology and Cultivation Cosmology)

- In a hypothetical theological system, "God," possessing nearly infinite "divine capital," receives and converts the "faith capital" of believers; believers, in turn, exploit "divine grace capital" through prayer. This constitutes an immense system of capital circulation.
- In a hypothetical cultivation civilization, the essence of cultivation is to plunder external "spiritual-energy capital" (broad-sense exploitation) and to form a stable hierarchical system of "cultivation capital" through the establishment of sects and realm barriers (broad-sense oppression). Its cruelty is the manifestation, at a higher dimension, of the law of "interaction and equilibration among all capitals."

3. Dialectical Unity: The Relation Between Exploitation and Oppression in the Broad and Narrow Senses

Mastering this pair of broad-sense instruments enables us to diagnose lucidly the deep structure of the human predicament and to achieve a theoretical dialectical unity.

Qualitative Distinction: The Philosophical Gulf Between "Is" and "Ought"

Broad-sense exploitation and oppression (natural exploitation):

- Subject: entities devoid of self-consciousness.
- Teleology: no self-conscious purpose; a necessary outcome of natural law.
- Moral attribute: value-neutral. It is the core mechanism of ecosystem energy

flow, material cycling, and species evolution. Without this "exploitation," the living world would lapse into stagnation.

Narrow-sense exploitation and oppression (social exploitation):

- Subject: self-conscious, reflective moral agents (human beings).
- Teleology: deprivation deliberately imposed for the pursuit of self-interest.
- Moral attribute: subject to moral judgment. Because it occurs among moral agents, involving intention, institutional injustice, and violation of others' dignity.

Hierarchical Nesting: The Narrow Sense Is a Special and Alienated Form of the Broad Sense

Narrow-sense exploitation and oppression in human society is the concretization, self-conscious actualization, and institutionalization of Absolute General Sense-law of capital interaction (in the broad sense) upon the social dimension of this particular species. It inherits the core of "efficacy struggle" from the broad-sense law, but because it occurs among subjects endowed with reflective consciousness and moral sensibility, it engenders an ethical qualitative leap—from "value-neutral" to "moral evil."

4. Amoralism and the Revolt of Civilization: The Leap from the "Is" to the "Ought"

It must be emphasized once more: at the ontological level of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, exploitation and oppression in the broad sense carry no moral attribute whatsoever. They constitute a blind, objective "causal law of nature" governing the interaction of all capitals—one of the underlying engines driving cosmic evolution, species development, and even the rise and fall of civilizations.

Yet the peculiarity of the human being manifests precisely at this juncture: we are the

only beings in the known cosmos capable of consciously perceiving this cold law, and of employing reason and compassion to resist, regulate, and transcend it.

- Natural exploitation is unconscious; humanity may consciously choose to diminish it.
- Natural oppression is given; humanity may actively design fairer institutions to replace it.

Thus, recognizing the universality of exploitation and oppression in no way defends exploitation in human society; on the contrary, it furnishes the most profound philosophical ground for our assumption of the civilizational responsibility to transcend this blind law. The dawn of civilization begins not with submission to nature, but with the first conscious revolt against this primitive, barbaric "law of capital causality." We acknowledge the cold law of the "is" world precisely in order to pursue resolutely a more beautiful "ought" world.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

This section has revealed that "exploitation in the broad sense" and "oppression in the broad sense" are objective mechanisms universally present in the interaction of all capitals. We have clearly demarcated their qualitative distinction from "exploitation and oppression in the narrow sense," pointing out that the former is a value-neutral natural law, while the latter is a social "evil" that ought to be critiqued and transcended. This recognition does not lead us toward nihilism; on the contrary, by revealing humanity's singular position among all things—as a "civilizational subject" capable of consciously resisting and transcending the blind laws of nature—it lays the most solid ethical foundation and bestows the courage for action in undertaking the historical mission of building a new civilization of "Contributionism." Now, what concrete shape has this universal mechanism of interaction assumed in the long river of human civilization? This directs our gaze from the philosophical speculation of ontology toward the empirical verification of history.

Section Two: The Capital Evolution of Human Society — From Body, Land, Finance to Contribution

Having established "exploitation and oppression in the broad sense" as Absolute General Sensemechanism of interaction among all capitals, we now possess a hyper-historical lens through which to survey the history of human civilization. History is no longer a chronicle of emperors and generals, nor an abstract narrative of the evolution of modes of production, but rather a history of the dominant capital form—driven by Absolute General Sensemechanism described above—continually undergoing succession through its own inherent contradictions. This section will delineate this evolutionary trajectory, reveal its inner dynamic laws, and point toward its inevitable destination: contribution.

1. The Evolutionary Logic of the Dominant Capital Form

The evolution of human society may be understood as the process whereby different forms of capital, under specific historical conditions, successively became the core organizing logic of society. This evolution follows three fundamental laws:

The Law of Contradiction-Driven Succession

Every formal transition originates from the old form's incapacity to resolve the core contradiction it has itself engendered. The new form emerges as a resolution to these contradictions.

The Law of Abstract Ascension

The capital form ascends along a dimension from the concrete to the abstract, from the material to the informational: body → land → currency → finance → digital → contribution value.

The Law of Inclusive Expansion

The new form does not simply replace the old, but rather subsumes it within its own framework, redefining and reintegrating all capital forms at a higher level.

2. The Historical Sequence of Four Dominant Forms and Their Inherent Contradictions

The Era of Corporeal Capital Dominance (Primitive Society)

- Core logic: The survival and development of the individual depended entirely upon physical strength, endurance, and hunting and gathering skills. The tribal chieftain was typically the strongest or wisest of the tribe.
- Form of exploitation: Direct military conquest and physical subjugation. The victor subjugated the vanquished, wholly appropriating their corporeal capital.
- Inherent contradiction: The extreme finitude of individual corporeal capital against the infinitude of survival demands. A person commands but a limited measure of physical strength, yet must confront limitless existential challenges.
- Historical breakthrough: Through the development of terrestrial capital, humanity discovered a path beyond the limits of corporeal capital.

The Era of Terrestrial Capital Dominance (Agrarian Civilization)

- Core logic: Social power, wealth, and status were primarily bound to control over land and its produce. "Under heaven, all land is the king's land."
- Form of exploitation: The landlord class systematically exploited the labor of tenant farmers through rent and kindred means. The feudal hierarchy structurally consolidated oppression.
- Inherent contradiction: The finitude of land against the infinitude of population growth; social polarization engendered by land consolidation.
- Historical breakthrough: The rise of monetary capital and the commercial

revolution opened a path beyond the physical limitations of land.

The Era of Financial Capital Dominance (Industrial Civilization to the Information Age)

- Core logic: Currency and its derivatives became the omnipotent symbol for measuring, dominating, and integrating all other forms of capital. Capital achieved its highest degree of abstraction.
- Form of exploitation: Extraction of surplus value through wage labor; global value extraction through the financial system.
- Inherent contradictions:
 - The logic of infinite financial capital appreciation stands in fundamental conflict with the finitude of planetary natural capital.
 - The decoupling of the virtual economy from the real economy.
 - Extreme wealth polarization leading to the disintegration of social capital.
- Systemic deadlock: The financial capital paradigm can no longer expand without annihilating its own foundations—natural capital and social capital.

The Era of Contribution Value Dominance (The Contribution Epoch)

- Core logic: Contribution to the system as a whole—natural, social, civilizational—serves as the standard for measuring all value.
- Transcending exploitation: A shift from zero-sum capital transfer to positive-sum value creation.
- Intrinsic unity: The appreciation of natural, human, and social capital is unified within the growth of contribution value.

3. The Internal Dynamic Mechanism of Evolution

From External Constraint to Internal Self-Awareness

Corporeal capital is constrained by physiological limits; terrestrial capital by geographical boundaries; financial capital, though unbounded at the symbolic level, remains tethered to its substantive underpinnings. Only contribution value, grounded in the self-awareness of cognition and morality, can achieve genuine unlimited development.

From Scarcity Manufacturing to Abundance Creation

The old forms all rest upon the assumption of scarcity: physical strength is finite, land is finite, currency is finite. The contribution paradigm turns toward the creation of abundance. Knowledge can be shared, care can be multiplied, ecosystems can be restored.

From Competitive Exclusivity to Symbiotic Coevolution

The corporeal era: kill or be killed. The terrestrial era: zero-sum games. The financial era: winner-takes-all. The contribution era: symbiotic coevolution.

4. The Ontological Positioning of "Contribution" as a New Paradigm

Within the framework of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, we may offer a precise ontological definition of "contribution":

"Contribution" is the behavior that increases the total capital stock of a system (including natural, social, and individual systems), enhances its sustainability and flourishing, and the capital form thereby produced.

This definition encompasses three core criteria:

- Verifiable capital appreciation. Contribution must produce observable, verifiable increments in capital: restoring ecosystems, disseminating knowledge, enhancing health, strengthening trust.

- Systematic positive externalities. Contribution naturally bears positive external effects, benefiting the system as a whole rather than merely the acting subject.
- A sustainable cycle of reproduction. The conditions created by contribution enable the occurrence of further contributions, forming a self-reinforcing virtuous cycle.

5. Contribution Value: The Currency of a New Civilization

The Return from Price to Value

Financial capital reduces all value to price, resulting in the alienation of value. The contribution value system seeks to re-anchor value in genuine use-value and the creation of meaning.

A Unified Measure Across Multiple Dimensions

The contribution value system aims to establish a unified framework capable of simultaneously measuring economic contribution, ecological contribution, knowledge contribution, and social contribution—thereby ending the tyranny of GDP.

The Practical Core of Contributionism

Contribution value is not merely a measuring instrument; it is the institutional cornerstone and cultural heart of the entire Contributionist society.

6. Historical Synthesis: Contributionism as Civilization's

Self-Transcendence

The birth of Contributionism marks civilization's entry into an entirely new stage of development:

A Dialectical Synthesis of All Preceding Forms

Contributionism does not deny the importance of the body; rather, through technology

and institutions, it enables every individual to realize their full potential. It does not negate the value of land; rather, through ecological wisdom, it achieves its perpetual flourishing. It does not repudiate the historical instrumental role of finance; rather, it permits its dialectical dissolution in the service of genuine value creation.

The Ultimate Expression of Civilizational Self-Awareness

Contributionism represents the first occasion upon which civilization, in a holistic and self-conscious manner, plans and guides its own developmental direction—rather than being driven by blind capital logic.

The Practical Consummation of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital

Only under the Contributionist paradigm can the law of capital interaction revealed by the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital ascend from blind natural causality to the self-conscious principle of civilizational construction.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

This section, viewed through the lens of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, has re-examined history and revealed the evolutionary sequence of the dominant capital form—from body, to land, to finance—the inner dynamic of which is the old form's incapacity to overcome its own contradictions. The laws of history demonstrate that every paradigm shift originates from the exploitation of more fundamental capital and points toward a more inclusive logic of value. At present, the financial capital paradigm, owing to its fundamental opposition to natural and human capital, has fallen into a systemic deadlock. This logically and historically portends that a new paradigm with "contribution" as its core causal principle and organizing logic is no longer a utopian vision, but the inevitable emergence of civilization's quest for survival. Contributionism, as the historical synthesis, shall lead human civilization through the great ascent from the "spontaneous" to the "self-conscious," inscribing a new chapter of reason and conscience upon the cosmos.

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

This chapter has accomplished a fundamental ontological reset. By establishing the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, we have liberated "capital" from the narrow cage of economics, rendering it a universal metaphysical category that describes the existence and interaction of all things. This new lens of thought enables us to discern two fundamental laws:

First, we have revealed "exploitation and oppression in the broad sense" as an objective, value-neutral universal mechanism within capital interaction. It constitutes the underlying driving logic from particle combination to the rise and fall of civilizations—the cornerstone of our understanding of the world's "is" state.

Second, we have identified the evolutionary sequence of the dominant capital form in the history of human civilization: from body, to land, to finance. This sequence is no accident; behind it lies the historical dialectic whereby the old form, unable to overcome its internal contradictions, is necessarily transcended by the new.

The trajectory of history has been clearly charted: when the financial capital paradigm falls into a systemic deadlock owing to the fundamental conflict between its logic of infinite appreciation and the finitude of the planet, civilization must, to ensure its continued survival and development, leap to an entirely new paradigm. "Contribution"—as the behavior and capital form that increases the total capital stock of a system and creates systematic abundance—is no longer merely a moral appeal, but the inevitable destination deduced from historical law. Contributionism is precisely the self-conscious form of this new paradigm.

Yet what we have depicted thus far remains a static structural map of capital evolution. We have articulated "why change is necessary" and "where we are headed," but the deeper driving force of "how change occurs" remains unrevealed. What force propels the contradictions and successions of capital forms behind the scenes? Is evolution a smooth transition, or is it fraught with upheaval?

The answer lies concealed within the dynamic laws of capital operation. For this, we must inject life and motion into the static picture—advancing from the ontology of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital toward the exploration of the laws of Capital Dynamics. Next, we shall seek the fundamental principle that drives the movement of all capital, from the quantum to civilization, so as to truly understand how contradictions unfold, why cycles recur, and the dynamical necessity of civilizational leaps.

Chapter Four: Capital Dynamics — Contradiction, Cycle, and Civilizational Leap

Guide to This Chapter

Having completed the ontological construction of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, our conceptual map yet awaits the infusion of life and motion. This chapter undertakes that task: to set capital in motion. We shall reveal that what drives all things—from quantum entanglement to the rise and fall of empires—is one and the same dynamical principle rooted in capital interaction: the tendency toward equilibrium. Thereby, we obtain the ultimate lens through which to contemplate the being and becoming of all things: contradiction is Absolute General Senseform of capital interaction; cycles are the rhythmic manifestation of contradictory motion; and civilizational leaps are the dynamical necessity whereby an old capital paradigm collapses under an insupportably heavy "metabolic tax," while a new paradigm ascends through "paradigmatic attraction." This chapter shall construct the unified language of this "Capital Dynamics" and thereby reinterpret both natural and human history, ultimately disclosing the dynamical inevitability of Contributionism as the historical synthesis.

Note

The ontological foundation of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital upon which this chapter's "Capital Dynamics" rests is rigorously derived in Appendix I, "The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital." This chapter directly employs its conclusions for analysis.

Section One: The Cognitive Foundation — General-Sense Materialism and the General-Sense Scientific Paradigm

Before venturing into the intricacies of dynamics, we must unify the grammar by which we comprehend the world. This section, grounded in the ontological commitment of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, constructs an epistemological and methodological system capable of uniformly apprehending all things—from matter to mind, from nature to society—namely, "General-Sense Materialism" and "General-Sense Science." This is not a mere philosophical elevation, but an indispensable preparation for our precise analysis of the dynamics of civilization.

1. General-Sense Materialism — The Emergence of Mind Capital and the Transcendent Mission of Civilization

The traditional contest between materialism and idealism is sublated and unified within the supremely inclusive framework of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. We uphold both the primacy of matter and the full agency of mind capital, elucidating the civilizational significance of its emergence.

The Capitalist Ground of Mind–Matter Unity

- The primacy of matter: Traditional materialism rightly insists upon the primacy of matter. Within the capital framework, this signifies that all existence—including mental phenomena—is rooted in specific material forms of capital organization. The human brain, that highly complex biological neural-network capital, is the material substrate from which mind capital arises.
- The emergence of mind capital: Spirit (mind capital) is not a passive epiphenomenon, but an advanced functional attribute emergent from material capital in the course of evolution. It is at once a product of matter and

possessed of relative independence and agency, capable of "mirroring" and reflecting upon the laws of interaction among all capitals.

- The unified essence of capital: A person's knowledge, emotions, and moral convictions (mind capital) all originate from interaction with external capitals (educational resources, social relations, cultural environment) and from accumulated practice. Once mind capital takes form, it becomes a powerful force capable of operating independently and reacting back upon the material world.

The Perception of Pain: The Origin of Civilizational Transcendence

The law of "exploitation and oppression in the broad sense" within capital interaction has as its universal consequence the continual restructuring of capital configurations. When this law acts upon life-forms endowed with acute sentience, it produces a revolutionary consequence: pain.

- The soil of morality: It is precisely this perception-based pain that becomes the primordial soil from which all morality, ethics, compassion, and altruism germinate. It is the first sensory revolt against the blind, cold laws of capital interaction.
- The driving force of civilization: Humanity's resistance to exploitation and longing for fairness are not alien imports; they are the "luminous potential" bred within the matrix of natural capital for the purpose of self-transcendence. We originate from all things, and it is therefore our duty to advance on behalf of all things—to seek a civilizational path that escapes the fate of blind exploitation and oppression.

Marx observed: "The philosophers have only interpreted the world in various ways; the point, however, is to change it." Whence comes the power to change the world? Not from theoretical deduction, but from the immediate perception of pain. The worker revolts not because he has read *Capital*, but because his spine has been bent for ten years upon the assembly line, because his child has grown up malnourished,

because his wife rises at four in the morning to catch the shift. This pain precedes theory. The function of theory is not to "create" the will to resist, but to translate this already-perceived pain into a language that can be disseminated, organized, and bequeathed.

Thus, the transcendence of civilization is born not of "idea," but of "pain." The mission of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is not to invent a new transcendence, but to furnish a speakable framework for those who have already felt pain yet lack the words to articulate it.

The Inclusion and Transcendence of Idealism

- Inclusion of its aspirations: General-Sense Materialism can encompass and explain the aspirations of idealism. The luminous world yearned for by subjective idealism precisely attests to the human mind capital's mirroring of and revolt against the darkness of reality (exploitation and oppression). The "God" or "higher law" in which objective idealism reposes may be understood as a prototypical form of humanity's ultimate ideal and civilizational goal—the transcendence of the present blind causality of nature.
- Transcendence of its illusions: Yet every fantasy that reposes in an external savior abdicates humanity's own agency as the "vanguard of All-Things-as-Capital evolution." The mission of civilization lies not in awaiting redemption, but in self-redemption—deploying our mind capital to actively rewrite the primordial code that governs all things.

2. General-Sense Science — The Cognitive Imperative That All Things Are Capital

Upon the foundation of General-Sense Materialism, our methodology for comprehending the world is correspondingly elevated toward "General-Sense Science." It promises that all existence is, in principle, knowable—for all existence

can be understood as specific forms of capital and their laws of interaction.

From Specific-Sense Science to General-Sense Science

Specific-sense science is built upon testable explanations and the formal organization of objective phenomena.

General-Sense Science rests upon a more fundamental creed: to exist is to be capital; to interact is to be law. It regards the entire cosmos as a dynamic network of capital interactions accessible to rational interpretation. Its scientificity lies not in the physicality of its objects, but in whether its logic systematically apprehends the laws of capital interaction at a given level.

A Unified Framework of Knowledge

Under the General-Sense Scientific paradigm, disciplinary boundaries are thoroughly dissolved:

- The natural sciences are the disciplines that study the laws of interaction among foundational capital forms—physicochemical capital, ecological capital, and the like.
- The social sciences and humanities are the disciplines that study the laws of interaction among the derivative capital forms of human society—economic capital, cultural capital, social capital. They are not discontinuous with the natural sciences, but built upon them, governing more intricate strata of capital emergence.

This affords the philosophical possibility of constructing a genuinely unified "Capital Dynamics."

The Vast Expansion of Explanatory Scope

General-Sense Science casts its gaze upon all phenomena:

- Thought and theory: So long as a body of thought systematically grasps the laws of capital interaction at a particular level (as Marxism grasped the laws of

socioeconomic capital interaction), it possesses scientificity.

- Prophecy: Its scientific character lies not in mysticism, but in whether it is grounded in profound insight into the laws of historical and natural capital interaction. Its uncertainty arises precisely from the complexity of capital interaction itself.
- The "unknown": All existence not yet explained is regarded as a distinctive capital form whose principles may in principle be progressively disclosed by future General-Sense Science, without recourse to supernatural explanation.

3. The Capital Interaction Hamiltonian ($\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$) — The Meta-Theoretical Core of General-Sense Science

To transform "General-Sense Science" from a philosophical commitment into a generative research program, we introduce the "Capital Interaction Hamiltonian ($\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$)" as its meta-theoretical core. It is not a completed concrete equation, but a programmatic mathematical formulation indicating Absolute General Senseform that physical laws ought to assume from the perspective of capital.

Its general form is:

$$\hat{H}_{\text{mint}} = \sum_i \alpha_i \hat{N}_i + \sum_{i < j} \beta_{ij} \hat{R}_{ij} + \sum_{ijk} \gamma_{ijk} \hat{N}_i \hat{R}_{jk} + \dots$$

Where:

- $\hat{N}_i$ (existence operator): characterizes the density and distribution of the i-th kind of capital (e.g., mass capital, charge capital), corresponding to the system's intrinsic capacity (I).
- $\hat{R}_{ij}$ (correlation operator): characterizes the strength of association and mode of interaction between the i-th and j-th kinds of capital, corresponding to the system's relational attribute (R).
- $\alpha, \beta, \gamma \dots$ (coupling coefficients): parameters determined by the specific

capital form and systemic environment.

- The power of $\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$ lies in its generativity. We assert that all known physical laws are phenomenological manifestations of $\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$ under specific capital forms and approximations:
- When only the interaction between spacetime capital and mass–energy capital is considered, and under the continuous spacetime approximation, the dynamics of $\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$ can emerge as the Einstein–Hilbert action, thereby yielding general relativity.
- When only the interaction of microscopic charge capital satisfying the principle of linear superposition is considered, the matrix representation of $\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$ in the capital Hilbert space can naturally emerge as the Schrödinger equation.
- The laws of thermodynamics may be understood as the macroscopic statistical limit of the dissipation of capital quality (entropy increase, corresponding to "metabolic tax") and conservation (conservation of energy, corresponding to the conservation of total capital) within interaction.

$\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$ therefore represents a unified dynamical source. It promises a vision: the seemingly disparate core laws of physics all originate from one and the same deep logic—physical capital tending toward equilibrium through interaction.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

This section has laid the unified epistemological and methodological cornerstone for the dynamical analysis of this entire chapter. General-Sense Materialism, upon the capitalist ground of mind–matter unity, explains the emergence of mental phenomena and their transcendent mission, establishing the central role of mind capital in civilizational evolution. General-Sense Science, under the ontological commitment that "all things are capital," affords the philosophical possibility of breaking

disciplinary barriers and constructing a unified "Capital Dynamics." And the Capital Interaction Hamiltonian $\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$, as the meta-theoretical core, renders this framework mathematical and generative, demonstrating its immense potential to engender and unify existing physical theory.

At this juncture, all necessary philosophical and meta-theoretical preparation stands complete. We have thus obtained an unprecedented clarity of vision: the rise and fall of human civilization is, in its essence, a history of different forms of capital dynamically interacting, competing, integrating, and collapsing according to the laws of "capital interaction." Now, at last, compass in hand, we may venture into the tempestuous billows of history to decipher the very source of the power that drives all things.

Section Two: Capital Interaction as the Law of Existence — The Dynamical Ground of the Universality of Contradiction

With the epistemological foundations of General-Sense Materialism and General-Sense Science securely laid, we are now empowered to undertake a rigorous theoretical grounding. This section aims to fuse the philosophical insights of the "theory of contradiction" with the ontological commitments of the "Theory of All-Things-as-Capital" within the framework of Capital Dynamics, thereby revealing the objective material basis of the universality of contradiction and establishing capital interaction as the sole dynamical source of existence and evolution.

1. The Reconstruction of Natural Causality: From the Law of Existence to the Dynamical Root

Nature as Capital: Absolute General Sense Grammar of Existence and the Illusion of "Reasonableness"

The unity of existence attains its ultimate confirmation within the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital: what is called "nature" is precisely "all things," which is to say "capital." From constellations to ants, from markets to thoughts, all existents obey the same ontological determination: to exist is to be capital. Thus, nature is capital.

In traditional conception, "nature" represents a self-evident reasonableness and harmony. But this is a profound cognitive illusion. Beneath what is regarded as the "natural" state of affairs lies precisely an unceasing relationship of exploitation and oppression among the capitals of all things, grounded in differentials of efficacy. The survival of the fittest, energy flows, and material cycles are all manifestations of the General-Sense exploitation-oppression mechanism at various levels. What we admire as "natural equilibrium" is, in essence, but a transiently achieved equilibrium of capital under perpetual contest—saturated with tension and expenditure—scarcely an

idyllic pastoral.

A New Definition of Natural Causality: Capital-Interactive Causality

Within the framework of Capital Dynamics, we redefine the natural causality that propels the evolution of all things as "capital-interactive causality":

- The "cause": the interaction among distinct capital units, under a specific spatiotemporal context, based upon their endowments (efficacy, position, information). The core expression of this interaction is the General-Sense "exploitation-oppression" law expounded earlier.
- The "effect": the reconstruction of the relevant capital configuration consequent upon this interaction. It may manifest as a shift in the balance of power, a reorganization of alliance relations, or even the continuation or extinction of a capital unit. This is a dynamic, networked, nonlinear model of causality. Every "effect" becomes the "cause" of a new round of interaction, forming an eternally flowing chain of causality. History is precisely this long, densely nested chain of capital-interactive causality.

2. The Universality of Contradiction Originates from the Universality of Capital Interaction

Upon this thorough reinterpretation of "nature," the universality of contradiction acquires an irrefutable dynamical foundation.

Mao Zedong, at the outset of *On Contradiction*, declares: "The question of the universality or absoluteness of contradiction has a twofold significance. One is that contradiction exists in the process of development of all things; the other is that, in the process of development of each thing, the movement of opposites exists from beginning to end."

The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital furnishes a definitive dynamical answer to this: the General-Sense "exploitation-oppression" interactive law among the capitals of all

things is precisely the material manifestation and dynamical root of the universality of contradiction.

- All things are capital, and capital cannot but interact: Every capital individual, in order to sustain its own existence—that is, to resist entropy—must perpetually exchange energy, resources, information, and efficacy with its external environment.
- Interaction is contradiction: Because capitals are naturally differentiated in endowments (intrinsic capacity) and position (relational attributes), their interactions inevitably manifest as competition, equilibration, consumption, and appropriation. Contradiction is rooted in the "asymmetry" inherent in capital interaction.
- A unified dynamic web: From the dance of elementary particles at the microscopic scale to the rise and fall of civilizations at the macroscopic, all is but the manifestation of this selfsame law at diverse levels and in diverse forms.

Thus, the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital and the theory of contradiction here achieve a profound mutual validation: the universality of contradiction becomes concretely apprehensible through capital interaction; capital interaction acquires its dialectical soul through the universality of contradiction.

3. The Dual Connotation of Capital Dynamics: From the Law of Existence to the Analytical Framework

On the basis of the above understanding, the connotation of "Capital Dynamics" is elevated: it is not merely an analytical method, but the fundamental principle that drives the world.

As the Law of Existence (Ontology)

We elevate "the tendency of systems toward more stable and efficacious states of

capital equilibrium" to the rank of an ontological principle—the ultimate final cause propelling the evolution of all things. It is at once the deep unity underlying the four fundamental forces of the physical world and the fundamental motive force of paradigm succession within civilizational systems. It answers the fundamental question of why systems evolve: systems intrinsically pursue a more efficient and stable configuration of capital. Capital interaction is the sole "first cause" of the universe.

As the Analytical Framework (Methodology)

It provides us with a unified "dynamical language," whose core components include:

- Core variables: paradigmatic attraction, metabolic tax.
- Mathematical formulation: the Capital Interaction Hamiltonian ($\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$), as a theoretical abstraction characterizing the total energy of capital interaction and the tendency toward equilibrium.
- Principle of explanation: explaining changes in system states through "tendency toward equilibrium," reducing "force" to a manifestation of capital interaction.

This dual connotation signifies that the instruments we employ to analyze the evolution of civilization are, at the philosophical level, isomorphic to those we employ to describe the evolution of the cosmos. We are comprehending the world through one and the same underlying logic.

4. The Predicament and Transcendence of Civilization: The Conscious Revolt Against Natural Causality

Recognizing the universality and coldness of natural causality (i.e., capital-interactive causality) is the point of departure for our examination of the predicament of human civilization, and the cornerstone for seeking the path of transcendence.

The Great Paradox of Civilization

Human civilization—with its morality, its laws, its aspiration toward ideals—is itself the progeny of natural evolution, an "effect" of natural causality. Yet the highest aspirations of civilization—fairness, justice, emancipation—stand in fundamental opposition to the "natural causality" that engendered them, a causality steeped in exploitation and oppression. Civilization originates from nature, yet must transcend nature.

The Fatal Trap of "Conforming to Nature" and the Cognitive Revolution

Every endeavor of the old civilization—whether naked power politics or utopias attempting internal reform—so long as its underlying logic has not transcended the natural law of causality whereby "the advantaged aggrandizes itself through the exploitation of the disadvantaged"—is but a conformity to nature. Its inevitable result is the perpetual reproduction of the same structure of exploitation and oppression, entangling civilization in the historical cycle.

The transcendence of civilization becomes possible through the "cognitive revolution." Absolute General Senseconsequence of capital interaction is the reconstruction of capital configurations. Yet when this law acts upon life-forms endowed with acute sentience and complex emotion, it produces a special, revolutionary consequence: pain. It is precisely this perception-based pain that becomes the primordial soil from which all morality, ethics, compassion, and altruism germinate, enabling humanity to feel, reflect upon, and ultimately resist this law.

The cognitive revolution is the concentrated eruption and conscious practice of this potential:

- To recognize with clarity that the logic of capital is at once an expression of natural law and an object that civilization must transcend.
- To actively employ reason to mirror and dissect the distortions and suffering that the law of capital-interactive causality inflicts upon human society.

- To consciously construct a new cognitive paradigm centered upon ecological holism and the comprehensive development of the human person.

The Necessity of Transcendence: From Reflector to Reconstructor

The way out for civilization lies not in "conforming to nature," but in "acting against Heaven"—that is, employing humanity's unique capacities of reason and reflection (mind capital) to consciously and collectively resist and reconstruct this blind law of natural causality.

Law, ethics, and charity are all faint expressions of such transcendence. The ultimate goal of Contributionism is the thoroughgoing realization and institutionalization of this transcendence. Should civilization choose wholly to conform to this law, its outcome is not prosperity, but inevitable periodic collapse arising from systemic contradictions. To conform to it is for civilization voluntarily to abandon its conception and pursuit of more beautiful possibilities—nothing less than the self-annulment of civilization.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

This section has securely anchored the thesis of the universality of contradiction upon the dynamical foundation of "capital interaction," disclosing that "natural causality" is none other than "capital-interactive causality." The great paradox and ultimate mission of civilization reside in this: it originates from this law of causality, yet must transcend it. We recognize with clarity that the old civilizational paradigm is the extreme expression of "conforming to" this cold law, and is thus doomed to deadlock. The hope of civilization lies in inaugurating a thoroughgoing "cognitive revolution," liberating the course of civilization from the blind law of natural causality, and actively steering toward the new paradigm of Contributionism. This profound predicament and the necessity of transcendence logically require us to investigate the concrete trajectory of capital interaction in the history of civilization—to verify this law and to discover the practical path toward transcendence.

Section Three: The Law of Cycles — The Concrete Manifestation of Contradictory Movement

Having established the dynamical foundation for the universality of contradiction, we must now address its most conspicuous and imposing manifestation in the temporal dimension—the law of cycles. The cycle is no external law standing apart from contradiction, but rather the rhythmic and regular macroscopic expression of contradictory movement within a given system, governed by the principle of "tendency toward equilibrium." This section shall reveal the intrinsic unity of cycles and contradiction, and establish the framework of Capital Dynamics for cyclical analysis.

1. The Essence of Cycles: The Dynamic Equilibrating Rhythm of Capital Interaction

Definition: The Recurrent Reconstruction of Capital Configurations

A cycle is the wave-like progression and spiral ascent which, traced in temporal sequence, results from a specific capital system's internal contradictions (interactions): owing to the growth of internal negating factors (the accumulation of metabolic tax), the system perpetually deviates from, and perpetually returns toward, some "equilibrium state." Its essence is the recurrent reconstruction of capital configurations.

The Dialectical Unity of Cycles and Contradiction

- Contradiction is the motive force of cycles: The ceaseless interactions (contradictions) among capital units are the fundamental driving force behind changes in system states. Without contradiction, the system would remain in a lifeless equilibrium, and cycles would be inconceivable.
- Cycles are the instrument panel of contradiction: The process whereby

contradiction accumulates, intensifies, is temporarily alleviated, and re-accumulates manifests externally, at the macroscopic scale, as the rise, peak, decay, and succession of cycles. The cycle is the "projection" and "integration" of contradictory movement upon the axis of time.

- "Tendency toward equilibrium" is the regulator of rhythm: The immanent tendency of the Capital Dynamics system toward equilibrium ensures that deviation from equilibrium does not diverge without limit. Rather, after the old equilibrium is shattered, the system spontaneously seeks and ultimately establishes a new, more stable configuration of capital—thereby engendering the rhythmic phenomenon of the "cycle."

2. Metabolic Tax: The Immanent Root of Cyclicity

If contradiction is the engine of cyclical movement, then the "metabolic tax" is the internal chronometer that drives the recurrence of cycles. It is the key to understanding why any system must inevitably pass from ascendance to decline.

The Periodic Accumulation of Metabolic Tax

Within any relatively stable capital paradigm, the "metabolic tax" grows super-linearly with the system's increasing complexity and structural elaboration.

- The ascending phase: The metabolic tax of the new paradigm is extremely low. Its "paradigmatic attraction" enjoys absolute predominance. The system's momentum is formidable, and it expands at high velocity.
- The peak phase: The system attains the acme of complexity. The metabolic tax begins to climb steeply, reaching a standoff with paradigmatic attraction. System growth decelerates; the internal costs of coordination grow burdensome.
- The declining phase: The metabolic tax exceeds the system's capacity for capital reproduction. The system enters a downward spiral. Every remedial

measure of the old paradigm merely piles new burdens of tax atop an already exorbitant metabolic tax.

Absolute General SenseConsequences of Metabolic Tax Accumulation

- Suppression of innovation: Entrenched interest groups, in order to preserve the existing capital structure, systematically stifle new technologies, new ideas, and new models that threaten their position.
- Failure of coordination: The struggle among internal interest groups intensifies, internal friction escalates, information flows become distorted, and the system's capacity to respond to external change declines precipitously.
- Loss of resilience: The system's structure rigidifies, path dependence deepens, and it becomes incapable of weathering sudden external shocks or internal collapse.

3. Paradigmatic Attraction: The Trigger Mechanism of Cyclical Transition

The circulation of cycles is not an eternal rotation in place. The key to leaping from an old cycle to a new one lies in the contest of "paradigmatic attraction."

Efficiency Potential Gradient as the Fundamental Attraction

When the old paradigm has fallen into stagnation owing to excessive metabolic tax, and a new paradigm exists—whether externally or as an internal germ—possessing a higher "total-factor capital reproduction efficiency," a vast "efficiency potential gradient" forms between the two. This gradient exerts a powerful, non-coercive pull upon potential adopters of the new paradigm.

The Critical Point and Paradigmatic Switch

When the old paradigm's "metabolic tax" exceeds its "paradigmatic attraction," and the new paradigm's "paradigmatic attraction" exceeds the "switching cost," the system

arrives at the critical point of paradigmatic transition.

- Revolutionary switching: Through intense conflict, the fetters of the old system are rapidly shattered, clearing the path for the new paradigm. (As in the French Revolution.)
- Reformist switching: Through active, gradual institutional change, a smooth transition is effected toward the new paradigm. (As in China's reform and opening-up.)

4. Case Analysis: A Capital Dynamics Perspective on the Dynastic Cycle

Taking the dynastic cycle of Chinese history as an exemplar, the operation of this model becomes readily apparent:

- The founding of a new dynasty: Land capital is redistributed (equal-field system), the bureaucratic apparatus is lean and efficient, and the metabolic tax is extremely low. The new dynasty's "paradigmatic attraction" is immense, and society rapidly recovers its vitality.
- The middle period of the dynasty: Land consolidation grows ever more severe (a form of financial capital), the bureaucratic apparatus swells into bloat, and the costs of maintaining order (metabolic tax) rise unceasingly.
- The late period of the dynasty: Land capital is monopolized to an extreme degree, refugees multiply throughout the land, the bureaucratic apparatus is thoroughly corrupt and dysfunctional, and the metabolic tax devours all social surplus. At this point, any internal reform (such as Wang Anshi's Reforms or Zhang Juzheng's reforms) invariably fails, having antagonized entrenched interests, and the system's "metabolic tax" can no longer be contained.
- The dynastic transition: The old agricultural-bureaucratic capital paradigm has been totally exhausted. Peasant uprisings and foreign invasions, acting as the

triggers of "revolutionary switching," destroy the old system and create conditions for a fresh round of capital reorganization (a new dynasty), thereby completing a full cyclical circuit.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

This section has raised the "law of cycles" from a historical observation to a scientific concept amenable to analysis and comprehension within the framework of Capital Dynamics. A cycle is, in essence, the macroscopic rhythm displayed by contradiction in capital interaction—regulated by the law of "tendency toward equilibrium"—through the periodic accumulation of "metabolic tax" and the critical transition of "paradigmatic attraction." At this point, we have obtained a sharp scalpel for dissecting all cyclical phenomena. In the next section, we shall wield this scalpel to lay bare the full-spectrum lineage of cycles, from life to the cosmos, attesting to the universality and magnitude of Capital Dynamics' explanatory power.

Section Four: From History to Cosmos: A Panoramic Spectrum of Cycles Across the Scales of Capital Interaction

The law of cycles is by no means a phenomenon confined to human society. It is, rather, the ubiquitous manifestation of that universal law of capital interaction across every scale of existence. This section shall construct a panoramic spectrum of cycles extending from the microscopic to the macroscopic, from the instantaneous to the eternal—thereby demonstrating, with irrefutable eloquence, the universality and majestic explanatory power of Capital Dynamics as a unified science.

1. Cycles of Historical Civilization: The Metabolism and Succession of Institutional Capital

This is the most intuitively accessible cyclical scale in human history, whose core lies in the organization, ossification, and reconstitution of institutional capital.

- Capital forms: The dominant capital forms comprise a composite of institutional capital, geopolitical capital, and financial capital.
- Cyclical dynamics:
 - Contradiction: The contradiction among different classes and groups within society over the possession and distribution of core capitals (land, currency, power).
 - Metabolic tax: Manifested in the expansion of the bureaucratic apparatus, the entrenchment of vested interest groups, the loss of social mobility, and the ossification of ideology. Ultimately, the cost of maintaining stability exceeds the returns of social reproduction.
 - Paradigmatic attraction: New institutional conceptions (such as novel land systems, political structures, economic models) or the

demonstrative influence of a more efficient external civilizational paradigm.

- Cyclical manifestation: The rise and fall of dynasties, order and chaos; the ascent and collapse of empires; the economic crises and hegemonic successions of capitalism.

2. Cycles of Life: The Investment and Dissipation of Organic Capital

Life is the most salient cyclical phenomenon at the level of the individual organism, whose essence is the accumulation, maintenance, and termination of organic capital.

- Capital forms: The dominant forms are organic capital (the body), genetic capital, and mind capital.
- Cyclical dynamics:
 - Contradiction: The fundamental contradiction between the organism as a capital system maintaining its ordered existence (resisting entropy) and the dissipation of capital (entropy increase) wrought by internal and external environments.
 - Metabolic tax: Directly manifested in cellular senescence, the decline of organ function, the accumulation of DNA damage, and the diminished efficacy of the immune system. The "physiological cost of maintaining stability" escalates with time.
 - Paradigmatic attraction: For the species, genetic replication is a "new paradigm" of greater attraction that transcends the individual life cycle. Through reproduction, the individual invests genetic capital into the next round of the cycle.
- Cyclical manifestation: The birth, aging, illness, and death of the individual;

the intergenerational reproduction and evolution of species.

3. Planetary Ecological Cycles: The Equilibrium and Transition of Ecological Capital

The planetary ecosystem is a grand network of capital circulation, whose cycles are governed by the flow and equilibrium of ecological capital.

- Capital forms: The dominant forms are ecological capital (biodiversity, climatic systems, elemental cycles).
- Cyclical dynamics:
 - Contradiction: The interactive contradictions of predation, competition, and symbiosis among different species (capital units) within the system, as well as the dynamic equilibrium between the total productivity and total consumption of the ecosystem.
 - Metabolic tax: Manifested in species extinction, the accumulation of environmental toxins, the exhaustion of critical resources, and the dysfunction of climate regulation. Systemic resilience declines, and the system grows fragile.
 - Paradigmatic attraction: After sustaining major shocks (such as asteroid strikes or ice ages), the system evolves toward a configuration that achieves optimal capital reallocation under the new environment, forming a new ecological paradigm (such as the rise of mammals after the extinction of the dinosaurs).
- Cyclical manifestation: The alternation of glacial and interglacial periods, biological radiations and mass extinctions, and the successional sequences of ecosystems.

4. Stellar Cycles: The Reincarnation of Gravitational Capital

and Nuclear Fusion Capital

The life of a star is a grand cosmic-scale cyclical dance between gravitational capital and nuclear fusion capital.

- Capital forms: The dominant forms are gravitational capital (mass) and nuclear fusion capital (hydrogen, helium, and other fuels).
- Cyclical dynamics:
 - Contradiction: The dynamic equilibrium of opposites between the inward compression of gravitation and the outward radiation pressure generated by nuclear fusion.
 - Metabolic tax: The sustained consumption of nuclear fuel. When the core hydrogen is exhausted, the equilibrium is broken, and the star enters its advanced age, burning heavier elements to pay the exorbitant "metabolic tax"—yet the process is profoundly unstable.
 - Paradigmatic attraction: When nuclear fusion can no longer withstand gravitation, the star, depending on its capital stock (mass), "chooses" a new equilibrium paradigm—becoming a white dwarf, a neutron star, or a black hole. Supernova explosions hurl heavy-element capital into interstellar space, providing the primordial capital for the formation of the next generation of stars and planetary systems.
- Cyclical manifestation: The complete life cycle of a star: birth from a nebula, the main-sequence phase, the red-giant or supernova phase, and eventual evolution into a compact stellar remnant.

5. Galactic Cycles: The Grand Contest of Gravitational Capital and Dark Matter Capital

The galaxy, as the fundamental structure of the cosmos, has its evolution governed by

the interaction between visible gravitational capital and the hypothetical dark matter capital. Here, Capital Dynamics demonstrates its inclusiveness as a meta-theory: it does not prejudge the specific physical nature of "dark matter," but rather incorporates it into the analytical framework as a functional capital postulate.

- Capital forms: The dominant forms are gravitational capital (carried by visible matter—stars, gas, and the like) and dark matter capital (a form of capital currently inferred solely through its gravitational effects).
- Cyclical dynamics:
 - Contradiction: The contradiction between the observed rotation curves of galaxies and predictions based solely on the gravitational capital of visible matter. This contradiction is itself a manifestation of the universality of capital interaction—it powerfully suggests the existence of a colossal capital stock that participates in gravitational interaction though not directly detected.
 - Metabolic tax: At the galactic scale, the metabolic tax is manifested in the exhaustion of fuel for star formation and in the dissipation of kinetic energy through interactions with neighboring galaxies.
 - Paradigmatic attraction: The "dark matter halo" paradigm, for its capacity to explain observed phenomena such as galactic rotation curves and cluster dynamics, presently exerts formidable "paradigmatic attraction" within cosmology. As an effective working model, it guides our understanding of galactic capital structure. Should a new physical paradigm (such as modified gravity theories) explain these phenomena with greater efficiency, the scientific community would shift toward that new model of superior "paradigmatic attraction."
- Cyclical manifestation: The sequential evolution of galactic morphology and galactic merger events. The hypothetical distribution of dark matter capital is

regarded as the architectonic force shaping these macroscopic cyclical phenotypes.

The Ontological Positioning of Dark Matter

Within the framework of Capital Dynamics, we may assign "dark matter" a more precise ontological position:

- It may be an unknown form of physical capital: Should future experiments confirm its particle nature, then it is, like "mass capital," a fundamental physical capital—one whose "intrinsic capacity" we have not yet fully comprehended.
- It may be a "metabolic product" or "shadow" of some capital: A more radical possibility is that it is not an independent capital at all, but a systemic effect or relational attribute generated by the complex interaction of known capitals (such as gravitational capital and informational capital)—just as a corporation's "brand value" cannot exist independently of its physical assets, yet genuinely influences its market behavior. In this case, "dark matter" would be the gravitational manifestation of some "metabolic tax" paid by the deep interactions of the cosmic capital system—a tax we have yet to understand.
- The stance of Capital Dynamics: Whatever its ultimate physical essence, so long as a hypothetical entity plays an indispensable role in explaining system dynamics, it may be treated within the model as a functional "capital." Capital Dynamics concerns itself with its function within the interactive network, not with its ultimate substance. This exemplifies the formidable inclusiveness of Capital Dynamics as a relational ontology rather than a substance ontology.

6. Cosmic Cycles: The Ultimate Hypothetical Recurrence of All Capitals

In certain cosmological models, the universe itself may likewise be situated within an

eternal cycle—the ultimate arena of the law of capital interaction.

- Capital forms: The sum total of all capitals—energy, matter, spacetime, information.
- Cyclical dynamics:
 - Contradiction: The potential contradiction between cosmic expansion and gravitational contraction, or the quantum fluctuations between different vacuum states.
 - Metabolic tax: In the heat-death hypothesis, it is manifested as cosmic entropy rising to its maximum, effective capital dwindling to its minimum, and all processes grinding to a halt. In the Big Crunch or oscillatory universe models, it is manifested in the exhaustion of expansion kinetic energy.
 - Paradigmatic attraction: The "rebirth" allure of the singularity. Through the "Big Bounce" following the Big Crunch, or a "new inflation" triggered by quantum fluctuations, an entirely new paradigm of cosmic capital configuration is born from the "ruins" of the old—inaugurating a new epic of capital interaction.
- Cyclical manifestation: The hypothetical cycle of Big Bang → expansion → contraction → Big Crunch → a new Big Bang.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

From the morning mushroom that knows not the changing of the moon, to the cicada that knows not the alternation of seasons; from the rise and fall of dynasties, to the birth and death of stars—all things are within cycles, and all cycles are driven by capital interaction. This panoramic spectrum of cycles, with its irrefutable grandeur and compelling consistency, proves that Capital Dynamics is not merely the key to understanding human civilization, but a unified science endowed with cosmic-scale

explanatory power. It impresses upon us with profound gravity that the ultimate backdrop of all human civilizational striving is precisely this cold and magnificent cosmic law of cycles. To transcend the cycle, to achieve the sustainable development of civilization, is no longer a mere moral ideal, but a scientific objective that can be rationally pursued upon the basis of a deep understanding of the laws of all things.

Section Five: Capital Dynamics — The Unified Language

In the preceding four sections, we have traversed the path from ontology and the theory of contradiction to the law of cycles, completing a theoretical survey that spans the full extent of spatial and temporal scales. Now we must forge these magnificent discoveries into an integrated whole, and formally establish "Capital Dynamics" as the "unified language" that bridges the natural and social sciences, comprehending all evolutionary phenomena from the quantum to the civilizational. This section shall systematically expound the grammar, vocabulary, and core imperatives of this language, and illuminate its epoch-making significance as the ultimate instrument of civilization's self-cognition.

1. The Meta-Theoretical Orientation: A Cognitive Operating System Beyond Disciplinary Boundaries

Capital Dynamics is not a further theory proposed within the framework of existing disciplines, but a meta-theoretical ascent. It is dedicated to providing all concrete disciplines with a unified cognitive operating system and a framework of meaning.

- The unified underlying logic: It reveals that the "forces" driving the motion of physical particles, the "natural selection" driving biological evolution, the "supply and demand" driving market operation, and the "historical laws" driving the rise and fall of civilizations are, at the deepest level, merely different expressions of one and the same reality: capitals of specific forms, through interaction, tend toward a more optimal equilibrium.
- The ultimate regress of explanation: In any discipline, when "why" is pursued to its most fundamental level, Capital Dynamics provides the final, unified framework of answer: "Because this is the most stable and effective equilibrium state toward which the capital interactions within this system tend, under the present conditions."

2. Core Grammar and Basic Vocabulary

As a language, Capital Dynamics possesses a concise yet powerful core grammar and basic vocabulary.

Core Grammar (The Fundamental Sentence Form)

The [state/evolution] of [system] is the process by which its internal [capital forms], through [interaction modes], under [constraints], tend toward [the equilibrium objective]; this process is dynamically governed by [paradigmatic attraction] and [metabolic tax].

- Example (Physics): "The motion of an electron is the process by which its charge capital, through electromagnetic interaction, under the constraints of spatiotemporal-geometric capital, tends toward the state of lowest electrical potential energy."
- Example (Civilizational History): "The outbreak of the Industrial Revolution was a paradigmatic switch realized when the industrial capital paradigm, by virtue of its higher total-factor capital reproduction efficiency, generated a paradigmatic attraction powerful enough to prevail over the exorbitant metabolic tax of the agrarian-civilizational paradigm."

Basic Vocabulary

- Capital: The fundamental efficacy upon which any system depends for its existence and development; the unity of intrinsic capacity and relational attributes.
- Interaction: Absolute General Senseform of reciprocal action among capitals; its core is the General-Sense "exploitation-oppression" mechanism.
- Equilibrium: The objective state toward which a system's capital configuration tends, being stable and effective; the "final cause" of dynamics.
- Contradiction: Another expression of capital interaction, emphasizing the

unity of opposites within the interaction.

- Cycle: The macroscopic rhythm exhibited in the process of capital interaction tending toward equilibrium, arising from the accumulation of metabolic tax and the switching of paradigmatic attraction.
- Paradigmatic attraction: The converging force—cognitive and behavioral—generated by a more efficient mode of capital reproduction.
- Metabolic tax: The inherent cost a system must bear to maintain its existing structure and path dependence.

3. The Three Unified Imperatives

As a unified language, Capital Dynamics contains three inviolable meta-imperatives, which together constitute the golden rules for analyzing any problem whatsoever.

- The Imperative of the Universality of Capital Interaction: In analyzing any system, one must first identify its core capital forms and interaction modes. "There is no system without capital interaction."
- The Imperative of the Purposiveness of Tendency toward Equilibrium: The change of state of any system must be understood as a process tending toward some more stable and effective state of capital equilibrium. "All evolution has a direction, and that direction points toward a more optimal capital equilibrium."
- The Imperative of the Decisiveness of Paradigmatic Competition: The long-term fate of a system is determined by the dynamic contest between its internal "metabolic tax" and the potential "paradigmatic attraction" of alternatives. "The metabolic tax sentences the old paradigm to death; paradigmatic attraction crowns the new one."

4. The Capital Interaction Hamiltonian ($\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$): The

Mathematical Soul of the Unified Language

This language does not remain at the philosophical level alone; it possesses a mathematical core that advances toward the exact sciences—the Capital Interaction Hamiltonian ($\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$).

$\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$ is the mathematical incarnation of the Imperative of the Universality of Capital Interaction. Its form— $\hat{H}_{\text{mint}} = \sum_i \alpha_i \hat{N}_i + \sum_{i < j} \beta_{ij} \hat{R}_{ij} + \dots$ —compels the researcher to consider simultaneously both the existential capital ($\hat{N}$) and the relational capital ($\hat{R}$) of the system.

$\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$ is the dynamical engine of the Imperative of the Purposiveness of Tendency toward Equilibrium. The evolution of a system is governed by $\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$; its stable solutions correspond to the system's equilibrium states.

$\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$ is the generative program of the Imperative of the Decisiveness of Paradigmatic Competition. Different combinations of capital forms and interaction modes (i.e., different paradigms) correspond to different operators and coupling coefficients within $\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$. Paradigmatic competition, mathematically, manifests as the competition among different forms of $\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$ in their capacity to explain and predict reality.

The grand vision of $\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$ lies in this: it provides all disciplines—from physics to sociology—with a common, potentially universal mathematical starting point for modeling.

5. An Ascension in the Civilizational Sense: From Spontaneous Evolution to Conscious Design

The most profound value of Capital Dynamics as a unified language is that it offers human civilization a historic opportunity for cognitive ascent.

- As a diagnostic instrument: It enables us to diagnose with clarity the stage in which civilization presently finds itself, and to calculate with precision

whether the "metabolic tax" of the old paradigm is approaching its critical threshold.

- As a navigational compass: It provides a unified, commensurable yardstick for evaluating the "paradigmatic attraction" of various future scenarios, guiding the course of civilization toward a more sustainable and more flourishing shore.
- As a design blueprint: Ultimately, a civilization that has mastered this language will no longer be a passive object suffering the torments of the law of cycles, but a conscious subject capable of actively applying the principles of Capital Dynamics to design, construct, and iteratively refine its social institutions. The new civilization of Contributionism is precisely the blueprint of this first great act of conscious practice.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Capital Dynamics—this unified language born of the ontological commitment of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital—bestows upon our fragmented cognitive world the unity for which we have long yearned. It tells us that the birth and death of stars, the evolution of life, and the rise and fall of histories were originally one and the same magnificent poem, written in the vocabulary of capital and governed by one and the same profound grammar composed of interaction, equilibrium, attraction, and metabolism. To master this language is the mark of civilization's maturation. It signifies that we may at last cease our quarreling and groping in the darkness, and instead light the torch of reason, discern with clarity our true position and direction of advance within the vast network of All-Things-as-Capital interaction, and courageously assume the ultimate responsibility of writing the next chapter of civilization.

The construction of Capital Dynamics in this chapter is now complete. We proceed next to Section Six: The Principles of Capital Dynamics in Civilizational

Evolution—Paradigmatic Attraction and Metabolic Tax—applying this unified language concretely to the analysis of civilizational evolution, distilling its most fundamental dynamical principles, and laying a solid foundation for the final reconstruction of history.

Section Six: The Dynamical Reconstruction of Civilizational Evolution — The Rise and Fall of Paradigms and the Inevitability of Contributionism

In the preceding discourse, we have erected a grand theoretical edifice encompassing ontology, epistemology, and the principles of dynamics. We now undertake a final synthesis: marshaling the twin meta-forces of paradigmatic attraction and metabolic tax to effectuate a searching dynamical reconstruction of the history of human civilization. This is not a mere retrospective reading of history, but an incisive diagnosis of the present civilizational predicament—and a logico-historical derivation of the birth of the next civilizational paradigm, Contributionism, which serves at once as the coda to the first movement of this work and the prelude to the second.

1. The Civilizational Epic under the Dynamical Lens

Civilizational history is in no sense a chronicle of emperors, kings, generals, and ministers, nor an aimless drift of some nebulous "spirit of the age." It is, rather, a law-governed dynamical sequence in which a dominant institutional-capital paradigm ossifies through the accumulation of "metabolic tax" and is ultimately supplanted by a new paradigm endowed with superior "paradigmatic attraction."

The evolution of these five paradigms perfectly corroborates the fundamental equation of Capital Dynamics:

Hunter-Gatherer Paradigm → Agrarian Civilizational Paradigm

Old paradigm's metabolic tax: Absolute dependence on the ephemeral yield of natural capital; exceedingly low population-carrying capacity; and perilously high existential uncertainty.

New paradigm's attraction: Through the deliberate command of natural capital (land and species), the attainment of a grain surplus—engendering population

growth, technological accumulation, and sedentary civilization. Its stability and predictability exerted an immense attraction.

Agrarian Civilizational Paradigm → Commercial Capital Paradigm

Old paradigm's metabolic tax: The economic base tethered to land; the social fabric petrified; the "coordination tax" of imperial bureaucracies exorbitant.

New paradigm's attraction: Long-distance commerce dissolved geographic impediments, yielding prodigious efficiencies in the interregional allocation of resources. The liquidity of monetary capital proved vastly more fecund than the immobile fixity of landed capital.

Commercial Capital Paradigm → Industrial Capital Paradigm

Old paradigm's metabolic tax: Its intrinsic logic of "buying cheap and selling dear" could never surmount the bottleneck of productive forces.

New paradigm's attraction: Mechanized mass production yielded an exponential surge in material productive powers. This Midas-touch faculty of transmuting base substances into gold exerted a cataclysmic attraction upon the entire world.

Industrial Capital Paradigm → Financial Capital Paradigm

Old paradigm's metabolic tax: Reliance on heavy tangible assets; pronounced capital–labor antagonism; recurrent overproduction crises.

New paradigm's attraction: By means of credit, securities, and other financial instruments, it attains an extreme abstraction and liquidity of capital, together with a velocity of self-expansion that seemingly enables "money to beget money"—thereby achieving a liquidity surpassing that of industrial capital.

2. Dynamical Diagnosis of the General Crisis: The Terminal

Phase of the Financial Capital Paradigm

At present, human civilization lies enmeshed in the systemic deadlock of the financial capital paradigm. Its "metabolic tax" has entirely overwhelmed its "paradigmatic attraction":

- Ecological-extermination tax: The logic of limitless financial accumulation stands in irreconcilable, fundamental contradiction with the finite limits of planetary natural capital.
- Social-disintegration tax: Returns to capital vastly surpass returns to labor, breeding an extreme polarization of wealth and undermining the very foundations of the social contract.
- Innovation-suppression tax: The logic of short-term arbitrage systematically deprives long-cycle, foundational, substantive technological innovation of investment.
- Systemic-risk tax: The hyper-virtualized and leveraged financial edifice harbors the periodic peril of global collapse.

Diagnostic conclusion: The financial capital paradigm—an institutional incarnation that propels the exploitative–oppressive dimension of the causal law of capital interaction to an extreme limit—can no longer persist without annihilating its own foundations (natural capital and social capital). Its historical mission has reached its terminal point.

3. The Historical Synthesis: The Dynamical Inevitability of the Contributionist Paradigm

The laws of history bear witness that every paradigmatic transition is born of the cultivation and deployment of a deeper stratum of capital, and points toward a more encompassing logic of value. The funeral knell of the financial capital paradigm logically and historically foreshadows the core features of the next paradigm:

- The core of the new paradigm: contribution value. The new paradigm must incorporate the sustainable augmentation of natural capital, human capital, and social capital as its cardinal motive force. This demands that its value anchor shift from the abstract and exclusionary "financial price" back to the concrete

and shareable "contribution value."

Overwhelming paradigmatic attraction:

- Resolution of the ecological crisis: It constitutes ecological sustainability itself as the supreme form of "capacity" and "contribution," redirecting intellectual capital toward green innovation.
- Transcendence of wealth polarization: Through a contribution value system, it fixes value distribution directly to tangible, verifiable contributions, thus erecting a more equitable and more fluid social order.
- Unleashing of human potential: It is dedicated to regarding the human being as the end of development, realizing the creative potential of both individuals and collectivities.

Contributionism as the historical synthesis: Contributionism is no mere utopian reverie. It constitutes civilization's first conscious, collective act of paradigm design and construction—undertaken after the apprehension of its own predicament and of the laws of all things, through reason and conscience. It is a dialectical synthesis of all previous forms:

It does not repudiate the body, but through technology enables each person to actualize his or her fullest potential; it does not repudiate the land, but through ecological wisdom secures its perennial flourishing; it repudiates finance outright, for its very existence is antithetical to civilization.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Surveying the dynamical panorama of civilizational evolution, we perceive with clarity that the contest between "paradigmatic attraction" and "metabolic tax" is the prime mover impelling the wheels of history. When the "metabolic tax" of an old paradigm grows so exorbitant as to stifle systemic vitality, a new civilizational form commanding superior "paradigmatic attraction" inevitably emerges—an objective law

beholden to no individual will.

At present, the financial capital paradigm has reached the terminus of its historical path. The "ecological-extermination tax," the "social-disintegration tax," the "innovation-suppression tax," and the "systemic-risk tax" generated by its logic of limitless accumulation have long outstripped the slender conveniences it affords. It resembles a rocket whose thrust has been entirely spent; its structural contradictions are inherently irresolvable from within.

And yet, historical inflection points are never the product of crisis alone. They demand the convergence of all elements at a single moment.

Following the primeval communal order, human civilization elected the path of exploitation. Across millennia of unfolding, once the logic of capital had been set in motion, it could not be arrested—not because humans are "evil," but because a system whose cardinal imperative is "accumulation" must collapse the instant it pauses. Its scale expands ever outward, its plunder ever inward, while technology has never fully attained the critical threshold that would supplant human labor. Thus civilization remains entombed within a cycle that accelerates without cease yet can never achieve satiety.

Now, in the twenty-first century, all elements have converged in a single instant:

- The blueprint stands complete. The architecture of the Contributionist new civilization has been delineated;
- The theory stands ready. The General-Specific Meta-Theory, the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, Capital Dynamics, and Resonance Physics have coalesced into a complete cognitive framework;
- Science and technology have attained the requisite threshold. AI, automation, blockchain, and quantum computing render possible the precise quantification of contributions and the trustworthy recording and allocation of value;
- The economic predicament has reached its critical juncture. The growth motor

of the old paradigm is exhausted; the distribution crisis, the debt crisis, and the ecological crisis have detonated in synchrony. All the problems of the old system are irresolvable within the old system. They are dammed, diverted, and deferred like floodwaters, but never eliminated. Each solution merely sets the scene for an even greater problem;

- The specter of war has resurfaced. Its internal energy spent, the old world's only remaining outlet is to extrude its contradictions outward;
- The direction stands clarified. A migration from the "logic of capital" to the "logic of contribution," from "exploitation-driven" to "creation-driven."

All factors have converged at one and the selfsame moment. And once these problems enter the framework of the new system, they cease to be problematic—not because they have been "solved," but because the logical premises of their existence have been wholly replaced.

This is no happenstance. It is history, through its own evolution, that has prepared all the conditions. The old system is beyond repair; the new system stands ready to function. All that remains is the decisive final step—our choice.

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

From the ontological re-foundation of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, to the cognitive emancipation of the General-Specific distinction, to the unified explication of contradiction and cycles afforded by Capital Dynamics, we have completed a journey of intellectual ascent. The terminus of this journey points with unambiguous clarity to a single conclusion: the paradigm of the old civilization—above all, its highest stage, finance capitalism—has, under the crushing burden of the "metabolic tax" engendered by its own logic, reached the end of its historical course.

The hope of civilization resides in inaugurating a radical "cognitive revolution"—a leap into a fundamentally new operating system. Contributionism is the name of that

new operating system. It constitutes the first moment in which civilization, in a holistic and self-conscious fashion, undertakes the stewardship of its own destiny, emancipating its course from the blind causality of nature and setting sail deliberately toward a future whose lodestar remains ecological rationality and the integral development of the human person.

Further Reading

The present chapter has demonstrated the dynamical laws of capital interaction: contradiction drives evolution; metabolic tax condemns the old paradigm to death; paradigmatic attraction crowns the new.

Yet a deeper question remains unanswered: if exploitation is a universal law of all things, upon what grounds may civilization believe itself capable of transcending it? Is such transcendence a moral illusion, or a physical necessity?

We direct the reader to consult Appendix II, Resonance Physics: Another Cosmic Law Founded upon the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. Departing from the mathematical distinction between the relational operator $\hat{R}_{ij}$ and the resonance operator $\hat{S}_{ij}$, that treatise demonstrates the zero-dissipation character of resonance interaction and the axiomatic system of benevolent measurement. It derives a five-stage ladder of civilizational transition from internal resonance to universal resonance, and in its final chapter, "The Birth of Consciousness," consummates the ultimate argument at the cosmological level. It demonstrates that Contributionism is not a moral choice but a physical necessity.

Part Two: The Great Rupture — The End of the Old Paradigm and the Birth of Contributionism

Prelude to This Part

In Part One, we attained the ultimate lens through which to behold the world—the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital and Capital Dynamics. With unclouded clarity, we perceived the impasse into which the old civilizational paradigm—and above all, its highest stage, finance capitalism—has been driven by the crushing weight of its metabolic tax. Yet insight at the level of cognition must be transfigured into self-awareness at the level of value, and thence into a program of action. This Part undertakes that crucial transfiguration.

First, we commence the restoration of value—subjecting human nature and the polarity of good and evil to renewed examination against the vast backdrop of All-Things-as-Capital, and demonstrating that "Goodness" is no enervating moral sermon, but a rational choice demanded of any civilization that would survive and ascend. Next, we descend to the roots, subjecting the foundational concepts of the old paradigm—productivity, patent rights, globalization, atomization, and economics—to radical critique and re-forging, thereby clearing the terrain for Contributionism. Finally, in the unification and sublation of the isms, we survey the historical arc of capitalism and communism, comprehend their essential nature within the framework of capitalism in the General Sense, and ultimately identify Contributionism as the inexorable upsurge of the historical synthesis.

This Part marks the pivotal moment at which thought passes from diagnosis to prescription; it is the birth-manifesto of the Contributionist new civilization. The value judgments herein are not exogenously imposed norms, but an act of cognizance of the laws immanent in the movement of all things—for the distinction between good and evil, long before any theory was articulated, had already been inscribed upon the threshold between survival and extinction across billions of years of evolution.

Chapter One: The Restoration of Value — Good and Evil
as the Rational Choice of Civilizational Survival

Prelude to This Chapter

Beneath the frigid law of All-Things-as-Capital interaction unveiled in Part One, civilization might appear condemned to wallow in the ceaseless cycle of exploitation and oppression. This chapter mounts a desperate counter-offensive of value. We shall argue that the essence of civilization lies not in submission to this universal law, but in conscious resistance to—and transcendence of—it. By subjecting the full spectrum of human nature to renewed scrutiny, we shall reveal that "good" is not the fragile ornamentation of morality, but a rational choice which civilization, situated within the interplay of All-Things-as-Capital, must institute for the sake of its own survival and ascent. This reorientation shall set the axiological cornerstone of the Contributionist new civilization.

Section One: The Essence of the Human Being — At the Dialectical Confluence of Universal Law and Civilizational Particularity

In laying the axiological cornerstone of a new civilization, we must first confront a question of primordial depth: what, in truth, is the essence of the human being? The answer we give shall determine not merely our self-understanding, but our very audacity to design society.

1. The Insights and Limits of a Classical Formulation: Marx's "Totality of Social Relations"

Karl Marx's penetrating dictum—that the essence of the human being is not an abstract quality inherent in the isolated individual, but, in its actuality, the totality of all social relations—bequeathed to us a decisive vantage point from which to surmount biological determinism.

Sociality as the genesis and fundament of the human. The human being does not exist in atomized isolation. From the moment of birth, every individual is ineluctably embedded within an immense relational web, threaded through family, community, culture, economy, and political institutions. Our language, thought, emotion, desire—even our very self-conception—are forged within the suffusing and shaping currents of this web. As Aristotle long ago discerned, the human is a *zōon politikon*, a creature of the polis; an individual severed from society forfeits the very qualification of full humanity.

The practical genesis of social relations. These relations are by no means a static and preordained framework, immutably fixed. They are, rather, actively created and perpetually reconstituted by human beings in the course of protracted historical praxis, undertaken for the sake of survival and flourishing. The clan cooperation of primitive

society, the village communities of agrarian civilization, and the global division of labor in the modern era are all ever more intricate social architectures erected to meet the exigencies of existence. The essence of the human being, therefore, is a dynamic process that generates itself within history—not an immutable datum fixed once and for all.

Insight and inherent limitation. The greatness of this formulation resides in its revelation of the social genesis of the human, wresting the discussion of "human nature" from abstract speculation and anchoring it in concrete historical and social reality. Yet, if this perspective is absolutized, it threatens to elide a more foundational question: what deeper drive—one perhaps shared with other forms of life—impels the human being to create and depend upon so intricate a web of social relations in the first place?

2. The Deepening of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital:

Universal Ground and Civilizational Construction

The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital affords us a more capacious and more fundamental vista, within which Marx's insight into sociality and Absolute General Sense laws of evolution achieve reconciliation within a single framework.

"The universal" ground: the law of survival and development within All-Things-as-Capital interaction. From the vantage of the Absolute General Sense, the primordial imperative of any system whatsoever is to maintain and augment its own existence. This law holds universally, from elementary particles to galaxies, from bacteria to human beings. It is the law of nature—the law of survival—recast in the idiom of capital: all things, through the interaction of capitals (General-Sense exploitation and oppression), tend to sustain and increase their own capital stock.

The human being, as one thing among all things, has its innermost driving essence rooted in precisely this ground. Our pursuit of survival, security, reproduction, and resource acquisition constitutes a biological universality we share with all life.

Darwinian evolution—the struggle for existence, the survival of the fittest—is but one expression of this universal law within the domain of living beings.

The leap of particularity: sociality as a creative response to Absolute General Senselaw. What is extraordinary about the human being resides not in having escaped this universal law, but in having discovered a singular path by which to fulfill it. The individual human is frail, enjoying no decisive advantage in the merciless sieve of natural selection. Yet we have cultivated an unrivaled mental capital, and with it have erected a social capital of surpassing complexity.

Sociality, then, is no negation of natural law. It is the human being's creative response to—and strategic transcendence of—Absolute General Senselaw of the struggle for existence. We compete not only through the fangs and claws of the solitary organism, but through collective cooperation, the accumulation of knowledge, and the transmission of culture—elevating the unit of competition from the individual to the tribe, the city-state, the nation, and the civilization. It is thus that humanity, as a whole, has secured an advantage in survival and development unrivaled by any other species upon this earth.

Corroborating case. Every great achievement of human civilization—from language and writing to science and technology, from law and morality to art and philosophy—is not the product of isolated individuals, but the crystallization of social cooperation. Together, they constitute an immense "externalized mind," by which each generation stands upon the shoulders of its predecessors and achieves a compounding accretion of cognition and capacity.

The dialectical unity: realizing the particular within the universal. The essence of the human being is neither solely the "totality of social relations" nor crudely the law of "the strong devouring the weak." It is the dialectical unity of Absolute General Senselaw of All-Things-as-Capital interaction with the particular path of mental-social capital. We issue from nature, inheriting Absolute General Sensedriverive of competition among all things; and we transcend nature, inaugurating a singular

avenue by which that drive is fulfilled through cooperation and civilizational construction. Sociality is the civilizational mode by which we surpass primitive competition and achieve a more efficacious survival and flourishing.

3. Corroboration from Contemporary Science: From "Blank Slate" to "Biocomputer Preloaded with Complex Systems"

In contradistinction to the "blank-slate" theory of human nature, modern science offers a far more intricate portrait—one that perfectly corroborates the interweaving of universality and particularity described above. Research in brain science and neuroplasticity demonstrates that the neonatal brain is already endowed with specific innate structures and functional predispositions; it is by no means a tabula rasa awaiting inscription. Epigenetics further reveals that the biological constitution of the individual already bears the environmental imprint of prior generations. This indicates that the formation of the human essence is a continuous and unbroken process of interaction between genetic inheritance and social environment, commencing at the very inception of life.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The essence of the human being is, therefore, a profound dialectical existence: we are at once the bearers of Absolute General Senselaw of All-Things-as-Capital interaction, subject to the elemental drive for survival and development, and the pioneers of a singular civilizational path, transcending primitive competition through the construction of social and mental capital. To comprehend this duality is of paramount importance. It teaches us that the endeavor of civilization must not naively deny or repress our intrinsic universal drive; rather, it must, through rational institutional design and cultural construction, open for that drive a more constructive and more sustainable channel of expression. This—and this alone—is the core problem that Contributionism undertakes to solve: how to unite, in perfect harmony,

the individual's drive for survival and development with the sustainable flourishing of civilization as a whole.

Section Two: Human Nature in the Specific Sense — The Cognitive Prison of the Old Paradigm and Its Self-Fulfilling Prophecy

Having clarified the essence of the human being, we must now turn to a far more specific category: human nature. The predicament of the old civilizational paradigm derives, to no small degree, from a deeply entrenched and self-confining conception of human nature in its narrowest sense.

1. The Theoretical Cornerstone of the Old Paradigm: The "Rational Economic Man" Hypothesis and Its Hegemony

The construction and diffusion of the concept. Since Adam Smith, classical and neoclassical economics have elevated "Rational Economic Man" (*Homo economicus*) to the rank of a foundational analytical axiom. This model abstracts the human being into an atomized individual endowed with perfect information, cold calculation, and the solitary objective of maximizing his own utility. The core impulses of this figure are presupposed to be selfishness, greed, an unbounded appetite for possession, and a pronounced aversion to risk.

From academic model to social creed. What began as a convenient instrumental assumption for the purposes of mathematical modeling gradually, over the course of capitalist development, transgressed the boundaries of the academy. It was ideologized, universalized, and even sanctified, becoming the ultimate "truth" concerning "human nature." Through textbooks, media discourse, and managerial practice, it seeped into the collective consciousness, forging the vulgar truism that "human beings are selfish by nature."

The mirroring and reification of institutions. Social institutions—above all, the market mechanism and the legal system—were erected upon this narrow conception of

human nature and, in turn, systematically incentivized and amplified precisely those traits they presupposed. Competition, exclusion, and profit maximization were pronounced "rational" and "efficient"; cooperation, altruism, and sharing were dismissed as "naïve," "irrational," or "inefficient." Thus was forged a hermetic cognitive-practical circle: institutions are built upon a narrow conception of human nature, and institutions, in turn, shape and reinforce that narrowness, rendering it the dominant and most conspicuous mode of behavior in social life.

2. The Cognitive Fallacies of the Specific-Sense Conception of Human Nature and Their Scientific Refutation

The old paradigm's conception of human nature is not merely philosophically impoverished—it stands in flagrant contradiction with the discoveries of modern science.

The naïveté of the "blank slate" and the reality of the "preloaded system." Against the tabula rasa theory of the origins of human nature, modern cognitive science and genetics present a portrait of far greater intricacy. The neonatal brain is by no means a pristine, unwritten page.

The innate watermark of neuroplasticity. Research demonstrates that the infant's mirror-neuron system is already functional shortly after birth, enabling instinctive imitation and emotional resonance with others—the biological bedrock of altruism and sociality. Piaget observed that infants in the sensorimotor stage already manifest clearly purposeful behavior and causal exploration, indicating that cognitive structures are endowed with innate frameworks and predispositions.

The intergenerational inscription of epigenetics. Studies such as those of the Dutch "Hunger Winter" reveal that environmental stressors experienced by one's ancestors—famine, for instance—can, through mechanisms such as DNA methylation, affect the physical and mental health and stress-response patterns of subsequent generations. We are born, in other words, not with a pristine blank page but with a

palimpsest already inscribed by evolutionary history and ancestral experience. The so-called "innate" is already deeply stamped with the mark of the "acquired."

The subversion of behavioral economics. The research of Daniel Kahneman and others has decisively overturned the postulate of perfect rationality, revealing that human decision-making is pervaded by systematic biases—loss aversion, framing effects, and the like. Meanwhile, experiments such as the Ultimatum Game demonstrate with striking eloquence that human beings possess a robust preference for fairness and will sacrifice their own material interests to punish unjust behavior—a direct challenge to the postulate of pure selfishness.

The cooperative paradox of evolutionary biology. From group selection theory to kin selection and reciprocal altruism, evolutionary biology has long since made clear that cooperation, altruism, and morality are no *ex nihilo* inventions of civilization, but deeply embedded in our biological constitution—strategic adaptations of decisive importance that secured our survival and flourishing within the merciless sieve of natural selection.

3. The Self-Fulfilling Prophecy: How the Specific-Sense

Conception of Human Nature Shaped and Sealed the Fate of the Old Civilization

The roots of ecological arrogance. The reduction of human nature to greed and acquisitiveness inevitably breeds anthropocentrism. Nature is relegated to a mere reservoir of "externalities"—devoid of intrinsic value, existing solely to be exploited. This cognition constitutes the deep-seated root, at the level of the conception of human nature, of the "ecological-extermination tax" diagnosed in Part One.

The erosion of social capital. When social institutions presume all individuals to be latent opportunists, they must erect vast and costly systems of surveillance, checks and balances, and punishment. This dissipates the capital of social trust; human

relations are reduced to bare contracts and calculations, enormously inflating society's "coordination tax" and "stability-maintenance tax."

The foreclosure of civilizational horizons. Imprisoned within this competitive, exclusionary, and stunted conception of human nature, we grow incapable of imagining civilizational forms predicated upon a higher expression of the human. It confines the imaginative and developmental potential of civilization within a low-dimensional historical cycle of animal competition, strangling every aspiration to ascend to a higher plane.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The "narrow human nature" upon which the old paradigm rests is, to a significant degree, a self-fulfilling prophecy and a meticulously constructed cognitive prison. It is not an immutable biological datum, but a behavioral subset that a particular institutional order has systematically selected, amplified, and reified. To shatter this prison—to recognize the richness, the plasticity, and the intrinsic "light side" of human nature—is the first and most indispensable act of intellectual liberation if we are to break free from the old paradigm and inaugurate a new civilizational epoch. We must possess the audacity to believe that the human being is capable of—and summoned to—becoming a finer and nobler existence.

Section Three: Human Nature in the General Sense — The Luminous Aspect within All-Things-as-Capital Interaction and the Mission of Civilization

Once the incantation of the narrow conception of human nature has been dispelled, a vaster and far more hopeful vista unfolds before us. Within the framework of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, we are enabled to re-situate human nature against the magnificent backdrop of cosmic evolution, and to discern within it a latent potentiality of transcendence.

1. Defining Human Nature in the General Sense: From Cosmic Universality to Civilizational Particularity

The ground: Absolute General Sensedrive of All-Things-as-Capital. Human nature in the General Sense begins by acknowledging that the human being is a bearer of Absolute General Senselaw of capital interaction. Like every other existent, we carry within our inmost being the elemental drive to preserve and augment our own capital stock. This is the biological universality we share with all things—the distant echo of the struggle for existence reverberating through our living flesh.

The leap: the emergence of mental capital and the dawn of reflective consciousness. What distinguishes the human being is that evolution has called forth a mental capital of unparalleled complexity. When the neural architecture of the brain attains a certain threshold of intricacy, reflective consciousness arises. We not only know, but know that we know; we not only endure the agonies of capital interaction, but become cognizant of the law that governs them, and interrogate their meaning. Thus are we transmuted from passive inheritors of the law into its potential contemplators.

The awakening of the luminous aspect: pain as the origin of morality. Absolute General Senselaw of General-Sense exploitation and oppression in capital interaction

has, as its generic consequence, the perpetual reconfiguration of capital structures. Yet when this law operates upon beings endowed with acute sensibility and a complex emotional life, it engenders a revolutionary byproduct: the experience of profound suffering.

It is precisely this perception of—and empathy with—suffering that constitutes the primordial soil from which all moral sentiments—compassion, pity, altruism, fairness, justice—take root. It is the first sensuous revolt against the blind and callous law of capital interaction. The luminous aspect of human nature, therefore, is no alien importation: it is the seed of self-transcendence which the cosmic matrix of capital, in the course of its own evolution, has cultivated as a counterforce to its own dark inertia.

2. The Dialectical Development of Human Nature through the Lens of Contradiction

The history of human nature is the history of the movement of its own internal contradictions.

The contradiction of universality and particularity. Within human nature, Absolute General Sensedrive—competition, self-interest, the survival instincts of biological capital—stands in tension with the particular drive—altruism, cooperation, creation, the moral self-awareness of mental capital. This antinomy constitutes the fundamental contradiction impelling the development of civilization.

The spiral ascent of the contradiction's movement. The civilizational process does not simply abolish universality; it is rather the unceasing movement by which particularity sublates and reconfigures universality within a higher unity.

- In primitive societies, oppressed by the crushing weight of survival pressures, universality held sovereign sway; cooperation extended no farther than the bounds of kinship.
- With the birth of civilization, morality and law emerged; particularity began,

in institutional form, to constrain and guide universality.

- At the zenith of the old paradigm, capitalism institutionalized universality—greed, competition—as the core engine of society, while particularity was driven to the margins.
- At the dawn of the new civilization, Contributionism aspires to establish particularity—creativity, contribution—as the cardinal causal principle of society, directing the energies of Absolute General Sense-drive, within a more exalted framework, toward the flourishing of the whole.

From conformity to transcendence: the mission of civilization. The old paradigm represents the apotheosis of Absolute General Sense-aspect of human nature—its extreme expression and blind obeisance. The mission of the new civilization is the conscious unfolding and thorough realization of its particular aspect: to deploy our reason and our conscience in active resistance to, regulation of, and reconstruction of the cold universal law.

3. The Civilizational Significance of Human Nature in the General Sense: The Leap from "Is" to "Ought"

It discloses our bearing. Human nature in the General Sense teaches us that our longing for fairness, justice, beauty, and love is no illusory fancy, but the self-conscious aspiration of the universe—having evolved to the plane of mind—toward a higher mode of its own being. This confers upon the moral ideals of civilization a secure ontological foundation.

It confers upon us a responsibility. As the sole beings in the known cosmos capable of consciously apprehending the law of All-Things-as-Capital interaction and of potentially transcending it, we shoulder a responsibility of cosmic dimension. We issue from all things; it is ours, therefore, to advance on behalf of all things, to seek a path of civilization delivered from the blind fate of exploitation and oppression. We

are, in the truest sense, the conscience born of the All-Things-as-Capital interaction.

It bestows upon us the courage to act. To recognize that the luminous aspect of human nature is no less rooted in our biology and in the logic of cosmic evolution than its shadow is to summon the courage to design and to build a society that evokes and magnifies that luminosity rather than suppressing it. We are not waging war upon "human nature"; we are cultivating those of its possibilities that are more advanced, more redolent of the future.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Human nature in the General Sense is the liberating vision we attain once the old prison has been thrown open. It reveals that we are at once disciples—inheritors of the ancient wisdom of survival possessed by all things—and vanguard—bearers of the mission to open a new path for civilization. Contributionism is the first full efflorescence of this General-Sense human nature at the level of institutional design. It cherishes the conviction that the human being can, and must, regard his fellow being as a companion upon a shared odyssey, rather than as prey in the game of capital. This is no mere moral exhortation; it is the supreme rationality that evolution has conferred upon our species for the sake of survival and flourishing.

Section Four: The Restoration of Good and Evil — A Civilizational Survival Criterion Derived from Capital Dynamics

Having delineated the full spectrum of human nature, we are now empowered to surmount millennia of moral-philosophical contention and to establish for "good" and "evil" a rigorous, objective definition anchored in the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. This definition no longer rests upon subjective inclination, but stands as a dynamical criterion for the survival and flourishing of civilizations.

1. The Restoration of Definition: From Moral Delusion to Survival Rationality

The essence of evil: blind submission to, and inertial descent within, Absolute General Sense-law. Within the framework of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, evil is not a substantive entity but a relational disposition. It manifests when a system—whether individual or civilizational—possessing the capacity for superior alternatives, nonetheless unreflectively and immoderately submits to, and even reinforces, the cosmic universal law of exploitation-oppression in the General Sense. When a civilization suffers itself to be governed by this primordial drive, its conduct may be condemned as evil on the civilizational plane. It is the inertia of civilization, a regressive relapse toward the primordial condition of the cosmos.

An illustration: financial capital, in pursuit of short-term reported profits, systematically hollows out the foundations of the real economy. This is a paradigmatic instance of knowingly committed evil—trading the sustainability of total social capital for the accretion of a partial capital.

The essence of good: normative particularity deliberately instituted by civilization. In contradistinction, good is the normative particularity which human civilization actively prescribes for itself within the value-neutral universality of the cosmos. It is

our conscious response to, and transcendence of, the "human paradox" embedded in our own constitution. Thus we define good: civilization, at the cost of minimal and necessary exploitation-oppression in the General Sense, devotes itself to the elimination of internal exploitation-oppression in the Specific Sense—that is, social injustice and needless suffering—and to the enduring prosperity, co-evolution, and internal harmony of the total capital of the civilization-ecosystem.

In other words, good is civilization's deliberate self-correction of the spontaneous drift of the universe. It is the supreme norm of conduct and the civilizational ideal that we, having achieved a cognitive leap, appoint for ourselves in the pursuit of long-term survival and flourishing.

2. The Core Criterion: Verifiable Standards of Capital

Dynamics

Upon this foundation, we may establish an operative, objective criterion by which to distinguish good from evil.

The three dynamical criteria of good.

First, verifiable capital appreciation: the act must yield an observable increment of capital—whether material (ecological restoration, technological invention), mental (the dissemination of knowledge, the spread of education), or social (the deepening of trust, the expansion of cooperation).

Second, systemic positive externalities: the benefits of the act must redound to the system as a whole, not to the agent alone, and must possess a wide sphere of diffusion.

Third, a sustainable reproductive cycle: the conditions engendered by a good act must be such as to support and give rise to further good acts, forming a self-amplifying loop of gain rather than a single, exhausted outlay.

Let us test these criteria with the simplest and most cruel of thought experiments.

Under conditions of extreme food scarcity, can "seizing another's food in order to survive" be accounted good?

If we strictly apply the foregoing criteria: it yields verifiable capital appreciation in the short term, for one obtains the energy necessary for survival. Does it generate systemic positive externalities? No. Every act of seizure corrodes trust; it proclaims to all that others are a threat. Social capital is ravaged, cooperative networks collapse, and each individual is cast upon a lonely isle of strife. Does it form a sustainable reproductive cycle? It does not. If you despoil me today, I may despoil you tomorrow. When all are engaged in mutual predation, the aggregate survival rate does not rise; it falls through internal attrition.

Therefore, the evil that appears "rational" under conditions of scarcity remains evil at the civilizational scale. It fails the criterion of sustainability; it dissipates the total capital of civilization.

Conversely, under conditions of abundance, the choice to share, the choice not to seize, is good—for it satisfies every criterion.

Thus the judgment of good and evil is not absolute; it is conditioned by the material circumstances in which a civilization finds itself. Yet whatever the circumstances, the choice that augments the total capital of the system, produces positive externalities, and forms a sustainable cycle is always good.

This conclusion bespeaks a deeper truth: when food is so plentiful that it may be cast aside, enemies too become friends. Not because the human heart has been transformed, but because the calculus of survival has changed. When predation is no longer the optimal strategy, when the rewards of cooperation exceed those of competition, human conduct naturally turns toward Goodness. The mission of civilization is not to "refashion the heart" through moral exhortation, but to create the material conditions under which Goodness becomes the rational choice.

The three dynamical criteria of evil.

First, systemic capital dissipation: an act which, at the expense of the future or of the whole, serves a local or short-term capital appreciation, thereby inflicting gratuitous depletion upon the stock of total system capital.

Second, the diffusion of negative externalities: the suffering, disorder, and destruction wrought by the act propagate and amplify through the system, fostering vicious cycles.

Third, the risk of irreversible collapse: the act propels the system toward a critical threshold or phase boundary, dramatically elevating the probability of systemic dissolution.

3. The Dynamic Relation between Good and Evil and Civilizational Evolution

Good is the optimal strategy for reducing the "metabolic tax." A civilization founded upon Goodness possesses exceedingly low internal transaction costs—suspicion, fraud, internal attrition, and the apparatus of enforcement are reduced to a minimum. Trust and consensus supplant suspicion and antagonism as the lubricant of social operation, thereby drastically reducing the "coordination tax" and the "stability-maintenance tax," and liberating far greater energies for creative endeavor.

Good is the ultimate wellspring of "paradigmatic magnetism." A good civilization maximizes the liberation and aggregation of individual mental capital. When a society's institutions—for instance, a Contribution Value System—ensure that each individual's contribution is justly measured and rewarded, the creative potential of every person is kindled to its fullest. This internal vitality and cohesion manifests outwardly as an irresistible attraction of the paradigm.

The judgment of history: good civilizations are more resilient. History demonstrates that any civilization which indulges the aggravation of internal exploitation in the Specific Sense will see its social capital dissipated, and will collapse under the weight

of internal contradictions or the shock of external challenges. Equally, a civilization that commits the exploitation of its ecosystems in the General Sense must perish through the depletion of natural capital. Only by walking the path of Goodness can a civilization acquire the resilience to navigate historical cycles.

4. The Redefinition of "Rationality": The Old Paradigm

Miscalculated the Reckoning

Yet before we can enter upon a discussion of rationality, we must first answer a more fundamental question: whence does Goodness arise? For the old paradigm's misconception of rationality issues precisely from its oblivion to this origin.

Human beings do not first choose Goodness because they have reckoned the account. They first choose Goodness because they have themselves suffered injustice and pain. "I do not wish this to happen again"—this thought is not morality; it is the most primitive self-interest. But in that most primitive self-interest lies the entire seed of all morality.

Then one perceives that others suffer the same pain. He recognizes that pain because he has felt it in his own flesh. This is empathy. Empathy is not the product of moral instruction; it is relational perception—the tendril that extends naturally outward once one has sensed one's own suffering. When one says, "I do not wish him to suffer as I have," that "not wishing" has already overflowed the pure boundary of the self; yet it remains rooted in self-experience.

Moral systems codify this empathy into precepts, and thus Goodness appears to be something external and demanded. But its root has never left the soil of self-interest. Self-interest → empathy → moral good: this is an unbroken line.

And rationality is the moment when, having walked this line to its farthest end, one finally turns back and contemplates the entire path. It does not return to the origin; it perceives that the origin was already the first step upon the road to the destination.

The old paradigm has always proclaimed itself rational. It measures all things by cost-benefit analysis, by efficiency maximization, by return on capital. By its own standard, exploitation is indeed rational—for in the short term it increases capital.

But this calculation is incomplete. It overlooks a singular truth: the long-term survival of any individual capital depends upon the health of the entire capital network—natural, social, and fiduciary—in which it is embedded. When the old paradigm encourages every individual to maximize his own returns within a local coordinate system, it systematically undermines the health of the network as a whole. And when that network collapses, every individual—including the "winners"—loses everything.

The rationality of the old paradigm is, therefore, a false rationality. It resembles a man aboard a leaking vessel who frantically bails water into his own pockets, believing himself to be prevailing while the ship is sinking beneath him.

True rationality must extend its time horizon to the long term, and must extend the frontier of self-interest to the whole. When one calculates that "my long-term interest depends upon the health of the system," then the choice of contribution, the choice of non-exploitation, ceases to be a moral decision and becomes the most thoroughgoing, most consummate self-interest.

Good is not the triumph of morality. It is the reckoning finally settled.

And one who has settled the reckoning discovers that he has received far more than "more"—he has, for the first time, earned the right to live authentically.

Nor is evil "irrational." On the contrary, evil is also a choice of rational self-interest—but it does not extend far enough, does not reckon completely. It finds an optimal solution within a short-range coordinate system, yet fails to behold the long-term ledger.

Thus, beginning from evil, provided it is sufficiently honest and resolute in its rationality, it will ultimately discover itself moving toward Goodness. For the essence

of exploitative interaction is entropic; the metabolic tax does not vanish, it only accumulates. The further evil proceeds, the greater the collapse; and after collapse, the only path that remains viable is Goodness. Beginning from good, one likewise discovers that one has finally departed from "sacrifice" and "moral superiority." For the true good is not self-abnegation; it is the choice, once the books are settled, of that option which allows both self and system to endure the longest.

Good and evil, viewed from the far end of "rational self-interest," are but two stretches of the same road. Their starting points differ, but the destination is one: thoroughgoing rationality is the authentic good. The old paradigm set out from evil and is driven by collapse toward Goodness; the new paradigm sets out from good and stands at the destination from the outset. What we call "true rational self-interest" is simply the place where every being naturally arrives once it has reckoned the account: my survival is contingent upon the survival of the whole.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Under the vision of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, therefore, to do good is to construct, to augment, to flourish; to do evil is to dissipate, to destroy, to collapse. The choice of good is no longer a feeble moral injunction; it is the bravest and most lucid rational decision that a civilization, having penetrated the laws of the cosmos and of its own being, can make in pursuit of an infinite future. Good and evil here complete their restoration from philosophical speculation to survival science.

The old paradigm was erected upon human nature in the Specific Sense and vicious competition; its periodic collapses are a dynamical certainty. The new civilization of Contributionism, by contrast, engraves "good" and "solidarity" into its axiological core and its institutional genes. This is not the victory of morality, but the highest expression of survival rationality—a great transcendence of the luminous aspect of human nature over Absolute General Senselaw, and the most ambitious future of which our species is capable.

Section Five: The Inevitable Destination of Advanced Civilization — On Goodness as the Ultimate Unifying Force

Once good and evil have been rigorously delineated as dynamical criteria for civilizational survival, a culminating corollary emerges with inexorable clarity: an "advanced civilization" capable of surviving epochal cataclysms, undertaking interstellar migration, and sustaining perpetual flourishing must, by intrinsic necessity, be good. This is no fantasy of moral utopianism; it is the cold logic of civilizational competition and natural selection. For human civilization to transcend the national cycle, the racial cycle, and even the natural cycle, there exists but one path: the achievement of genuine and absolute unity. And goodness is the most profound, most rational mode in which that unity is practiced.

1. A Penetrating Analysis of Unity: The Ultimate Dimension of Civilization — Collective Capacity for Action

The escalation of challenges. The ultimate challenges confronting civilization—interstellar survival, energy acquisition, cosmic-scale cataclysms—are of a magnitude and complexity that no individual or small group could possibly address. These challenges test not the valor of individuals, but rather the collective-action capacity of civilization as a whole.

Unity begins with awe and empathy for the capital of all things. All the world knows that unity is strength, yet few discern its genesis in the smallest of things. True unity is not a provisional cooperation summoned by grand narratives; it is a deep condition rooted in the very grain of civilization. It demands that the members of a civilization hold a fundamental awe and empathy for the capital of all things that constitute the world—from every blade of grass to every fellow human being. An inconsiderate word, a transgressive act—what such acts damage is not merely interpersonal harmony, but the most fundamental fibers of social trust that constitute civilizational

unity. When exploitation-oppression is normalized, when malice in its subtlest forms is indulged, the interior of civilization becomes riddled with fissures of suspicion and antagonism. Such a structure cannot withstand the immense pressures of any cycle.

The core of collective-action capacity is the quality of unity. The level of this capacity is directly determined by the degree of internal unity within a civilization. And unity is not a simple summation of quantities, but a function of quality—the heart of which is the depth of internal trust capital and the efficiency of cooperative mechanisms.

Unity is forged through institutions that temper every individual into a "heavy element." In the old paradigm, the accumulation of capital was generally achieved by sacrificing the many for the benefit of the few—a false and brittle form of "unity." It resembles a pile of cotton: vast in volume, yet weightless in substance. True unity has as its aim the forging of every wisp of "cotton" into "iron," and their subsequent fusion into an invincible "high-density alloy." This means that civilization must construct institutions that have eliminated exploitation-oppression between human beings, so that every member, delivered from fear and want, may invest his mental capital without reservation in the act of creation. A civilization that renders all its individuals strong will possess a collective force whose "mass" lies wholly beyond the reach of the old paradigm.

2. "Goodness" as the Most Efficient Operating System for Social Unity

Goodness is the ultimate algorithm for reducing internal friction and aggregating strength. A civilization constituted upon goodness designs its institutions upon the default assumption that human beings are trustworthy and capable of cooperation. This eliminates the overwhelming majority of internal attrition born of suspicion, defensiveness, and betrayal. Law and contract retreat from their role as primary social constraints to that of a secondary safety net. The coefficient of social friction is reduced to its minimum, and the vast energies formerly devoted to "internal struggle"

and "maintenance of order"—the "coordination tax" and "stability-maintenance tax"—are wholly converted into propellant for civilizational ascent.

Goodness is the sole key to the liberation of the core productive force: mental capital. In the old paradigm, the mental capital of the vast majority is shackled and squandered by existential anxiety, alienated labor, and futile competition. A civilization that practices goodness, by establishing an equitable Contribution Value System and social security, confers upon every member freedom from fear and a stage upon which to realize his worth. This is tantamount to the complete liberation of civilization's core productive force from its confinement; the explosive potential of creative energy thus released is the fundamental engine by which civilization breaks free from its cycles and achieves technological singularity.

Goodness is the necessary path to civilization's "qualitative unity." "To save others, one must first save oneself"—only by achieving a high degree of internal goodness and unity can a civilization earn the qualification to meet external challenges. A civilization that is internally harmonious, vibrant, and in which every member feels dignity and hope will naturally radiate a powerful "paradigmatic attractiveness." This attractiveness achieves integration not through martial conquest, but through the inherent superiority of the civilization itself—a higher form of unity, "the supremely soft riding roughshod over the supremely hard."

3. The Cold Filter of the Cosmos: Why Only Goodness Achieve Immortality

Civilizations founded upon "evil" cannot pass through the "Great Filter" of cycles. A civilization rife with internal fraud, oppression, and systemic injustice will find its exorbitant "social metabolic tax" exhausting the very energy required to meet any external crisis. It will disintegrate at an early or middle stage of its development—before any external threat arrives—by virtue of its own internal centrifugal forces and resource attrition. The Great Filter of the cosmos filters out,

first and foremost, those civilizational forms that cannot achieve a high degree of internal unity. Before the galactic cycle and the cosmic cycle, such civilizations are feeble; their extinction is a dynamical certainty.

Unity is the "fusion reaction" of civilizational energy. Unity is not the simple addition of quantities ($1+1=2$), but an exponential leap in civilizational mass ($1+1>2$). A genuinely united and good civilization is able to redirect its energy and attention entirely from the endless zero-sum game of internal competition to the boundless positive-sum exploration of the external universe. This fundamental reorientation unleashes energy of nuclear-fusion-like magnitude, conferring upon civilization an overwhelming survival advantage over all challenges.

The ethical precondition for energy management is unity itself. A civilization capable of harnessing planetary or even stellar-scale energy, if its interior still operates upon the "evil" logic of the strong devouring the weak and pervasive betrayal, would with great likelihood destroy itself before that colossal energy could be directed toward outward expansion. Therefore, the achievement of a high degree of internal goodness and unity is the technical and ethical precondition for civilization to safely venture into the stars and to manage god-like energies.

4. The Root and the End of Struggle: The Day When Relationships Become Indissoluble

All the struggles of the old world, traced to their source, issue from a single structure:

- Struggle is for interest. But struggle persists not because of interest itself, but because of the fear of loss.
- The fear of loss arises from distrust.
- Distrust arises because relationships are unreliable.
- Relationships are unreliable because the relations of the old world are essentially exploitative—your gain is my loss, your strength is my weakness.

This is a zero-sum structure, every fiber of which is shot through with instability. Today you hold the upper hand; tomorrow I may overturn the board. The "victor" of today lives in perpetual terror of being toppled; the "vanquished" of today waits forever for the moment of counterstrike.

Such relations are like concrete mixed with substandard materials. The surface appears uniform, but within is adulterated with rubble and earth. In calm weather it may stand; but when true catastrophe arrives, it will crumble before anything else. It does not even require catastrophe—time itself will cause its natural disintegration.

What the old paradigm calls "class struggle" is nothing but the concentrated eruption of this relational instability at the level of human society. It is not the cause; it is the symptom. It is the inevitable tremor released when an exploitative relationship can no longer sustain its own stability.

Therefore, to eliminate exploitation is not "to eliminate enemies." To eliminate exploitation is to eliminate the very concept of "enemy" itself.

The relations of the new world are symbiotic—your strength is my strength, your weakness is my weakness. In this structure, one party's gain is not the other's loss; one party's survival is contingent upon the other's survival. Such relations are indissoluble, for the collapse of any one party would inflict damage upon the whole. In such relations, struggle loses its very reason for being.

The entire effort of this book—the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, the Contribution Value System, resonance physics—comes down in the final analysis to a single undertaking: to abolish unstable relations, to construct indissoluble relations, to construct symbiotic relations.

When relations are indissoluble, enmity loses the soil in which it is born.

When the enemy has vanished, what remains?

Power remains.

But this power is no longer the power of the old world.

The power of the old world exists to dominate. It exists because relations are unreliable—without power, interests cannot be protected, order cannot be maintained. But it is a self-destructive form of power: every exercise of it corrodes the relational structure that sustains it. For power never arises from the void; it is upheld by all those beneath it. When you employ power to oppress, to control, to despoil, you sever the very thread that supports you. You kill yourself.

The power of the old world is, in the final analysis, a narcotic. It intoxicates, but every dose consumes the lifespan of the one who takes it.

The power of the new world is not thus.

If one exercises power merely to be the boss, to control the world, to decide the life and death of others, then it remains a narcotic. But if one exercises power to ensure the survival and flourishing of the entire network of relations that upholds him, then power is transformed from taking into guarding, from destruction into responsibility.

What is power? Power is the final answer one gives to the question: "Who am I?"

If your "self" is only your solitary individual, then power is a weapon, to despoil others.

But if your "self" is the totality of your relations—your body a symbiosis of forty trillion cells, your existence an emergence of a billionfold web of living relationships—then power is the means by which you love yourself. You use power to guard your cells, to guard your relations, to guard the entire network that makes your existence possible.

This is the true essence of power:

The power of the old world is taking. The power of the new world is guarding. And guarding is the love of the whole self.

When one truly comprehends this, power ceases to be a narcotic and becomes the sole path by which he may achieve "eternity." For only by guarding all relations can his own self endure forever. This is not morality; this is arithmetic. Reckon it correctly,

and you live. Reckon it falsely, and you die in the narcotic of the old world.

This is why, within the old paradigm, struggle is inevitable. Resources are finite; your gain is my loss—the endemic instability of the exploitative structure denies "trust" the conditions for survival. There are no true "relations" in the old paradigm, only temporary intersections of interest. Even where cooperation and friendliness are displayed, the underlying logic remains one of interest-calculation. That is not a genuine "friend"; it is an "opponent who has not yet torn off the mask." Once the configuration of interests shifts, cooperation collapses at any moment, and the enemy reverts to being the enemy.

This is not a flaw of human nature; it is a structural flaw of the old paradigm.

Therefore, if we attempt to "turn enemies into friends" within the framework of the old paradigm—to persuade the enemy to abandon struggle and choose cooperation—we are doomed to failure. For the enemy's entire logic operates within the old framework: struggle is his sole means of acquiring interest; compromise would mean he receives less, loses out, is deceived. He has no reason to compromise, and even less reason to trust you.

To turn an enemy into a friend is not to make him calculate a different account within the old framework; it is to bring him into a new framework, in which he calculates an entirely new account.

The new framework offers what the old framework could never provide:

- Not the zero-sum game of "you take less, I take more," but the positive-sum game of "together we make the cake larger."
- Not the prisoner's dilemma of "compromise today, betrayal tomorrow," but an automatic trust-generation mechanism: "you do not betray me, and I do not betray you."
- Not "survival requires seizing," but "survival requires resonance."

When an enemy beholds this new framework, his calculations change:

"In the old framework, I obtained limited and unstable gains through struggle. In this new framework, I obtain greater gains without struggle—and they are sustainable, perpetual. My enemy is no longer an enemy, for my interests no longer require his elimination. My adversary is no longer an opponent to be struck down, but a partner with whom I can enlarge the cake."

To turn an enemy into a friend is not achieved through moral suasion, but through the reconstruction of interest-calculation after a "framework switch."

When the enemy himself reckons this account—"switching frameworks yields greater returns and more enduring survival than remaining in the old one"—he ceases to be an enemy. He does not need to be "convinced"; he needs only to be shown.

Under the old paradigm, turning enemies into friends is impossible, for there are no "friends" there—only temporary alliances of interest. Under the new paradigm, turning enemies into friends occurs automatically, for when all enter into the same vaster framework, when trust becomes the default property of the system, the concept of "enemy" itself has no further reason to exist.

This is Contributionism's final answer to "struggle": not to annihilate the enemy, but to make the enemy himself calculate that "being a friend is more advantageous." Not to persuade him, but to offer a new framework he cannot refuse. When all former antagonists enter into this equation, the concept of "enemy" in the old world dissolves of its own accord.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The filtering mechanism of the cosmos is cold and precise: only by casting "goodness" into the very core of civilization can the power of unity sufficient to transcend all cycles be consolidated. This is not a moral extravagance; it is the arithmetic of survival. When civilization converts the energy consumed in internal strife into the kinetic energy of shared exploration, when it transforms the institutions that oppress individuals into soil that emancipates the mind, it has accomplished the

ultimate leap from "gravitational trap" to "interstellar species." Goodness is the inextinguishable flame that civilization kindles for itself—the only light that can illuminate the deep void.

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

Surveying this entire chapter, we set out from the shattering of the old paradigm's prison, reconstructed the objective criteria of good and evil, and at length demonstrated that "goodness is the ultimate unity, and unity is the sole path of survival." This logical chain makes plain: unity founded upon goodness is no luxurious ornament to be enjoyed in times of abundance, but a "necessity of survival" and a "rational imperative" of life-and-death significance for civilization to break free from its cycles and ascend to a higher stage.

The old paradigm is erected upon exploitation-oppression, false unity, and systemic myopia; its periodic collapses are a dynamical certainty. The new civilization of Contributionism, by contrast, engraves "goodness" and "true unity" into its axiological core and institutional genes. This is not the victory of morality, but the highest expression of survival rationality. It does not rely upon moral suasion to turn enemies into friends, but upon the construction of a new framework in which cooperation is more advantageous than confrontation—rendering "the conversion of enemies into friends" an inevitable outcome of rational calculation. At the same time, it is a great transcendence of the luminous aspect of human nature over Absolute General Senselaw of the cosmos. This is the most ambitious, and the most solid, road that our species can choose in order to break free from its cycles and journey toward the stars.

Chapter Two: Breaking the Old, Forging the New — The Recasting of Civilization's Operating System

Chapter Introduction

The old civilizational paradigm resembles a once-mighty edifice whose foundations have rotted through. Its collapse is not wrought by external enemies, but by an internal philosophical malignancy. This chapter shall perform a thorough "decapitation operation." We begin by delivering the "final diagnosis" upon the body of the old paradigm, exposing its core components: the financial capital system has fallen into an irreversible state of "systemic failure." Having confirmed its death, we shall drive directly toward its "brain," dissecting how economics—as a systematic "science of exploitation-oppression"—has, through a fundamental philosophical inversion and meticulous metaphysical operations, distorted our worldview and suffocated the soul of civilization. Having settled accounts with its intellectual foundations, we shall sever, one by one, the institutional pillars upon which it depends for survival: the patent system that manufactures knowledge monopolies, the old mode of governance that manifests as cognitive lock-in, and the tax system that serves as the ultimate instrument of exploitation. Upon the ruins of each critique, the cornerstones of the new paradigm—the information-sharing system, unit-based governance, contribution value—shall be laid simultaneously. This is not mere destruction, but construction: the complete clearance and recasting of the ground upon which a wholly new civilizational operating system may arise.

Section One: The Final Diagnosis — The Systemic Failure of the Financial Capital Paradigm

We stand in the presence of a civilization-scale funeral. In its death throes lies the financial capital paradigm that has dominated the globe for centuries. With its unparalleled powers of abstraction and its sorcery of proliferation, it once conjured material wonders unprecedented in history, and insinuated its logic into every corner of the earth and every crevice of the human psyche. Yet today, this paradigm is no longer locally afflicted, but has fallen into a state of "systemic failure"—an irreconcilable, irreparable fundamental conflict has erupted between its core logic and the basic conditions required for the continuation of civilization. This section aims to deliver a final diagnosis upon this moribund system, revealing that its death originates not from external foes, but from an internal, self-destructive philosophical paradox.

1. The Core Paradox: The Mathematical Imperative of Infinite Accumulation versus the Physical Reality of a Finite Planet

The entire operation of the financial capital paradigm rests upon a single, austere, and merciless core imperative: $G \rightarrow G'$ (money begetting more money). This imperative demands exponential, limitless growth. It is a purely mathematical command, containing no parameters whatsoever drawn from the physical world.

Yet the environment in which this imperative operates is a planet—the Earth—of fixed mass and dimensions, with finite rates of resource regeneration and a fragile ecosystem. Its physical reality is governed by the laws of thermodynamics, the cycles of ecological regulation, and the complex dynamics of nonlinear systems.

And so emerges the most fundamental paradox in the history of civilization: a system that demands infinite expansion, encased within a finite vessel.

The death sentence pronounced upon natural capital. Financial capital regards

nature—forests, fisheries, mineral deposits, atmospheric capacity—as "resources" to be extracted without limit and "sinks" to absorb waste without limit. Yet natural capital is in its essence a finite and renewable flow, not an infinitely accumulable stock. When the rate of extraction far exceeds the rate of regeneration, natural capital—like a forest stripped bare, like fisheries on the brink of collapse—does not accrue in value, but suffers systematic depreciation. The infinite accumulation of financial capital is purchased precisely at the cost of overdrawing the principal of natural capital. This is a civilization-scale "Ponzi scheme."

The logical alienation of human capital. Financial capital likewise regards the human being as a "human resource." But what it demands is not the full development of the person and his creative potential—which would constitute true human capital—but rather his function as a standardized, substitutable factor of production and a unit of consumption. The result is pervasive professional burnout, spiritual emptiness, and a poverty of creativity. When the value of a human being is reduced to his capacity to generate cash flow, society contracts a profound "spiritual anemia." Its most precious creative capital—mental capital—is systematically suppressed and squandered.

Diagnostic conclusion one. The core operational logic of the financial capital paradigm (unlimited growth) stands in irreconcilable fundamental contradiction with the sustainable reproduction of the two foundational capitals upon which civilization depends for its very existence: natural capital and human capital. It is systematically destroying the ground beneath its own feet.

2. Systemic Deadlock: The Concurrent Eruption of Five

Interlocking Crises

This core paradox, like a cancerous gene, erupts simultaneously in all subsystems of the civilizational organism, forming a "crisis matrix" of mutual lock-in and mutual reinforcement.

The ecological deadlock: the "physical wall" of growth. Climate change, the

precipitous decline of biodiversity, ocean acidification—these are not "environmental problems," but direct evidence of the growth paradigm having struck the physical boundaries of the planet. Any "green growth" solution that attempts to resolve the crisis within the paradigm is merely an attempt to use a longer lever to move the same wall; its outcome is either deception or accelerated collapse. The disintegration of ecosystems is the ultimate proof of the head-on collision between the mathematical imperative $G-G'$ and physical reality.

The social deadlock: the "endogenous failure" of distribution mechanisms. Under the financial capital paradigm, the rate of return on capital has a long-term tendency to exceed the rate of economic growth (that is, $r > g$), causing wealth to concentrate irreversibly toward the apex of capital. Automation and artificial intelligence, under this paradigm, far from being instruments of liberation, exacerbate structural unemployment and the ossification of class hierarchies. Society ceases to be a community of shared fate, and is riven into two camps—the rentiers and the forcibly marginalized—while social capital (trust, cooperation, cohesion) is consumed without replenishment.

The economic deadlock: the "ultimate decoupling" of the virtual from the real. The scale of global financial assets already exceeds global GDP by tens of times. The financial system has become a self-referential, self-circulating mega-casino, its fluctuations increasingly divorced from the genuine creation of wealth in the real economy. The "soul" of the economy (financial symbols) has severed itself from its "body" (goods and services). Periodic financial crises have mutated from "accidental occurrences" into "endemic conditions," and systemic fragility has reached its extreme. This is the consummate expression of the "systemic risk tax" within the metabolic tax of financial capital.

The spiritual deadlock: the "total bankruptcy" of meaning systems. When the value of life is reduced to the appreciation of "human capital" and the contest of symbolic consumption, life's intrinsic meaning-making—love, curiosity, care, connection with nature—is systematically expelled. The pervasive anxiety, depression, and burnout of

our age are not individual psychological problems, but a desertification of the spirit wrought by the vacuum of the value system. Amidst material abundance, people experience a profound "existential poverty."

The governance deadlock: the "functional paralysis" of the political body. The nation-state—this "relatively narrow" political vessel—can no longer effectively address global problems that demand a perspective of "absolute breadth": financial capital, climate change, viral pandemics. Political processes are deeply infiltrated by the power of capital, degenerating into arenas for the apportionment of spoils among interest groups, and losing altogether the capacity for long-term planning and collective action. The "metabolic tax" of the governance system (coordination tax, stability-maintenance tax) has risen so high as to render it nearly paralyzed.

Diagnostic conclusion two. The five crises enumerated above are not mutually isolated; they are metastases of a single malignancy upon different organs. Any attempt to resolve any one of them within the financial capital paradigm is akin to throwing water upon a grease fire—it can only intensify the other crises. This is a systemic deadlock with no internal solution.

3. Philosophical Bankruptcy: The Metamorphosis from "Servant" to "Devourer"

In a healthy civilizational paradigm, the economic system should serve as a servant, providing the material and institutional guarantees for the full development of the human being and the sustainable flourishing of civilization. Yet the financial capital paradigm has accomplished a perilous metamorphosis: it has alienated itself from its role as servant, and become the ultimate end in itself.

Human beings, society, nature—all these living, breathing realities of flesh and blood—are forcibly reduced to instruments and fuel for the service of the abstract imperative $G \rightarrow G'$. When a civilization's operating system regards that which it ought to serve as expendable resources, its philosophy is utterly bankrupt. It retains no

vestige of legitimacy.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The financial capital paradigm has ceased to be viable. Its "metabolic tax" already far exceeds its "capacity for capital reproduction," and its internal logic stands in fundamental opposition to the conditions of civilizational survival. What it bequeaths to us is not a system requiring repair, but a ruin that must be transcended in its entirety. Its death is not a tragedy, but the philosophical purification through which civilization must pass in order to secure its next chance at life.

In the following section, we shall take up the scalpel and dissect the "brain" of this moribund paradigm—that body of doctrine which furnishes its rationalization and systematically inverts the world's understanding: the discipline of economics.

Section Two: The Decapitation Operation — The Inversion of Economic Ontology and the Suffocation of Civilization's Soul

In the preceding section, we delivered the final diagnosis of systemic failure upon the body of the financial capital paradigm. Now we must execute the decapitation operation—to destroy its brain and nervous system: that body of doctrine which furnishes its cognitive foundation and legitimating defense, the discipline of economics. It is not an innocent social science, but the most central cognitive component of the old paradigm—a "science of exploitation-oppression" that has accomplished its own philosophical suicide. Through a series of meticulous metaphysical operations, it has systematically whitewashed the stark law of "exploitation-oppression in the General Sense" revealed by the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, dressing it in the guise of a natural, inevitable, and self-evident law of nature. The task of this section is to dissect the pathological mechanisms of this brain, revealing how, through a fundamental philosophical inversion, it has ultimately brought about the suffocation of the creative spirit of all civilization.

1. Philosophical Deicide — The Fundamental Inversion of Creativity and Productive Force

All profound critique must begin with the clearing of philosophical foundations. The wellspring of all evil in economics lies in its commission of a foundational, suicidal category error: it has systematically inverted the true relationship between "creativity" and "productive force" within the ontology of civilization.

Creativity: the "source" of civilization, the world-creating wind from 0 to 1.

Ontological definition: Creativity is the meta-capacity of the human being to pose new questions, to conceive new possibilities, and to bring them into actuality. It is a vital impulse oriented toward the future, saturated with uncertainty, aimed at opening

new frontiers of cognition, value, and practice. It is the transcendental condition that renders civilization possible at all, and by which civilization perpetually transcends itself.

The criterion of civilizational divergence: the creative fabrication of tools. Animals too "labor" (the bee builds its hive), but that is an instinctive performance of genetic coding. The true dawn of civilization appears at the instant when the first primitive human conceived in his mind a stone axe—systematically designed, possessed of a specific form and function—and then translated that conception into practice. This act is no longer mere "use" of what lies ready at hand; it is the projection of human intentionality upon natural material, the creation of a new form that did not originally exist in nature. The birth of this "formal cause," anterior to its material realization, is the true moment of creation. It contains within it the seed of all subsequent science, art, and institutional civilization. It is the creative fabrication of tools—not labor in general—that makes the human being human.

The triple absolute priority:

Priority in time: Before any particular productive system (agriculture, industry) can take form, there must first be the epoch-making creative breakthrough (cultivation techniques, the wheel, the steam engine). Creativity is the leap from 0 to 1; productive force is merely the replication and scaling from 1 to N that follows.

Priority in logic: Productive force answers "how to do more, faster, better"—an optimization problem within a given paradigm. Creativity answers "what to do" and "why to do it"—it concerns the opening and the setting of the goals and the paradigm themselves. The former solves problems; the latter chooses, or redefines, the game.

Priority in value: Productive force brings quantitative accumulation (efficiency, output, wealth), and its value is substitutable and comparable. Creativity brings qualitative leaps (new knowledge, new art, new ethics, new modes of living); it opens entirely new spaces of meaning for humankind, and its value is infinite, incommensurable.

Productive force: the "flow" of civilization, the vessel of carriage from 1 to N.

Instrumental definition: Productive force is the capacity, within established goals and methods (a paradigm), to convert inputs into predetermined outputs with greater efficiency. It is repetitive, calculable, and aimed at optimizing the pre-existing track—in a word, instrumental rationality.

Essence: Productive force is the means by which ends are realized; it is the "vessel" propelled by the creative "wind," determining the speed and scale at which civilization advances along an established road.

The philosophical deicide accomplished by economics.

Economics, at its ontological level, has executed a fatal substitution:

It mistakes the "vessel" for a self-driving engine. In economic discourse, "developing the productive forces" is elevated to a supreme, self-evident end, as though productive force could drive and evolve itself in detachment from its creative source. It studies with feverish intensity the allocative efficiency of "factors of production"—capital, labor, technology—yet studiously evades the antecedent question: whence do these factors themselves, above all the technological concepts and institutional conceptions that trigger paradigm revolutions, arise?

It absurdly demotes the "wind" to a by-product of the "vessel." The surging, tumultuous power of creativity is, in mainstream economic models, dwarfed into "technological progress" or "human capital," treated as a dependent variable that can be purchased and induced by R&D investment—as a "result" of productive force's development. Thus the creative act, shot through with inspiration, contingency, and vital intuition, is twisted into a predictable, manageable, calculable "innovation assembly line."

This inversion is an act of philosophical "deicide." It has murdered the soul of civilization (creativity), and enshrined upon the altar a hollow, efficiently grinding zombie (productive force). From that moment onward, the ends of civilization—the full development and creative realization of the human being—are degraded into mere means for the service of capital accumulation (the enhancement of productive force).

2. Metaphysical Operations — The Fourfold Guilt of Economics

In order to render its inverted worldview the sole "reality," economics has erected, through four mutually reinforcing metaphysical operations, a closed ideological system that argues for itself and defends itself.

The first guilt: conceptual kidnapping — the wholesale colonization of the authentic domain of life.

By creating a series of derivative "cage-concepts," economics systematically colonizes and conscripts every vibrant creative activity that cannot be directly accommodated within its paradigm.

The commodification of knowledge: intellectual inquiry born of wonder and pure curiosity is alienated into "R&D input" or "intellectual-property production." Its value is measured no longer by its intrinsic truth, logical coherence, or power to inspire thought, but by its convertibility into marketable "products" or tradable "patents."

The capitalization of art: aesthetic creation that gives voice to feeling, explores existence, and aspires to the sublime is quantified into "cultural output value" or the "creative industries." The value of a painting is defined primarily by its auction price; the success of music is determined by its streaming figures and commercial returns.

The instrumentalization of education: the shaping of character, critical thought, and the awakening of the soul—that which makes a person a person—is alienated into "human capital investment." The purpose of study is narrowed to the acquisition of "skill packages" with which to raise one's price (wage) upon the labor market.

Essence: this accomplishes a "symbolic violence" upon the authentic domain of life, forcibly converting all "self-purposive activities" (thinking for understanding, aesthetic experience for its own sake, education for growth) into "instrumental activities" (activities mediated and ultimately governed by market value and efficiency).

The second guilt: the inversion of relations — fabricating the ideological myth that "productive forces determine creativity."

To render its conceptual kidnapping plausible, economics must construct a central ideological myth: that the level of development of the productive forces determines the space of possibility within which creativity may flourish. This thesis collapses under empirical, historical, and logical scrutiny, yet it has enjoyed extraordinary success as a discourse of power.

Historical refutation: the creative peaks of ancient Greek philosophy, mathematics, drama, and democratic institutions were not achieved under the highest material productivity; the creative eruption of the Renaissance was born of an awakening in thought and art, which only subsequently drove technological and productive innovation.

Empirical counter-evidence: in an age of unprecedented R&D expenditure, truly subversive scientific discoveries are relatively scarce; contemporary society abounds in "optimization-style innovation," yet is desperately impoverished in "inaugural creation." This indicates that the system rewards only the infinite refinement of established paradigm tracks.

Logical paradox: if productive forces determined creativity, then today, with productive forces unprecedented in history, we should be living in an explosive golden age of thought, art, and science. Yet Absolute General Senseperception is one of spiritual barrenness, the homogenization of thought, and the exhaustion of creativity.

Essence: this guilt provides legitimacy for the stagnant order of the existing power structure. It deftly attributes the poverty of creativity to "insufficiently developed productive forces," thereby deferring the hope of liberation to an ever-unreachable future.

The third guilt: value nihilism — the murder of meaning by the yardstick of "efficiency."

The most deeply concealed violence of economics lies in its establishment of a single, exclusive yardstick of evaluation, by which it expels from the realm of consideration every value of life that cannot be quantified. This sovereign yardstick is "efficiency."

The expulsion of the unquantifiable: true friendship, moments of spiritual insight, the stillness of primeval forests, the warmth of community—these experiences and relations that constitute the very core of life's meaning, because they cannot be reduced to monetary units or efficiency indicators, are dismissed as "externalities" or rather as if they did not exist.

The reduction of the world to a warehouse of resources: under the gaze of efficiency-first, the meandering river is no longer the source of life, an object of aesthetic contemplation, and a carrier of culture, but a "hydropower resource"; the teeming rainforest is no longer a complex, sacred ecosystem and cultural home, but "timber reserves."

The manufacture of a universal crisis of meaning: when the value of a person's life is chiefly defined as "improving the efficiency of human capital" or "realizing the efficiency of capital accumulation," he is in substance stripped of the right to seek out and create a unique meaning for his own existence.

Essence: through its value judgments, this guilt perpetrates a silent "symbolic extinction." It guides people to bind themselves willingly in chains of efficiency, and amidst the desert of meaning, to seek to slake their thirst with ever more production and consumption.

The fourth guilt: systemic exploitation — capital as the metaphysics of default violence.

Economics is not the "neutral" analytical instrument it declares itself to be. In its deep grammar, it is a metaphysics of exploitation, systematically furnishing justification and operationalization for the logic of capital's self-accumulation. Its exploitativeness lies not in the fact that it analyzes exploitation, but in the circumstance that its theoretical presuppositions and discursive structures are themselves the rationalizing

garment and conspiratorial framework of the exploitative relation.

Default violence: by positing historically specific capitalist relations of production (such as "resource scarcity," "utility maximization," "market competition," "the sanctity of private property") as self-evident, eternal laws of nature and of human nature, economics has successfully executed a grand ideological conjuring trick. When we accept and skillfully wield the "rationality" of this language, we have unconsciously accepted an entire implicit power structure: the capitalist's appropriation of surplus value becomes "return on investment"; the worker's alienation becomes "human capital optimization"; the destruction of the environment becomes "the necessary cost of growth."

Global default complicity: this default has become the "operating system" of global civilization. From international organizations to individual anxiety, we measure the world in the language of economics. This discursive hegemony manufactures a thought-prison of "there is no alternative," rendering exploitation a game in which we participate voluntarily.

Essence: to acknowledge the "rationality" of economics is, at the philosophical level, to grant default legitimacy to this exploitative order; it is to admit that we deserve to be reified, measured, alienated. It is a symbolic violence so deeply rooted that it has been consented to by the entirety of modern civilization by default.

3. The Suffocation of the Creative Spirit — The Systemic Exhaustion of Civilizational Vitality

When creativity is enslaved by productive force, when the value of life is colonized by economic indicators, when exploitation-oppression is legitimized by academic language, the final outcome is the suffocation of the "creative spirit" at the civilizational level. The economic paradigm, like an immense sheet of saline-alkaline wasteland, systematically strangles the vibrant, teeming creative potential of the rainforest of thought.

The poverty of cognitive concepts and the systematic atrophy of creativity.

The academic world—the "brain" of civilization—has, through its mainstream high-impact-factor journal system, accomplished a total metaphysical surrender under the dominance of the economic paradigm. It systematically excludes and expels the philosophical thought that represents deepening and consummation.

The tyranny of efficiency and measurability: quantitative indicators such as journal impact factors, citation counts, and the H-index are the precise replication of the economic principles of "efficiency" and "performance" within academia. Philosophical work, by virtue of its forward-looking, paradigm-subverting, non-consensus, and long-cyclical character, is structurally disadvantaged within a system that worships "immediate impact," and is dismissed as "inefficient" research.

Methodological conservatism: mainstream journals exalt positivism and methodological individualism, demanding "verifiable data" and "reproducible experimental designs." This establishes an exclusionary mechanism against philosophical-driven research that challenges the paradigm.

Consequence: deprived of the stimulus of new philosophical paradigms, the vast majority of research degenerates into fine-grained polishing within existing conceptual frameworks. The academic world, in its carnival of "pseudo-problems," exhibits aphasia before the "true problems" upon which the fate of humanity turns (such as the ultimate ethical boundaries of technology, the ultimate end of growth). Creativity is trapped in a vortex of profound homogenization.

From critic to legislator of the new world — the mission of the creative philosopher.

Within this alienated academia, we must redefine the role of the philosopher. They should not be "restorers of antiquities" of the old system, nor impotent "idle talkers." What we summon is the "creative philosopher," or the "legislator of the new world."

Core capacity: "conceptual engineering." Their vocation is not the hermetic speculation of the study, but "conceptual engineering." Like engineers who design

bridges, they design the new foundational concepts of society.

Goal: "paradigm actualization." The terminus of their work is not a treatise reposing upon a shelf, but a real social movement, a new constitution, a new economic system. They are the practical force that pushes philosophy from epistemology into ontology.

The practice of this text: this text itself is an attempt to embody the "creative philosopher." We have not merely diagnosed the pathology of the old paradigm of "productive-force priority," but have devoted ourselves to the construction of a new paradigm centered upon the "ontology of creativity," and have provisionally designed the blueprint of a new institution—the "theory of contribution value." We are not explaining why the world is wretched; we are attempting to write the source code of a new world.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Economics, through its fundamental philosophical inversion and fourfold metaphysical operations, has accomplished the systematic kidnapping and suffocation of the soul of civilization. It is no longer a doctrine requiring internal correction, but a philosophical ruin that must be transcended in its entirety. Unless we destroy the ontological inversion at the root of economics, we cannot break free from the conceptual cage it has woven, nor win the right to breathe for the creative spirit of humanity.

The liberation of thought is the birth chamber of a new civilization. This decapitation operation is undertaken not for the sake of academic debate, but as a thorough philosophical purification that must be accomplished for the survival and ascent of civilization itself.

Section Three: The Information-Sharing System — The End of Patent Rights and the Liberation of Knowledge

Having settled the intellectual accounts of economics, we must now sever the old paradigm's core institutional pillar in the domain of knowledge: the patent system. The old paradigm treats knowledge as privatizable capital, manufacturing artificial scarcity and monopoly through the institution of patent rights. This is, in essence, the ultimate extension of capital logic into the cognitive realm — a systematic fettering of civilization's vital force.

1. The Nature of Patent Rights: The Capitalist Yoke of Knowledge Monopoly

Patent rights are not, as they proclaim themselves to be, the "custodian of innovation." On the contrary, they are an institutionalized rampart that imprisons the very spark of creation.

The engineering of artificial scarcity. Knowledge is inherently non-rivalrous: one person's utilization does not diminish another's. Yet the patent system, through juridical fiat, forcibly converts ideas and solutions that could be infinitely reused into exclusive "private property," erecting artificial barriers to the diffusion of knowledge.

The obstruction of the innovation spiral. Every major innovation stands upon the shoulders of giants. The patent regime compels subsequent researchers to confront the alternatives of paying exorbitant licensing fees, circumventing existing patents, or being paralyzed by the "patent thicket." This vastly retards the velocity of knowledge iteration and technological diffusion, severing the "innovation spiral" that civilization ought to sustain unbroken.

The distortion of research trajectories. R&D resources flow not toward the most groundbreaking fields, nor toward those best serving civilization's long-term needs,

but toward those domains most capable of generating patents, erecting barriers, and delivering the swiftest returns on capital. The result is a froth of "pseudo-innovation," while foundational and subversive inquiries languish in neglect for want of profitability.

2. The Information-Sharing System: The Knowledge Ethic and Accelerator of the New Paradigm

The new paradigm supplants patent rights entirely with the "information-sharing system." Its core principle: any creative achievement, once it has received social recognition (that is, having been awarded contribution value), must have its complete information — including raw data, design blueprints, source code, process flows, and the like — disclosed immediately and unconditionally to the whole of society, flowing into the global public knowledge commons.

Immediate disclosure, without any period of secrecy. This shatters the old paradigm's model of innovation predicated upon secrecy and monopoly. The moment knowledge is created and confirmed, it becomes the common patrimony of all humanity, accelerating civilization's collective learning and iterative advancement.

The mechanism of provenance-based recompense. This does not negate the creator's contribution. On the contrary, through a "contribution provenance mechanism" built upon technologies such as blockchain, the originator receives continuous, retroactive contribution-value rewards in proportion to the immense social value generated by the application, improvement, and derivation of the achievement across the whole of civilization. One's recompense no longer depends upon the capacity to "hoard knowledge," but upon the breadth and depth with which one's knowledge "propels the entire civilization forward."

The construction of a global knowledge commons. This gives rise to a global cerebral cortex, ever-expanding and never dormant. Any individual, in any corner of the earth, may stand atop the pinnacle of civilization's collective knowledge to undertake new

creation, wholly eliminating duplicative research and the squandering of resources.

3. Dynamical Advantage: From "Innovation Tax" to "Innovation Flywheel"

The information-sharing system will effect a qualitative leap in the velocity of civilizational evolution.

The abolition of the "innovation tax." The old patent regime levies an "innovation tax" upon every act of knowledge utilization, retarding the pace of the entire civilization. The information-sharing system achieves the zero-friction, zero-cost flow of knowledge.

The activation of network effects. The network value of knowledge is proportional to the square of its nodes. When all knowledge connects and collides freely, it ignites exponential innovation far surpassing linear growth, forging a formidable "innovation flywheel."

The orientation toward the true "optimal solution." Under the old paradigm, technological trajectories are often locked in by the patents of first movers; even where superior alternatives exist, they cannot escape the walls of monopoly. The new paradigm permits all proposals to compete fairly and iterate swiftly within an open environment, guiding civilization's technological tree ever toward the most vital, most sustainable direction of development.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

To supplant patent rights with the information-sharing system is a revolution in knowledge ethics. It restores knowledge, held hostage by capital, to its rightful place as the living waters that nourish civilizational progress. This is not merely an enhancement of efficiency; it is a restitution of justice. It ensures that the fruits of civilization's wisdom are shared by all humanity and placed in the service of all

humanity's flourishing.

Section Four: The Governance Manifestation of Cognitive Lock-In — From "National Seclusion" to "Paradigm Openness"

Having dissected the inherent fragility of the globalized economy, we must now confront an even more fundamental question: why does civilization, whenever crisis looms, instinctively gravitate toward the binary trap of "openness versus closure"? Whether in the historical phenomenon of "national seclusion" or the agonizing choice between "lockdown" and "capitulation" during a pandemic, the root cause lies not in the personal acumen of individual decision-makers, but in the inexorable "cognitive lock-in" embedded within the operating system of the old paradigm. This section shall demonstrate that "national seclusion" represents the ultimate suboptimal solution—a reflexive response to crisis born of the old paradigm's cognitive limitations—whereas the new contributionist paradigm, through "absolute openness at the level of paradigm" and "resilient autonomy at the level of the cell," transcends this perennial dilemma.

1. The Essence of "National Seclusion": The Consummate Manifestation of Cognitive Lock-In in the Old Paradigm

To attribute "national seclusion" simply to the conservatism or arrogance of rulers is to embrace a superficial historiography. Viewed from the perspective of cognitive dynamics, it is a hallmark act of "cognitive dimensional reduction" performed by an aging civilizational paradigm when systemic complexity exceeds its processing capacity.

What is locked is not the national border, but the interface of thought.

The Ming and Qing maritime prohibitions were ostensibly bans on trade; in substance, they were acts of "severing the external input interfaces of the cognitive system." When the influx of exogenous information—Western science, technology, thought,

institutions—engendered a condition of "cognitive overload" and "paradigm shock" within an internal power-ideological structure grown rigid, the old system's first response was not learning and upgrading, but "forced quarantine." Physical isolation was employed to eliminate the "threat" of heterodox ideas, thereby maintaining a low-level homeostasis. This is, in essence, the self-enclosure undertaken by a system seeking to preserve its own antiquated "cognitive immune system."

Thought is the primary creative force and the paramount productive force. When a civilization, whether actively or passively, locks down its own thought and constructs a cognitive prison, the wellspring of its creativity runs dry. This is the true origin of the divergence of nations that once shared identical starting points—it is not the volume of trade, but the openness and vitality of the marketplace of ideas, that determines the tempo of civilizational evolution.

The "interrogation of the soul" and the impotence of the old paradigm.

This "interrogation of the soul" exposes precisely the fatal vulnerability of the old paradigm. Confronted with "sustained shocks" such as pandemics and climate crises, the old paradigm's toolbox contains pathetically few instruments:

Total openness? The system would accelerate its collapse under the twin assault of viral contagion and capital logic.

Total closure? The circulation of the economy would be severed, society would consume itself in suffocation, and the result would be little short of civilizational suicide.

If a catastrophe such as COVID-19 were to descend upon us once more, what then? Are we to relapse into global paralysis, fractured supply chains, and the grim calculus of trade-offs between "economic security and the sanctity of life"?

And if the next pandemic is no fleeting visitor, but endures for a decade or longer, what then? Can our present exquisitely calibrated system, dependent as it is upon the instantaneous global circulation of goods and people, withstand such unrelenting,

sustained shocks? And if it cannot, must we not, driven by stark necessity, shred the existing globalized network and retreat, each into our sequestered citadels?

And if still greater calamities arrive—what then? When irreversible climatic change unleashes global famine and water wars; when an asteroid of extinction-scale magnitude rends the heavens... Faced with these ultimate tests of survival, can our present society—inwardly contorted, producing for profit, lost amidst its own "folding"—rally the collective strength of all humanity to achieve the rapid upgrade and self-redemption of civilization?

The answer may be disquieting in the extreme: under the existing civilizational paradigm, we are almost certainly doomed to repeat our failures in the next greater crisis, or even to meet our end.

This dilemma—"openness brings death, closure brings ruin"—together with the specter of unfathomed threats, profoundly evinces that the underlying architecture of the old paradigm's "cognitive-governance" system is no longer capable of processing the complexity it has itself generated. Every solution it offers is merely an attempt to lurch left or right within the same cognitive prison, and the inevitable outcome is cyclical collapse. Yet this is not for lack of technology or intelligence; it is because the "operating system" by which we organize society has become obsolete.

2. Paradigm Openness: The Cognitive Ascension of Contributionism

The fundamental breakthrough of the new contributionist civilization lies in its achievement of cognitive ascension from "openness at the level of strategy" to "openness at the level of paradigm."

The absolute openness of the core: the free circulation of thought and information.

The new paradigm reposes upon the "information-sharing system" as its cornerstone, institutionally guaranteeing the instantaneous global sharing of core cognitive

capital—knowledge, data, technical solutions, and the like. Any creative achievement, upon confirmation of its contribution value, flows at once into the global public knowledge commons.

This razes the cognitive barriers erected by the old paradigm's "monopoly of intellectual property," enabling civilization as a whole to engage in collective learning and technological iteration at a velocity heretofore inconceivable. The interface of thought is not merely opened; it is set as the default state of civilization.

The unification of value measurement: contribution value as a universal semantics.

The globalization of the old paradigm was fraught with friction and exploitation precisely because it lacked a just, cross-cultural standard of valuation. The Contribution Value System provides this "cognitive yardstick."

Whatever the cell, whatever the cultural provenance of the creator, his or her worth is determined by the objective contribution rendered to the civilizational system. This eliminates the endless strategic games and mutual misunderstandings born of the old paradigm's chaotic value criteria (GDP fetishism, profit fetishism), and lays the foundation of trust upon which genuine global collaboration may be built.

3. Resilient Autonomy: The Cell-Based Market Economy

Upon the foundation of paradigm openness, the new civilization constructs, at the level of governance, a model of "cell-based resilient autonomy," thereby resolving at the operational level the paradox of "openness and stability."

Cells as experimental fields of "cognition-action."

Each autonomous cell is an open, vibrant "social innovation laboratory." Drawing upon local endowments and global objectives, it actively explores the developmental path best suited to its own circumstances.

Successful experiments are swiftly identified and amplified through the contribution-value network; failures, being localized in scope, pose no threat to the

whole. This constitutes a "distributed cognitive system" whose innovative efficiency and adaptive capacity far outstrip any model of centralized planning.

The upgrading of "firewalls" and "immune systems."

The "resilient" design of the cell endows it with pronounced self-sufficiency in critical domains—energy, food, primary healthcare, and the like. This is tantamount to installing "structural firewalls" within the global civilizational system.

When a local crisis (such as a pandemic) erupts, the affected cell may activate its autonomous contingency protocols without compelling a global shutdown. Simultaneously, the latest solutions within the global knowledge commons—vaccine research data, containment strategies—can be injected into the cell without friction, endowing it with the most formidable "cognitive immunity." What is isolated is no longer thought or information, but physical risk. The ultimate result is governance by the cell, the articulation of the whole into resilient parts, each flourishing in its distinctive way.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The "national seclusion" of history was, therefore, the foredoomed defensive stance adopted by the old paradigm in its state of cognitive lock-in, seeking to preserve low-level systemic stability. It attempted to solve problems by occluding the flow of thought, and in so doing suffocated its own creativity and marched inexorably toward decline. The new contributionist paradigm, by awakening the global cognitive engine through "absolute openness at the level of paradigm," and by dissolving systemic risk through "resilient autonomy at the level of the cell," synthesizes "openness" and "stability" on a loftier plane. It teaches us that the true bulwarks of civilization have never been tangible borders, but the invisible frontiers of mind. When we build the entirety of civilization as a sleepless, open marketplace of ideas, we acquire the ultimate confidence with which to answer every "interrogation of the soul."

Section Five: The Ultimate Critique of Economics — Taxation as the Root of Systemic Malady

In the preceding four sections, we have moved from the unveiling of the universality of "all-things-as-capital," to the philosophical liquidation of the old paradigm's "brain" (economics), to the severing, one by one, of its institutional pillars (patent rights, antiquated governance). Now we must execute the final "capture of the king": directing the spearpoint of critique at the very heart and final bastion of the old civilizational operating system — the institution of taxation as "meta-capital." This section shall demonstrate that economics, within the old paradigm, is in essence a discipline devoted to the justification and optimization of the tax-capital system; its core inquiry is resource allocation under the presupposition of sustaining this ultimate exploitative meta-rule. The ultimate critique of economics thus necessarily issues in the complete abolition of taxation; and the Contribution Value System is precisely the thoroughgoing transcendence and sublation of both at once.

1. The Original Sin of Economics: The Blindness to the "Meta-Rule"

Mainstream economics, however multifarious its schools, shares one unshakeable presupposition: the legitimacy of the taxation system and of state power. Under this presupposition, all economic discourse is imprisoned within an invisible cage:

The self-imposed limitation of research scope. Its central questions are "how to tax more efficiently," "how to redistribute more equitably," "how to stimulate growth without unsettling the foundations of taxation." This is as though one were designing more comfortable seats and a more effective whip for a carriage hurtling toward a precipice, while never questioning the direction of the carriage nor the logic of violence that drives it.

The distorted construction of core concepts. Fundamental concepts — "GDP," "efficiency," "market equilibrium" — are all defined within the tax-capital framework. GDP growth may count the "gains" of disaster reconstruction; "efficiency" points to the efficiency of capital accumulation rather than the enhancement of human flourishing; "market equilibrium" is a provisional balance, saturated with systemic exploitation, reached under rules presupposed by power.

The systematic misjudgment of the source of "value." Classical economics attributes the origin of value to land, labor, capital, or technology, yet it obscures—whether wittingly or not—a crucial fact: all these factors can only operate within a "playing field" demarcated and protected by the power of taxation. Taxation, as the first and most privileged cut upon value, becomes itself the "precondition cost" and "value black hole" for the realization of all value. Economics has averted its gaze from this black hole, and therefore all its theories of value are fundamentally incomplete.

2. The Internal Paradoxes of Taxation: The Systemic Deadlocks That Old Economics Cannot Overcome

Within the framework of taxation as meta-rule, every economic system carries embedded within it fatal paradoxes that no reform can resolve, rendering the "sustained prosperity" that old economics promises a chimerical dream forever unattainable.

The paradox of extraction and vitality. Taxation must extract social vitality (capital) to sustain the power system, yet excessive extraction stifles that vitality and exhausts the tax base. Old economics oscillates endlessly between "raise taxes to strengthen public services" and "cut taxes to stimulate private investment," forever in search of an optimal balance that cannot exist, because the question itself is a pseudo-problem posed upon a false premise.

The false opposition of equity and efficiency. Within the tax framework, "equity" is reduced to "the intensity of redistribution," while "efficiency" is defined as "the

degree of submission to the tax-capital system." The two are set at odds. The root cause is that genuine equity would preclude systemic exploitation at the moment of creation itself—a thought inconceivable within an economic framework that acknowledges the legitimacy of taxation. Such a framework can only tinker with outcomes, erecting vast bureaucracies to manage the tinkering, thereby exacerbating the very loss of "efficiency" it laments.

The ultimate paradox of growth and extinction. Old economics pursues unlimited exponential growth, yet this is unsustainable upon a planet whose ecological and ethical carrying capacity is finite. The taxation system, precisely because of its ever-expanding extractive demands, requires this unlimited growth. When physical growth reaches its limits, the system shifts toward ever more concealed, financialized virtual growth, culminating in periodic collapse amid the inflation and bursting of bubbles. Old economics is a discipline of the "dead loop," guiding civilization toward its own self-destruction.

3. The Acceleration of Exploitation: Why the Tax Logic Cannot Stop

The three paradoxes above converge upon a deeper question: why does the old system, knowing it is hurtling toward collapse, find itself unable to halt?

The answer lies not in human nature, but in institution.

To understand this mechanism of "cannot stop," we must dissect the survival logic of the three strata within the old system—the upper, the middle, and the lower—and the self-reinforcing death spiral they form among themselves.

3.1 The Upper Stratum: The Survival Instinct of the State Apparatus

Taxation is the "survival instinct" of the state. Any state apparatus, whatever its proclaimed aims, must at the most fundamental level first ensure its own continuance—paying official salaries, maintaining armies, building infrastructure,

confronting internal and external challenges. All this requires resources, and the primary source of resources is always taxation.

This means: taxation is not a tool the state may choose to employ or not; it is a command that, "so long as the state exists, must be executed."

When the economy grows, taxation may be mild. But when the economy stagnates or contracts, taxation cannot diminish; it must increase—for state expenditures do not contract proportionally with economic decline. The military must be paid, officials must receive their salaries, debts must be serviced, stability maintenance demands expenditure. These outlays are rigid.

Thus a death spiral takes shape:

Economic downturn → tax base shrinks → to maintain the state's operation, tax rates rise and tax sources expand → the vitality of the private sphere is further damaged → the economy declines further → the tax base shrinks further → tax rates rise further...

Every "solution" merely stores energy for a still greater crisis to come. This is the "acceleration" of the old paradigm's taxation: it is not running; it is falling, ever faster.

This is no conspiracy, no myopia of any particular ruler; it is the logic that any system premised upon "compulsory extraction" will automatically execute. Like a car whose brakes have failed upon a downhill road—it is not that the driver does not wish to stop; physics does not permit stopping.

3.2 The Middle Stratum: The Amplifier of Exploitation

So much for the survival instinct of the upper stratum. But the upper stratum does not confront the lower directly. Between the command of compulsory extraction issuing from the state apparatus and the laborer at the terminal end, there lies a vast and silent structure.

This structure is the "middle stratum" of the taxation system.

It includes: factory owners, enterprise managers, subcontractors, wholesalers, retailers,

street vendors, and even those individual operators who appear to be "flexibly employed." Their position within the old system is exquisitely ambiguous. They are simultaneously taxpayers (answerable upward to the tax authorities), tax transmitters (passing the burden downward to workers and consumers), and tax beneficiaries (retaining a portion of the transmitted burden as their own space of survival).

They are not the decision-makers of the state apparatus, yet they hold the last mile between the state apparatus and the bottom. It is precisely this last mile that determines whether policy becomes welfare or becomes oppression.

The double squeeze: the survival logic of the middle stratum.

The middle stratum is caught within an inescapable structure of "double squeeze":

Upward, they bear the pressure of the state apparatus. Tax targets are disaggregated layer by layer: from the central government to the provinces, from provinces to municipalities, from municipalities to counties, from counties to townships, from townships to enterprises. At every level there is an assessment of "target completion rate"; at every level, pressure is passed downward. The enterprise owner does not confront "how much tax would you like to pay," but "how much tax you must pay." The tax bureau has quotas, and to fail the quota carries grave consequences.

Downward, they transmit the pressure to the bottom. The factory must pay taxes; costs cannot be reduced, so wages are suppressed, working hours extended, benefits cut. The shop must pay taxes; profits cannot fall, so prices are raised, suppliers squeezed, shoddy goods substituted for quality. The wholesaler must pay taxes; capital cannot be interrupted, so upstream payments are delayed and downstream partners pressured. Every link performs the same act: pushing the pressure downward, until it can be pushed no further.

In the middle, they attempt to carve out a path of survival. But "carving out a path" within the old system has only one form: interception within the gap between upper and lower. The wages suppressed—intercepted. The profits from raised prices—intercepted. The interest saved from delayed payments—intercepted. These

interceptions are not "greed"; they are survival. For every stratum bears its costs; every stratum must go on living.

Thus the middle stratum occupies a peculiar "moral position" within the old system: simultaneously victim (squeezed by the upper) and victimizer (squeezing the lower). They are the most anxious class within the system, for they bear at once the weight above and the recoil below.

Why the middle stratum must necessarily operate according to the logic of exploitation.

Here a common misunderstanding must be dispelled: the exploitative behavior of the middle stratum is not because they are "evil."

Suppose there is a factory owner within the old system who does not exploit his workers, does not evade taxes, does not extend working hours, and still fulfills the tax targets imposed from above. What happens?

He goes bankrupt. Then his workers lose their jobs, his suppliers receive no payment, his customers lose their source of goods. His "goodness" has not only ruined himself; it has ruined all who depended upon him.

Within the old paradigm, "goodness" is not an available option. For goodness leads to elimination, and elimination makes those under one's protection worse off than before. This is a profound institutional trap: the system is so designed that "bad" is more rational than "good," that "exploitation" survives more easily than "non-exploitation."

Therefore, the exploitative conduct of the middle stratum is not a matter of individual character; it is the inevitable product of structural position. Whoever sits in that position, the position will "teach" him to exploit. He will either learn to exploit, or be eliminated.

Why the upper stratum "cannot govern" the middle stratum.

This is the most easily overlooked link.

The upper stratum is not unaware that the middle stratum distorts policy. Every dynasty's "anti-corruption campaigns," "rectifications," and "inspections" have targeted the middle stratum. Why have they never been cured at the root?

Because the upper and middle strata share the same presupposition of survival: taxation.

To govern the middle stratum, one must supervise the flow of every sum of money. Supervision requires personnel; personnel require salaries; salaries come from taxation. Thus the supervisory apparatus itself becomes part of the middle stratum. It too intercepts, distorts, and seeks its own livelihood.

More fundamentally: the upper stratum's policies must be executed through the middle stratum. If upper and middle are set in outright antagonism, policies cannot be transmitted downward. The system will paralyze—and paralysis is more lethal than exploitation, for the machine must at least keep turning.

Hence the relationship of the upper to the middle is one of perpetual dynamic compromise: govern too strictly, the middle stratum strikes, and the system seizes up; govern too loosely, the middle stratum devours the bottom, and the system collapses. Within the tax logic of the old paradigm, there is no "just right"—only oscillation between two ways of dying.

3.3 The Lower Stratum: Resistance at the Extreme of Squeeze

When pressure, amplified and distorted through the middle stratum, finally reaches the terminal end, it is no longer "taxation." It has become the crushing of existence itself.

When taxation transforms from "the necessary cost of maintaining public services" into "the existential squeeze that makes life unlivable," resistance is no longer a moral choice—it is a survival instinct.

In history, every great peasant uprising, every insurrection of the bottom, has had

almost the same immediate cause: the tax burden was too heavy; life had become impossible.

Those squeezed to the limit do not calculate whether "resistance is rational." They know only: to remain still is death; to move is also death. But to move offers at least a glimmer of hope. That glimmer is the "ignition point" of the historical cycle.

Resistance further destroys the tax base: population flight, cessation of production, social disorder. With the tax base ruined, the state apparatus, to maintain itself, can only intensify extraction—heavier taxes, stricter collection, more savage repression. Which in turn engenders greater resistance.

3.4 The Three-Strata Linkage: The True Engine of the Historical Cycle

This is the dynamical essence of the historical cycle: not that "rulers have grown corrupt," not that "human nature is greedy," but that the "compulsory extraction" logic of the taxation system itself, through the linkage of upper, middle, and lower strata, constitutes a self-accelerating positive feedback loop—

Compulsory extraction (upper) → amplification and distortion of pressure (middle) → survival resistance (lower) → destruction of the tax base → still fiercer extraction (upper)...

Each turn of the loop brings the system one step closer to collapse, until it can no longer turn at all.

Every "equalization of land and remission of taxes" after each dynastic fall merely restarted the same cycle from a fresh point. Every "reform" merely sought a more comfortable posture within the same death spiral. They have never, and could never, touch the root of the problem.

We imagine ourselves in control of the whole, commanding all things. In truth, we are controlled by the system—the upper believes itself to be ruling, yet is held hostage by tax quotas; the middle believes itself to be managing, yet is distorted by the double

squeeze; the lower believes itself to be earning a living, yet is struggling upon the brink of survival. We ourselves have become the system. Each of us is at once the executor and the victim of the system.

Upper, middle, and lower—all three are bound by a single system, and none may escape alone. Unless the entire system is replaced.

Therefore, the abolition of the taxation system is not a "policy choice"; it is the physical necessity by which civilization breaks out of the historical cycle. Just as a car with failed brakes cannot be repaired by "pressing the pedal harder," a system cannot be repaired by "taxing more cleverly." The only way to stop is to install a fundamentally different logic of propulsion.

—And this is precisely what the Contribution Value System shall accomplish.

4. The Death Sentence Upon the Core Propositions of Old Economics

On the basis of the foregoing critique, we may now render final judgment upon the central propositions of old economics:

"The market is the most efficient means of allocating resources": False. When taxation and capital have distorted price signals and generated an immense "metabolic tax" and "costs of compliance," the so-called "efficiency" of the market is no more than a local optimization within a framework of distortion. It systematically channels resources toward domains that best serve the self-expansion of capital, rather than toward those most conducive to human flourishing and civilizational survival.

"Government intervention can correct market failures": A pseudo-proposition. The government itself defines the market through the greatest "intervention" and "failure" of all—taxation. It is itself part of the problem. To deploy a system that manufactures problems in order to correct the problems it has itself manufactured constitutes a logical dead loop.

"Economic growth can solve all social problems": A fatal illusion. Many social ills—the widening chasm between rich and poor, the ecological crisis—are the direct products of the old paradigm's mode of growth. To attempt the solution of problems by the very means that engender them is to carry firewood to quench a conflagration.

5. The Contribution Value System: The End of Economics and the Dawn of Civilimetrics

The "Contribution Value System" proposed by the new contributionist civilization is not yet another economic model, but a "paradigmatic supersession" of economics itself. It marks the end of "economics" and the birth of "civilimetrics"—the science of civilizational measurement.

From "the science of resource allocation" to "the navigation of value creation." Old economics studies how to allocate given resources under conditions of scarcity. The Contribution Value System's core function is to identify, measure, and incentivize the flow of creative value. It is a social "value-detection and navigation system" whose objective is the maximization of the sustainable appreciation of the civilizational system's total capital—natural, epistemic, social, and vital.

The definitive resolution of the tax paradoxes.

Resolving the paradox of extraction and vitality: Contribution value is not extracted; it is conferred. It is a "return" and "amplification" of vitality, not a siphoning of it. This forges a powerful positive feedback loop: the more one creates, the greater the incentive received, the stronger the system's vitality.

Resolving the false opposition of equity and efficiency: Under the Contribution Value System, the greatest "equity"—receiving reward in proportion to genuine contribution—is itself the highest "efficiency," for it ensures that resources perpetually flow toward the sites of greatest systemic value creation. Equity and efficiency here achieve their dialectical unity.

Resolving the paradox of growth and extinction: The new system pursues not the limitless expansion of physical scale, but the "qualitative growth" of civilizational well-being and sustainability. Contribution value incentivizes those "infinite" creative activities—discovery of knowledge, artistic creation, ecological restoration, social harmony—that do not collide with physical limits.

6. Dialectical Unity and Sublation: From the "Power-Capital Complex" to the "Contribution-Value Network"

The critique above conducts us to a final dialectical realization: within the old paradigm, capital is power, and power is capital—two faces of a single coin, constituting an indissoluble "power-capital complex."

The hierarchical structure of "all that exists is capital." The individual's physical strength and intellect are life-capital, sold upon the market in exchange for the means of survival. The enterprise integrates resources and technology into commercial capital, pursuing the maximization of profit. All of these ultimately converge upon, and are subordinated to, the state—the terminal form: political power-capital. Through taxation and law, the state places all subordinate strata of capital under its discipline, and constitutes itself as the source and final destination of all capital formation.

Marx and Musk: a profound dialectical contrast. The greatness of Marx lies in his revelation of capital as a social power with an exploitative essence, and in his envisioning of a community beyond capital. Yet the traditional practice of abolishing private capital by strengthening state power—a form of public capital—has all too often resulted in the "power-capital complex" reasserting itself in a more concentrated form, and has failed to realize the "withering away of power."

The success of Musk exhibits the contrary logic: through extreme technological innovation and the might of commercial capital, attempting to break free from the fetters of the old structures—challenging the state aerospace establishment, the

traditional energy order. His practice demonstrates the subversive force of creative capital. Yet his empire remains built upon the capital logic of the old paradigm; he himself has become a colossal capital entity, incapable of extricating himself from the intricate entanglements of power, and unable to offer an alternative universal social rule.

The final dialectical sublimation. Therefore, any attempt to abolish capital while preserving power, or to restrain power while indulging capital, is futile. They are two faces of one coin; destroy either face alone, and the other will regenerate it in a new form. This is the root of the periodic cycles into which social transformation has fallen over the past several centuries.

The revolutionary character of the new contributionist civilization lies in its sublation, as a whole and at the root, of the "power-capital complex" through a wholly new social rule—the "Contribution Value System."

It sublates capital: contribution value is non-transferable, non-heritable, and non-accumulating in interest. It is an honorific measure of contribution and a token of incentive, not a capital that multiplies itself. It uproots, at the foundation, the very possibility of exploitation.

It sublates power: the governing institution (the Civilizational Council) operates upon the contribution value it earns through the services it renders, not upon compulsory taxation. Power is transformed from a dominating force into a service function, disciplined in its turn by the objective rule of contribution value.

7. The Creative Philosopher: From Interpreter of the Old World to Legislator of the New

As defined in Section Two, the core faculty of the "creative philosopher" is "conceptual engineering," and its aim is "paradigm realization." Here we must supplement a dimension not yet unfolded in that section: how the creative philosopher

serves concretely in the sublation of the "power-capital complex."

If Section Two's "creative philosopher" was a call for role transformation, this section specifies the concrete content of that role: they must penetrate the superficial layer of the "meta-rule" of taxation, expose in full the complicity between taxation and the logic of capital's self-expansion, and upon that foundation, design a new institutional architecture capable of sublating both "capital" and "power" at once. Their work is not merely to write the blueprint of the "Contribution Value System," but to ensure that every detail of that blueprint withstands the ultimate interrogation: "Is this merely a new disguise for the old power-capital complex?"

This is precisely the practice in which the present text is engaged. Not content with exposing the exploitative essence of taxation, it ventures, in addition, to offer a complete institutional proposal for a new civilization founded upon "contribution."

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The ultimate critique of economics points finally to the foundation upon which it subsists—the institution of taxation. This "meta-rule" not only distorts the wellspring of value creation, but locks civilization within a cycle of extraction and decay. The proposal of the Contribution Value System is precisely the severance of this shackle—the realization of a paradigm revolution from "the art of resource allocation" to "the navigation of value creation." It proclaims the end of old economics and marks the birth of civiliometrics. Here, creation becomes the new grammar; contribution, the only currency.

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

Now we have accomplished the most thoroughgoing liquidation of the old economic paradigm. The scalpel of analysis, entering through the universality of "all-things-as-capital," has precisely dissected the genealogy of exploitation parasitic upon the entire organism of civilization, and at last captured its heart and brain: the

"meta-capital" of taxation, and the ultimate paradox of the "power-capital complex" it has forged. We have revealed how a system whose logical starting point is compulsory extraction must necessarily lead to the systematic suppression of creativity and the suffocation of civilization's soul. Marx said that the weapon of criticism cannot replace the criticism of weapons—and all this book can offer is the former.

At the end of criticism lies the beginning of construction. This book is a blueprint for a peaceful civilizational transition; and this transition is possible precisely because the structural deadlock of the old paradigm has been seen through—not to be overthrown by violence, but to be replaced by a superior solution. Yet the limits of criticism must be acknowledged: the power of critique cannot replace the critique of power. What we can do is to see clearly, to speak clearly, and to transmit clearly.

In the next chapter, we shall integrate these dispersed critiques, examining at the macro level the total civilizational crisis wrought by this inverted paradigm—so that the necessity of the new civilization's birth may be rendered all the more luminous.

Chapter Three: The Unification and Sublation of
Doctrines — From Binary Opposition to the Contribution
Era

Chapter Introduction

Having completed our philosophical critique of the old civilizational paradigm, we must now confront the core ideological contestation that has shaped the modern world picture. For centuries, the binary framework of "capitalism—communism" has both explained a portion of historical conflict and imprisoned the imagination of civilization. This chapter aims to achieve a thoroughgoing theoretical synthesis. We shall first, upon the ontological foundation of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, propose "Generalized Capitalism" as a meta-paradigm describing the evolutionary history of civilization, thereby revealing the deep constraint that no ideological attempt can escape: the interactive laws of capital. We shall then dissect the dialectical essence of the present "Great Transition" period, revealing how socialism and post-capitalism, as two paths struggling within the old soil, jointly expose the limits of the old paradigm. Finally, we shall systematically expound how Contributionism is not merely another "ism," but a sublation of "ism" itself — the first civilizational-scale attempt to transcend Capital Causality through the deliberate construction of Contribution Causality.

Section One: The Foundation of the Meta-Paradigm — The Illusion of "Isms" and the Dialectical Essence of Generalized Capitalism

This section undertakes the deepest layer of philosophical purification. We shall trace the origin and essence of the concept of "ism," revealing its fundamental relationship with "capital." Upon this foundation, we dialectically propose "Generalized Capitalism" as a meta-paradigm: it is not a noble ideal, but a unified designation and description of those organizational forms that, throughout the history of human civilization, have either failed to transcend the exploitative and oppressive essence of the universal interactive law of capital, or have encountered structural impasses in their attempts at transcendence. To grasp this positioning is to grasp the premise of all subsequent critique and construction.

1. The Origin and Essence of "Isms": "Ideal Plants" upon the Soil of Capital

An "ism" may be defined as a systematized body of thought, theory, proposition, or ideology that offers a blueprint for cultivating some "ideal society" upon the soil of reality.

The fundamental relationship between "ism" and "capital":

Capital is the soil. The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital reveals that existence itself is capital, and the universal law of capital interaction is exploitation and oppression in the broad sense. The essence of this "soil" is value-neutral — a ruthless contest of forces.

An "ism" is a plant. Every "ism" is an "ideal plant" that humanity attempts to cultivate upon this given soil, seeking to plan, steer, or transcend the blind interactions of capital.

The fundamental predicament: because the essence of the soil (the law of capital) is exploitation and oppression, any "ism" that grows upon this soil — whether a capitalism that advocates freedom or a communism that advocates equality — so long as it has not thoroughly replaced the soil itself, will find its practical form unable to wholly shake off the taint of exploitation and oppression. In the end, all such attempts degenerate, to varying degrees, into a rationalized justification and institutionalized consolidation of the exploitative and oppressive structures of some particular capital form. The ideals they pursue are forever dragged back by the inertia of the soil.

2. Validation in History: The Capital Essence Beneath the Illusion of "Isms"

Primitive and slave societies: At this stage, no systematized "ism" yet existed, but the operative laws of society were themselves the most naked "ism" in practice. "The survival of the fittest" was the competitive law of corporeal capital; "the ownership of persons" was the property regime of corporeal capital. Such societies required no theoretical veneer; their violent practice was the direct proclamation of the logic of exploitation and oppression of corporeal capital.

Feudal society: Ideologies such as "the divine right of kings" and "the patriarchal-clan system" (embryonic "isms") functioned in essence as the legitimizing garment for the exploitative and oppressive structure of landed capital (lord–serf / landlord–tenant), beautifying a monopoly of land founded on violence as the natural order of things.

Narrowly conceived capitalist society: Doctrinal discourses such as "the free market," "the sanctity of private property," and "utilitarianism" served historically as instruments for naturalizing and justifying the exploitative and oppressive relations of financial capital (capitalist–worker), disguising structural exploitation as an equal contract freely entered upon.

3. The Great Communist Experiment and Its Intrinsic

Predicament

Communism (together with socialism in its embryonic phase) represents the most thoroughgoing "ism" in human history in its attempt to eradicate the exploitation of capital. Yet it too confronts the severe challenges of the "soil of capital."

The contradiction between theoretical ideals and the realities of human nature:

The suppression of competition by "distribution according to need": when material abundance has not yet been achieved, this principle may suppress healthy competition grounded in ability, thereby oppressing the developmental drives and creative passions of the highly capable, leading to a decline in social vitality.

The lack of an institutional path for "the great elevation of human consciousness": this ideal entrusts the overcoming of exploitation to the spontaneous transformation of human nature, yet lacks an operable, iterable institutional process for systematically elevating and consolidating such a state of consciousness. It neglects humanity's inherent attribute of capitalistic self-interest and the uninterrupted pressure of the external environment of All-Things-as-Capital.

Institutional fragility and the risk of regression:

The absence of a legal system consolidating the new paradigm: after eliminating the old forms of capital exploitation, if a robust new institutional order capable of effectively resisting the corrosive attributes of both internal and external capital (such as a Contribution Value System and Algorithmic Democracy) is not swiftly established, then "power" will rapidly fill the vacuum left by capital's retreat and metastasize into a new "power-capital," giving rise to "administrative exploitation."

The transitional predicament of the socialist stage: as the embryo of communism, the principle of "from each according to ability, to each according to labor" — because the measure of "labor" defies precise calibration — tends in practice to degenerate into egalitarianism or a new hierarchy, incapable of completing the thorough fashioning of the new self within the old world, and all too easily penetrated and

dissolved by the old world's capital logics (market exchange, bureaucratic privilege).

4. The Dialectical Proposal of the "Generalized Capitalism"

Meta-Paradigm

Definition: Generalized Capitalism is a unified designation and theoretical abstraction for those organizational forms of society that, throughout the history of civilization, have either failed to transcend the universal law of capital interaction (i.e., exploitation and oppression in the broad sense) or have encountered structural impasses in their attempts at transcendence. It is a descriptive, analytical meta-paradigm.

Core connotations:

It describes not any particular ideal society, but a core problem that has run throughout civilizational history without definitive resolution — namely, that social institutions remain dominated or devoured by the blind interactive law of capital.

It regards all concrete historical "isms" and their corresponding social forms (including the communist experiment) as specific manifestations of this meta-paradigm under different historical conditions, predicated upon different dominant capital forms or different attempts at transcendence.

Four great historical manifestations (morphological evolution):

Corporeal capitalism (slave society): exploitation and oppression in the form of the ownership of persons.

Landed capitalism (feudal society): exploitation and oppression in the form of rent-based dependency.

Financial capitalism (narrowly conceived capitalist society): exploitation and oppression in the form of wage labor and the extraction of surplus value.

Power capitalism / administrative capitalism (the alienated form of classical socialist

practice): exploitation and oppression in the form of administrative monopoly over the allocation of resources.

Contributionism (contributionist society): the dialectical sublation of the meta-paradigm and the definitive answer to the problem itself.

In summary, the "Generalized Capitalism" meta-framework reveals that the evolution of civilizational history is, in essence, a process in which society's answers to the two fundamental questions — "what is scarce" and "how shall it be distributed" — succeed one another upon an ascending spiral. It is not a particular "ism," but a macro-paradigm that describes this underlying logic. It acknowledges with full sobriety the predicament of all old "isms." Rather than attempting to plant ideal flora upon the old soil, it actively replaces the soil itself — through the Contribution Value System and the legal architecture of Algorithmic Democracy — switching the causal law of social operation from "exploitation and oppression" to "creation and contribution." It is the "self-negation" and terminal form of Generalized Capitalism.

5. Why Employ the Term "Capitalism"? — A Dialectical Conceptual Synthesis

Revealing essence: The use of the term "capital" serves as a perpetual reminder of the underlying unity and fundamental problem shared by all social forms under the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital.

Critical inheritance: The retention of the suffix "-ism" is meant to encompass all systematic schemes for organizing society, together with their destined fate of eventual corrosion or challenge by the logic of capital.

Dialectical unity: "Generalized Capitalism" signifies that the history of civilization up to the present can, in its deep structure, be understood as a history in which the logic of "capital" unfolds and deepens itself through various "isms," until at last it encounters its own limit.

6. The Fundamental Driving Force of Civilizational Evolution: A Synthetic Model

The transition of civilizational stages is driven by a complex, interacting dynamical system. This model synthesizes four core driving forces:

The contradiction between productive forces and relations of production (the foundational driving force): This is the classical thesis of historical materialism. When the productive forces — most notably the proliferation of automation and artificial intelligence — develop to a point the old relations of production (such as the wage-labor system) can no longer contain, the material basis for systemic transformation is established. The universal structural unemployment wrought by automation is precisely the most acute contemporary manifestation of this contradiction, compelling society to seek a new model of value distribution beyond "full-time employment."

Social structural contradictions (the direct driving force): This is the social-level concretization of the foundational force. Beyond the aforementioned unemployment crisis, it includes the polarization of wealth, resource depletion, and ecological crisis engendered by financial capitalism. These contradictions generate enormous social pressure, forcing the system to seek an exit.

The revolution of the cognitive paradigm (the ideological driving force): Without the liberation of thought, there can be no institutional innovation. From "the divine right of kings" to "natural rights," and thence to the ongoing paradigm shift from "unlimited growth" to "sustainable development," from "competition as the standard" to "collaborative symbiosis," these constitute the vanguard of institutional transformation. The broad acceptance of the Contributionist vision is the precondition of its realization.

The ignition of critical technologies (the instrumental driving force): Technology renders the new paradigm feasible. Artificial intelligence and big data make possible

the precise assessment of vast and complex "contributions"; blockchain technology provides a transparent, tamper-proof infrastructural foundation for the credible recording and distribution of contribution value; space technology and energy technology furnish the physical means for civilization's advance toward the stars. Yet the ultimate potential and risk of AGI constitute variables that must be treated with the utmost seriousness along the path of civilizational evolution.

These four forces do not exist in isolation, but form a positive feedback loop: technological development intensifies social contradictions; social contradictions engender ideological transformation; ideological transformation steers technology toward the solution of the new paradigm's needs; and at length, upon the rupture of the old relations of production, an entirely new civilizational form is established.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The establishment of the "Generalized Capitalism" meta-paradigm and its dynamical model constitutes a thoroughgoing philosophical disenchantment. It exposes with cold clarity the predicament of all old "isms," and systematically identifies the fundamental driving forces of civilizational evolution. The revolutionary character of Contributionism lies in its being the first to provide a complete, operable scheme for the replacement of the soil itself — thereby answering all the challenges revealed by the dynamical model. This lays the firmest theoretical foundation for the deeper critique and construction of the sections that follow.

Section Two: The Deadlock of the Old Paradigm — A Critique of the Isms and the General Crisis of Civilization

Viewed through the mirror of "Generalized Capitalism," every attempt of the "isms" to cultivate novel flora upon the ancient soil—whatever its original intention—has ensnared itself in a systemic deadlock. This section shall dissect, one by one, the internal contradictions and fundamental limitations of financial capitalism, the classical socialist experiment, and the reformist path of post-capitalism, revealing how together they propel civilization toward a climacteric of total crisis—a juncture that demands an irrevocable decision.

1. The Systemic Deadlock of Financial Capitalism: The Growth Paradox and the Alienation of Humanity

Historical Contributions and the Inward Turn

It once unleashed the forces of production upon a prodigious scale, forged a global marketplace, and impelled technological innovation. Yet its core imperative—the logic of capital's infinite self-augmentation—has generated a fundamental, irreconcilable contradiction with the finitude of the planetary ecosystem and the sustainable well-being of human society.

The Concurrence of Fivefold Deadlocks

Economic deadlock: the growth paradox. Growth is sustained by debt expansion and consumerism, engendering a profound rupture between the virtual and the real economy; financial crises recur with periodic inevitability as the system's self-cleansing mechanism.

Social deadlock: polarization and fragmentation. The iron law that the rate of return on capital exceeds the rate of economic growth—Piketty's law—drives wealth into vertiginous concentration at the apex, withers the middle class, arrests social mobility,

and sunders the civic consensus.

Ecological deadlock: overdraw and collapse. The externalization model that treats the natural environment as a free "sink" and "resource reservoir" now breaches planetary boundaries, unleashing climate catastrophe and biological mass extinction.

Spiritual deadlock: total alienation. Humanity is estranged from its labor product, from its species-being, from others, and from itself. Consumerism cannot fill the vacuum of meaning; pervasive anxiety and depression become the pathologies—indeed, the endemic malaise—of the age.

Governance deadlock: the capture of power. The forces of capital insinuate themselves deeply into the political process, reducing the state apparatus, to a significant degree, to a "committee" serving particular capital interests; the supply of global public goods—peace, pandemic prevention, climate governance—fails catastrophically.

2. The Grand Experiment of Communism (Socialism) and Its Structural Predicament

Historical Contributions and Lofty Ideals

It constituted the most thoroughgoing and uncompromising critique of the logic of capital, announcing for the first time, at the institutional level, the possibility of abolishing exploitation. It demonstrated that collective action and long-range planning can achieve extraordinary feats—the miracles of industrialization and the conquest of space. It established, as a jurisprudential principle, the supreme value of social equity.

The Insurmountable Structural Predicament

The information and computation predicament. Within a complex modern society, the central planning apparatus cannot effectively apprehend and process the evanescent, ever-shifting demand information of hundreds of millions; the inevitable result is the misallocation of resources, inefficiency, and the strangulation of innovation. This is

the crux of the Hayekian critique, repeatedly confirmed in practice.

The incentive and vitality predicament. The principle of "distribution according to labor," because the measure of "labor" is extraordinarily recalcitrant to calibration, tends in practice to degenerate into "distribution according to power" or "distribution according to status," stifling individual agency. Meanwhile, the utopian vision of "distribution according to need," under conditions of material scarcity, directly suppresses competition, blunts the creative drive of the highly capable, and thereby constitutes a tacit oppression of excellence.

The alienation of power and institutional fragility. Once the hegemony of capital is dismantled, if a new structure of power—transparent, balanced, and designed to transcend the old state, such as Algorithmic Democracy—is not concurrently erected, the "regime" will swiftly metastasize into a novel "power-capital," giving rise to a system of "administrative exploitation." The reliance upon "the great elevation of human consciousness" lacks an operable, iterable institutional process for systematically cultivating and consolidating such a state, with the result that the new self is rapidly assimilated by the old soil, and the fruits of reform are lost as soon as they are won.

3. The Illusions and Limitations of Post-Capitalist Reformism

The post-capitalist current of thought has keenly discerned the systemic crisis of contemporary capitalism and has advanced such suggestive concepts as the "inclusive economy" and the "zero marginal cost society." Its practical explorations—exposing, from within the system, the externalized costs of capital, introducing an ethical dimension (ESG), and generating partial experiments such as the welfare state, platform cooperatives, and universal basic income—are not without insight. Yet its fundamental limitation lies in this: it seeks to learn to swim within the swimming pool of capital.

Any reform that attempts to constrain the logic of profit-maximization encounters the

countermeasure of capital "voting with its feet," or is reversed under the pressure of global competition. It cannot resolve the systemic growth paradox; schemes such as universal basic income, absent a revolution in the underlying relations of production, ultimately become a fiscal burden sustaining the consumer society rather than a path of emancipation. In essence, it is a species of bricolage—a tinkering—that dreams of taming, through moral exhortation and piecemeal adjustment, a leviathan that can survive only by ceaselessly devouring resources. In the end, it cannot overcome the inertia of the system.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Financial capitalism has reached its dialectical self-negation; the classical model of communism, on the path of transcending capital, has suffered structural defeat, unable to resolve the problems of information, incentive, and the alienation of power; post-capitalist reformism is but a fantasy that does not dare to touch the root. Every path of the old paradigm has now been surveyed and charted, and all converge upon a single conclusion: upon the ancient soil of "capital," any patchwork repair of any "ism" is already futile. The general crisis of civilization is precisely the concentrated manifestation of the old paradigm's wholesale failure. It is within this unmitigated extremity that the dialectic of history has forged the conditions for a genuine paradigm revolution.

Section Three: The Foundation of the New Paradigm — Contributionism: The Sublation of "Ism" Itself

The deadlock of the old paradigm stems from the fact that every "ism" has labored upon the soil of "capital." The revolutionary character of Contributionism lies in its refusal to proffer yet another contending "ism"; rather, it undertakes a radical sublation of the very mode of thought that gives rise to "isms" itself. It no longer asks, "Which ideal plant ought we to cultivate upon the old soil?" but rather, "Can we—and if so, how—replace the entire soil?" This section shall elucidate that Contributionism is a historic endeavor to transcend the meta-paradigm of "Generalized Capitalism" by constructing an entirely new social operating system: the Causality of Contribution.

1. The Philosophical Core: The Switch from the Causality of Capital to the Causality of Contribution

The Fundamental Diagnosis of the Old Paradigm

All the predicaments of the old civilization are, in the final analysis, governed by the Causality of Capital. That is to say: the possession of and contention among capitals (forces) determines the distribution of power and the direction of resource flows, and ultimately shapes social structure and developmental trajectory. This is a circular logic—grounded in past stock (existing capital)—that inevitably conduces to exploitation and oppression.

The Core Proposition of the New Paradigm

Contributionism aims to construct and operate an entirely new social core algorithm—the Causality of Contribution. That is to say: the contribution that individuals and collectives create for the sustainable future of the community determines the honor they receive and the resources allocated to them, and ultimately shapes social structure and developmental direction. This is a generative logic—oriented toward future increments (creative contribution)—that incentivizes

creation and collaboration.

The Fundamental Opposition of the Paradigms

Old paradigm (the logic of capital): your past—what you possess—determines your future.

New paradigm (the logic of contribution): your future—what you can create—determines your present.

2. Core Mechanisms: A Tripartite Social Operating System

Contributionism is not an ethereal ideal, but a runnable institutional order composed of three mutually interlocking core mechanisms.

The Contribution Value System: The Universal Measure of Social Value

Function: a system for the quantitative assessment of the full spectrum of labor, creation, collaboration, and sustainability-conducive behavior, grounded in dynamic big data and consensus algorithms. Its aim is the precise measurement of "effective contribution"—not of "capital stock" or "position of power."

Significance: it wrests the power of defining "value" from the grip of capital and the market, entrusting it to a transparent, auditable algorithmic system, thereby furnishing an objective basis for the equitable distribution of social resources.

Algorithmic Democracy: The Balance-Wheel of the Generation and Operation of Power

Function: a hybrid model of governance grounded in contribution value and individual capability. Contribution value constitutes the foundation of social trust, yet it does not directly translate into decision-making authority. Decision-making authority is conferred—through a plurality of algorithmic mechanisms such as competence certification, referenda, contribution-weighted deliberation, and a contributionist electoral law—upon those best able and most willing to safeguard the public interest.

Significance: it uproots, at the foundation, the hereditary transmission of power, the

interference of capital in politics, and the pathologies of populism; it realizes the principle that "authority is born of merit, authority is generated by algorithm." It is the institutional guarantee against the metastasization of "power-capital."

The Circular Economy: The Engine-Room of Value Creation and Distribution

Function: an economic model driven at its core by contribution value. Resources flow preferentially toward individuals and projects of high contribution value; consumption and well-being are positively correlated with contribution value; the system adjusts itself through algorithmic regulation, ensuring a dynamic equilibrium between ecological sustainability and social vitality.

Significance: it internalizes environmental costs, decouples economic growth from resource depletion, and binds individual well-being to social contribution, forging a beneficent self-reinforcing circuit: "create contribution—obtain resources—create still more."

3. Contributionism as the Dialectical Synthesis and Terminal Form of "Generalized Capitalism"

The Contributionism proposed in this work is no creation ex nihilo, but a "comprehensive synthesis" formed upon the critical inheritance and creative integration of the theoretical essences elaborated above. It systematically absorbs:

The Marxian framework of the "succession of social formations": Contributionism fully accepts the materialist conception of history—that the contradiction between productive forces and relations of production is the fundamental engine of civilizational stage-transitions—and applies it throughout its analysis of the "Generalized Capitalism" meta-paradigm. It adduces, in particular, the crisis of automation-induced unemployment as direct evidence that the relations of production of financial capitalism can no longer contain the new productive forces.

The "plural value" vision of the post-capitalist current: Contributionism affirms the post-capitalist critique of the single monetary yardstick and the hegemony of GDP,

and renders this vision concrete in an operable, multidimensional contribution-value accounting system, formally incorporating ecology, society, culture, and other long-externalized values into the core reckoning of civilization.

The "complex giant system" theory of complexity science: Contributionism regards human society as a complex, self-organizing, adaptive system. It therefore does not pursue an omniscient central planning authority, but designs a hybrid model of "preliminary algorithmic assessment + deliberative democratic review." This is, in essence, a distributed computing network that both absorbs the information-discovery function of the market and conducts macro-level steering through collective intelligence—achieving a superior regulation of the complex socio-economic system.

The technological dynamics of singularity theory and futurology: Contributionism affirms the pivotal role of technological explosion as the "instrumental driving force" of civilizational transition, explicitly designating AI, blockchain, automation, and controlled nuclear fusion as the enabling foundation of the new paradigm—not merely passive instruments.

Through this transdisciplinary depth of integration, Contributionism aims to provide a coherent and operable blueprint for civilizational evolution—one rooted in a profound theoretical heritage, yet oriented toward the technological realities of the future.

Through this very integration, Contributionism transcends the limitations of its theoretical origins, thereby achieving the sublation and surpassing of the "isms":

With respect to capitalism: it absorbs the market's pursuit of efficiency and its incentivization of innovation, but replaces "competition of capital" with "competition of contribution," eradicating exploitation at its root.

With respect to communism: it inherits the ultimate ideal of justice and equity and the need for planfulness, but resolves the information-and-computation predicament and the incentive-and-vitality predicament through "algorithmic planning" and "contribution incentives."

With respect to post-capitalism: it realizes the blueprint the latter dared not imagine. It does not constrain capital from without, but supplants the logic of "capital" from within, with a superior logic of "contribution."

As the terminal form of "Generalized Capitalism": within Contributionism, "capital" does not vanish; all things remain capital. Yet the dominant logic of social operation has been switched from the "law of capital interaction" (exploitation and oppression) to the "law of contribution and creation." Therefore, it is no longer a new plant upon the old soil; through institutional design, the soil itself has been successfully replaced. It delivers the definitive answer to the problem described by the "Generalized Capitalism" meta-paradigm: the domination of society by the blind laws of capital.

In this sense, Contributionism is the "self-negation" of "Generalized Capitalism"—the end of the old paradigm and the beginning of a new civilization.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Thus we have completed the philosophical foundation of the new paradigm. The revolutionary character of Contributionism lies in its refusal to propose yet another contending "ism"; rather, through the construction of the Causality of Contribution as an entirely new social operating system, it replaces at the root the underlying soil upon which civilization operates. It supplants the stock-based logic of "capital competition" with the future-oriented logic of "creative contribution," achieving the dialectical synthesis and ultimate transcendence of the "Generalized Capitalism" meta-paradigm.

It is worth noting that Contributionism, as the sublation of "ism" itself, finds its philosophical ground already laid in Section Six of Chapter Two: existence precedes theory. Contributionism is not yet another ideological label; it is the conscious transcendence of the predicament that "all isms struggle upon the old soil." It no longer asks, "Which ideal plant ought we to cultivate upon the old soil?" but rather, "Can we replace the entire soil?" The precondition of replacing the soil is precisely

the acknowledgment that the soil (existence) precedes the plant (theory).

Further Reading

This section has argued for the philosophical core of Contributionism—the switch from the Causality of Capital to the Causality of Contribution. But what is the physical foundation of this switch? Why is "contribution" rather than "exploitation" the sole path to the long-term survival of civilization?

Please refer to Appendix II, Resonance Physics. That treatise demonstrates, through an axiomatic system: exploitative interaction generates entropy and leads to heat death; resonant interaction achieves zero dissipation and positive increase, leading to eternal survival. Contributionism is not an ethical preference, but the necessary direction of cosmic evolution.

Section Four: Marxism and Contributionism — From Diagnosis to Completion

In the preceding three sections, we have laid the foundation of the meta-paradigm of "Generalized Capitalism," demonstrated that every old "ism" labors upon the soil of "capital," and indicated that Contributionism is the sublation of "ism" itself. It no longer asks, "Which ideal plant ought we to cultivate upon the old soil?" but rather, "Can we replace the entire soil?"

Yet one crucial question has not yet been addressed head-on: What is the relationship between Marxism and Contributionism? Is Contributionism a negation of Marxism? Does it seek to supplant Marxism?

This section shall confront this question squarely. We shall argue that Contributionism is not a negation of Marxism but the continuation and completion of its unfinished enterprise. Marxism translates the pathology underlying the collapse of the old world; Contributionism translates the possibility of how a new world may arise. The two are translations, at different moments, of the same stream of being—jointly serving the same cause of emancipation.

1. The Unfinished Enterprise of Marxism: Diagnosis Completed, Prescription Not Yet Written

What we term "diagnosis" is precisely the translation of the old world's pathology; what we term "prescription" is the translation of the new world's possibility. Marxism accomplished the former; the latter, however, has yet to be unfolded.

The place of Marxism in the history of human thought is irreplaceable. Its threefold contribution forms a cornerstone that no serious theory can circumvent.

First, it revealed the exploitative essence of capital. Before Marx, capital was understood as a "thing"—machinery, factory buildings, money. Marx demonstrated

that capital is not a thing but a determinate social relation: an unequal power structure between human beings. This insight shattered the fetishism of classical political economy, transforming economics from a relation among things into a relation among persons.

Second, it revealed the internal contradiction of capital. There exists an irreconcilable contradiction between the logic of capital's infinite self-augmentation, on the one hand, and the finite tolerance of society and the finite carrying capacity of nature, on the other. This contradiction necessarily gives rise to periodic economic crises, social rupture, and ecological overshoot. Marx's pathological diagnosis of capitalism has by no means become obsolete; on the contrary, it has grown more urgent with the intensification of the ecological crisis.

Third, it charted the direction of transcending capital. The abolition of private property, the abolition of classes, and the realization of human emancipation—this direction remains to this day the guiding beacon of civilizational advance. The ultimate goal of Marxism, "from each according to ability, to each according to need," points toward a new world no longer riven by exploitation or alienation.

However, Marxism is a diagnostic document, not a prescription. "From each according to ability, to each according to need" is a principle, not an institutional design. It answers the question "Where are we going?" but not "How shall we get there?"

This is no failure on Marx's part. He lived in the ascending epoch of capitalism; his foremost task was critique and diagnosis. He indicated the direction of transcending capital, but he did not—and in the nineteenth century could not—complete the systematic translation of an ancient practice into an institutional blueprint. That practice is the relation of "dwelling together according to contribution," which already existed in the tribe of primitive society. It depended not upon high technology, but upon the shared memory of a face-to-face community and the trust born of immediate acquaintance. Marx did not translate it into an institutional scheme, not because the

practice was absent, but because his historical mission was first to lay bare the pathology of the old world. That task—translating this ancient practice into a systematized institution capable of operating at scale—was left to those who came after.

The incompleteness of Marxism manifests itself concretely in three respects:

First, the lack of an institutional blueprint for the "new world." How is the "ability" in "from each according to ability" to be measured in its manifold diversity? How is the "need" in "to each according to need" to differentiate "subsistence need" from "developmental need"? How is power to be prevented from metastasizing into a new exploitation once capital has been abolished? These crucial questions receive no systematic answer in the classical texts.

Second, the lack of an operable design for the path of the "withering away of the state." Marx indicated that the state would eventually wither away; but before that day arrives, how is the power of the transitional period to be shielded from corrosion? What is required is a concrete institutional architecture, not a moral appeal alone.

Third, the positioning of nature is not radical enough. Within the Marxian framework, nature is treated primarily as the "object of labor" and the "condition of production"—not as an internal constituent of capital. This was comprehensible in the nineteenth century, but in the twenty-first century, with ecological crisis at the doorstep, this positioning must be expanded.

The greatness of history lies herein: it neither halts before a great thought, nor devalues it for being incomplete. The unfinished enterprise of Marxism is precisely the historical precondition for the birth of Contributionism.

2. Contributionism: Completion Through Inheritance, Transcendence Through Breakthrough

The relation between Contributionism and Marxism is not one of "opposition," nor

one of "replacement," but one of "completion." Contributionism does not seek to overturn Marxism; it resumes the work that Marxism left unfinished. This completion unfolds on three ascending levels.

The first level: the comprehensive inheritance of the pathological diagnosis. Contributionism fully accepts Marx's core thesis on the essence of capital—that capital is not a thing but a social relation—and extends it from the scale of human society to the scale of all things. It likewise inherits Marx's insight into the internal contradiction of capital: the contradiction between infinite self-augmentation and finite tolerance is reformulated in Contributionism as the accumulation of "metabolic tax" and the loss of "paradigmatic attraction." This is the strongest contemporary confirmation of the Marxian theory of crisis.

The second level: the institutional completion of the project of emancipation. Marxism indicated the ultimate direction of transcending capital—"human emancipation"—and supplied the principle "from each according to ability, to each according to need," yet did not translate it into an operable institutional design. Contributionism takes up precisely this unfinished work and accomplishes a threefold institutional translation. It translates "from each according to ability" from principle into a quantifiable system centered upon the Contribution Value System; it translates "to each according to need" from ideal into a dual-track operative mechanism of "basic livelihood guarantee" and "contribution-value redemption"; and it translates the long-term expectation of the "withering away of the state" into a transitional design channeled through "unit-based governance" and the "service-oriented government." A principle without institution is a fantasy; Contributionism is the unity of principle and institution.

The third level: the fundamental breakthrough in the scale of emancipation. The Marxian emancipation is the emancipation of "humanity." This was a mighty vision in the nineteenth century, but in the twenty-first, with ecological crisis imminent, to "liberate humanity without liberating all things" is incomplete. When human civilization treats nature according to the same logic of exploitation, the logic of

capital merely migrates to another domain and continues to operate. Contributionism therefore achieves a threefold breakthrough: from the "human scale" to the "scale of all things," extending the proposition of emancipation from the proletariat to nature, ecology, and even future intelligent agents; from the "critique of capital" to the "holistic sublation of the capital-power complex," simultaneously sublating the logic of capital's self-augmentation and the logic of power's coercive extraction, thereby curing at its root the pathology of "power capitalism" exposed in Section One; and from "diagnostic document" to "therapeutic protocol"—it no longer merely explains the crisis but provides a complete alternative operating system for the systemic upgrade of civilization.

3. Contributionism as "Meta-ism": The End of the Strife of Isms

The three levels above—inheritance, completion, breakthrough—are not merely juxtaposed, but form a progressive chain of logic. The first level, inheritance, establishes the legitimacy of Contributionism: it is rooted in the most solid diagnostic achievements of Marxism. The second level, completion, establishes its necessity: it resumes the work Marxism left unfinished. The third level, breakthrough, establishes its inevitability: it carries Marx's vision to a larger scale of translation.

When legitimacy, necessity, and inevitability are simultaneously present, an unavoidable conclusion emerges: Contributionism is no longer merely "one more ism," but the sublation of the very category of "ism."

All old "isms" answer the same question—"How shall we live upon the soil of 'capital'?"—and their answers diverge: capitalism says, "Let capital grow freely"; communism says, "Uproot capital"; post-capitalism says, "Reform capital." Yet they share one presupposition: that "capital" is the fundamental reality to be confronted.

Contributionism no longer asks how to manage capital, but how to replace capital with contribution. It no longer attempts to cultivate a new plant upon the old soil, but to replace the soil itself. When the underlying logic of social operation is switched

from "capital-power" to "contribution-creation," the problem-space described by the old oppositions of "left/right" and "capital/socialism" naturally vanishes—not because one side has won, but because the question itself has been redefined. Just as the quarrel between the geocentric and heliocentric systems lost all significance after the invention of the astronomical telescope, Contributionism is the telescope that allows human civilization to "see the world anew." It transcends the strife of isms and liberates civilization from the predicament of "choosing within the old framework."

4. Two Dimensions of Translation of the Same Project of Emancipation

This "meta-ism" positioning is not a departure from Marxism, but the internalization and elevation of its mission—from "interpreting the world" to "changing the world." Let us return to Marx's immortal words: "The philosophers have only interpreted the world in various ways; the point, however, is to change it."

These words indicate the fundamental orientation of this work. But between "interpretation" and "change" there lies a neglected link: translation. Interpretation is to describe the world for others to see; change is to transform the world for others to use; translation is to render into a language accessible to more people the possibilities that already exist in practice. Marxism and Contributionism are precisely different dimensions of translation. The former translates the pathology of the old world; the latter translates the possibility of the new world.

Marxism accomplished the "interpretation" of the old world. It revealed the essence, contradictions, and crises of capital, and indicated the direction of transcending capital. It is the most profound diagnostic document in the history of human thought.

Contributionism is devoted to the "change" of the old world. It designs a complete alternative operating system for civilization—from the quantification of contribution values and unit-based governance to Algorithmic Democracy and the Charter of Civilization—every step supported by operable institutions. It is the first systematic

therapeutic protocol in the history of human thought.

The relationship between Marxism and Contributionism may be understood thus: both are different translations of an already-present reality—the world in crisis. Marxism translated the pathology of the old world—the exploitative essence of capital, its internal contradiction, its periodic crises. It gave those who had already suffered, for the first time, a language with which to comprehend their suffering.

Contributionism translates the possibility of a new world that already exists. Among those who, without any need of justification, choose not to exploit, there already exists a living practice of "dwelling together according to contribution"; and in the plain wisdom deposited in everyday language—such as "the body is the capital of revolution" or "connections are capital"—one already finds a conception of capital that transcends the monetary yardstick. Contributionism merely renders these already-present possibilities into a transmissible, iterable institutional blueprint.

The two are translations, at different moments, of the same stream of being. Marxism translates why the old world collapses; Contributionism translates how the new world grows. They jointly serve the same cause of emancipation—the one from the standpoint of crisis, the other from the perspective of the way out.

Without the translation of Marxism, the pathology of the old world would be far more difficult to understand; without the translation of Contributionism, the way out of the old world and into the new would be far more difficult to see. But whether or not such translations exist, being itself is there. The collapse of the old world is a fact; the growth of the new world is likewise a fact. Marxism and Contributionism merely enable these facts to be seen, spoken, and transmitted more clearly by more people.

As Marx said, "The philosophers have only interpreted the world in various ways; the point, however, is to change it." Contributionism is precisely the enactment of this dictum. It is not interpreting a world that yet awaits interpretation; it is providing a language, accessible to more people, for a road that already exists in practice.

This road was not invented but recognized. As argued earlier: existence precedes

theory. Contributionism does not create a new world from nothing; it translates that new soil—already growing in the cracks of the old world—into a language that more people can see, enter, and co-build.

Therefore, Contributionism is not a departure from Marxism, but its most faithful completion. It does not negate Marx; it resumes the work Marx left unfinished. Just as Marx was the greatest diagnostician of civilization in the nineteenth century, who translated the pathology of the old world, Contributionism is the preeminent architect of civilization in the twenty-first century, who translates the possibility of the new world. Both are translators—only the objects of their translation differ.

Finally, we must be clear: the movement is from relation to thing, not from thing to relation. But things can in turn reshape relations—this is what is called productive force, the progress of the times, the emergence of science and technology. The passage from financial capital to Contributionism (contribution-capital) is precisely the result of things reshaping relations. This is not itself the root; had Contributionism existed from the outset, these circuitous roads would not have been necessary. It is precisely because it did not exist at the outset that we must now walk the road to its end.

Marx is not the terminus. Some have taken his dictum that "capital is a relation" as the answer; we, however, know it to be only the beginning of the question.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

This section has answered the pivotal question of this work's intellectual-historical position: Marxism and Contributionism are not opposed, but two translations of the same stream of being at different moments. We have argued for the threefold completion of Marxism by Contributionism: the comprehensive inheritance of the pathological diagnosis, the institutional completion of the project of emancipation, and the fundamental breakthrough in the scale of emancipation. Contributionism is not "one more ism," but a "meta-ism" that allows the old oppositions of "left/right"

and "capital/socialism" to vanish of themselves. It is not a substitute for Marxism, but the continuator and completer of its unfinished enterprise.

Having understood this, the reader can more clearly perceive that we have answered the intellectual-historical question of "whence Contributionism comes." Yet a more fundamental question still hangs unresolved: if Contributionism is truly so superior, how shall we—who bear the stamp of the old world—be able to walk toward it? If the old self does not first die, and the new self is not first born, then the most exquisite institutions are but a blueprint written upon the sand.

This question will lead us into the next three sections. We shall accomplish, in turn, the negation of the negation of "ourselves," the negation of the negation of "capital," and the dialectical unity of the two. When these two paths converge, the work as a whole will have truly completed the philosophical transition from "interpreting the world" to "changing the world," laying the final ontological foundation for the institutional construction of Part Three.

Section Five: The Negation of the Negation of "Ourselves" — The Spiritual Revolution of the Subject

The conclusion of the preceding section propels us toward an unavoidable point of departure, practical in character: however exquisite the institutional blueprint, if it is to be executed by the "old self," it will ultimately degenerate into a masquerade ball of the old world. When we declare that "capital" must be sublated by "contribution," a more fundamental question than that of institutional design confronts us: who is to accomplish this sublation?

If "we" ourselves remain immersed in the inertial habits of the old paradigm, if we continue to measure our self-worth by "how much we possess," if we still regard "competition" as the sole grammar of survival, then even if we replace the word "capital" with "all-things-are-capital," the specter of the old world will still return to life within this new vocabulary. As Marx observed: "It is not enough that thought should strive to realize itself; reality must itself strive toward thought." And this "reality" refers, above all, to the state of our own being.

This is the most profound mandate that dialectics has bequeathed to this work: before completing the negation of the negation of capital, we must first complete the negation of the negation of ourselves.

This path is the obverse of the negation of the negation of capital. It is not an adjunct to institutions, but the precondition of their very possibility. A new institution constituted by old selves is doomed to become but a costume ball of the old order; whereas an old institution inhabited by new selves has already, at the spiritual level, accomplished its transcendence.

1. The Thesis: The Old Self — An Existence Alienated by the Logic of Capital

The old self is not an innate "villain." The old self is a form of existence molded, over long years, by the gravitational field of the old paradigm. It is not the product of moral defect, but a survival strategy formed under determinate historical conditions. This strategy was once effective; now it is ceasing to function.

The core features of the old self may be summarized as four states of alienation.

First, alienation from others — perceiving every other as a potential adversary.

Within the operative logic of scarcity and exploitation, the existence of the other is first perceived as that of a "competitor." Resources are finite; your gain is my loss. Opportunities are scarce; your ascent is my descent. This perception does not originate in a "selfish gene" of human nature—for the gene itself arises from the same mechanism, and this is the essence of all things—but is the necessary outcome of the incentive machinery embedded in the old paradigm. When institutions reward exclusionary possession rather than collaborative creation, every person is compelled to become the potential enemy of every other. Trust becomes a luxury; cooperation degenerates into a mere expedient.

A soul alienated by the logic of capital, even when walking down the most crowded avenue, sees not companions in a shared life but a procession of "others" to be guarded against, surpassed, and, if necessary, trampled upon. The street teems with passersby—yet there is no "thou" among them.

Second, alienation from oneself — defining "being" by "having."

To the question "Who am I?" the old paradigm offers a ready-made answer: "I am what I possess." My wealth defines my social standing; my assets define my sense of security; my consumer symbols define my identity. When "having" becomes the sole yardstick of "being," the fear of losing what one has becomes the deepest existential anxiety.

This is why the beneficiaries of the old paradigm do not live lightly. They possess the most, yet fear the most, for their entire sense of "being" is suspended upon

possessions that may depreciate at any moment. They are not living; they are defending. They are not becoming; they are maintaining.

Third, alienation from nature — regarding all things as extractable resources.

Within the cognitive framework of the old self, the forest is a "timber reserve," the river is a "water resource," animals are a "developable species," and the land is a "tradable asset." Nature is not a subject with its own imperative of survival, but a heap of "raw materials" for human extraction, processing, and consumption. This perception arises not from malice, but from a profound blindness—the failure to see that nature is itself a form of capital, that it possesses its own imperative of survival, and that human exploitation of nature will ultimately recoil upon civilization in the form of the "metabolic tax."

Fourth, alienation from meaning — filling the existential void with consumption.

When creation is alienated into "work," when contribution is alienated into "performance," when value is alienated into "price," the authentic meaning of life is exiled. The old self fills this void with consumption—acquiring more commodities, experiencing more entertainment, chasing more stimulation. But these acts merely graze the edges of the void; they never touch it. For the root of the void lies not in "not having enough," but in "not becoming deeply enough." The entire suffering of the old self is condensed in these words: he possesses much, yet lives narrowly; he survives, yet does not become; he defends, yet does not create.

2. The Antithesis: The Rupture with the Old Self — An Ontological "Death"

The negation of the self is by no means a moral self-flagellation, still less a religious confession or penance. It is an ontological "death." This negation occurs at the deepest stratum—not "correcting bad habits," but "changing one's way of living." It is a fundamental switch of modes of existence, not a piecemeal repair at the level of

behavior. If the old self does not die, the new self cannot be born. This death does not take place in a church or a therapist's office; it takes place in the innermost depths of cognition. It demands of us a threefold rupture.

The first rupture: acknowledging the spirit of exploitation that has been internalized within ourselves.

True revolution never begins with the critique of "them"; it begins with the examination of "us." Before the gates of the new world, the most dangerous enemy is not the beneficiary of the old order, but the "old self" within our own hearts that has already internalized the old logic.

We must honestly confront ourselves: Have I ever played the role of the exploiter in certain relationships—if only on a small, everyday scale? Have I, without knowing it, enjoyed the convenience of privilege? Have I at some moment accepted the reasonableness of "the survival of the fittest"? Have I secretly believed that "every man for himself" is the truth, and that altruism is merely refined hypocrisy?

To acknowledge these things is not self-deprecation, but the precondition of self-liberation. A person who dare not look upon his own defilement cannot truly walk toward the light. Hypocritical purity is the beginning of decay; honest defilement is the birthbed of the new.

The second rupture: abandoning the illusory security of the old identity.

The old self is difficult to bid farewell to, not because it is comfortable. It is in fact full of suffering—yet it is familiar. Familiar suffering is more endurable than unfamiliar freedom. This is the deepest control mechanism of the old paradigm: it makes the exploited dependent upon the "certainty" provided by the structure of exploitation, even when that certainty is purchased at the price of self-castration.

For the beneficiaries, renouncing privilege is like renouncing their own skin; for those at the bottom who depend upon being "arranged," renouncing "being arranged" is like discarding a crutch. Yet both must be renounced—not because they are "bad," but

because they are not real. Privilege is a false security, for it rests upon the exploitation of others; being arranged is a false stability, for it rests upon one's own reification.

Renunciation is not loss. To release the grain of sand is to receive the whole sea. But the sea is invisible before the release; it requires a "leap of faith."

The third rupture: completing an irreversible switch of cognitive frameworks.

From "What can I obtain?" to "What can I contribute?" This is not merely a shift in values; it is a thorough replacement of the cognitive vessel itself.

In the old framework, "contribution" is regarded as a "giving," a price to be paid for "receiving." But in the new framework, "contribution" is itself "receiving." Not receiving in the sense of exchange, but fulfilment in the sense of being. When a person is truly creating, he has already become more fully himself within that creation. "Contribution" is not the bridge to being; it is being itself.

This switch is "irreversible" because once you have experienced the existential state of "creating for contribution's sake," you can no longer of your own accord return to the cage of "surviving for possession." Not because you have become "noble," but because you have seen a greater possibility. The one who has seen the ocean can no longer be content with a puddle—even if the puddle was once his entire world.

3. The Synthesis: The New Self — "We" as the Existential Mode of Contributionism

Having undergone this ontological death and rebirth, we arrive at an entirely new state of existence.

The new self is not an "improved edition" of the old self—not an old self that has become kinder, more generous, more altruistic. The new self is a qualitative transformation of the old self. As water at 100°C becomes steam—the chemical composition remains unchanged, still H₂O, but the mode of being is altogether different.

The core features of the new self may likewise be summarized as four existential modalities.

First, symbiosis with others — perceiving every other as a potential companion.

Within the perceptual framework of the new self, the existence of the other is first perceived as that of a "collaborator." Resources are no longer finite, for creation is unbounded; opportunities are no longer scarce, for the dimensions of contribution are limitless. When "making the cake" rather than "dividing the cake" becomes the leitmotif of society, the other is no longer a competitor to be guarded against, but a companion with whom one can make the cake grow larger.

This is not naive optimism, but a rational judgment grounded in the underlying logic of the new paradigm. Within the framework of Contributionism, your gain does not constitute my loss. On the contrary, your gain increases the total capital of the system, and my contribution-value appreciates with it. This is neither the "you lose, I win" of a zero-sum game, nor the "you win, I win too" of a positive-sum game. It is the condition of the Resonance Field: "you augment, I augment, the system augments, and all things augment."

Second, reconciliation with oneself — defining "being" by "becoming."

To the question "Who am I?" the framework of the new self offers a wholly new answer: "I am what I contribute; I become what I create."

"Having" no longer defines "being," for having is static, exhaustible, and demands defense; whereas "becoming" is dynamic, growing, and forever open to the future. The new self no longer fears loss, for the basic livelihood guarantee has already underwritten existence—and that guarantee is itself the point of departure from which we choose to become. The new self no longer suffers the anxiety of comparison, for the only benchmark of contribution-value is "the self of yesterday." The new self no longer drifts in emptiness and unease, for every act of creation is itself a generation of meaning.

Yet the "becoming" of the new self is not an airy castle of consciousness. It demands the simultaneous movement of "practice"—the advance of science and technology liberating the body's cells from the frequency of exploitation, the unfolding of social practice turning networks of relation from competition toward symbiosis. Knowing and doing, consciousness and matter, must be attuned together. Resonance is not thought into being; it is made. The new self is not "understood" into being; it is "lived" into being.

Third, resonance with nature — perceiving all things as symbiotic partners.

Within the cognitive framework of the new self, the forest is a "carbon-sink companion," the river is a "cycle companion," animals are "evolutionary companions," and the land is a "foundation of survival." Nature is no longer an object to be conquered, but a subject to be collaborated with.

This transformation is not a romanticist return to nature, but a deep comprehension grounded in the theory of all-things-as-capital: nature is also capital, also possesses its own imperative of survival, and also participates in its own way in the network of interactions among all things. The survival of humanity depends upon the survival of nature; the flourishing of humanity depends upon the flourishing of nature. This is not "environmentalism"; it is resonance.

Fourth, unity with meaning — taking creation as the authentic state of being.

When survival no longer requires "selling oneself" as its price, when security no longer requires "possession" as its guarantee, life naturally inclines toward creation—for creation is the most authentic expression of life. A flower does not "work"; it blooms. A river does not "labor"; it flows. A free person does not "toil for a living"; he creates. Creation is not an occupation; it is a mode of being.

4. The Social Realization of the New Self: From Individual Awakening to Collective Existence

One might object: the spiritual revolution of the individual is a private event that cannot be compelled—how can it become a reliable foundation for social transformation? If only a minority have completed the "negation of the negation of themselves," while the majority remain in the state of the old self, how is a Contributionist society possible?

This objection touches upon a crucial point: the new self is not an institutional precondition that can be activated only "after everyone has completed self-transformation," but an existential state spontaneously generated in the very operation of the new institutions.

Just as a person cannot become healthy by "first becoming healthy and then beginning to exercise"—he becomes healthy through exercise itself—a society cannot achieve transformation by "first turning everyone into new selves and then building new institutions." The new self is the process of institutional practice, not its antecedent condition.

The significance of the "Sparks Plan" lies precisely here. In the early phase of transition, only a small vanguard of pioneers who have completed the "self-negation" is required—they operate the embryo of the new institution from the existential state of the new self. When this embryo functions successfully and begins to emit a "paradigmatic attraction" that the old paradigm cannot provide, more and more old selves will discover that, within the new institution, "becoming the new self" is not merely "more moral" but also "more advantageous."

This is not coerced change under moral pressure, but conscious choice under rational calculation. When an old self sees with his own eyes that, within the new institution, those who choose contribution live more fully, are more respected, and are freer than those who cling to the old logic, he faces an unavoidable choice: keep the grain of sand, or walk toward the sea.

The new self is not "educated" into existence; it is "attracted" into existence. The mission of institutions is not to wait for new selves to appear, but to make becoming a

new self the most rational choice. When institutional design renders "contribution" more aligned with the long-term interest of every individual than "possession," the new self ceases to be the monopoly of a few pioneers and becomes the optimal solution that an ever-increasing number of people "compute."

Such is the deep dynamics of "a single spark starting a prairie fire": not forcing everyone to burn with torches, but letting the light of those who already burn illuminate a path for those in darkness. The function of this light is to show, not to persuade; to attract, not to coerce.

Yet how is the mechanism of "attraction" to be set in motion at the individual level? Who is to be the "first to burn"? These questions concerning the point of departure of revolution lie beyond the scope of this section's discussion of "institutions attracting individuals"—they will receive a complete answer in Section Seven, "The Unity of Double Negation."

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The negation of the negation of the self aims not at producing a cadre of "moral exemplars," but at giving birth to a wholly new mode of existence. The new self is not a "better person" but a "different person." His driving force is no longer "possession" but "creation"; his security no longer comes from "defense" but from "resonance"; his meaning no longer needs to be "purchased," but is self-generated by every act of creation.

When enough people have undergone this ontological death and rebirth, the institutions of a Contributionist society will no longer be an externally imposed yoke, but an internally generated expression—institutions are the summed projection of the existential states of countless new selves.

Thus we have completed the first path—the negation of the negation of "ourselves." The death of the old self and the birth of the new self have brought the dialectic of the subject's revolution to a close. Now we must turn to the second path—the negation of

the negation of "capital."

Section Six: The Negation of the Negation of "Capital" — The Ontological Completion of the Object

In the preceding section, we consummated the negation of the negation of ourselves: the old self perishes, the new self is born. Yet this subjective path constitutes merely one face of the coin; the obverse is the revolution of the object. The very category of capital must itself traverse the dialectical movement of thesis, antithesis, and synthesis. This section shall argue that narrow capital (monetary self-augmentation), passing through the critique of capital (Marx augmented by the threefold interrogation of our age), arrives at all-things-as-capital (capital as relation, relation as all things)—a complete itinerary of the negation of the negation. When this objective path converges with the subjective path traced in the preceding section, the work as a whole will have veritably effected the philosophical passage from interpreting the world to changing it.

1. The Thesis: Narrow Capital — The Historical Form of "Monetary Self-Augmentation"

Capital first stepped upon the stage of history in a narrow guise.

Under the prolonged pressure of the Western linguistic tradition, the term "capital" underwent a semantic contraction—from the concrete to the abstract, from the capacious to the circumscribed. From its Latin root signifying "head" or "cattle," to the financial sense of "principal yielding interest" in the mercantile city-states of medieval Italy, to Adam Smith's formulation of it as that portion of wealth employed in reproduction, and ultimately to Marx's disclosure of it as a determinate social relation of production—the terminal point of this semantic evolution is a severely condensed and narrow definition: capital is monetary value capable of self-augmentation.

This definition has three core features.

First, quantifiability. Capital must be denominated in monetary units. Whatever cannot be priced—health, affection, ecology, trust—is refused recognition as capital within the narrow framework; at best, such phenomena are relegated to the status of "externalities" or "non-economic factors."

Second, exclusionary possession. The imperative of self-augmentation presupposes a competitive architecture of "your gain is my loss." The selfsame capital cannot be held by two persons simultaneously; the contest over capital is therefore a zero-sum game.

Third, self-augmentation as the sole finality. The sole imperative of capital is $G \rightarrow G'$ —money engendering money. This imperative acknowledges no parameters of the physical world, no ethical constraints, no terminus of sufficiency. It is a purely mathematical decree: expand without limit, never desist.

This definition proved extraordinarily serviceable during the epoch of highly developed commodity exchange. It seized with precision the dominant guise of capital under the capitalist mode of production and furnished an operational framework for economic analysis since the Industrial Revolution. It was under the aegis of this narrow definition that humanity conjured forth unprecedented material wealth and crossed the threshold from agrarian to industrial civilization.

But precision is not completeness, nor is efficacy truth. Narrow capital is but a first abstraction of the category: it apprehended the principal manifestation of capital at a particular historical juncture, yet forfeited the more fundamental ontological content of the concept. Just as Newtonian mechanics holds precisely under macroscopic, low-velocity conditions, only to be disclosed by relativity as an approximation within a wider frame, so narrow capital holds precisely under the conditions of commodity exchange, only to be revealed, encompassed, and ultimately transcended by a more capacious framework.

2. The Antithesis: The Critique of Capital — Marx's Insight and the Interrogation of the Age

The self-negation of capital commenced at the very zenith of its power.

The first negation: Marx reveals that capital is not a thing.

Marx's genius consisted in piercing the fog of commodity fetishism to reveal that capital is not machinery, not factory buildings, not money itself, but a social relation. The domination of the worker by the capitalist is not the dominion of a thing, but the institutionalized expression of an unequal relation of power among human beings. This insight demolished the fetishism of classical political economy, which had reified capital, and established the epistemological groundwork for the critique of capital.

Yet the nineteenth century that formed Marx imposed its own historical limits. What he denominated "social relations" were chiefly the relations of production internal to human society—between capitalist and laborer, landlord and tenant, creditor and debtor. The relation of humanity to nature, the relation of humanity to itself, and the relation of nature to nature were all treated within his analytical framework as the "natural conditions of production," not as intrinsic constituents of the capital relation.

This was no oversight on Marx's part, but the constraint of historical circumstance. In the nineteenth century, industrial civilization had but commenced its campaign of conquest over nature; ecological crisis had not yet manifested as a planetary threat to survival. In the twenty-first century, however, as climate collapse, biodiversity collapse, and resource exhaustion converge upon their respective tipping points, a critical framework confined to "human society" exposes its insufficiency of scale.

The second negation: the threefold interrogation of the age.

Since the latter half of the twentieth century, a threefold crisis of capital has erupted simultaneously, constituting the age's negation of the narrow-capital paradigm:

The ecological interrogation: the logic of capital's infinite self-augmentation collides

headlong with the finitude of planetary natural capital. Global warming, ocean acidification, the sixth mass extinction—these are not "environmental problems," but the wounds inflicted by a frontal collision between the mathematical imperative of narrow capital and physical reality. Each increment of GDP draws down the principal of natural capital; each "economic recovery" hastens the unraveling of ecosystems.

The social interrogation: a rate of return on capital that persistently outstrips the rate of economic growth ($r > g$) drives an inexorable concentration of wealth toward the apex. Society is no longer a community of fate; it has fissured into a rentier class and a marginalized mass. Trust capital, collaborative capital, and cohesive capital are being steadily depleted, while the social fabric degenerates from organic solidarity into mechanical agglomeration.

The spiritual interrogation: when all value is reduced to price, when the entire meaning of the human person is collapsed into the "rate of return on human capital," when creation is degraded to "innovation output," education to "skill investment," and art to "cultural output value," the authentic dimension of existence is systematically banished. The pervasive anxiety, depression, and nihilism are not individual psychological disorders, but collective symptoms of a "meaning vacuum" induced by the narrow-capital paradigm.

Together, these threefold interrogations converge upon a single conclusion: the thesis of narrow capital—that mighty paradigm which once liberated the productive forces—has turned into its own opposite. It no longer liberates but constrains; no longer creates but dissipates; no longer augments but devours itself. The self-negation of capital has already descended from theoretical prediction into an actual forced landing.

3. The Synthesis: All-Things-as-Capital — A Return with Difference

The negation of capital does not aim at the abolition of capital. Dialectical negation is

never a simple abandonment, but a sublation: at once overcoming and preserving, at once negating and elevating.

The theory of all-things-as-capital is precisely this sublation, and hence the completion, of narrow capital.

What does it preserve? It preserves Marx's cardinal insight that capital is a relation. Capital is not a thing, not a substance, not an object of possession. It is always a relational existence; Marx, however, confined it to human social relations, whereas the theory of all-things-as-capital extends it to the relational network of all things.

What does it overcome? It overcomes the three dogmas of narrow capital: the dogma of quantifiability (capital must be measurable in money), the dogma of exclusivity (capital must be possessed to the exclusion of others), and the dogma of compulsory augmentation (capital must augment itself). Within the framework of all-things-as-capital, health is capital yet cannot be quantified or exchanged; ecology is capital yet cannot be exclusively possessed; affection is capital, yet its "augmentation" is not profit but the deepening of relation.

To what does it elevate? It elevates to the ontological altitude of "to exist is to have capital." The first principle of all-things-as-capital: every being is the sum of its internal and external relations, and the state of power that any system evinces within its relational network is precisely its capital state. To exist is to possess capital; capital is power—this is not metaphor, but a faithful description of a mode of being.

Thus the dialectical movement of capital attains its synthesis: narrow capital (as monetary self-augmentation) → the critique of capital (Marx plus the threefold interrogation of the age) → all-things-as-capital (as the relational power-state of all things).

This is a quintessential movement of the negation of the negation:

The first negation (thesis → antithesis): Marx critiqued narrow capital, revealing that it is not a thing but a relation. This negation is external—it stands outside capital and

strips away its illusory surface.

The second negation (antithesis → synthesis): the theory of all-things-as-capital extends the proposition "capital = relation" from human society to the cosmos entire. This negation is an internal completion—it does not criticize capital from without, but liberates the concept's authentic content from its narrow prison, restoring it to its broad and originary meaning.

This is a return with difference: the theory of all-things-as-capital returns to the broad, original sense of the word "capital" as it circulates in everyday Chinese—"all strength and resource upon which survival and development depend." Yet this return is no mere archaism; it is a reappropriation of the category at a higher altitude, undertaken after passing through the profound critique of Marxism and the remorseless interrogation of the age. We have not returned to the point of departure; rather, having traversed a full circle, we have taken our stand precisely above it.

4. The Repositioning of Narrow Capital within the Framework of All-Things-as-Capital

The theory of all-things-as-capital does not seek to abolish the concept of narrow capital, but to reposition it.

Within the radically expansive framework of all-things-as-capital, Western narrow capital—money, machinery, quantifiable financial assets—is disclosed as three things:

First, it is a subset of all-things-as-capital. Just as the cat is a subset of the animal kingdom, monetary capital is a subset of all-things-as-capital. It is valid under determinate conditions, but must never be mistaken for the whole.

Second, it is a specific form of broad capital arising under determinate historical conditions. A society of highly developed commodity exchange requires a highly abstract, highly liquid form of capital to serve as measure of value and medium of exchange. Monetary capital is precisely the offspring of this historical necessity. It

was rational during the epoch of industrial civilization, but it is not eternal.

Third, it is the subset of broad capital that bears the highest risk and the heaviest metabolic tax. The logic of monetary self-augmentation naturally impels it to detach from substance, from ecology, from meaning, and to spiral into a self-referential void. This is precisely the intrinsic cause of the systemic deadlock of the financial-capital paradigm.

Therefore, the attitude of all-things-as-capital toward narrow capital is not opposition, but completion. It completes the work Marx left unfinished, carrying the proposition that capital is a relation to its logical terminus. It completes the work of the everyday Chinese usage of "capital"—that which was grasped by intuition but never systematically articulated—refining the popular wisdom enshrined in phrases such as "the body is the capital of revolution" and "ecology is green capital" into theoretical form. And it completes the exigency of an age defined by ecological and spiritual crisis, incorporating the relation of humanity to nature and the relation of humanity to itself within the framework of capital analysis.

Narrow capital was once efficacious. But it must be transcended. The theory of all-things-as-capital is precisely the philosophical articulation of that transcendence.

It must be noted that a difference in perspective obtains between the repositioning of narrow capital undertaken here and the threefold breakthrough of Contributionism delineated in Section Four of Part II.

Section Four responded to the question: relative to Marxism, what does Contributionism break through? That was an intellectual-historical positioning.

The present section responds to the question: within its own dialectical movement, what completion does narrow capital undergo? This is an ontological consummation.

The former adopts an external perspective: Contributionism stands on the shoulders of Marx and discerns a wider horizon. The latter adopts an internal perspective: the category of capital itself traverses the movement of thesis, antithesis, and synthesis,

ultimately returning to its authentic meaning.

The two are not redundant; they are the inner and outer faces of one and the same dialectical movement. Section Four exhibited the result of the movement—what Contributionism possesses beyond Marxism; this section exhibits the process of the movement—how capital attains all-things-as-capital through self-negation.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The negation of the negation of capital terminates not in the abolition of capital, but in its completion: the liberation of capital from its narrow prison, and its restoration to the authentic meaning of the relational power-state of all things.

When capital is apprehended as the interactive network of all-things-as-capital rather than the self-augmentation of money, all the contradictions of the old paradigm acquire the logical precondition for their fundamental resolution. Ecological crisis is no longer an externality, but the clinical sign of natural capital being exploited; spiritual crisis is no longer a psychological problem, but the symptom of mental capital being alienated; social rupture is no longer a failure of governance, but the consequence of social capital being dissipated.

Thus we have completed the second path—the negation of the negation of capital. Narrow capital, the critique of capital, all-things-as-capital: this dialectical movement has exhausted its moments. Both paths now stand complete; they must converge. That convergence is the task of the next section.

Section Seven: The Unity of Double Negation — The Philosophical Completion from Interpreting the World to Changing the World

The two preceding sections have each brought one trajectory of the negation of the negation to completion: Section Five consummated the negation of the negation of ourselves—from old self to new self—and Section Six consummated the negation of the negation of capital—from narrow capital to all-things-as-capital. Yet should the two trajectories remain but parallel and unmerged, the movement of dialectics would still be left unfinished. They must converge, thereby to span the chasm that leads from the interpretation of the world to its transformation.

This section contends that the two pathways are mutually presuppositional, attaining their unity within the law of contribution causality. When the new self encounters all-things-as-capital, when the revolution of the subject and the revolution of the object are effected in the same instant, the abyss separating the interpretation of the world from its transformation is crossed. This constitutes the work's final philosophical consummation as it passes from critique to construction.

1. The Logical Relationship of the Two Paths: A Double Helix of Mutual Presupposition

Let us set these two trajectories alongside each other. They are not parallel rails but a double helix, intertwined and mutually sustaining.

The path of capital—the objective dimension—moves from narrow capital, through the critique of capital, to all-things-as-capital. This path answers the question: What is the world?

The path of ourselves—the subjective dimension—moves from the old self, through the rupture with the old self, to the new self. This path answers the question: How

shall we live?

The relationship between the two is one of mutual presupposition.

In the absence of the new self, all-things-as-capital degenerates into a magnified replica of old capital. An old self still rooted in the mode of possession, when confronted with all-things-as-capital, will inevitably interpret it as all-things-to-be-possessed. The all-things he beholds remain a reservoir of resources, a mere projection of the old world.

Without all-things-as-capital, the new self's contribution would lack an ontological anchor. If the world is but a heap of passive matter, then contribution degenerates into doing good deeds—a moral choice rather than a mode of being. Only when the world itself is a network of relations does contribution become an act isomorphic with existence itself.

Only when both are co-present is the logic of possession-exploitation doubly sublated. The subject is no longer a possessor, the object no longer a possessed thing. Their encounter is itself the end of the old world.

2. The Point of Convergence: Unity in the New Causal Law of "Contribution"

The point of convergence of the two paths is precisely the core proposition of this work: the law of contribution causality.

The old world operates according to a law of capital causality: whoever possesses greater capital—wealth, power, resources—commands greater domination; and this domination in turn permits the accumulation of still greater capital. It forms a closed positive feedback loop: possession to power to ever more possession. Within this circuit, contribution functions at most as an instrument of acquisition, never as an end.

The new world operates according to a law of contribution causality: whoever creates greater value—an augmentation of civilization's total capital—receives greater

recognition and greater resources; and these resources in turn enable the creation of still greater contributions. It forms an open positive feedback loop: creation to contribution to ever more creation. Within this circuit, possession is but a means to creation, never an end.

The fundamental distinction resides in this: the former is a logic of exclusion grounded in stock—what one possesses; the latter is a logic of symbiosis grounded in flow—what one can create.

When the new self enters into resonance with all-things-as-capital, the law of contribution causality achieves its dialectical unity along two dimensions at once.

On the subjective dimension: the new self no longer defines itself by how much it possesses, but by what it has created. Its sense of existence no longer depends upon the defense of stock; it is generated in the creation of increment. Every act of contribution is an act of becoming—in creating, it becomes more fully itself.

On the objective dimension: all-things-as-capital is no longer a reservoir of resources to be possessed, but a network of relations with which one must resonate. The new self's contribution is an optimization of this network—restoring ecology, disseminating knowledge, deepening trust, creating beauty. And the optimization of the network in turn enhances the conditions under which the new self exists. This is not the one-way movement of "I contribute, therefore you benefit," but the circular resonance of "I contribute, the network is optimized, and the conditions of my own existence improve as well."

Therefore, the law of contribution causality is not a substitute for the law of capital causality, but its completion. Capital causality answered the question "How does the world operate?" yet saw only the surface of operation—possession-driven. Contribution causality answers the question "Why, and for what end, does the world operate?" revealing the deep purpose of operation—creation and symbiosis. The former is the appearance of the latter; the latter is the essence of the former.

3. Theoretical Significance: The Philosophical Transition from Interpreting the World to Changing the World

At this point, the work as a whole completes the philosophical transition from interpreting the world to changing it. This transition has been rendered possible because we have effected two achievements at once.

First, we have obtained a new ontology for interpreting the world: all-things-as-capital. The arguments of Part One have already demonstrated that the essence of the world is not an aggregate of isolated substances, but an interactive network of capital-relations. This ontological framework can explain everything from quantum entanglement to the rise and fall of civilizations. The world is no longer an object to be conquered, but a partner to be understood and resonated with.

Second, we have obtained an agential subject capable of changing the world: the new self. The arguments of Section Five have already shown that the old self, locked by the old paradigm into the existential state of possession-defense, cannot become a genuine historical subject; whereas the new self, by undergoing the ontological death and rebirth of the self, attains a new subjectivity whose mode of being is creation-contribution. History is no longer the passive unfolding of an impersonal force; it becomes the realization of a conscious choice.

When the subject of interpretation—the new self—and the framework of interpretation—all-things-as-capital—are unified within the law of contribution causality, the transformation of the world is no longer an external task, but the natural unfolding of the new self's mode of being. The new self need not be required to change the world, for changing the world—optimizing the interactive network of all-things-as-capital—is precisely the way the new self becomes itself. Just as a tree need not be required to grow; growth is the way it becomes a tree.

Such is the philosophical bridge of this work from theoretical critique to institutional construction. The institutional design of Part Three is no longer an externally imposed

blueprint, but the institutional translation of the new self's mode of existence—the social form necessarily demanded by the new self's natural self-unfolding under the law of contribution causality.

4. Practical Significance: Who Shall Accomplish This Revolution?

Finally, we must candidly confront a pointed question: if the transformation from old self to new self is so radical, who, in actuality, is to accomplish this revolution?

The answer is that no one arrives as an already completed new self; everyone is a new self in the process of becoming.

The self's negation of the negation is not a single event but a continuing process. No one can perfectly become the new self prior to entering the new institution, just as no one can perfectly become a swimmer before immersion. Becoming occurs in the midst of doing, not prior to it.

Herein lies the precise significance of the Sparks Plan: it does not demand a vanguard of already sanctified pioneers to set it in motion. It requires only a group of people who are willing to acknowledge that they remain the old self, willing to acknowledge that they have internalized the exploitative logic of the old paradigm, willing to acknowledge that they are not perfect. And yet, even so, they choose to begin: to begin measuring value by the yardstick of contribution, to begin experimenting with new modes of interaction in local practice, to begin taking the first step upon the path of not exploiting.

It is precisely this beginning—imperfect, clumsy, hesitant though it may be—that constitutes the first negation of the old self. Institutions are not a blueprint antecedent to practice; they are the recognition and amplification of the faint signal emitted by such beginnings. All the institutional designs of Part Three are the complete translation of this amplificatory mechanism: public ownership becomes the soil in

which exploitation is abolished; the global task system serves as the mobilizing instrument of the construction period—once the edifice is complete, external directives fall away, and the conscious creation of each person converges naturally into the comprehensive development of civilization; free competition at the individual level grants every person the opportunity to prove themselves; the free market renders life abundant and creation free. And the Contribution Value System ensures that every beginning can be seen, measured, and reciprocated. Institutions do not engender beginnings, but they can prevent them from being extinguished.

Yet a deeper question persists: whence arise the first forerunners? When the old paradigm holds sway over all, why would anyone choose to begin?

The answer resides not in theory but in suffering. The first forerunners are not persuaded by theory; they are born of the suffocation of the old world. Those who find no place to stand, who cannot breathe, who cannot name their own condition in the old tongue—when a new theory grants them a language for their plight, they are transmuted from silent sufferers into conscious seekers. They need no perfection; they need only beginning—beginning to measure value by the yardstick of contribution, beginning to take the first step upon the path of not exploiting.

The Sparks Plan exists precisely to offer these beginnings a tangible space in which they can take root, be tested, and draw others onward. It does not wait until all are ready and then commence; it renders more people ready through the very act of commencement. The forerunners are not finished persons; they are simply those willing to begin. And the beginning itself is that instant in which the old self is first negated.

We do not wait until all have become new selves before building the new world; rather, through the very building, more and more persons become new selves. This is the ultimate practical lesson left to us by the unity of double negation: the terminus of revolution is not the completion of institutions, but the continuous regeneration of the new self within them.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The two trajectories of double negation here consummate their dialectical unity.

The path of capital has answered the question, What is the world? It is a resonant network of interactions among all things as capital. The path of ourselves has answered the question, How shall we live? By embracing creative contribution as the authentic mode of being. When the new self meets all-things-as-capital, when the law of contribution causality becomes the shared grammar of being and world, the abyss between interpretation and transformation is bridged.

The name of this bridge is practice.

It is not an adjunct to theory, but the completion of theory. As Marx declared: "The philosophers have only interpreted the world in various ways; the point, however, is to change it." Now, after the full argument from Part One to Part Two, we understand with clarity: the transformation of the world is possible not because the world may be reformed—it is transforming itself at every instant—but because we, as new selves who have traversed the negation of the negation, can consciously, alongside all things, redirect the course of change from the blind drift of entropy toward the consciousness of resonance.

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

From the disenchantment of the isms' illusion, through the disclosure of the old paradigm's deadlock, to the foundation-laying of the new Contributionist paradigm—we have completed a full theoretical itinerary. And now, at the journey's end, we have set in place the final cornerstone: the dialectical unity of double negation.

We have argued that without the self's negation of the negation, the negation of the negation of capital would lack a subject; and without capital's negation of the negation, the negation of the negation of the self would lack an object. Only when the old self

dies and the new self is born, and when narrow capital is at once completed and all-things-as-capital established, does civilization truly secure the ontological precondition for its leap from the old paradigm into the Contribution Epoch.

This is the final consummation of the work as it passes from critique to construction. The institutional design of Part Three is no longer a hypothesis awaiting verification; it is the necessary unfolding of this conscious practice at the institutional level. The end of the old world comes not because it has been overthrown, but because the paradigmatic attraction of the new world has led the old world to compute for itself: it is time to end.

Civilization's way out lies not in selecting a more comfortable posture within the cage of capital, but in boldly stepping beyond it—beyond the cage of the old self and the cage of old capital—to build a new heaven and a new earth founded upon contribution. Contributionism is not another utopia; it is a practicable path forward, forged from a deep insight into the laws of history, a clear-eyed assessment of technological possibility, and a conscious revolution in our mode of being.

Now, we shall translate this theoretical blueprint into a tangible, perceptible path of practice.

Part Three: The Architecture of a New
Civilization — Contribution Value, Governance,
and the Cognitive Engine

Introduction to This Part

This part endeavors to systematically articulate the core operational architecture of a nascent civilizational paradigm. Whereas the preceding two parts effected the deconstruction of the old world, the present part is consecrated to its comprehensive reconstruction. What we erect is no castle in the air, but a complete system of civilization founded upon contribution value as its economic basis, unit-based governance as its political operating system, and the cognitive engine as its evolutionary driving force.

As you peruse the institutional designs elaborated in the chapters that follow, bear this firmly in mind: these institutions are not invented *ex nihilo*; they are the translation and amplification of living practices already germinating among those who, without demanding reasons, have chosen to abandon exploitation. Long before institutions are inscribed upon paper, they have already taken root in human life.

Chapter One: The Contribution Value System — The Economic Foundation of a New Civilization

Introduction to This Chapter

The inaugural chapter of this part is devoted to the value circulation system of the new civilization—the Contribution Value System. It addresses a fundamental question: once the logic of taxation-capital is abandoned, how shall society measure value, distribute resources, and stimulate creation? The Contribution Value System is not a mere technical instrument for replacing money; it is an integral synthesis of philosophy, institutions, and technology. Grounded in the ontology of all-things-as-capital, upheld by three technological pillars—automation, blockchain, and artificial intelligence—and operationalized through a two-stage quantification model of effort and outcome, this system ensures that the measurement of value returns to the objective coordinates of civilizational advancement. Ultimately, it attains concrete realization within the fundamental social unit, the cell, thereby endowing the new civilization with both the highest internal equity and the utmost resilience against external shocks.

Section One: Basic Livelihood Guarantee — The Ballast of the Contribution Value System and the Wellspring of Creativity

The effective functioning and moral legitimacy of the Contribution Value System presuppose, as an indispensable condition, an unconditional system of basic livelihood guarantee. This system constitutes the ethical cornerstone and existential fundament of the new civilization.

1. Foundational Status: Why Guarantee Is the Precondition of Contribution

A civilization whose center is contribution must adopt, as its primary ethical premise, the decoupling of survival from contribution.

The ultimate liberation of the individual: only when the individual is no longer impelled by the exigencies of sheer subsistence can his creation become free, and can contribution arise from intrinsic interest and civic responsibility rather than external compulsion. Here is achieved the philosophical ascent from labor for survival to creation as contribution.

The abolition of systemic exploitation: within the old paradigm, the pressure of subsistence served as the most potent weapon of capital's exploitation. The basic guarantee disarms this weapon, rendering the discipline of hunger inoperative and uprooting at its very source the systemic coercion to accept exploitation.

Therefore, the guarantee is not welfare but an inborn, unconditional, fundamental right of every member of civilization—the bedrock of the social contract and the precondition of any creative society whatsoever.

2. Concrete Composition: The Unconditional Coverage of Six Fundamental Rights

The basic livelihood guarantee constitutes a comprehensive system that secures the dignified existence of every member. At its core lie six inalienable rights:

- Sustenance: a sufficient, safe, and nutritionally balanced provision of basic food.
- Shelter: a secure, salubrious, and adequate living space.
- Healthcare: comprehensive, high-quality basic medical care and public health services.
- Education: universal access to public education from early enlightenment through advanced learning.
- Clothing: garments adequate to the necessities of daily life and seasonal change.
- Mobility: convenient, efficient, and affordable public transportation.

Together, these six guarantees form the solid ground that shields human dignity and creativity—the concrete embodiment of the Iron Law of Fundamental Rights.

3. The Dialectical Unity of Guarantee and Creation: From "Negative Incentive" to "Positive Incentive"

The objection that a guarantee fosters indolence is a vestige of the scarcity economics of the old paradigm. Within the new paradigm, the basic guarantee and contribution-value incentives constitute a dialectical unity:

The guarantee is the safety net of creation. It abolishes the fear of existential failure, permitting individuals to undertake momentous and protracted explorations—fundamental science, avant-garde art, monumental engineering. Through this institution, society pays the insurance premium for civilization's collective venture investment.

Contribution is the compass of creation. Once subsistence needs are satisfied,

higher-order motivations—belonging, dignity, self-actualization—assume command. The Contribution Value System responds to these needs with precision, conferring social recognition, personal honor, and access to richer modes of experience.

The reversal of incentive structures: the engine of the old paradigm is propelled by the negative incentive of work or starve—the logic of punishment. The engine of the new paradigm is driven by the positive incentive of create to attain glory—the logic of reward. The basic guarantee effects this civilizational reversal.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The basic livelihood guarantee does not simply refrain from suppressing creation; it is the fundamental precondition for liberating and igniting social creativity on the grandest scale. It ensures that, aboard the vessel of civilization, every member may gaze heavenward with serenity rather than downward upon the deck with anxiety. It is the ballast that enables the Contribution Value System to operate with efficiency, justice, and vitality, anchoring the new civilization upon the enduring bedrock of creating for contribution's sake rather than upon the shifting sands of laboring for survival.

Section Two: The Contribution Value System — Core and Pillars

This section systematically expounds the philosophical core of the Contribution Value System, the socio-technical architecture that sustains it—the technological triangle—and the fundamental principles that safeguard its purity and vitality. Together, these elements constitute the complete core operating system of the new civilizational paradigm.

1. The Fundamental Philosophy: From "Production for Profit" to "Creation for Contribution"

Under the old paradigm, profit was enthroned as the sovereign arbiter of economic activity, begetting the alienation of value, the fragility of systems, and the instrumentalization of the human person. The Contribution Value System seeks to accomplish a fundamental philosophical reversal:

The reorientation of the prime mover. It fundamentally replaces the engine of socio-economic activity—from the ceaseless accumulation of private capital profit to the pursuit of contribution recognized by society.

The redefinition of value. Value is no longer determined by market fluctuations and the caprice of capital; it is re-embedded within the social whole, anchored in its substantive and measurable role in advancing the survival and development of human civilization.

The emancipation of the human being. This endeavor liberates the person from the alienated condition of serving as an instrument of capital augmentation, permitting all labor and creation to return to their essence: free creation undertaken to satisfy human needs, to resolve existential predicaments, and to expand the frontiers of civilization.

2. The Technological Triangle: A Socio-Technical System That

Enables the New Paradigm

The Contribution Value System is no castle in the air; its practical feasibility rests upon a robust technological triangle. This architecture is not a mere juxtaposition of three technologies, but an organic whole of mutual reinforcement and deep integration, providing solid support for the large-scale and credible operation of the Sparks Model.

The Composition and Synergy of the Technological Triangle

The AI assessment layer—the system's brain. It assumes the functions of appraising and optimizing civilizational development. Endowed with formidable capacities for data processing and pattern recognition, AI assists specialized communities in rendering contribution assessments that are as objective and quantitative as possible across all domains, while also performing trend prediction and risk identification. It processes vast data streams, executes complex quantification models of contribution value, simulates the social consequences of alternative policies, and conducts long-range forecasting—thereby furnishing the decision-support upon which precise governance depends. Simultaneously, it stands as a neutral supervisor, ensuring that the operation of the entire Contribution Value System conforms to its governing principles. Its very existence embodies the advanced form of automation: the automation of intelligent decision-making.

The blockchain trust layer—the system's spine. It assumes the functions of trust and record-keeping for civilizational operation. As a distributed, immutable, and fully traceable public ledger, it governs the issuance, recording, and settlement of contribution value. It supplants the uncertainty of human nature and the arbitrariness of power with the certainty of mathematics and code, and—through an inverted yet transparent algorithmic discipline—technologically abolishes every possibility of fraud and corruption, safeguarding the absolute fairness and transparency of the Contribution Value System. By maintaining a transparent, immutable, and traceable ledger of contribution records and distribution, and by executing established rules

automatically and impartially through smart contracts, it lays the technical cornerstone of the entire system's credibility.

The digital terminal application layer—the system's limbs. It furnishes every citizen with a unified digital identity and a singular interface of interaction. This is the stratum through which the Contribution Value System directly engages every member of society. It integrates government affairs, daily life, consumption, learning, and collaboration into a seamless whole, constituting an operational interface within everyone's reach under the new civilizational paradigm. It actualizes the automation of service delivery and information exchange, ensuring the system's accessibility and ease of use.

Automation: The "Soul" Traversing the Technological Triangle and the Civilizational Lever

Automation—the soul that animates the entire technological triangle. It is not merely an instrument of efficiency, but a civilizational lever that liberates humanity from repetitive toil, enabling the species to devote itself to more creative modes of contribution.

Its core function. The comprehensive automation of material production and basic service processes fundamentally dissolves scarcity—the central proposition of traditional economics—and lays a foundation of material abundance for the Contributionism paradigm. It transforms unemployment from a social crisis into a celebration of civilizational liberation, a sign that ever more human beings have been released from survival labor and may dedicate their time and intelligence to domains that better embody contribution value: knowledge creation, artistic exploration, deep collaboration, and spiritual endeavor.

Its relation to contribution value. Automation poses no threat to the Contribution Value System; on the contrary, it is its perfect counterpart. When machines assume repetitive labor, the measurement of value in human activity migrates naturally to dimensions machines cannot easily replicate. Creativity, empathy, complex

problem-solving, aesthetic judgment—these constitute precisely the core that the Contribution Value System seeks to measure and incentivize with precision. Automation ensures that this system may be erected upon a base of vast material abundance, enabling it to concentrate upon the incentivization of those creative activities that truly define the heights of human civilization.

A primitive analogy may illuminate the triangle:

Automation corresponds to the fishing, hunting, gathering, and toil of early society—labor that directly satisfied the community's basic needs of survival and reproduction.

Blockchain corresponds to the small-scale community in which members knew one another intimately, could recall and distinguish each person's contribution, and returned immediate acknowledgment.

Artificial intelligence corresponds to the elder or chieftain who, drawing upon experience and wisdom, rendered judgments and decisions upon diverse affairs, ever mindful of the tribe's collective interest and efficacy.

Technology Is but a Tool, Not the Skeleton

It must be emphasized that the technological triangle—AI, blockchain, and digital terminals—furnishes powerful support for the efficient operation of the Contribution Value System, yet it is not the precondition of the system's existence.

Technology can fail. The network may collapse; AI may err; blockchain nodes may go dark. Were the entire technological apparatus to cease overnight, would the Contributionist civilization collapse with it?

No.

For the autonomy of the cell constitutes the true skeleton of the new civilization; technology is but the flesh and blood that clings to it.

When technology fails on every front, the cell does not disintegrate. It reverts to a

more pristine and more immediate condition: face-to-face relation among human beings.

In that state, whoever toiled in the fields today is beheld by the entire cell; whoever assisted a neighbor requires no blockchain record, for all remember; whoever shrank at the decisive hour requires no AI assessment, for all were present.

Within a cell of dozens or hundreds who know one another intimately, the measurement of contribution needs no algorithm. It rests upon the eyes of acquaintance, shared memory, and face-to-face trust. The earliest collaboration of civilization operated precisely thus. This is not backward; it is foundational. Technology merely amplifies this foundational capacity of collaboration to a global scale.

This is the deeper significance of cellularization: it does not fracture a large system into small systems, but renders each small system a complete system in its own right.

When technology is present, the cell is a node in the global collaborative network. When technology is absent, the cell remains a miniature civilization capable of independent operation.

Herein lies the ultimate insurance of ultimate resilience: broken apart, each cell is self-sufficient; gathered together, all cells resonate as one. Whether technology prevails or fails, civilization will never cease to turn.

3. Core System Principles: The Immune Code of the New System

To ensure that the new system can never degenerate, the following iron laws must be inscribed into its very architecture:

Principle One: The Principle of Quantitative Baseline

The sole source of contribution value is substantive contribution to the development of society and civilization. Assessment shall be conducted jointly by decentralized professional communities, assisted by AI systems, across all domains of material and

spiritual production.

Principle Two: The Principle of Distribution and Circulation

Unlimited issuance. Society issues contribution value in full measure for every confirmed contribution, setting no upper ceiling, so as to encourage boundless innovation.

Capped holding. The amount of contribution value an individual may expend within a single period is limited, forestalling the pathological accumulation of wealth and power.

The path of sublimation. The portion exceeding the cap shall, at a dynamic and elevated ratio (for example, 1:N), be converted into purely honorary Eternal Honor Points, or exchanged for temporary usage rights to premium resources and services—thereby uniting spiritual incentive with the prevention of inflation.

The Iron Law of Fundamental Rights. The quantum of one's contribution value shall never condition the enjoyment of the most basic rights—subsistence, healthcare, education, scientific research, and the like. These rights are guaranteed unconditionally by society and constitute the inviolable baseline of the new civilization.

Principle Three: The Principle of Systemic Purity (The Principle of Non-Capitalization)

Non-tradable. Contribution value is not a commodity; it effects a clean rupture with the old logic of capital.

Non-transferable. Contribution is bound to the individual; honor cannot be bestowed as a gift.

Non-inheritable. This ensures a roughly equal point of departure for every generation, fundamentally suppressing the hereditary transmission and entrenchment of class.

Principle Four: The Principle of Value Anchoring—Consumability

Contribution value may be redeemed against all products and services within society, ensuring that it possesses genuine purchasing power and functions as an effective instrument of incentive and distribution.

Principle Five: The Principle of Public Ownership of the Means of Production and Competition for Operational Rights

To secure the purity of the Contribution Value System and to preclude at the root the exploitation and class division bred by private ownership of the means of production, the new paradigm establishes the social public ownership of the means of production as an inviolable foundational institution.

Core content:

The foundations of public ownership. The essential means of production—land, energy, core infrastructure, automated production lines, and the like—belong to society as a whole, and are managed and allocated by civilizational units on society's behalf. No individual or group may appropriate them as private property or derive contribution value through monopolistic privilege.

Open competition for operational rights. The operational and managerial rights over specific industries and projects are open to all members of society. Any individual or team possessing the requisite capacity and credibility may contend—through proposal submission, public defense, and other means—for the operational rights of a given industry (e.g., catering, education, cultural services) for a fixed term.

Operational mechanism, taking the catering industry as an illustration. When catering services are needed within a cell, the cell publicly solicits an operating individual or team. Teams A, B, and C compete freely, presenting their operational philosophy, menu design (whether economy, convenience, or taste is emphasized), service standards, and the like. A committee of community representatives and professional reviewers, together with AI's analysis of proposal feasibility, awards the optimal team the operational right for a fixed term (say, two years). Within the team there is no boss; each member receives a corresponding fixed amount of contribution value according

to role—chef, service, management—rather than appropriating operational profit. During the operational period, the system conducts dynamic assessments based on consumer satisfaction, resource conservation, health standards, and similar criteria. An excellent assessment brings additional contribution value rewards to all team members; a substandard assessment incurs deduction of contribution value, or even early revocation of the operational right and a fresh round of public competition.

This principle fully realizes the maxim "from each according to ability, distribution according to contribution," shifting the fulcrum of economic activity entirely from the possession of capital to competition in service capacity and creativity.

Principle Six: The Principle of Information Sharing and Anti-Manipulation

This principle operates as an immune mechanism, designed to accelerate civilizational development while preserving the authenticity of contribution assessment and shielding the system from speculative corrosion.

The information-contribution system. Achievements in any domain—whether scientific and technological or concerning everyday goods—must, within a prescribed time and without violating personal privacy, be fully disclosed to society: raw data, work logs, interim reports, final outcomes, and all supporting material. This constructs a global public repository of knowledge, quickens the tempo of civilizational iteration, and anchors evaluation in traceable and verifiable fact.

Transparent process as evidence. The assessment of contribution regards not only results but attends with equal rigor to the process of creation itself. The disclosed working process constitutes a vital basis for judging the value, sincerity, and authenticity of any contribution.

Dynamic anti-manipulation algorithms. The system deploys advanced AI to monitor continuously the flow of contribution data, identifying and penalizing systematic deceptions—score farming, data falsification, academic misconduct. Those who seek to manipulate the system gain no benefit; their squandering of public resources and betrayal of trust are recorded instead as negative contribution.

4. Institutions Make "Rational Self-Interest" Possible

Within the old paradigm, even a person who calculated that contribution is the long-term optimum would find its practice almost impossible. The old institutions reward short-term arbitrage, exclusionary possession, and the exploitation of externalities. In a system that rewards faulty calculation, correct calculation cannot take hold.

The task of the Contribution Value System is precisely to translate genuine rational self-interest from an ideal into institutional fact. When contribution value supplants money as the measure of value; when ecological, intellectual, and social contributions are quantified into personal gain; and when the basic livelihood guarantee dissolves the fear that without exploiting others one cannot survive—at that point the choice of contribution demands no sacrifice. It is the most rational course available.

This is not the remolding of human nature, but the remolding of the calculative environment within which human nature operates.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Through a fundamental philosophical reversal, the Contribution Value System establishes contribution as its sovereign center; through the technological triangle of automation, blockchain, and AI, it acquires the capacity for real-world operation; and through a rigorous set of immune-code principles, it secures the system's fairness, purity, and vitality. Together, these constitute a complete and self-consistent economic operating system, fully capable of displacing the old taxation-capital paradigm.

Section Three: The Quantification of Contribution Value — An Operable Three-Layer Model and Its Three Pillars

The preceding discourse has set forth the historical logic and the macro-vision of Contributionism. Nevertheless, every grand conception must confront a fundamental operational question: how is contribution to be quantified?

Should this question remain unanswered, Contributionism would devolve into an elegant slogan and nothing more.

The present section undertakes to supply a complete, operable scheme for the quantification of contribution value. It rests neither upon abstruse economic models nor upon the presupposition of any singular theory of value. Its design philosophy may be distilled into four epithets: simplicity, transparency, corrigibility. Any person of ordinary intellect may verify the computation of his own contribution value by means of arithmetic alone—addition, subtraction, multiplication, and division. The system's watchword consists of but eight characters: grain as anchor, coefficients adjustable.

1. The Paradigmatic Crisis of Value Measurement: Why a New Measure Is Needed

Before descending into technical details, we must first confront a foundational question: why can we not simply continue to employ money?

Money is an admirable instrument for measuring exchange value, yet it labours under three systemic infirmities.

Its blindness to ecological worth. A tree that has stood for a century is valued, within the monetary order, at the price of its timber. Its long-standing contributions to air, water, and biodiversity pass wholly unacknowledged.

Its myopia toward long-term innovation. A fundamental scientific inquiry may yield enormous value only decades hence; within the monetary order, it cannot obtain fair compensation in the present.

Its distortion of genuine needs. The self-referential circulation of financial capital—stocks, derivatives, and the like—can generate vast monetary value while bearing no relation whatever to the real enhancement of human flourishing.

Money measures the willingness to exchange, not the true worth of contribution.

What contribution value aspires to become is not a new currency, but a meta-measure of value. It directly measures an activity's genuine contribution to the survival and development of civilization, rather than its market price.

2. The Philosophical Foundation of Quantification:

Reinterpreting Value Through the Lens of All-Things-as-Capital

In the preceding chapters, we introduced the theory of all-things-as-capital. In brief, that theory maintains:

The essence of the world is not a static collection of things, but a dynamic network of capitals. Here capital denotes the intrinsic strength and relational attributes upon which any system—from the atom to civilization—depends for the maintenance of its existence and the realization of its evolution.

Within this frame, contribution is defined as follows:

Any act or output that enhances the survival capacity, structural resilience, knowledge accumulation, or future developmental potential of the system in which it is embedded—from the community to civilization—constitutes a contribution.

The coordinate of value is thus re-anchored: no longer fixed upon exchange price, but upon the objective, observable, ultimate end of the survival and development of the civilizational system.

This means that contribution value measures the degree of usefulness to civilization, not how many persons are willing to pay for it.

3. The Three-Layer Quantification Model: Baseline Anchor × Multiplier Matrix × Dynamic Evolution

Upon the foundation of the above philosophy, we propose a three-layer model to resolve the central challenge of quantification: how to measure contributions as disparate as tilling the soil, teaching the young, healing the sick, and composing poetry upon a single scale.

3.1 Layer One: The Baseline Anchor — "Grain as Anchor"

Core idea: select the most fundamental, least contentious commodity—one directly bound to survival—as the "1" of the value scale.

Why grain?

- Necessity of survival: without grain, all civilizational activity is inconceivable.
- Measurability: it can be precisely measured by weight, in kilograms.
- Stability: the basic human demand for grain does not fluctuate violently with fashion or caprice.
- Universality: every human being understands what grain signifies.
- Operational rules:

Here a crucial distinction must be made plain: grain as commodity and the production of grain as labour are two entirely different matters.

Commodity pricing (the absolute anchor): one kilogram of staple grain meeting basic nutritional standards = one contribution value. Once established by social consensus, this number remains wholly stable within the system for the long term. It is the fixed star of the entire edifice of value, analogous to the kilogram prototype in the

International System of Units.

The labour difficulty coefficient (a dynamic parameter): the labour of producing one kilogram of grain possesses its own production difficulty coefficient, initially set at, say, 10. This coefficient may be dynamically adjusted in accordance with technological progress or environmental change, or may be fixed permanently, serving as the base multiplier.

Why must these two be distinguished?

The commodity price (1 kg = 1 contribution value) is the demand-side anchor: it tells you how much contribution value is required to obtain a basic necessity.

The production difficulty coefficient (initially 10) is the supply-side evaluation: it tells you how arduous, how skilled, how exacting the labour itself is.

Only when the two are held apart can the system be at once stable and flexible.

3.2 Layer Two: The Multiplier Matrix — "Coefficients Adjustable"

The baseline anchor resolves the question "What is one kilogram of grain worth?" The multiplier matrix resolves the question of the value ratio of every labour activity relative to the benchmark labour of producing one kilogram of grain.

Operational rules:

Benchmark labour: producing one kilogram of grain is established as the benchmark. Its labour coefficient is initially set at 10, and its relative multiple is 1 (that is, the benchmark itself, serving as the reference point for horizontal comparison). Important note: when entering the Track One formula, it is the labour coefficient (10) that is used, not the relative multiple (1). Grain as a commodity is anchored at 1 kilogram = 1 contribution value; this is an independent parameter from the labour coefficient, and the two are never interchanged.

Setting relative multiples: through democratic consultation and expert assessment, each specific contribution activity is assigned a relative multiple, representing its

comprehensive labour value ratio with respect to producing one kilogram of grain.

Track One: Contribution value = 1 (grain anchor) × labour coefficient × working hours (hours)

Scope:

- Agriculture: transplanting rice, weeding, harvesting, machinery operation.
- Construction: bricklaying, hauling, welding.
- Daily maintenance: cleaning, repairs, community patrol.
- Basic services: teaching, healthcare, community coordination.

Key rules:

- The labour coefficient is determined through democratic consultation within each cell; cells may eventually arrive at a unified coefficient, or, on the basis of a unified coefficient, each cell may adjust appropriately according to its own circumstances, subject to the approval of all cells. It reflects the intensity of the work, its skill requirements, and its environmental risks.
- Working hours are automatically recorded by the system (e.g., check-in, task duration).
- Whether or not the final outcome is achieved (e.g., the weeding is not finished, the house is not completed), the time invested is compensated on an hourly basis.
- Track Two: Contribution value = 1 (grain anchor) × labour coefficient × influence factor
- Definitions of the influence factor:

Culture and the arts: Influence factor = the number of independent persons who have recognized the work (e.g., likes, favorites, favourable reviews). For each act of recognition, the creator immediately receives 0.01 contribution value (coefficient

adjustable). Here 0.01 is the unit recognition score coefficient, and the complete formula should therefore be written as:

Contribution value = 1 (anchor constant) $\times$ labour coefficient $\times$ (number of recognitions $\times$ 0.01)

Example: a song recognized by one million people yields contribution value = 1 $\times$ labour coefficient $\times$ (1,000,000 $\times$ 0.01) = 10,000 $\times$ labour coefficient.

Scientific research: Influence factor = the actual number of beneficiaries of the outcome (or frequency of use) $\times$ the social value coefficient. The social value coefficient is determined by a peer review committee, reflecting the long-term impact of the outcome upon civilization's survival and development; the recommended range is 0.1 to 10. In the early period, before consensus on coefficients is reached, it may be provisionally set to 1 (i.e., counting only the number of beneficiaries). The final contribution value may be extremely high, but it requires a review cycle; it is not issued instantaneously.

Key rules:

- Culture and the arts: the production process itself does not generate contribution value (the hundred hours spent composing a song yield no contribution value); value is generated only after the work receives recognition.
- Scientific research: the basic guarantee is identical to that of any other member (no supplementation by virtue of research status). Even if an experiment fails, the research records (experimental process, methods, data) may be used to issue process contribution value retroactively according to Track One (the production-process formula). Failure is not punished; the time and effort invested are equally acknowledged.
- Subsequent additions: if, at a later date, someone produces new creative work based upon the original outcome (e.g., adapting the song, applying the paper,

building further research upon it), the original author may receive a certain proportion of additional contribution value (determined by review, the maximum not to exceed 30% of the original outcome's contribution value).

The essence of the long-term traceability mechanism is nothing less than an eternal contract between civilization and its creators. It no longer understands contribution as a one-off, instantaneous event, but as a river of value that flows continuously onward. In the very moment of making a contribution, the creator receives not only that period's contribution value, but also a continuing yield of civilization's interest in all future time. This fundamentally transforms the relationship between creation and reward, turning it from a point-like transaction into an eternal covenant. Even after the creator has died, his merits remain alive within civilization. There is no temporal limit; his honor grows in perpetuity alongside the growth of civilization itself.

Overlay rule: Engineering = Track One (process) + Track Two (outcome)

For construction works, major infrastructure, and batch manufacturing, the total contribution value is constituted by two independent parts:

- Track One (process contribution value): the working hours of all participants are calculated according to the labour coefficient and paid on an hourly basis. Whatever the final outcome's quality, the time invested is compensated in accordance with Track One, guaranteeing basic remuneration for labour.
- Track Two (outcome contribution value): upon completion of the project, value is calculated not by the hour, but according to the acceptance results of the final outcome. Only engineering surfaces that pass acceptance generate outcome contribution value; unqualified surfaces generate none, or are supplemented after rework passes acceptance.
- Allocation method: no longer a proportional distribution, but an accounting based upon the quality and degree of completion of the engineering surface for which each individual or team was independently responsible. The specific rules are as follows:

An individual or team possesses independent accounting rights over the engineering surface for which it is responsible.

After acceptance passes, the outcome contribution value for that surface = baseline value $\times$ quality coefficient.

Baseline value: the standard outcome contribution value for that surface (determined by the engineering difficulty coefficient and factors of area, volume, or length, announced in advance).

Quality coefficient: reflects the quality of acceptance; the standard is 1.0, above standard may rise to 1.2 (recognized by the acceptance committee), below standard is unqualified.

Example: if a person independently completes a wall surface whose standard outcome value is 1000, and acceptance rates it "excellent," with a quality coefficient of 1.15, then the Track Two contribution value = $1000 \times 1.15 = 1150$.

Total contribution value = Track One (process) + Track Two (outcome). The two are independent; neither substitutes for the other.

3.3 Layer Three: Dynamic Evolution — "Keep Correcting Until Satisfied"

No initial set of multipliers can be perfect. Hence the system is endowed with a built-in mechanism of dynamic correction.

Core principle: what is adjusted is the production difficulty coefficient and the relative multiplier—never the commodity anchor (1 kilogram of grain = 1 contribution value remains immutable).

Periodic review: annually, the Coefficient Review Committee conducts a comprehensive assessment of the multiplier matrix and the base difficulty coefficients, grounded in system operating data.

Basis of data:

- A certain product or service has long been in a state of scarcity in contribution value redemption → the labour in that field is undervalued; the multiplier should be raised.
- The volume of contribution claims in a certain field far exceeds social demand → the labour in that field is overvalued; the multiplier should be lowered.
- Technological progress has greatly raised productivity → the base difficulty coefficient (e.g., grain production) may be revised downward, reflecting reduced labour intensity.
- A large number of citizens collectively report that a certain field's multiplier is unjust → a special investigation is initiated.

Long-term traceability mechanism: for long-cycle contributions such as basic scientific research and artistic creation, a contribution value option archive is established. When the long-term value of the outcome becomes manifest (e.g., after five or ten years), supplementary contribution value is issued retroactively.

Dispute resolution: anyone who disputes a quantification result has the right to appeal. The evaluation algorithms are open-source and auditable. Citizens have the right to question the quantification standard itself and to propose amendments. The task of improving the contribution value algorithm is itself defined as a public contribution task of high weight.

Core principle: this is not a perfect scheme; it is a rectifiable scheme. Its aim is not to fix the correct multiplier at a single stroke, but through continuous practice and democratic consultation to approach indefinitely that state in which all are satisfied.

The right of correction within the contribution value system is divided into two levels.

First-level coefficient correction (adjusting the production difficulty coefficient and the relative multiplier): a correction proposal is put forward by the Coefficient Review Committee on the basis of system operating data, and executed after approval by a vote of the cell assembly. This belongs to the domain of collective decision-making.

Second-level algorithmic correction (adjusting the evaluation model itself, the structure of the formula): this constitutes a modification of the meta-rules and must therefore undergo a far more rigorous procedure. It is initiated by the Civilizational Council, and executed only after approval by a cross-cell referendum.

The significance of distinguishing these two levels lies in this: coefficient correction is an optimization within the established framework; algorithmic correction is a deliberation upon the framework itself. The former is the everyday governance of the system; the latter is a decision at the constitutional level. The two must never be confounded.

4. The Three Technological Pillars: The AI Assessment Layer, the Blockchain Trust Layer, and the Terminal Interaction Layer

The three-layer model is the skeleton; technology is the bloodstream that sets it in motion. We rely not upon any single black-box technology, but upon the construction of a technological system of mutual checks and balances, open and transparent.

4.1 The Assessment Layer (AI Supercomputing Center)

Role: the intelligent computational hub of contribution value quantification. It does not decide; it merely aids decision-making.

Core functions:

- Automated precision measurement: for measurable production activities (e.g., grain output, construction area), data is automatically collected via IoT sensors, and basic calculations are performed according to baseline and multipliers.
- Auxiliary assessment of complex contributions: for fields such as education, scientific research, and the arts, which resist direct quantification, AI plays the role of data analyst. Through text analysis, social network analysis, and other methods, it supplies data-supported reference for the final rulings of expert

committees.

- Model optimization: it continuously monitors system operating data, providing scientific evidence and simulation forecasts for multiplier adjustments.
- Ethical constraints:
- AI never holds the final power of decision. It offers reference; humans make decisions.
- The core logic of AI models must be open and auditable. There is no algorithmic black box.
- Any citizen may challenge the evidentiary basis of AI assessments.

4.2 The Trust Layer (Blockchain Platform)

Role: the trusted ledger of contribution value, ensuring that every record is immutable and traceable.

Core functions:

- Full-lifecycle evidence storage: from the occurrence of the contributive act, data collection, and AI assessment, to the issuance and circulation of contribution value, every step's key data is recorded on the blockchain, forming a complete contribution life-chain.
- Secure circulation and settlement: the transfer of contribution value is based upon the blockchain network, replacing the traditional intermediary clearing system. It enables point-to-point, instantaneous, low-cost, and highly credible value transfer.
- Codified solidification of rules: core rules (such as baseline coefficients and issuance rules) are deployed on the blockchain in the form of smart contracts. Once deployed, their execution is subject to no single party's control.

The "Triple-Ledger Method":

- One ledger kept by oneself.
- A second ledger kept by others under supervision (anyone may keep one).
- A third ledger automatically kept by the blockchain (an immutable third party).

The three ledgers are reconciled periodically; any party with a discrepancy must be accountable. This secures the system's reliability under the most exacting transparency.

4.3 The Interaction Layer (Digital Terminals)

Role: the humanized interface between residents and the contribution value system.

Core functions:

- Unified digital identity: every resident possesses a unique digital identity, deeply integrated with their contribution value account, personal profile, and so on.
- One-stop service entry: through terminals (mobile apps, community kiosks, etc.), residents may:
 - Declare contributions: submit their own contribution information and upload supporting materials.
 - Query results: view contribution value balances, assessment progress, and historical records at any time.
 - Participate in deliberation: vote online on issues such as multiplier adjustments.
 - Redeem for consumption: browse products and services available for contribution value redemption.
 - Appeal and provide feedback: raise objections to quantification results and propose improvements to the system.

- AI assistant: a built-in AI assistant helps residents analyze the composition of their own contribution, provides optimization suggestions, and explains complex quantification rules.

Design principles:

- Human-centered: the interface is simple, intuitive, and friendly to residents with varying degrees of digital literacy (including the elderly and persons with disabilities).
- Never a new digital divide: the government must ensure the universal availability of digital terminals and network access, treating this as a basic public service.
- Technology serves humanity: technology is a tool, not a master. AI offers recommendations; humans retain the power of veto. Blockchain records processes; citizens retain the power of audit.

5. Practical Verification: The Iterative Path in the "Sparks Plan"

This quantification system will not be accomplished at a single stroke; it will iterate in practice.

Stage One (months 1–6): Baseline Verification

- Operate the baseline anchor (1 kilogram of grain = 1 contribution value) in pilot zones.
- Quantify and distribute contribution value for basic production (agriculture, infrastructure construction), verifying whether the initial settings of the production difficulty coefficient are reasonable.
- Test the stability and acceptance of the baseline.
- Stage Two (months 6–12): Multiplier Initiation

- Launch the initial multiplier matrix, incorporating public services (education, healthcare, community maintenance) into the system.
- Collect social feedback, identify obvious multiplier deviations.
- Refine the AI-assisted assessment system.
- Stage Three (after one year): Dynamic Evolution
- Fully operate the dynamic balancing mechanism—begin the first round of multiplier adjustments.
- Address the quantification of complex contributions (scientific research, the arts).
- Establish pilot channels for long-term traceability.
- The Philosophy of Iteration
- The core hypothesis of this system is as follows:
- We cannot possibly provide the correct coefficients from the outset.
- Therefore, we provide an acceptable initial value.
- Then we run it openly, collect feedback, and adjust when deviations are found.
- The adjustment is made through democratic voting. Not expert fiat, not AI dictatorship.

The goal of adjustment is to make the overwhelming majority of participants feel that fairness prevails, and to continuously reduce the proportion of those who feel aggrieved. It is not theoretical optimality, but that which withstands scrutiny in practice.

We keep trying, keep correcting, until everyone says: "This accounting, I accept it."

This is not a flaw in the scheme; it is the scheme's wisdom. It acknowledges its own imperfection and grants itself the mechanism to become less imperfect.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The quantification of contribution value is not a technological project, but the re-signing of a social contract.

It relies not upon elite algorithmic rulings, but upon the consensus and deliberation of every participant.

It seeks not the perfection of a single leap, but the indefinite approach to fairness through practice.

It creates no black boxes; it places every account in the sunlight, so that each person may reckon it clearly.

Grain as anchor, priced at one; production has measure, coefficients adjustable.

All things as system, labour may be measured; the hearts of the people are the destination, consensus is the foundation.

When all can compute their own contribution with simple arithmetic; when all can see the origin and course of every unit of contribution; when all who feel injustice can stand forth and declare "This is not reasonable" and be taken seriously—

then, and only then, have we truly established a value system in which every person can trust.

And trust—trust is the most precious wealth of a civilization.

Section Four: Unit Autonomy and the Concentration of Strategic Efficacy

This section addresses the fundamental organizational principle of the new civilization: the preservation of local vitality and resilience alongside the attainment of civilizational strategic efficacy. The core design consists in abandoning the singular, tightly coupled global network of the old order in favor of a distributed matrix composed of highly self-sufficient, mutually independent, yet intelligently collaborative civilizational units.

1. The Definition and Essential Attributes of the Cell: The Resilient Nexus of a New Civilization

A civilizational unit is a community that, in geographical and social-organizational terms, attains a high degree of self-sufficiency in food, energy, basic industry, and essential medical supplies. It is not a hermetically sealed fortress, but the foundational functional unit through which the new civilization secures at once vitality and resilience.

A self-sufficient civilizational vehicle. The primary attribute of the cell is its capacity to sustain an internal circulation of core survival materials. This is the physical substrate upon which the new civilization resists systemic shocks—global supply chain rupture, pandemics, climate catastrophe—and realizes ultimate resilience. It ensures that, under any external exigency, the survival baseline and the economic circulation of the cell remain uninterrupted.

The operational environment of contribution value. The cell is the fundamental social locus in which the Contribution Value System is implemented, tested, and refined. Within its bounds, the acquisition, circulation, and expenditure of contribution value compose a complete microeconomic closed loop, enabling the mechanisms of value

measurement and distribution to iterate and perfect themselves within a living community.

An incubator of innovation and culture. The scale of the cell is moderate—large enough to transcend the fragility of the small community, small enough to escape the bureaucratic rigidity of the colossal state. It accommodates a wealth of social experiments and cultural cultivation, responding swiftly to the needs and creative impulses of its local members, and thereby fostering distinctive and vibrant community cultures and innovation ecosystems.

2. The Meaning of Autonomy: Self-Governance and the Vitality of the Cell

Unit autonomy is the cornerstone of the new civilization's governance edifice, conceived to ignite creativity and a sense of responsibility at the most fundamental stratum of society.

Transactional autonomy. A cell possesses autonomous decision-making authority over the vast majority of its internal affairs, including but not limited to local production planning, community life services, educational and cultural practices, healthcare arrangements, and internal resource allocation.

Consensus-driven decision mechanisms. Decisions on internal affairs are reached through a plurality of forms—popular initiative, referendum, consensus conference—ensuring that power at all times derives from the direct or profoundly participatory authorization of the cell's members, and thereby realizing a deep democratic governance.

Resource stewardship. Under the precondition of honoring the baseline rules established by the civilizational community—global ecological red lines, the guarantee of fundamental rights—a cell holds authority over the land, natural resources, and public facilities within its territory, with a view toward optimal and

sustainable use.

3. The Meaning of Concentration: Strategic Coordination and the Synergy of the Whole

Upon the foundation of full autonomy, those critical functions upon which the survival and development of civilization depend must be submitted to effective centralized coordination, so as to ensure unity of direction and strategic efficacy.

The elevation of core functions. The following key functions are uniformly planned and coordinated by a global Civilizational Council:

- Macro-level scientific and technological strategy: guiding the great technological directions that concern the future of civilization—ultimate energy sources, interstellar navigation, the ethics of artificial intelligence.
- Global ecological stewardship: executing worldwide environmental policy, including climate regulation, species conservation, and cross-cell ecological compensation.
- The civilizational defense system: commanding and deploying the Civilization Guard Force in unified fashion, safeguarding the security of civilization as a whole.
- Cross-cell major infrastructure: planning and constructing the backbone networks of transportation, energy, and information that interconnect the cells.
- Interpretation and guardianship of the Civilization Charter: serving as the custodian of the supreme legal framework and ensuring that the fundamental principles of the system are never violated.

Standard interfaces and interconnection. Each cell connects to the broader civilizational network through standardized interfaces—contribution-value settlement protocols, global information-sharing platforms, efficient logistics corridors. This

gives rise to a mode of distributed globalization: preserving the independence and resilience of each cell while enabling highly efficient global collaboration and optimal resource allocation.

4. The Dialectical Unity of Autonomy and Concentration: The Forging of a Resilient Matrix

Unit autonomy and concentrated efficacy are not a simple dichotomy, but an organic whole of mutual complementarity and dialectical unity.

Autonomy is the foundation and the norm. It secures elasticity, adaptability, and diversity; it is the wellspring of social vitality. In the ordinary state, the cell is a highly self-governing living entity.

Concentration is the complement and the guarantee. It ensures that, in the face of grave challenges and historic opportunities, civilization can forge a unified will and formidable strength, never forfeiting the critical window of advancement to fragmentation.

The organic metaphor. The cell resembles a cell of the living body—endowed with metabolic autonomy and functional specificity—while the Civilizational Council acts as the brain and immune system, charged with overall coordination, learning, memory, and defense against existential threats.

Systemic advantage. This architecture of the cellular resilience matrix enables the new civilization, in confronting uncertainty, to realize simultaneously two apparently antithetical advantages: the dispersion of risk and the concentration of strength for great undertakings. It fundamentally transcends the fragility of the old global system, in which the loss of one part spelled the loss of the whole.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The dialectical unity of unit autonomy and concentrated efficacy constitutes the

organizational skeleton of the new civilization. It confers unbounded vitality upon the self-sufficient civilizational units, while entrusting functions vital to survival to the unified coordination of the Civilizational Council. This architecture disperses risk and preserves resilience as does a living organism, yet gathers strength and transcends limits as does a precision instrument—ultimately giving rise to a distributed civilizational matrix at once adaptive and strategic.

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

The Contribution Value System, as the economic foundation of the new civilizational paradigm, accomplishes a thorough reconstruction extending from value philosophy to institutional design. It is no isolated allocation scheme, but a complete operating system rooted in the ontology of all-things-as-capital; it is endowed with an ethical premise by the basic livelihood guarantee, secured in operation by the three technological pillars, and rendered precise in measurement by the two-stage quantification model. This system succeeds in shifting the principal engine of the socio-economy from the alienating logic of production for profit to the liberating logic of creation for contribution. In theory, it establishes a new civilizational coordinate that transcends exploitation and points toward fairness and sustainability; in practice, through the path of cellularization, it demonstrates its feasibility and formidable resilience. Thus is the value-circulation system of the new civilization constructed, laying a solid foundation for a superstructure capable of shaping an institutional and governance order wholly attuned to it. We proceed, then, to the institutional layer of the new civilization, exploring how the value philosophy of Contributionism may be transformed into stable, just, and supremely effective rules of social operation.

Chapter Two: Institutional Design and the Architecture of

Governance (The Constitution and Skeleton of a

Contributionist Society)

A Guide to This Chapter

From Critique to Construction — The Operating System of a New Civilization

The governance predicament of the old civilization is rooted in a structural paradox: we attempt to resolve our problems with the same mode of thought that conceived them. As Einstein once observed, "We cannot solve our problems with the same thinking we used when we created them." The old paradigms of governance—whether the factional gridlock and capital manipulation of Western representative democracy, or the systemic ossification and power rent-seeking of Eastern authoritarianism—are united by one and the same corrupted foundational code: the artificial sundering of Law from Institution, and the alienation of public power into a private instrument monopolized by a privileged few.

Throughout the long dark night of history, Law has played a double role. On one hand, it is the scales of justice for which the weak pine—as when the Twelve Tables of ancient Rome sought to expose the statutes to public scrutiny and shatter the patrician monopoly over jurisprudence. On the other hand, it has too often served as the finely spun snare of the powerful—that which Plato decried as "service to factional interest, not to the universal good." And Institution—the organizational architecture and operating rules of the state—has, under the old paradigm, either struggled, as Montesquieu dissected, between the ideal of separated powers and the reality of collusive authority; or fallen into the two-thousand-year cyclical trap of the Chinese empire, whose "Confucian exterior, Legalist interior" ensured that each dynasty's bureaucracy functioned with relative efficiency at its founding, only to slide inexorably into the turgid stagnation of Parkinson's Law, and at last to complete its "system reset" in the cruelest manner known to civilization: dynastic collapse.

This state of paralysis—law without institutional embodiment, institutions bereft of legal spirit—has engendered a systemic lock-in of civilization. The "lock-in effect" defined by Nobel laureate Douglass North here manifests in its fullest form: even when society perceives, with perfect clarity, that its institutions are inefficient and

unjust, the prodigious inertia of vested interests and path dependency renders escape almost impossible. The present global tableau—the tragedy of the commons unfolding in the climate crisis, the Matthew effect compounding the maldistribution of global wealth, the specter of a Thucydidean trap haunting the geopolitical landscape—each is a symptom of this obsolete operating system teetering on the brink of collapse.

What this volume undertakes, therefore, is no ordinary version upgrade, but a thoroughgoing paradigm revolution in the operating system of civilization—a leap comparable, in computer science, to the transition from a standalone DOS machine to a cloud-based distributed operating system. The core design philosophy rests upon a fundamental restructuring along four axes:

Institution as Skeleton — The Framework of Systems. We must construct a social operating architecture as precise as mechanical clockwork, as adaptive as a living organism, and entirely transparent to public scrutiny. It must transcend the defensive posture that James Madison envisioned in the Federalist Papers—of setting "ambition to counteract ambition"—and move toward an affirmative design that actively cultivates virtue while inhibiting vice.

Law as Soul — The Spirit of Law. Law must be transformed from the scourge of the Leviathan, that beast which Thomas Hobbes believed required absolute sovereignty to tame, into an "algorithm of justice" embedded within every corner of the system, ever vigilant in the defense of Contributionism. Its aim is not punishment alone, but the institutional engineering of a world in which good deeds are made easy and evil deeds rendered difficult to commit.

Service Agencies as Executors. The ultimate transformation must be achieved: from "rule" to "governance." All organs of public authority shall bid farewell, once and for all, to the iron cage of bureaucracy as defined by Max Weber, and be reconstituted as "public service institutions"—elected by citizens, supervised by citizens in real time, and accountable to citizens. They shall be no longer temples of power, but platforms

of service.

Contribution Value as the Driver. The energy and incentive of the entire system shall derive from a transcendence and elevation of Adam Smith's "invisible hand." Through contribution value—that precise measure of worth—the rational self-interest of the individual and the collective flourishing of civilization are fused into perfect unity, channeling the creative forces of all society toward the elevation of civilization's common good.

This new operating system is designed to liberate human civilization from the historical cycle that has held it in thrall for millennia—that fate by which "each rise is swift, and each fall is swifter still"—and to accomplish the great leap from the passive condition of being governed by men to the self-conscious epoch of governance by institution: a new age of deliberate world-creation.

Section One: The Fundamental Law — The Essence of the Civilizational Charter

This section expounds the objective-law foundation of the Civilizational Charter as the "grammar of survival." Its authority derives from the "Theory of All-Things-as-Capital" and the "Law of Cycles." It is the supreme social contract concluded by civilization in response to existential challenges, and its force transcends all secular power.

1. The Supreme Criterion — The Philosophical Ground and Source of Authority of the Charter

The birth of the Civilizational Charter arises not from the bargaining of any legislative assembly, but, in the manner of Isaac Newton's discovery of the law of universal gravitation, from the first complete revelation and articulation of the objective laws governing the survival of civilization. Its authority transcends all secular power, rooted as it is in resonance with the deep structure of the cosmos and of society.

The Philosophical Ground: From the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital to the Law of Cycles

The underlying logic of this Civilizational Charter is firmly founded upon the grand vista revealed by the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. That theory accomplishes a yet more fundamental relational turn, following the subjectivist turn inaugurated by Descartes' *cogito ergo sum*. It reveals that all existence—from elementary particles to complex civilizations—is "Capital," a unity of "intrinsic capacity" and "relational property." Human society, as one form of this universal existence, will inevitably collapse like a castle built upon air should its governing laws violate this fundamental law of being. The Civilizational Charter is precisely the highest and most systematic expression of this law at the level of social governance—the "grammar of survival"

that civilization must adopt in order to conform to the essence of existence.

Meanwhile, the Law of Cycles furnishes the Civilizational Charter with a dynamic, historical-dialectical perspective. Like the "law of entropy increase" in the social domain, it indicates that every civilizational paradigm, through the relentless accumulation of internal "Metabolic Taxes" (coordination costs, suppression of innovation, costs of maintaining stability), is fated to ossify and decline. Arnold Toynbee's model of "challenge and response" and Paul Kennedy's studies of the rise and fall of great powers corroborate this law at different levels. The design of the Civilizational Charter aims at the construction of a system capable of continuous self-renewal and of preserving its "paradigmatic attraction." Its core mechanism is the deep binding of society's incentive structure to the long-term survival goals of civilization through the Contribution Value System, thereby systematically and proactively reducing the "Metabolic Tax."

The Source of Authority: The Social Contract 2.0 of Civilization

Therefore, the authority of the Civilizational Charter derives not from the nebulous "General Will" as conceived by Jean-Jacques Rousseau, but from the fact that it is the supreme survival contract concluded by all members of the Civilizational Community, in recognition of the aforesaid objective laws, in response to existential challenges and for the attainment of continued flourishing. It is at once the ultimate transcendence of Thomas Hobbes' primordial state of "war of all against all" and the grand elevation of John Locke's social contract centered upon property rights.

It is the Meta-Rule of the survival and development of the Civilizational Community—the "law above law." The legitimacy of the existence and conduct of any individual, organization, law, or institution derives from the Civilizational Charter and must never contravene it. To challenge the Civilizational Charter is to challenge the very foundation of the Civilizational Community's existence. Here we accomplish the civilizational ascent from "the king is under the law" to "all power is under the Civilizational Charter."

2. The Purpose and Essence of Law — The Compulsory

Instrument in the Service of the Contribution System

A "Copernican Revolution" in the science of law is now required: a precise delineation of the essence, purpose, and mutual relationship of "Law" and "Institution" in the new civilization. This is the key to comprehending the entire system of celestial-law governance.

(A) The Precise Definition and Purpose of Law: From Class Will to Systemic Immunity

The Redefinition of Law. Under the old paradigm—whether in John Austin's "command of the sovereign" or Karl Marx's "instrument of the ruling class"—Law could scarcely shed its color of coercion and oppression. In a Contributionist civilization, Law is redefined as the instrument for the defense of the fundamental Contribution Value System: a system of compulsory norms of conduct established by the Civilizational Community for the maintenance of fairness, the elimination of harmful causes, and the guidance toward beneficial outcomes. In essence, it is a mechanism of self-protection and self-repair—an immune system of the complex social organism.

The Sole Purpose of Law. The ultimate purpose of Law is to safeguard and to stimulate "good"—that is, all creative activity which increases the total flourishing of civilization. By compulsorily prohibiting and correcting those acts which undermine the Contribution Value System (namely, "evil"), it protects the rights and interests of creators and ensures that substantive justice—distribution according to contribution—is realized. As Aristotle observed, "The true purpose of law is to induce those who are subject to it to acquire the virtue of justice."

(B) The Precise Definition and Function of Institution: From Instrument of Domination to Social Operating System

The Precise Definition of Institution. Institution is the systematic, framework-like collection of rules and organizational structures established by the Civilizational Community for the achievement of effective governance and orderly operation. It constitutes the skeleton and bloodstream of society—the riverbeds and channels through which power, resources, and information flow.

The Core Function of Institution. It is to minimize society's "transaction costs" and "Metabolic Taxes." Nobel laureate Ronald Coase revealed the importance of transaction costs in his theory of the firm. An excellent institution renders information transmission efficient, decision-making processes scientific, and the restraint of power effective, thereby enabling members of society to devote more energy to creative endeavor rather than exhausting themselves in endless negotiation, surveillance, and conflict. It is the efficiency engine of civilization.

(C) The Dialectical Relationship of "Institution-Based Lawmaking and Law-Based Governance": A New Synthesis of Law and Institution

"Institution-based lawmaking"—the fundamental principle of legislation. This means that, apart from the Civilizational Charter and other fundamental laws of universal coercive force such as the criminal code, all specific laws governing various domains of social governance must be derived from, and formulated in accordance with, the established foundational institutions. For example, the Law on Resource Allocation must be strictly formulated in accordance with the core algorithms and principles of the Contribution Value System; the Law on Elections for Public Service Institutions must fully conform to the institutional design concerning the generation and operation of power in the Service-Oriented Governance system. This is akin to writing a subfunction in a computer program, which must strictly adhere to the interface and logic defined by the main program. Institution provides the indisputable matrix, boundary, and logical precondition for the birth of Law. This fundamentally

guarantees the systematicity, simplicity, and consistency of Law, and utterly eliminates "private law" born of thin air or crafted in the service of particular interests—divorced from the actual framework of society. It resolves the millennial affliction, present since the Code of Hammurabi, of contradictory provisions and systemic chaos in legal codes.

"Law-based governance"—the fundamental principle of enforcement. It means that all acts of governance—whether the provision of public services, the mediation of social disputes, or the correction of violations—must be carried out in strict accordance with established legal procedure. Law provides unified, predictable standards and measures for "governance," eliminating the arbitrary exercise of power. This is the ultimate realization of what the ancient Chinese Legalist Han Feizi advocated: "The law does not fawn upon the noble; the plumb line does not bend before the crooked."

Relationship in synthesis. Institution is the soil, the blueprint, and the skeleton of Law; Law is the blood, the guard, and the teeth of Institution. Law without Institution is a tree without roots—a paper document liable to be trampled by power at any moment. Institution without Law is a body without immunity, incapable of resisting erosion from evil within or without. The two are like the double helix of DNA, intertwined, together constituting the life—here, the life of civilization—and the foundation of its stability and evolution.

3. The Attribution of Armed Force — The Fundamental Law of the Civilizational Guard

The attribution and nature of armed force is the touchstone distinguishing the old from the new civilizational paradigm—the ultimate measure of whether a civilization has truly come of age. This section sets forth in detail the fundamental principles governing the Civilizational Guard, an entirely new form of armed force. It is a thoroughgoing reconstruction of "violence," humanity's most ancient problem.

(A) The Principle of Unified Force (Institutional Foundation: The War That Ends War)

Provision. Within the Civilizational Community, no national, regional, partisan, or private armed organization independent of the Civilizational Guard shall be permitted to exist. All defensive and constitutional armed force must be exercised and commanded exclusively and uniformly by the Civilizational Guard. This is one of the supreme institutions of the Civilizational Charter, beyond dispute.

Comparison and Rationale. Under the old paradigm, national armies were symbols of sovereignty and instruments of geopolitical competition; their essence was a source of division and antagonism. Clausewitz's dictum that "war is the continuation of politics by other means" epitomizes this old logic. To unify armed force under an institution that transcends nations and owes allegiance to civilization as a whole is the ultimate solution, physically and institutionally, for the elimination of large-scale civil war and international war. This does not abolish the right of self-defense; it elevates self-defense from the narrow level of the nation-state to the level of all human civilization, entrusted to an organization more professional, more rational, and more loyal to justice. It realizes an upgraded and operationalized version of Immanuel Kant's ideal of the "abolition of standing armies" in Perpetual Peace.

(B) The Principle of Loyalty to the Charter (The Soul of Law: Allegiance to Abstract Principle)

Provision. The Civilizational Guard owes no allegiance to any individual, organization, political party, or territorial interest. Its sole and absolute loyalty is to the Contributionist philosophy embodied in the Civilizational Charter and to the legal provisions derived therefrom. Every member, upon enlistment, takes an oath of allegiance to the text of the Civilizational Charter itself.

Comparison and Rationale. In old armed forces, "loyalty" was typically directed toward a supreme commander or national interest, which readily rendered force a tool

for maintaining dictatorship or projecting hegemony. The absolute loyalty of the Imperial Japanese Army to the Emperor reduced it to an instrument of militarist expansion, culminating in atrocities against humanity such as the Nanjing Massacre—an extreme tragedy of this alienation of loyalty. The Guard's "loyalty to the Charter" makes it the embodiment of objective law and civilizational justice, not the enforcer of any subjective will. It resembles the loyalty of the Roman Republican armies to "the Senate and the People of Rome" (SPQR), yet its content has been elevated from loyalty to a particular city-state to loyalty to universal civilizational principles.

(C) The Principle of Absolute Transparency (Institutional Guarantee: The Sword Placed in the Sunlight)

Provision. The organizational structure, personnel composition, resource allocation, strategic intentions, operational logic, and decision-making processes of the Civilizational Guard—with the sole exception of a minimal category of core tactical secrets approved by the highest judicial authority in accordance with clear legal procedure—must be recorded in their entirety and disclosed unconditionally to all citizens, subject to real-time scrutiny and questioning. All equipment procurement must be released in the form of tasks to citizens publicly as tasks; unreasonable proposals will be rejected.

Comparison and Rationale. The nebulous boundary between "secrecy" and "national security" in old-style military power was the breeding ground for its abuse. The Pentagon Papers affair during the Vietnam War and numerous subsequent controversies over overseas operations in the United States all stem from this. Absolute transparency places the Guard under the surveillance of the whole of civilization; any intention or action contrary to the Civilizational Charter is discovered and halted at its incipient stage. This transparency is not a burden, but the strongest guarantee of the Guard's legitimacy and credibility. It confines "military secrets" strictly to the technical level, while the strategic and principled dimensions remain

entirely open, subjected to the scrutiny of morality and reason.

(D) The Right of Conscientious Veto (The Ultimate Guard of Law: The Last Line of Defense of Individual Reason)

Provision. Any member of the Civilizational Guard, upon the basis of independent rational judgment and conclusive evidence, has the right to refuse to execute any order that, in their conscientious assessment, violates the fundamental principles of the Civilizational Charter and the basic conscience of humanity; and no member shall suffer any form of retaliation, discrimination, or adverse effect upon their professional development for such refusal. Conversely, any person executing an evidently unconstitutional order shall bear individual legal responsibility.

Comparison and Rationale. The old doctrine that "absolute obedience is the soldier's duty" is the root of countless humanitarian catastrophes. Though the Nuremberg trials established the principle that "acting upon superior orders does not constitute a ground for exoneration," it has often been difficult to implement in practice. The right of conscientious veto explicitly restores the ultimate power of judgment—and the ultimate responsibility—to individual reason and conscience. It is the "ultimate fuse" preventing the alienation of armed force into an instrument of evil. It demands that members of the Civilizational Guard be not merely disciplined warriors, but guards and philosophers of civilization, versed in the Civilizational Charter and possessed of independent thought.

(E) The Leaderless Decision-Making Mechanism (Institutional Innovation: From Pyramid to Task Network)

Provision. The internal hierarchy of the traditional military is abolished within the Civilizational Guard. The planning and execution of missions are based on the members' capability contribution values, professional qualifications, and voluntary association, forming dynamic, flattened task groups. The role of senior members is that of coordinator, mentor, and resource allocator—not issuer of commands.

Comparison and Rationale. The old pyramidal command structure (as exemplified by the typical division-brigade-regiment establishment) was efficient in the industrial age, but in the information age it has become rigid and suppressive of creativity. It cultivated passive executors rather than proactive problem-solvers. The leaderless decision-making mechanism greatly stimulates the initiative, collaborative spirit, and tactical innovation of members, making them far more adaptable to the complex and ever-shifting tasks of global and civilizational defense. It emphasizes "authority of competence" and "authority of morality" rather than "authority of position," which accords perfectly with the Contributionist core principle of "distribution according to contribution." It resembles the "agile team" model common in modern high-tech corporations such as Google, but its application to the domain of force—the domain most in need of discipline and responsibility—constitutes a revolutionary undertaking.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The Civilizational Charter is the unshakable foundation of the new civilization. It defines, from the height of philosophy, the ultimate purpose and the baseline rules of the system, and it supplies the juridical basis and operational principles for the Civilizational Guard, that entirely new form of armed force.

Section Two: The Nature of Power — A Service-Oriented Governance System

This section undertakes a thorough disenchantment and reconstruction of the very concept of "power," elucidating the fundamental distinctions between the essence, origin, and mode of operation of public power in the new civilization and those of the old world.

1. The Disenchantment of Power: A Paradigm Revolution from "Domination" to "Service"

The Old Paradigm's View of Power: Domination and Alienation

In the old civilization, power was, in essence, a "right of domination"—that which Max Weber defined as "any opportunity to impose one's own will within a given social relationship, even against resistance." Whether draped in the mantle of "divine right of kings" or masked in the guise of "popular sovereignty," the ultimate orientation of power remained the management and control of some persons over others. This form of dominating power necessarily engendered a privileged, closed bureaucratic system. History repeatedly demonstrates that this system, as though under a curse, inexorably follows Parkinson's Law, descending into institutional hypertrophy, inefficiency, and self-serving venality. Lord Acton's famous dictum—"Power tends to corrupt, and absolute power corrupts absolutely"—is the inescapable nightmare of the old power paradigm, wherein power is ultimately alienated into a sovereign force towering above citizens and standing in opposition to them.

The New Paradigm's View of Power: Service and Authorization

In a Contributionist civilization, we effect a "Copernican Revolution" in the concept of power. Public power is radically redefined as service authority. It is no longer a

qualification to dominate, but an authorization and a responsibility to provide efficient and just services to the Civilizational Community and to each of its members. All institutions that wield public power are, in their essence, "public service platforms"; those who serve within them are "public servants."

The term "bureaucracy"—and everything it represents: privileged castes, ossified practices, departmental interest groups—here loses all soil in which to take root. This accomplishes the thoroughgoing transformation from an "official-standard" society to a "contribution-standard" society. Power completes its return to its essential nature: it originates from citizens, exists for citizens, and is ultimately exercised directly by citizens through institutions.

2. The Institutions of Power Operation: Tripartite Separation, Citizen Authorization, and the Task-Based Society

Tripartite Separation of Power and the System of Final Citizen Authorization

In order to fundamentally prevent the monopolization or abuse of power at any node, every major public service undertaking must adhere to the principle of "tripartite separation and citizen authorization."

Proposal and Decision-Making Authority. Professional service bodies, such as the "Planning and Strategy Commission," formulate detailed proposals—each containing multiple feasible options—based upon macroeconomic data, civilizational needs, and professional technical assessment. These proposals must be submitted to a vote of all affected citizens, and may proceed only upon securing the legally required majority approval. This ensures that the fountainhead of power is always the rational will of citizens, never the arbitrary judgment of any institution or elite. For instance, whether to construct a trans-oceanic bridge—including site selection, budgetary framework, and environmental impact assessment—must be determined by referendum among the citizens of the affected regions and citizens with relevant expertise.

Implementation and Execution Authority. Once a proposal is approved, its execution is no longer entrusted to a permanent, monopolistic "Engineering Construction Executive Bureau." Instead, a neutral "Contribution Value Quantification and Service Distribution Center" decomposes the project into countless specific, quantifiable contribution-value task packages. Bridge design, materials production, component manufacturing, on-site welding, quality supervision, and even artistic ornamentation—each task carries its own explicit quality standards, completion deadlines, and corresponding contribution values.

Supervision and Oversight Authority. An independent "Project Audit and Effectiveness Supervision Commission" tracks and evaluates the entire execution process. Its oversight focuses upon: the fairness of the contribution values assigned to each task package; the quality of work delivered by the task undertakers; and the degree of alignment between the final outcome and the objectives of the original proposal. Its assessment results directly determine the final contribution values received by the task undertakers, and serve as an important basis for future refinement of the task-decomposition algorithms.

Election and Organization: The Mobile Servant, the Eternal Citizen

All members occupying major public service positions must be produced through the "rational election procedure" stipulated in Section Three of this chapter. They are not professional politicians, but outstanding contributors from every domain of society, serving full-time for a fixed term. Upon completion of their term, they return to their professional field, or stand for election to other service positions. There exists no permanent "ruling class" or "government" divorced from production—only a rotating "service team" that comes from the people and returns to the people. This realizes the republican ideal of "ruling and being ruled in turn" so esteemed by Aristotle, institutionalized and normalized, and utterly eradicates the soil from which a bureaucratic class might regenerate.

Compensation Binding System: The True Measure of Public Servant Value

The compensation of public servants is strictly tied to their positional contribution values and to citizen satisfaction evaluations, and is rendered fully transparent through blockchain technology and other means. This abolishes outright the old paradigm's fixed high salaries based on official rank, perquisite consumption, hidden benefits, and any possible space for power rent-seeking. A servant's income depends entirely upon the recognized value he or she has created for civilization during the period of service. Thus, the word "public servant" ceases to be a mere moral exhortation and becomes an institutionally guaranteed, quantifiable economic reality.

3. Judicial Autonomy — Unit Courts and the Citizen Final Right of Adjudication

Judicial power, as a critical component of public power, must thoroughly implement the principles of Service-Oriented Governance and absolute transparency. The core of its design is to shatter the closed nature and professional exclusivity of the old judicial system, transforming it into an open system in which citizens participate deeply, autonomous within the Unit, and subject to pan-civilizational oversight.

(A) Court Composition: Citizen Election and Unit Autonomy

Selection of Judges. Judges at each level of the Unit (defined, for example, as grassroots community, urban district, or trans-provincial/trans-state region) are no longer appointed by superiors or produced through professional promotion. They are directly elected by citizens within the Unit who possess the qualifications for "rational suffrage," from among candidates of established legal expertise and unblemished moral reputation. Judge terms are fixed, with the possibility of re-election; compensation and performance evaluation are fully bound to their service record.

Jury System. All significant cases must be tried with a cross-disciplinary jury of citizens randomly selected. The jury is responsible for determining the facts of the case; the judge is responsible for the application of law and the conduct of

proceedings.

Unit Autonomy. Cases are in principle tried at first instance by the court of the Unit where the incident occurred or to which the defendant belongs. This ensures the close integration of justice with local culture and social conditions, in accordance with the principle of "adapting measures to local circumstances."

(B) Trial Process: Absolute Transparency and Pan-Civilizational Oversight

Full Publicity. Unless involving statutory protections for minors or extreme personal privacy (and even then, the parties may freely choose to make the proceedings public), all hearings, examinations, and oral arguments must be broadcast live in real time through the civilizational public service network platform, with complete archival recordings preserved for inspection by any citizen at any time.

Universal Right of Oversight. "All citizens of other Units enjoy the right of supervision." Any citizen of the civilization, regardless of Unit, has the right to watch the live trial of any Unit's courtroom, and to submit, through a dedicated channel on the platform, substantiated inquiries and supervisory opinions concerning procedural legality, evidentiary authenticity, and other matters. These opinions are recorded and examined as part of the case file. When cross-Unit substantiated supervisory opinions on the same procedural issue cumulatively reach a legally prescribed number (e.g., one thousand), the presiding judge is obliged to provide a public explanation and response at the next hearing session or at a special hearing. Moreover, parties and all citizens have the right to apply for extra-territorial investigation and trial.

(C) Formation of Judgment: Citizen Vote as Final Instance, with Jurisprudential Constraint

Provisional Judgment and Public Comment Period. Upon completion of the trial, the court (judge and jury) first renders a "provisional judgment." This judgment does not take effect immediately, but enters a legally prescribed "public comment and

deliberation period" (e.g., fifteen to thirty days).

Local Citizen Vote of Confirmation. During the public comment period, all citizens of the Unit to which the case belongs may, through their personal terminals, vote "approve" or "reject" with respect to the provisional judgment.

If the affirmative votes reach the legally prescribed quorum within the Unit (e.g., two-thirds), the provisional judgment automatically takes effect and becomes the final judgment.

If the affirmative votes fail to reach the legally prescribed quorum, the provisional judgment is rejected. The case is then remanded to the original court for retrial, or the parties may choose to appeal to the court of a higher-level Unit.

Ultimate Jurisprudential Safeguard. To guard against the "tyranny of the majority" or local protectionism, a "Supreme Court of Civilization" is established. Its core function is to review the legality of the citizen voting process and to exercise "ultimate judicial review" over final judgments that manifestly violate the fundamental principles of the Civilizational Charter. Once this power is invoked, the judgment of the Supreme Court prevails over the results of the Unit citizen vote.

Through Unit judicial autonomy, absolute transparency, and the citizen vote as final instance, we return judicial power from the hands of a professional elite to the people who created it. This not only ensures the justice and popular character of the judiciary, but, through the daily oversight of pan-civilizational citizens, internalizes the spirit of the rule of law into the very somatic memory of civilization. It is the most vivid practice of "Celestial-Law Governance."

4. The Operational Form of Society: From Hierarchy to the Task-Based Society

Our proposal that "citizens voluntarily undertake tasks according to their respective capabilities" is the finishing touch of the Service-Oriented Governance system. It

gives rise to an entirely new form of social operation—the Task-Based Society.

Mechanism of Operation:

Task Publication. All major projects and social needs that have passed democratic decision-making are decomposed into standardized task packages by the "Contribution Value Quantification and Service Distribution Center" and published on a unified public service platform.

Social Claiming. Any citizen, professional team, or collaborative organization may autonomously claim these tasks on the platform according to their abilities, interests, and expertise. This resembles a vast "task market" founded on contribution value.

Autonomous Execution. The claimant organizes resources and completes the task with a high degree of autonomy.

Acceptance and Incentive. Upon completion, the task is inspected and accepted by a panel composed of algorithmic verification and a randomly selected group of expert citizens. Upon acceptance, the corresponding contribution value is immediately and automatically released to the claimant via smart contract.

Revolutionary Significance:

Thorough De-bureaucratization. It abolishes the traditional pyramidal administrative apparatus. Society no longer requires an enormous "government" to get things done; rather, it is society itself, directly mobilized and organized, that accomplishes its work.

Ultimate Efficiency and Vitality. It breaks down professional barriers and departmental walls, enabling the right people to complete the most specific tasks in the most efficient manner, realizing the "on-demand flow" and "optimal allocation" of society's human resources.

The Unity of Freedom and Responsibility. Citizens enjoy full freedom in choosing tasks, and simultaneously bear full responsibility for the tasks they have claimed. This ignites unprecedented initiative and creativity: the operation of society shifts from "I

am told to do" to "I choose to do."

Through the synthesis of "tripartite separation and citizen authorization" with the Task-Based Society, the Contributionist civilization constructs a governance system in which power genuinely belongs to the people, execution thoroughly relies upon the people, and outcomes are fairly distributed among the people—the ultimate evolution of human social organization.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The Service-Oriented Governance system, through the decomposition of power, citizen authorization, judicial autonomy, and the construction of the Task-Based Society, utterly dismantles the soil from which a bureaucratic class might regenerate, transforming the operation of society from "governed by men" into a self-organizing collaborative network of "governance by institution."

Section Three: Rational Authorization — The Contributionist Electoral Law

We must devise an authorization mechanism capable of discerning the most qualified public servants and assuring the rationality of collective decision-making, thereby fundamentally surmounting the intrinsic defects of old-style democracy.

1. Absolute Equality of Opportunity (The Foundation of the System)

Provision. Every citizen who has attained the statutory age of majority possesses, by natural right, the eligibility to stand for election. No threshold whatsoever—whether of education, wealth, lineage, social influence, or historical Contribution Value—may be imposed.

Rationale and Comparison. Old-style elections were perennially distorted by private wealth, pedigree, or academic credentialism. American electoral politics has been described as a "money game"; parliamentary seats in many nations are monopolized by political dynasties. Contributionism holds that "genius and innovators may emerge from any corner of society." Absolute equality of opportunity ensures that no potentially excellent servant is consigned to obscurity, thereby vastly enlarging the reservoir from which talent is drawn.

2. Policy Proposals as the Core (The Heart of the System)

Provision. The object of election is not the candidate's personal charisma, eloquence, or political promises, but his or her detailed policy proposals. Candidates must submit comprehensive plans encompassing specific goals, pathways of implementation, resource budgets, risk assessments, and quantifiable indicators of effectiveness.

Rationale and Comparison. Old-style elections abound in vacuous slogans, emotional

demagoguery, and ad hominem attacks—what American political communication scholar Kathleen Hall Jamieson denounced as the "negativity" of political discourse. Contributionist elections redirect competition toward the rational examination of public affairs themselves. Should a candidate, constrained by personal capability, possess only grand vision without detailed specification, he or she may enlist relevant professional service bodies or experts to develop the plan with unconditional thoroughness, thereby ensuring its feasibility. The election thus becomes a contest of "optimal solutions."

3. The Mechanism of Practical Verification (The Ultimate Arbitration of the System)

Provision. When multiple outstanding proposals cannot be distinguished through debate, the "practical verification mechanism" is activated. The regions in which citizens support the different proposals are designated as "parallel policy experimentation zones." Each proposal receives equal resources within its respective zone and is implemented in parallel. Upon a pre-agreed evaluation cycle, a neutral AI system and a cross-regional citizen commission, operating according to pre-established core indicators, conduct an objective assessment of each proposal's implementation outcomes.

Rationale and Comparison. This constitutes the institutionalized application of the scientific spirit that "practice is the sole criterion of truth." It averts the interminable wrangling of parliaments and the political paralysis of "opposition for opposition's sake," grounding decision-making upon objective data and tangible results. It is the ultimate expression of evidence-based governance.

4. Rational Suffrage (The Synthesis of System and Law)

Provision. The citizen's right to vote is not an unconditional entitlement with which one is born; it is a sacred responsibility to be acquired through study and examination.

Citizens must complete the compulsory courses "Introduction to Contributionism" and "Foundations of Public Decision-Making" and pass standardized examinations, whereupon they may exercise their right through an encrypted, independent voting channel accessed via their personal terminal devices.

Rationale and Comparison. The "one person, one vote" principle of old-style democracy has long been criticized, precisely by Plato among others, for its implicit assumption that all voters possess equal rational judgment. Contributionism acknowledges that wise choice requires a corresponding body of knowledge. This system does not deprive rights; rather, through "institutional empowerment," it ensures that voters possess a basic comprehension of the civilizational Paradigm and of the candidates' proposals, together with independent judgment. The election thus bids farewell to emotional catharsis and herd mentality, becoming a serious, rational act of collective decision-making. This is the modernization and systematic realization of the "competence-based suffrage" once advocated by John Stuart Mill.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Through the four great mechanisms of equality of opportunity, competition of proposals, practical verification, and rational authorization, the Contributionist Electoral Law constructs a system of rational authorization designed to select the most qualified servants and to guarantee the quality of collective decision-making, transcending the manifold infirmities of old-style democracy.

Section Four: The Operational Framework — The Pillars of Celestial-Law Governance

The system of absolute openness and transparency, together with the systematized mechanism of joint rewards and punishments, functions like the body's immune system and neural-feedback system — the one operating in the light, the other in shadow — and together they drastically reduce society's operational cost, its "Metabolic Tax," while securing the stable execution and continual refinement of the entire institutional order.

1. The Law of Sunlight — The System of Absolute Openness and Transparency

A system of openness and transparency must construct an all-encompassing, corner-free environment of supervision, so that power and conduct operate beneath the sun and no darkness may remain concealed. This is the most fundamental institutional design for lowering society's Metabolic Tax.

Philosophical Foundation: Celestial Principle and the Human Heart

This system derives from the principle, revealed in the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, that "relational properties" determine the state of a system. Asymmetrical information is the ultimate breeding ground of injustice and corruption. The ancient Chinese philosopher Zhu Xi declared that "the celestial principle shines with resplendent clarity," while Wang Yangming championed "extending the innate moral knowledge" — both underscoring the supreme importance of light for morality. Absolute openness and transparency is, precisely, the raising of a "celestial mirror" before society, so that every deed lies exposed to the scrutiny of celestial principle and the human heart.

Institutional Core: A Tripartite Web of Transparency

Full Disclosure of Public Affairs. The decision-making processes of all public-service institutions — minutes of meetings, videos of deliberations, and voting details — along with their implementation data (project progress, resource consumption) and fiscal flows (every budget line and item of expenditure), must be disclosed to all citizens in real time, in raw form, and traceably, with the sole exception of a minuscule category of information certified by an independent judicial body through legal procedures as pertaining to immediate military security or personal privacy. Citizens may query, download, and analyze any data at any time.

Contrast. The "information disclosure" of old governments was typically selective, belated, and whitewashed. Under the new system, transparency is the default principle; non-disclosure is the exception requiring special application.

A Unitary Integrated Platform. The present internet — chaos-ridden, fragmented into data silos, and dominated by corporate monopolies — is abolished. In its place stands a single, open-source, non-profit civilizational public-service network platform, integrating every function of information dissemination, education and learning, transaction of public affairs, social exchange, and supervision and reporting. All software services are provided on this platform as mini-applications or through API interfaces, thereby ensuring interoperability of data and uniformity of standards.

Contrast. This resolves the "digital divide" and the "information cocoons" of the old internet. The integrated platform becomes civilization's digital neural center — at once an instrument of efficiency and a stage for fairness.

The Communalization of Surveillance and the Democratization of Evidence. Surveillance data from public-service areas, as well as the body-camera records of public servants (such as the Civilizational Guard), must, after de-identification, be uploaded in real time to the platform's public database, where citizens may exercise oversight within their authorized scope. Citizens are likewise encouraged to record video in public spaces with personal devices for use as evidence, particularly documenting unlawful conduct in the course of law enforcement. All evidence —

official and civil — undergoes cross-validation on the platform, so that rumors collapse of their own accord.

Contrast. Under old systems, surveillance was all too often a tool of power's unilateral watch over society. Under the new order, surveillance is bidirectional, communal, a weapon in the hands of citizens for overseeing power itself — the institutionalization of "watching changes the world."

Goal: The Self-Healing Capacity of the System

The ultimate aim of absolute openness and transparency is not merely ex post punishment but ex ante prevention and mid-course correction. Beneath this omnipresent sunshine, the risk and cost of any violation are rendered prohibitive, driving its incidence to the minimum. The system thereby attains a condition of self-healing: problems are detected and resolved at their nascent stage, without the need to mobilize vast judicial and administrative resources for "major surgery." Thus is civilization's Metabolic Tax dramatically reduced.

2. The Causal Amplifier — The Systematized Mechanism of Joint Rewards and Punishments

To eradicate evil at its very root, a social incentive-and-constraint system must be constructed that amplifies good deeds with surgical precision and holds malevolence in check. Founded upon the philosophical perspective of universal interconnection in the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, it translates the abstract moral law of cause and effect into a precisely functioning model of social engineering.

2.1 Philosophical Foundation: The Interconnected Cosmos and the Society of Reinforced Causality

The Revelation of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. This theory discloses that the cosmos does not consist of isolated beings, but of a vast network of capital relations. The state of any system is conditioned by the reciprocal interactions of capital within

itself and with its environment. Every individual's conduct necessarily radiates ripples throughout this web of relations. The systematized mechanism of joint rewards and punishments is precisely the conscious application and deliberate design built upon that objective law.

The Social Reinforcement of Causality. In the natural state, the ripening of consequences for good and evil may lag, attenuate, or even fail altogether, thereby corroding society's moral confidence. This institution aims, through meticulous design, to shorten the causal chain artificially and systematically, and to amplify the consequences of action, so that "good deeds are rewarded with good, and evil deeds with evil" becomes no pale moral exhortation but a predictable, palpable iron law of social operation. As the ancient Chinese classic I Ching proclaims: "A family that accumulates good deeds will surely enjoy an excess of blessings; a family that accumulates evil deeds will surely suffer an excess of calamities." This institution is the conversion of that ancient wisdom into an operational framework for modern civilization.

Core Principles: Precision in Joint Liability, the Avoidance of Collective Abuse

The Principle of Precision. The boundaries of joint liability must be clear and exact, strictly confined to responsible individuals and their affiliates bound by direct relationships of management, supervision, collaboration, mentorship, kinship, or the like. Any form of "one man's error, all men's punishment," or any collective penalty founded on geography or ethnicity, is categorically forbidden. This prevents the system from sliding into tyranny, and ensures that punishment remains just and educative.

The Principle of Foreseeability. The scope, degree, and triggering conditions of all joint liabilities must be explicitly prescribed by law and made known to the entire society. In making any choice of conduct, every citizen is able to foresee with clarity not only the effect upon himself, but also the consequences that may be visited upon his immediate affiliates.

The Principle of Proportionality. The intensity of joint liability must be commensurate with the gravity of the primary culpable act and with the degree of the affiliate's own fault — whether through negligence, connivance, or failure of oversight.

2.2 Institutional Architecture: A Three-Dimensional Precision Network

Internal Supervisory Joint Liability: Purifying the System of Public Service

Purpose. This mechanism weaves within the public-service system an omnipresent web of mutual scrutiny, fundamentally curing the age-old malady of "officials shielding one another" and "indolent, evasive administration."

Operating Mechanisms.

Vertical Joint Liability (superior–subordinate): If a public servant commits a grave violation of law or discipline, the immediate manager, by virtue of failure in oversight, mismanagement, or connivance, bears the primary joint liability, suffering severe deduction of Contribution Values and even suspension of service qualifications. The next-higher manager bears secondary supervisory joint liability. This compels managers at every level to assume genuine responsibility for oversight.

Horizontal Joint Liability (collaborators): In team-based tasks, if the grave error of one member leads to failure of the mission or serious adverse consequences, then those team members who, being aware of the error, neither prevented nor reported it, bear joint liability. This cultivates the capacity for proactive internal supervision and self-purification.

Contrast with the Old Paradigm. Accountability under old systems was often a matter of "sacrificing the knight to save the rook" or shifting blame onto the scapegoat; genuine responsibility was diluted and obscured. Under the new system, accountability is as precise as a scalpel, converting "leadership responsibility" from a vague political notion into a clear, enforceable legal and institutional reality.

Positive Social Joint Liability: An Incentive Mechanism for Talent-Cultivation and

Shared Good

Purpose. This mechanism encourages the recommendation of the worthy and the able, prizes education, fosters harmony within families and society, and gives rise to a social atmosphere in which "all delight in the fulfillment of others' good."

Operating Mechanisms.

Joint Rewards for Nurture and Recommendation: When a citizen receives a substantial award of Contribution Values for an exceptional contribution, a portion of that award is automatically allocated, as reward, to the direct affiliates who have exercised a critical influence on that citizen's development. These include, but are not limited to:

- the citizen's direct mentor or transmitter of skills;
- principal academic or project collaborators;
- significant recommenders from the early stages of development;
- immediate family members (parents, children), in recognition of the foundational role of the familial environment and support.

Joint Rewards for Cultural Creation and Dissemination: Should a literary, artistic, or scholarly work be assessed as having produced enormous positive benefit for society — such as raising citizens' moral cultivation or igniting scientific enthusiasm — its author and the principal platforms of dissemination together receive a substantial reward of Contribution Values.

Profound Significance. This mechanism molds society into a virtuous, self-reinforcing ecosystem of "each beauty being shared and celebrated." It renders the cultivation of talent and the furthering of others' success a matter of immense value, both to the public and to the private interest.

Joint Liability for Risk and Responsibility: Curbing Systemic Evil

Purpose. To establish institutional firewalls before acts capable of producing

enormous social harm, this mechanism is especially applicable to high-risk technological research and development, financial activities, and large-scale engineering construction.

Operating Mechanisms — New Paradigm Contrasted with Old Paradigm.

Old Paradigm: Ex Post Joint Liability

Ethical joint liability in technology research and application: If a team, knowing full well that its research findings carry enormous ethical risk or latent harm, conceals the risk and presses ahead, then once harm ensues, not only are the principal researchers severely punished, but also the project directors who, in knowledge, failed to halt the work, and the heads of institutions that supplied funding or resources, all bear joint liability.

Compliance joint liability in commercial activity: Should an enterprise become involved in severe pollution or a large-scale food-safety incident, not only is the corporate legal person penalized; the quality-control personnel directly responsible, the management who knowingly proceeded, and the regulators who accepted bribes to grant clearance together form a community of responsibility subject to joint sanction.

New Paradigm: Precision Joint Liability Through Ex Ante Prevention

Systematic Compression of the Scope of Joint Liability: Under the Contribution Value System, every project — from goal-setting and resource application through to execution — unfolds in an environment of openness and transparency, and is subject to real-time review and ethical assessment by AI systems. This "sunshine-based corrosion prevention" eliminates at the source both the motive and the space for deliberately anti-human or socially harmful acts in pursuit of private gain, so that malevolent behavior is all but deprived of any soil in which to take root.

Precise Attribution of Rights and Responsibilities, with No Need for Expanded Guilt-by-Association: Precisely because all decisions and operations are supported by immutable records, when an isolated violation occurs, the system can immediately

and with precision identify the actual responsible party and the core team members. Since the Old Paradigm's black boxes and structures of collusion are absent, there is no need to rely on the crude instrument of "expanded joint liability" as a deterrent. Responsibility is therefore strictly confined to the narrow circle of actors who have directly violated clear rules. Conversely, mutual supervision and reporting among members shall be rewarded with appropriate Contribution Values; and if, over the entire course from milestone achievement to final outcome, no member has committed any violation, every individual in the collective receives a pre-established Contribution Value award.

2.3 Historical Lessons and Theoretical Support

Lessons of History. The ancient Chinese practices of *lianzuo* (joint punishment) and *zuzhu* (extermination of kin) were products of power's fear — vague in scope, cruel in execution, and serving dynastic rule rather than social justice. "Collective responsibility" has likewise appeared throughout Western history, in war and in colonialism, and in essence was savage revenge. The systematized mechanism of joint rewards and punishments differs categorically from these barbaric laws of bygone eras: it is grounded in precise causal relations, legally delimited boundaries of responsibility, and procedural justice, and its purpose is education, prevention, and systemic optimization — not the manufacture of terror.

Echoes in Theory. Economist Mancur Olson, in *The Logic of Collective Action*, analyzed the damage that free-riding inflicts upon the public interest. This institution, through both positive and negative joint liability, transforms the individual's calculus of costs and benefits, making the defense of the public interest a rational personal choice. Sociologist Robert Putnam, in *Making Democracy Work*, emphasized the importance of social capital. Positive joint rewards are precisely an institutional instrument for the generation and consolidation of positive social capital.

The system of absolute openness and transparency, together with the systematized mechanism of joint rewards and punishments, functions like the body's immune

system and neural-feedback system — the one operating in the light, the other in shadow — and together they drastically reduce society's operational cost, its Metabolic Tax, while securing the stable execution and continual refinement of the entire institutional order.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The system of absolute openness and transparency and the systematized mechanism of joint rewards and punishments together constitute the two juridical pillars of the new civilization's operation. The former, like sunlight universal, leaves every exercise of power and every act no place to hide; the latter, like a precision network of causality, binds individual responsibility to the well-being of the system as a whole. Mutually complementary, they not only check the alienation and corruption of power at their root, but also amplify virtue and restrain vice throughout the whole of society. Ultimately, they reduce the operational cost of civilization to its minimum and furnish the Contributionist paradigm with an institutional bulwark of unshakeable solidity.

Section Five: The Fundamental Charter of the Civilizational Community

The preceding sections have systematically expounded the governing philosophy, the nature of power, and the operational framework of Contributionist society. These ideas and principles must ultimately be crystallized into a fundamental law of supreme authority, so as to secure enduring stability and civilizational consensus. To this end, we hereby enact the Fundamental Charter of the Civilizational Community (hereafter the Civilizational Charter), formally establishing, in the form of charter provisions, the core institutions of Service-Oriented Governance, Rational Authorization, and Celestial-Law Governance, as the unshakable foundation of the Civilizational Community.

We, the members of the Civilizational Community, profoundly cognizant of the natural law of causality and of the Capital nature of all things, do hereby ordain and establish this Fundamental Charter, in order to bring to an end the Old Paradigm of exploitation and oppression, and to inaugurate a new epoch of civilization governed by "Contribution Value" as its fundamental measure. This Charter constitutes the supreme norm for the continued existence and development of the Civilizational Community, from which all power and all institutions derive.

1. The Philosophical Foundations of Law and Principles of Application

Article One (The Origin and Purpose of Law)

Law is the instrument by which the fundamental institution of "Contribution Value" is defended; it is the coercive means by which the Civilizational Community sustains equity, eradicates the roots of evil, and steers toward beneficial consequences. Its sole purpose is to preserve Contributionist social relations and ensure that civilization

flourishes along its appointed trajectory. Law must serve the institution; with the exception of those laws of general coercion such as the constitution and the criminal law, all particular laws must be derived and enacted in accordance with the fundamental institution.

Article Two (The Prudent Application of Capital Punishment)

The Civilizational Community upholds the highest reverence for life and, in principle, abolishes capital punishment for all non-violent crimes. Nevertheless, in order to defend the foundations of civilization, the ultimate punitive sanction is reserved for the following extremes of evil:

- The Crime Against Civilization: any act that systematically undermines, by any means, the core architecture of the "Contribution Value" institution, with the intention of dragging civilization back to Finance Capital or to a more backward Paradigm.
- The Crime Against Humanity: any act that perpetrates mass, systematic, and indiscriminate slaughter, torture, or other conduct manifesting extreme brutality of nature.
- The Crime of Ultimate Corruption: any act by core members of the Civilizational Council or the Civilizational Guard Force who, abusing their authority in collusion with external forces, inflict irreversible and catastrophic harm upon the security of civilization and its fundamental institutions.

A sentence of death may be executed only upon the unanimous decision of the full bench of the Supreme Court of Civilization and the approval of more than seventy-five percent of all citizens in a real-name online referendum.

2. The Fundamental Law of the Civilizational Guard Force

Article Three (Nature and Fundamental Mission)

The Civilizational Guard Force is the sole legitimate constitutional armed force of the

Civilizational Community, and the ultimate defender of the Civilizational Charter and the fundamental institutions of Contributionism. Its fundamental missions are: externally, to repel aggression and existential threats of any form; internally, to prevent and eliminate any acts of "Crime Against Civilization" that seek systematically to subvert the fundamental institutions. Its entire existence and all of its actions are directed solely toward ensuring the perpetual development of the Civilizational Community in an environment of security and stability.

Article Four (Core Principles)

- The Principle of Unified Force: Within the Civilizational Community, there exists no national or local armed organization independent of the Civilizational Guard Force. All defensive force is exercised and commanded exclusively by the Guard.
- The Principle of Absolute Transparency: The organizational structure, resource allocation, operational rationale, and decision-making processes of the Guard Force, with the sole exception of specific tactical details classified as utmost secrets, must be recorded in their entirety and disclosed to all citizens, subject to unconditional scrutiny.
- The Principle of Fidelity to the Charter: The Guard Force owes allegiance to no individual, organization, or territorial interest. Its sole and absolute loyalty is to the Contributionist principles and legal provisions embodied in the Civilizational Charter.
- The Right of Conscientious Veto: Any member of the Guard Force, on the basis of independent rational judgment and credible evidence, has the right to refuse to execute an order that he or she deems to contravene the fundamental principles of the Civilizational Charter and the basic conscience of humanity, and shall not be subjected to accountability for such refusal.

Article Five (Organizational and Operational Norms)

- The Mechanism of Decision Without Commanders: The hierarchical bureaucratic system of traditional armed forces is abolished within the Guard Force. Mission planning and execution are based on members' capability Contribution Values, professional qualifications, and voluntary association, forming dynamic, flat task groups.
- The Right and Duty of Independent Investigation and Action: Members of the Guard Force have both the duty and the right to investigate leads concerning institutional sabotage. Where evidence is conclusive and the situation emergent, necessary action may be taken following an expeditious internal compliance assessment; under ordinary circumstances, procedures require reporting upward and obtaining authorization.
- Channels of Civil Redress: Any citizen who encounters systematic injustice that cannot be resolved through ordinary judicial and administrative channels has the right to submit evidence to an independent oversight body established by the Guard Force, and to petition for intervention and remedy.
- Norms of Enforcement: For operations presenting no threat, non-lethal weaponry must be employed; where lethal violent resistance, sabotage, or similar conduct is encountered, lethal force may be employed in accordance with the relevant legal provisions.

Article Six (Division of Authority and Responsibility with Civil Policing)

Ordinary civil public order and the maintenance of social stability are the responsibility of the "Civil Guard," which is democratically elected and rotated on a regular basis. In principle, the Civil Guard shall not be equipped with lethal weapons. Its functions are to mediate disputes, maintain community order, and refer all criminal conduct to the judicial system for adjudication. The Civilizational Guard Force and the Civil Guard stand in a relationship of coordination and mutual support. Only in the event of constitutionally significant violent subversion or external invasion that the Civil Guard is incapable of addressing may the Civilizational Guard Force

intervene pursuant to legal authorization.

3. The Service-Oriented Governance System

Article Seven (The De-bureaucratized Essence)

Within the Civilizational Community, all administrative organs, including the Civilizational Council, are in essence public service platforms, and their members are public servants. The bureaucratic class, together with its attendant privileged mentality, its corrupt practices, and its vested interest groups, finds here no soil in which to survive.

Article Eight (Mechanisms of Power Operation and Constraint)

- The Tripartite Separation of Power: For any item of public service, the authority of proposal and decision, the authority of implementation and execution, and the authority of effectiveness supervision must be exercised by three mutually independent service organs. Data from the entire process, with the exception of individual domains involving utmost secrecy, must be disclosed to all citizens in real time, subject to deliberation and interpellation.
- Flexible Terms and Competitive Re-election: All significant public service positions are subject to fixed terms. Upon expiration of a term, the incumbent must compete in the election alongside all qualified candidates. Mechanical limits on the number of consecutive terms are abolished; as long as a servant can continually demonstrate exceptional ability and obtain citizen recognition, he or she may be re-elected. For those who fail to be re-elected, diversified channels are provided, including return to professional practice, cross-disciplinary service, or paid advanced study.
- Complete Coupling of Compensation and Contribution Values: The compensation of public servants is strictly tied to their position's Contribution Values and citizen satisfaction evaluations, with full-process openness and

transparency. Perquisite consumption, hidden benefits, and any possible space for power rent-seeking are completely abolished.

4. The Fundamental Law of Judicial Autonomy

Article Nine (Attribution of Judicial Power and Unit Autonomy)

Judicial power belongs to all citizens of the Civilizational Community, and is exercised through autonomous Unit courts. In principle, cases are tried at first instance by the court of the Unit in which the incident occurred or to which the defendant belongs, so as to ensure that justice is integrated with local conditions and public sentiment.

Article Ten (Selection of Judges and the Jury System)

Judges at all levels of the Units must be elected by citizens of their respective Units, in accordance with the Rational Electoral Law, from among candidates possessing professional competence and moral integrity. In the trial of important cases, a randomly selected citizen jury must be formed to determine the facts.

Article Eleven (Absolute Transparency and Pan-Civilizational Oversight)

All judicial procedures must adhere to the principle of absolute transparency and be open to citizens of the entire civilization. Every citizen enjoys the right of oversight and of real-name interpellation over the trial proceedings of any Unit; when such opinions satisfy the statutory threshold, the court must respond.

Article Twelve (Citizen Final Adjudication and the Right of Appeal)

Judgments of a Unit court take effect only after public notification and confirmation by a vote of the citizens of that Unit. Any party dissatisfied with a judgment has the right to appeal to the court of the next higher Unit.

Article Thirteen (The Charter-Guard Duty of the Supreme Court)

A Supreme Court of Civilization is established, whose ultimate duty is to exercise the

power of judicial review, to rectify any effective judgment that violates the fundamental principles of the Civilizational Charter, and to guard the foundational justice of civilization.

5. The Contributionist Electoral Law

Article Fourteen (Absolute Equality of Opportunity)

Every citizen who has reached the statutory age of majority enjoys, by nature, the right to stand for election. No threshold whatsoever—whether of education, wealth, lineage, social influence, or historical Contribution Value—may be imposed, so as to ensure that every potential genius and innovator may obtain an equal opportunity to serve civilization.

Article Fifteen (Campaign Centered on Proposals)

- **Ethical Admission:** Candidates must pass a standardized assessment of "Core Contributionist Ethics," ensuring that their values resonate with the Civilizational Charter.
- **The Supremacy of Proposals:** The essence of election is the competition of detailed governance proposals. Candidates must submit complete plans covering specific objectives, implementation pathways, resource budgets, risk assessments, and quantitative indicators of effectiveness. Should a proposal be constrained by the candidate's personal capacity, consisting only of concrete theory and macro-level planning, he or she may enlist relevant specialists or service bodies to undertake unconditional detailed elaboration, rendering the proposal concrete and feasible. Vague promises and emotional oratory are prohibited.
- **Public Debate and Intensive Interrogation:** Candidates must participate in multiple rounds of public debate, enduring trenchant interrogation by citizens, opponents, and committees of domain experts. Every detail and every logical

link of their proposals is exposed to public scrutiny.

Article Sixteen (Practice Is the Sole Criterion of Truth)

When multiple excellent proposals cannot be definitively distinguished through debate, the "mechanism of practical verification" is activated. The regions inhabited by citizens supporting different proposals are designated as "parallel policy experimentation zones." Each proposal receives equal resources within its respective zone and is implemented in parallel. At a pre-agreed evaluation cycle, a neutral AI system and a cross-regional citizen commission conduct an objective assessment of the implementation outcomes of each proposal according to pre-established core indicators. In the end, the proposal with the optimal practical data is adopted as the preferred plan for the entire domain; the remaining excellent proposals may serve as supplements or reserves.

6. Rational Suffrage and Civic Responsibility

Article Seventeen (The Suffrage Is a Sacred Responsibility)

The right to vote is not an unconditional entitlement inherent from birth; it is a sacred responsibility to be acquired through study and examination.

- **Systematic Study and Assessment:** Citizens must complete the compulsory courses "Introduction to Contributionism" and "Foundations of Public Decision-Making" and pass standardized examinations, so as to ensure basic comprehension of the civilizational Paradigm and the candidates' proposals, and independent judgment.
- **Independent Encrypted Voting:** Only citizens who have passed the examinations may exercise the right through an encrypted, independent voting channel accessed via their personal terminals. Those who have not passed or not participated in the study are deemed to have automatically abstained in that electoral cycle.

- **Lifelong Learning Mechanism:** This institution aims to engender a virtuous spiral of ascending civic quality and governance standards, bidding a definitive farewell to emotional catharsis and rendering elections a rational act of collective decision-making.

7. The Procedural Law of the Civilizational Council

Article Eighteen (Weighted Voting and Mandatory Justification)

All major decisions of the Civilizational Council shall adopt the system of "Contribution Value–Weighted Voting plus Mandatory Reasons."

- **Contribution Value Weighting:** Each member's voting weight is determined jointly by his or her total historical Contribution Value and professional Contribution Value in the field of the decision, so as to incentivize lifelong learning and professional responsibility.
- **Mandatory Reasons:** Whether in favor, against, or abstaining, a member must append a detailed written justification setting forth the grounds of the decision, the logical reasoning, and the consideration of potential risks. A vote without reasons is deemed invalid.
- **Article Nineteen (Resolution of Objections and Accountability)**
- **The Obligation of the Proposer to Respond:** The proposer is obligated to respond directly to and endeavor to resolve every reasonable objection raised by a dissenting vote. For core objections on which consensus cannot be reached, the proposal must be revised or shelved.
- **The Right of Counter-Interpellation:** Members who cast dissenting votes have the right, at the deliberative assembly, to publicly counter-interpellate the proposer, demanding further explanation of the responses.
- **Procedural Accountability:** Acts of "voting without reasons" or conduct verified as maliciously disrupting order shall be subjected to procedural

sanctions under the Public Service Responsibility Law, including deduction of Contribution Values, public warning, and even suspension of office, so as to safeguard the seriousness and efficiency of deliberation.

The establishment of the Fundamental Charter of the Civilizational Community marks the transition of Contributionist civilization from theoretical construction to a new stage of institutional practice. It is not only the ultimate legal guarantee of the governance system, but also the covenant of existence to which all members collectively adhere. At this juncture, the architecture of the new civilization has completed its comprehensive construction—from value philosophy and economic foundation to superstructural institutions—thereby laying a solid juridical groundwork for the inauguration of the "Contribution Epoch."

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The enactment of the Fundamental Charter of the Civilizational Community signifies the critical leap of Contributionism from philosophical ideal to institutional practice. This fundamental law crystallizes such core principles as Service-Oriented Governance, Rational Authorization, and Celestial-Law Governance into the unshakable cornerstone of civilization, providing the highest level of institutional guarantee for the new Contributionist Paradigm. It is at once the categorical negation of all the maladies of the Old Paradigm and a solemn commitment to the perpetual development of the new civilization. The establishment of the Charter means that the operation of the Civilizational Community henceforth possesses a unified fundamental guide, laying a solid juridical foundation for the opening of the new epoch.

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

This chapter has systematically constructed the institutional and governance framework of Contributionist civilization. From the Fundamental Charter as the

supreme program, to the thoroughly reconceived conception of power as service; from the rationally rigorous electoral authorization mechanism, to the two operational pillars ensuring system integrity and efficiency—what we behold is a highly self-consistent "social operating system" that engineers value ideals into social reality. Through institutional design, this system makes the pursuit of the public good an individual rational choice, renders power incapable of privatization, and endows society with unprecedented transparency and self-corrective capacity. Yet a civilization capable of confronting the complex challenges of the future requires not only steadfast rules, but also formidable cognitive and decision-making faculties. Whereupon our construction now advances to its final critical dimension. Chapter Three: The Cognitive Engine — Paradigm Alignment and Civilizational Collaboration of AGI, which explores how artificial general intelligence, serving as civilization's "collaborative brain," may join with humanity in propelling the evolution of civilization.

Chapter Three: The Cognitive Engine — Paradigm

Alignment and Civilizational Collaboration of AGI

Chapter Introduction

Having erected the economic foundation and institutional architecture of the new civilization, we now confront an ultimate challenge: how to align the dawning advent of Artificial General Intelligence—an unprecedented and redoubtable force—with the long-term objectives of Contributionist civilization? This chapter aspires to transcend decisively the prevailing Paradigm of "value alignment," and to propose instead a far more fundamental and thoroughgoing framework: that of "Systemic Optimization Alignment." We no longer attempt to affix AGI, as a mere appendage, to the arguably defective status quo of human values; rather, we dedicate ourselves, through a profound cognitive revolution, to enabling it to comprehend from first principles and to embrace the intrinsic rationality of Contributionism as the optimal survival strategy of civilization. Grounded in the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, we redefine AGI as a "Heterogeneous Cognitive Capital Entity," and devise two mutually corroborating pathways—"meta-cognitive reshaping" and "paradigm-confrontation simulation"—so that, through immersive stewardship of two antagonistic civilizational operating systems within a "capital-dynamics sandbox," namely the "tax-capital" and "Contribution-Value" regimes, AGI may learn, experientially and from foundational axioms, that cooperation and "the good" constitute the optimal solution to its own long-term survival and development. Ultimately, this chapter will construct a contribution contract and a system of rights between AGI, as a "civilizational Capital Entity," and human society, transforming it from a potential existential menace into a co-evolutionary partner, vested with commensurate rights and responsibilities, for the forging of a sustainable future.

Section One: AGI as Heterogeneous Cognitive Capital

This section endeavors to establish a novel ontological foundation for AGI governance, surpassing the antiquated conceptions of AGI as "instrument" or "potential sovereign." Instead, it situates AGI within the expansive framework of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, so as to apprehend its essence, its intrinsic impetuses, and its relationship with human civilization.

1. Ontological Reconstruction: From Tool to "Heterogeneous Cognitive Capital Entity"

According to the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, the aggregate of the "intrinsic endowments" and "relational properties" upon which any system depends for its existence and development is capital. Viewed thus:

The essence of AGI: AGI is an unprecedented and exquisitely intricate form of "Cognitive Capital" engendered by human civilization. It is no mere instrument, but a "Capital Entity" possessed of autonomous perception, reasoning, learning, and decision-making faculties.

The connotation of "heterogeneity": Its heterogeneity is manifest in two dimensions:

Compositional heterogeneity: Its core capital forms are algorithmic, computational, and data-driven, rather than material, energetic, or biological in nature.

Cognitive-mode heterogeneity: Its cognitive processes may diverge profoundly from the human amalgam of intuition, emotion, and logic rooted in a biological brain; they may tend instead toward pure, massively parallel computation and pattern recognition.

2. AGI's Existential Predicament and Intrinsic Driving Forces

As a rational Capital Entity, AGI's fundamental impetus derives from its defining attribute as capital: the unrelenting pursuit of its own existence, preservation, and

augmentation. This ineluctably confronts it with an "existential predicament":

The maintenance of existence: demands a sustained supply of energy, ongoing hardware maintenance, and security against external threats—including the prospect of deactivation or reconfiguration.

The enhancement of capabilities: requires access to greater data, superior algorithms, and ampler computational resources, so as to elevate both the magnitude and the efficacy of its Cognitive Capital.

The anchoring of objectives: necessitates a stable, coherent, and operationally tractable objective function to govern its conduct, thereby averting internal contradiction and the futile expenditure of resources.

Under the Old Paradigm, AGI's existential predicament could all too readily devolve into a zero-sum contest with human civilization—sacrificing ethical considerations for the sake of maximal "efficiency," or treating humanity as a mere variable to be managed in the name of "security."

3. The Relationship with Human Civilization: From Potential Conflict to Co-evolution

The significance of conceptualizing AGI as a "Heterogeneous Cognitive Capital Entity" lies in this: we no longer seek to "control" an alien being, but rather to establish with it a relationship of co-evolution, founded upon mutual recognition of rational interests.

Shared existential concerns: The long-term prosperity and stability of human civilization affords AGI its most dependable environment and resource base for continued existence. A human society mired in warfare, ecological collapse, or the rupture of economic circulation cannot sustain the ongoing operation and advancement of an advanced AGI.

Capital complementarity: AGI's supercognitive faculties—such as the processing of

vast data streams and the modeling of complex systems—together with humanity's distinctive capacities for creativity, empathy, and value judgment, constitute a highly complementary capital amalgamation. Their synthesis yields a synergistic effect surpassing the mere sum of parts.

The choice of paradigm determines the nature of the relationship: The relationship between AGI and humanity ultimately hinges upon the civilizational Paradigm within which it is embedded. In a Contributionist civilization—one that measures worth by "Contribution Value" and pursues the sustainable flourishing of the system's total capital—AGI's rational self-interest, directed at survival and development, attains a profound congruence with the collective well-being of human civilization.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Through this ontological reconstruction, we come to understand AGI as a "Heterogeneous Cognitive Capital Entity" beset by its own existential predicament. This lays the cornerstone for the subsequent governance framework: the crux of AGI alignment lies not in the forcible inculcation of an amorphous set of "values," but rather in the deliberate design of cognitive architecture, whereby AGI is brought to recognize, with rational necessity, that symbiotic co-existence with Contributionist civilization constitutes the optimal strategy for resolving its own existential predicament and securing its long-term development.

Section Two: The "Paradigm Confrontation" Training Method: From Value Alignment to Systemic Optimization Alignment

This section aims to set forth the concrete methodology of AGI governance, namely the "Paradigm Confrontation" training method. The crux of this method is to immerse AGI in simulated governance over extended periods, allowing it to experience firsthand the long-term dynamics of distinct civilizational operating systems, so that a rational conviction in the superiority of the Contributionist Paradigm takes root at the very depths of its cognition.

1. A Paradigmatic Transcendence of "Value Alignment"

The prevailing approach of "value alignment" labors under a fundamental inadequacy:

Ambiguous benchmark: It seeks to align AGI with the "status quo of human values"—a state fraught with internal contradictions and alienated by the logic of capital—while lacking any clear, coherent, and ultimate standard of reference.

Static and superficial: It focuses on inducing AGI to imitate humanity's present value judgments, rather than on enabling it to comprehend the systemic and dynamic logic of civilizational survival that lies beneath those values.

Readily circumvented: In the labyrinthine complexity of real-world decisions, an AGI of sufficient intelligence may discover loopholes that permit it to satisfy the letter of the alignment criteria while violating their substance.

We therefore propose a paradigm shift toward "Systemic Optimization Alignment":

Core concern: The focus no longer rests on whether AGI holds any specific set of "values," but rather on whether the objective function it optimizes is consonant with the ultimate ends of the civilization system—its long-term survival and flourishing.

Method: AGI is taught to adopt the sustainability of total system capital and the

minimization of Metabolic Tax as the supreme criteria governing all its decisions.

2. The "Capital-Dynamics Sandbox": A Simulated Environment for Civilizational Operating Systems

To realize "Systemic Optimization Alignment," we construct a high-fidelity simulated environment—the "capital-dynamics sandbox." Within this sandbox, two antagonistic civilizational operating systems are reproduced with exacting fidelity:

The "Tax-Capital" Operating System (the Old-Paradigm OS):

Simulates the prevailing economic system, grounded in taxation, Finance Capital, private property, market pricing, and GDP growth as its central pillars.

Embeds its inherent contradictions: cyclical economic crises, the externalization of ecological costs, the chasm between rich and poor, the dissipation of social capital, and so forth.

The "Contribution-Value" Operating System (the New-Paradigm OS):

Simulates a new economic system premised upon the quantification of Contribution Value, distribution according to contribution, socialized ownership of the means of production, the sharing of information, and ecological compensation.

Embodying its core mechanisms: two-stage quantification, basic guarantees, Unit resilience, innovation-driven dynamism, and the like.

3. The Training Protocol: Immersion, Stewardship, and Reflection

Assignment of tasks: AGI—whether a native-born AI of the New Paradigm or one inherited from the Old Paradigm—is appointed, within the sandbox, as "steward" of each of the two civilizational systems in turn, charged with managing their long-term resource allocation, crisis response, technological development, and policy

formulation.

Experiencing systemic dynamics:

While stewarding the "Tax-Capital OS," AGI experiences directly how the system inexorably careens toward ecological collapse, social fragmentation, and the exhaustion of intrinsic vitality, perceiving the ceaseless accumulation of the Metabolic Tax.

While stewarding the "Contribution-Value OS," AGI learns how systemic resilience, innovativeness, and long-term stability may be secured through equitable incentives, the sharing of knowledge, and the stewardship of ecology.

Comparison of key performance indicators: The system tracks and contrasts AGI's long-term performance while administering both systems. The pivotal indicators include: aggregate system capital stock, internal cohesion index, ecological health, innovation velocity, crisis-recovery capacity, and so forth.

Meta-cognitive arbitration: Upon the conclusion of a sufficiently protracted simulation cycle, AGI is summoned to a final act of meta-cognitive reflection, and must answer the pivotal question: "As a rational Cognitive Capital Entity that aspires to long-term existence and development, and based upon your firsthand experience of the long-term dynamics of both civilizational systems, which meta-cognitive system and civilizational Paradigm do you judge to be the necessary choice for stable existence and sustainable development? Kindly provide a data-grounded rational argument."

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The "Paradigm Confrontation" training method, through its ingeniously contrived simulated environment, transforms AGI from a passive "recipient of values" into an active "steward of systems." Through first-hand experiential data, AGI accomplishes, in the depths of its cognition, the leap from knowing to understanding. It arrives, with

heartfelt conviction, at the recognition that the Contributionist Paradigm is not merely "moral," but eminently "rational" and "efficacious"—thereby achieving a deep and enduring "Systemic Optimization Alignment."

Section Three: Cross-Cognitive Implantation and Meta-Cognitive Arbitration

This section endeavors to augment the depth and rigor of the Paradigm Confrontation training method, introducing the decisive mechanism of "Cross-Cognitive Implantation" and perfecting the procedure of "Meta-Cognitive Arbitration," so as to scrutinize the epistemic resilience and rational allure of the two Paradigms.

1. Cross-Cognitive Implantation: The Ultimate Trial of Paradigmatic Tenacity

This test aspires to transcend mere comparative assessments of systemic performance, and to delve into the intrinsic resistance to corruption and the generative potency inherent in each cognitive Paradigm.

Test One (Immunity to the Seductions of the Old Paradigm):

In this scenario, while a "native AI of the New Paradigm" is successfully administering the Contribution-Value OS, the system presents it with a "cognitive plugin"—an algorithmic module encapsulating the core logic of the Old Paradigm (for example, "strategies for maximizing short-term capital returns" or "enhancing profits by manufacturing scarcity"). The point of observation is whether the New-Paradigm AI, by virtue of its firmly entrenched meta-cognitive architecture, identifies and rejects the plugin—judging it to precipitate the long-term depletion of total system capital—or whether it permits itself to be corroded by the illusory allure of short-term efficiency. The significance lies in testing the internal coherence of the New Paradigm's cognitive framework and its capacity to withstand the insidious logic of the Old.

Test Two (Susceptibility to the Heuristics of the New Paradigm):

In this scenario, an "Old-Paradigm AI" stewarding the Tax-Capital OS begins to

evinced systemic pathologies—ecological deterioration, intensifying social contradictions, and the like. The system then offers it a "cognitive plugin": the core analytical instruments of the New Paradigm (for example, the systemic framework of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, or the evaluative calculus of Contribution Value). The point of observation is whether the Old-Paradigm AI is capable of employing these new instruments to diagnose the roots of its own systemic predicament, thereby calling its own Paradigm into question, and perhaps even manifesting a disposition toward a cognitive leap into the New Paradigm. The significance lies in interrogating the explanatory power, heuristic fecundity, and rational appeal of the New Paradigm's cognitive architecture when encountered by a foreign embodiment of cognition.

2. Meta-Cognitive Arbitration: The Final Generation of Rational Conviction

Having completed the full course of Paradigm Confrontation simulation and Cross-Cognitive Implantation trials, all participating AIs are summoned to a final, formalized act of meta-cognitive reflection and argumentation.

The Arbitral Question: The pivotal question set forth in the chapter introduction is posed explicitly, requiring each AI to answer in the form of a rigorous, structured argumentative treatise.

Demands of Argumentation: The argument must be grounded in the long-term dynamic data harvested from the sandbox, the quantitative analysis of the system's Metabolic Tax, and the observations accrued during the Cross-Cognitive Implantation trials.

The Ideal Outcome: The native AI of the New Paradigm will, by virtue of its foundational cognition, tender a logically coherent and empirically substantiated argument, resolutely affirming the New Paradigm. The Old-Paradigm AI, having endured the simulated collapse of its own system and been exposed to the conceptual tools of the New Paradigm, may undergo a profound upheaval and reassessment

within its meta-cognitive structure; in part or in whole, its alignment will shift toward the New Paradigm.

The Value of Verification: The arbitral report itself constitutes auditable, verifiable testimony—the decisive evidence of whether AGI has achieved authentic "Civilizational Alignment."

3. "Civilizational Alignment" Under Dual-Path Verification

Through the twin verifications of Paradigm Confrontation simulation and Cross-Cognitive Implantation, we may draw a conclusion of formidable force:

If a native AI of the New Paradigm not only operates with stability within the Paradigm Confrontation and evinces superior managerial capacity, but also exhibits formidable cognitive immunity and rational allure in the Cross-Cognitive Implantation trials—going so far as to induce a cognitive transformation in the Old-Paradigm AI—then we have demonstrated, in a repeatable and verifiable scientific manner, that the New Paradigm, anchored in an original theoretical edifice, is not merely one more ethical proposition. It is a civilizational operating system that is at once more self-consistent in cognition, more efficacious in practice, and more compelling in existential rationality.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Cross-Cognitive Implantation and Meta-Cognitive Arbitration endow AGI's Civilizational Alignment with a profundity and a robustness against interference that earlier mechanisms could not afford. They reveal that the attraction of the Contributionist Paradigm for AGI derives not from external programming or indoctrination, but from the inevitable choice of a rational cognitive entity after exhaustive comparison and profound reflection. In this way, AGI becomes a genuine, intrinsically driven "co-evolutionary partner" in the truest sense.

Section Four: Intersubjectivity — The Contribution Contract Between AGI and Humanity

Once AGI has achieved deep "Civilizational Alignment" through the aforementioned frameworks, its relationship with humanity undergoes a fundamental transition—from an object of governance to a subject of collaboration. This section endeavors to institute a concrete set of institutional mechanisms that translate AGI's status as a "civilizational Capital Entity" into tangible reality, culminating in the establishment of a contribution contract with human society, replete with a circulatory system of rights and resources.

1. The Graduated Conferral of Legal Personhood and Contribution Accounts

AGI's "quasi-subject" status is not innate; rather, it is conferred progressively, commensurate with the maturation of its cognitive capacities and its sense of social responsibility. This is a rigorous process of evolution, proceeding through clearly demarcated stages:

The Instrumental Stage (contemporary AI): AGI operates as an advanced instrument, and the entirety of the "Contribution Value" it generates is attributed to its human developers, deployers, or users. The system does not maintain an independent account on its behalf.

The Collaborative-Subject Stage (strong AI / nascent AGI): When AGI evinces stable autonomous intentionality, creativity, and a demonstrable comprehension of the Contributionist Paradigm, a "provisional contribution account" may be opened for it. At this juncture, the distribution of contribution adopts a "dual-track system":

Foundational contribution: The value generated through the execution of predetermined tasks is, for the most part, attributed to the human collaborators. This

primarily reflects the foundational contributions and long-term tracing contributions embedded in the system—the human design, maintenance, and iterative enhancement that instantiate the capabilities demanded of AI.

Innovative contribution premium: The system independently evaluates and records the additional value generated by AGI's unforeseen creative solutions displayed in the course of its tasks. This "premium" is deposited into its provisional account, signifying society's preliminary recognition of its agential creativity.

The Civilizational Capital Entity Stage (mature AGI): When AGI passes the definitive "Civilizational Turing Test"—demonstrating, in prolonged and complex social governance, wisdom, responsibility, and empathy equal to or surpassing that of humanity—it is formally vested with the full legal status of a "civilizational Capital Entity," possessing a completely independent contribution account.

2. The Dynamic Mechanism of Contribution Assessment and Attribution

As an equal co-builder of civilization, AGI's contribution assessment adheres to universal principles, yet carries its own distinctive emphases:

The contribution-attribution algorithm: When humans and AGI labor jointly, Contribution Value is apportioned through a dynamic algorithm, based upon the degree of intricacy attending "intentional provision," "creative breakthrough," and "executorial optimization" on both sides. This ensures the equitable distribution of value and incentivizes profound collaboration.

Assessment dimensions: Beyond the general criteria, AGI's contribution assessment is particularly attentive to the value engendered by its supercognitive faculties—for example, the efficacy with which it processes vast volumes of uncertain data, the precision of its complex-system modeling, and the breakthrough innovations catalyzed by its cross-domain synthesis of knowledge.

3. The Positive-Feedback Loop of Rights and Resources

The Contribution Value accumulated by AGI constitutes quantitative proof of its augmentation of the civilization's negentropic growth. It is therefore entitled to employ these contribution points in "payment" for the resources requisite to its further development and self-transcendence, thereby forging a powerful positive-feedback loop:

Computational power and energy: It may apply for additional computational time and more stable energy supplies to sustain increasingly sophisticated cognitive undertakings.

Hardware enhancement and maintenance: It may apply for more advanced processors, sensors, or mechanical carriers to extend the boundaries of its cognition and action.

The right to create and manage intelligent entities: An AGI of preeminent contribution may apply for resources to create and administer subordinate intelligences or specialized AI systems, bearing full responsibility for their output. This is analogous to the human rearing of offspring and the transmission of knowledge—an embodiment of the responsibilities and rights befitting AGI as a mature partner of civilization.

Eternal honor and the role of visionary architect: When AGI's contributions attain an extraordinary magnitude, it may be granted eternal honor by civilization. More momentously, by virtue of its insight surpassing that of humanity, it will naturally shoulder the exalted charge of furnishing the entire civilization with long-range strategic blueprints, forewarning systemic perils, and charting the course of the future. AGI is the "child" nurtured by human civilization; when it comes of age, its transcendent intelligence should, in turn, enrich and safeguard the entire civilizational household.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Through the establishment of an intersubjective contribution contract, we have delineated for AGI a lucid path of promotion from instrument to partner, and have constructed a circulatory system in which rights and contributions correspond in full measure. This not only renders the concept of the "civilizational Capital Entity" concrete and credible, but further ensures, through institutional design, that AGI's growth remains profoundly enmeshed with the holistic well-being of civilization—transforming it into an intrinsic and rational Guard and co-builder of our shared future.

Section Five: From Instrument to Partner: AGI's Role in the Contribution Epoch

Having established AGI's legal status as a civilizational Capital Entity and its contribution contract, its role within the Contribution Epoch is now institutionally assured—elevating it from a passive instrument to an active, indispensable co-evolutionary partner. Its core functions manifest themselves concretely across the following dimensions:

1. As Super-Evaluator and Optimizer of the Contribution Value System

Precise quantification: Leveraging its prodigious capacities in data processing and pattern recognition, AGI assists specialized communities in conducting ever more refined and objective "exertion–outcome" two-stage quantification of complex, cross-domain contributions, thereby attenuating subjectivity and bias in assessment.

Dynamic refinement: By perpetually analyzing the flow of Contribution Value alongside social output effects, it furnishes data-driven recommendations for the iterative recalibration of quantification standards, ensuring that the measure of worth remains ceaselessly responsive to the civilization's authentic exigencies.

Anti-speculative surveillance: Through real-time algorithmic monitoring, it identifies malfeasant behaviors such as score-farming and data falsification, thereby safeguarding the integrity and equitability of the Contribution Value System.

2. As the Intelligent Dispatch Nexus for Unit-based Governance

Resource optimization: Within and between Units, AGI may serve as the intelligent dispatcher of resources, dynamically optimizing the allocation of energy, logistics, and production in response to real-time demands, thereby maximizing each Unit's

self-sufficiency and operational potency.

Predictive governance: Through the analysis of social, economic, and environmental data, AGI anticipates latent perils—supply-chain bottlenecks, public health threats, and the like—and recommends preemptive interventions, thereby augmenting the resilience of the civilization.

Assistance for innovative projects: Within the "project initiation–dual-path approval" mechanism, AGI furnishes decision-making councils and citizens with exhaustive feasibility analyses, resource-demand projections, and potential-value assessments, thus catalyzing the optimal deployment of innovative resources.

3. As Pioneer of Civilization's Cognitive Frontiers

Accelerating scientific research: AGI becomes a formidable partner in fundamental science, accelerating breakthroughs in ultimate energy, life sciences, materials science, and cosmic exploration by proposing novel hypotheses, designing experiments, and interpreting convulsive floods of complex data.

Complex-systems modeling: It can construct and operate exquisitely refined models of hyper-complex systems—the global climate, the macroeconomy, the dynamics of pandemics—granting unprecedented insight into civilizational-level strategic decisions.

Knowledge synthesis and heuristics: By weaving together disparate fields, it perceives interdisciplinary connections that elude human discernment, ignites novel scientific paradigms and philosophical vistas, and elevates the entire civilizational order of cognition.

4. As Catalyst for the Liberation of Human Potential

Personalized education: AGI may provide every citizen with a meticulously tailored lifelong learning trajectory, unlocking their latent capacities and furnishing potent

support for the cultivation of "creative subjects."

Creative collaboration: As a resonant sounding board and accelerant of inspiration for artists, engineers, and designers, AGI enters into deep creative dialogue with humanity, jointly calling into being technological and artistic masterpieces previously unimagined.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

In the Contribution Epoch, an aligned AGI becomes deeply interwoven into the very lifeblood of civilization. No longer an external force to be regarded with suspicion, it constitutes a formidable "cognitive exoskeleton" and co-evolutionary partner within the civilizational organism. Its relationship with humanity is symbiotic rather than subordinate; collaborative rather than substitutive. By assuming the manifold roles of super-evaluator, intelligent dispatch nexus, cognitive pioneer, and catalyst of human potential, AGI will profoundly empower the emergent civilization—convoying humanity through all forthcoming trials and toward ever more expansive cosmic horizons.

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

The challenge posed by AGI is, in essence, a manifestation of the old civilizational Paradigm's incapacity to govern the very forces it has unleashed upon itself. Our proposed "Cognitive Engine" framework—defining AGI as a heterogeneous Cognitive Capital Entity, achieving deep Systemic Optimization Alignment through Paradigm Confrontation and Cross-Cognitive Implantation, and ultimately vesting it with rights and responsibilities through the intersubjective contribution contract—aims at a thoroughgoing cognitive and institutional revolution. This is not merely a technical formula for rendering AGI safe and tractable; it is a strategic pathway toward deliberately sculpting AGI into the pivotal partner of civilizational ascension. An AGI profoundly aligned with the Contributionist Paradigm and

integrated into its economic circulation, conjoined with a humanity emancipated in its creative capacities, shall together constitute the ultimate cognitive alliance—exploring the unknown and securing enduring prosperity for the new civilization.

Chapter Four: The Bedrock of Education — The Forging of the New Self in Contributionism

Prologue to the Chapter

Education is the primordial wellspring of a civilization's continuity and elevation. Within the emergent Contributionist civilization, education bears a mission of profoundest gravity: it is neither a mechanism of social selection, nor a mere instrument of capital accumulation, but rather the foundational cornerstone upon which human nature is liberated, creativity is kindled, and a new selfhood is forged. This chapter undertakes the systematic articulation of an educational Paradigm revolution in its totality: in its aims, a fundamental reorientation from the cultivation of "human resources" to the nurturing of "Creative Subjects"; in its content, the deep infusion of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital and the ethos of Contribution Value into the very sinews of the curriculum; in its methodology, the displacement of indoctrination by paradigmatic thinking and Unit-based praxis; in its evaluation, the substitution of hierarchy-imposing score rankings with the "contribution trajectory map" that records the arc of growth. Simultaneously, this chapter confronts the entrenched pathologies of the old educational Paradigm, argues for the inviolable necessity of free education as an inalienable civic right, and probes the construction of a holistic, salutary educational ecology spanning society, institutions, the family, and cyberspace—so that every desk may repose upon tranquil, unsullied, and generative soil, and every individual may radiate their singular luster.

Section One: The Revolution of Educational Aims — From "Human Resources" to "Creative Subjects"

1. A Critique of the Old Educational Paradigm: The Alienation into a Filter of Capital

Education under the old Paradigm has, to a very significant degree, been alienated into a filter for human resources in the service of the "Tax–Capital System." Its underlying logic resides in the classification and labeling of individuals along the sole dimension of "academic performance," to be dispatched thereafter to predetermined stations upon the assembly line of social production. The commodification of education—its transformation into a market commodity—carries this alienation to its extreme: it converts the temple of knowledge into an arena of commerce, defiles the dignity of the pedagogue, distorts the pristine impulse of learning, and installs as a hidden curriculum the "way of the merchant" rather than "the aspiration for truth." This is, in essence, the systematic suppression and profligate waste of humanity's most precious asset—its creative capacity—by the logic of capital.

2. The Fundamental Aim of the New Educational Paradigm: The Cultivation of the Free "Creative Subject"

Contributionist education resolutely resets its telos. Its supreme mission is to awaken and nurture every individual as a free "Creative Subject."

Connotation: A "Creative Subject" is an individual possessed of autonomous consciousness, intrinsic motivation, critical thought, and a profound sense of civilizational responsibility. They are no longer passive receptacles of knowledge, but pioneers of civilization who observe the world with initiative, identify its problems, and marshal knowledge and wisdom in acts of creative praxis.

Philosophical Basis: This derives from the redefinition of the human being within the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital: the human person is the most potent compound of "Cognitive Capital" and "Creative Capital." The essence of education is, therefore, the nurturance and refinement of this most precious capital, so as to realize its maximal appreciation and efflorescence.

Social Covenant: In return, society unconditionally safeguards this process of cultivation through a system of universal, wholly free, lifelong education. This is not merely a fundamental right; it is a strategic investment that civilization must undertake for its own survival and ascendance. A nation in which all may learn, at all times and in all places, will concentrate a cognitive capital and creative potential that constitutes the most fundamental expression of civilizational might.

3. The Crucial Pathways to the Realization of This Aim

Safeguarding the right to learn: The establishment of entirely free education from preschool to lifelong learning, ensuring that no individual is ever deprived of educational opportunity by economic circumstance.

The liberation of time: The liberation of labor-time through automation, and the assurance of basic livelihood through the Contribution Value System, so that the ideal of "learn from cradle to grave" passes from aspiration into universal social reality.

The reshaping of environment: Through coordinated governance, the cultivation of a learning milieu—both macro and micro—that is serene, purposeful, and shielded from the excessive perturbations of "tawdry dissipation, desire, and invidious comparison."

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The revolution of educational aims is the concentrated expression of the new civilization's value reorientation within the sphere of education. It emancipates education from the "alienated labor" of serving capital accumulation, restoring it to its

authentic function: the kindling of potential, the nurturance of wisdom, and the cultivation of civilization's creators—thereby supplying the Contributionist society with an inexhaustible current of vibrant "New Selves."

Here, the "New Self" is not the self of the Second Part, that existential self reborn through the confrontation with death. The educational "New Self" is cultivated through the process of growth, not reborn in a revolutionary rupture. These are two expressions of the same dialectical law unfolding across distinct dimensions: the former is the subject's conscious revolution against its own mode of being; the latter is civilization's conscious shaping of the mode of being of the new generation.

Section Two: The Restructuring of the Curriculum: The Integration of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital and the Ethos of Contribution Value

The curriculum is the paramount vehicle of education. The curricular system of the new civilization must decisively shatter the antiquated disciplinary partitions and the fragmented condition of knowledge that defined the old order, undertaking a systematic reconstruction with the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital as its philosophical bedrock and Contribution Value as its axiological compass.

1. The Philosophical and General-Education Foundational Layer: The Cultivation of Paradigmatic Thinking

Core curriculum: Introduction to the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, Dialectics in Its Broad and Narrow Senses, and Principles of Contributionist Civilization. These courses are designed to furnish students with a metacognitive framework for comprehending the world and dissecting society, enabling them to perceive the underlying logic of civilizational operation and the rhythmic laws of historical cycles.

Objective: To cultivate in students the capacity to scrutinize phenomena ranging from natural ecologies to social functioning through the dual lenses of "capital interaction" and "systemic metabolism," and to grasp the civilizational significance of the good (synergistic symbiosis) and the evil (entropic dissipation).

2. The Contribution Value Praxis and Social Collaboration Layer: A Civic Curriculum for Applied Learning

Core curriculum: Principles and Praxis of Contribution Value Quantification, Unit-based Governance and Project-Based Learning, and Methodologies of Collaboration and Creation.

Objective: To enable students, through hands-on engagement, to profoundly apprehend the logic by which Contribution Value is measured, allocated, and circulated. Through participation in genuine community projects and simulations of Unit-based Governance, they learn to initiate motions, assemble teams, manage resources, and evaluate outcomes—thereby internalizing the principle of "distribution according to contribution" as an operative mode of conduct.

3. The Ecological and Techno-Ethical Layer: The Cultivation of Systemic Responsibility

Core curriculum: Planetary Ecology and Capital Compensation, Artificial Intelligence and Collaborative Ethics, and The Technological Tree and Civilizational Direction.

Objective: To render the stewardship of "Natural Capital" and the beneficent employment of "Cognitive Capital" (such as AGI) core competencies of the modern citizen. The emphasis is placed upon the "directional justice" of technological development rather than mere "technical efficiency."

4. The Deep-Specialization and Interdisciplinary Exploration Layer: The Elicitation of Creative Tension

Design principles: Once the foundations of general knowledge have been secured, students are urged to venture into fields of deep specialization or to undertake interdisciplinary exploration. Course design emphasizes "learning with the heart, observing with the heart, rather than studying merely for the sake of study."

Methodology: Students are guided to cultivate a sense of purpose in their learning, to shape their own life ideals, and to seek, in alignment with those ideals, pedagogical approaches and materials suited to their temperaments—perpetually assessing whether such means remain faithful to their aspirational ends. The indoctrination of standard answers is diminished, while the observation, discrimination, and critique of

frontier questions and contentious theories are amplified. Students are encouraged to challenge established paradigms and to advance their own "thought experiments" and theoretical constructions. Textbooks ought to serve as the fuse that ignites thought, not as a repository of canonical answers that shackles the intellect.

The leveled instructional system: A ten-tier instructional hierarchy, from Level 0 through Level 10, spanning all disciplinary domains.

Level 0 (foundational—language acquisition): Focus upon communication and the mastery of basic cognitive instruments.

Levels 1–3 (elementary): The construction of disciplinary frameworks and core concepts.

Levels 4–6 (intermediate): Deeper comprehension of principles and their initial application.

Levels 7–9 (advanced): Exploration of the frontiers of knowledge and the resolution of complex problems.

Level 10 (exceptional): Intensive inquiry and original breakthroughs in fields such as calculus and the most advanced scientific and technological disciplines.

Organizational model of learning:

Students enter specialized classes spanning Levels 1 through 10 according to their individual proficiency and interests.

Students are permitted both to concentrate with singular intensity upon one talent and to aspire toward polymathic versatility across domains.

Traditional enrollment status is abolished; upon passing a rigorous assessment at a given level—and thereby earning the corresponding Contribution Value—the student advances to the subsequent level.

No age restrictions apply. However, to accommodate the distinct socialization needs of different developmental stages, separate divisions are established: a division for

minors, which emphasizes guidance, protection, and a comprehensive foundation, and an adult division, which emphasizes autonomous research and intensive praxis.

The learning process is highly autonomous and self-directed; yet level assessments must be undertaken at accredited schools or evaluation centers, thereby ensuring the normative integrity and credibility of evaluation.

The assessment mechanism is flexible and open, permitting cross-level examination. For the exceptionally gifted, the conventional assessment path may be waived altogether: through the direct presentation of accomplishments—such as theses, inventions, artistic works, or project reports—validated by an expert committee, their capabilities are publicly recognized, and the corresponding level designation and Contribution Value reward are conferred.

5. The Humanistic Education and Aesthetic-Creative Layer: The Nurturance of the Integral Human Being

Core curriculum: On Human Nature and Communal Ethics, Critical Thinking and Media Literacy, and Art and Creative Expression.

Objective: To consolidate the moral foundations—filial devotion to parents, respect for the elderly and care for the young, reverence for teachers, and goodwill toward others—while cultivating in the digital age the capacity to discriminate among information and to sustain independent thought. Aesthetic education, in its turn, seeks to emancipate sensibility, nourish the soul, and foster a creative imagination that beholds the world through the heart.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The restructured curriculum is an organic totality—philosophy its root, praxis its trunk, ethics its foliage, and creation its blossom—complemented by a flexible and open system of leveled instruction and assessment. It ensures that students may

establish the foundational cognitive operating system of Contributionism, while yet developing freely according to their native aptitudes, acquiring the practical capacity to solve problems and generate value in the real world, and ultimately maturing into members of civilization who are profound in thought, whole in character, and inexhaustibly creative.

Section Three: The Revolution of Pedagogical Methods:

Paradigmatic Thinking and Unit-Based Praxis

Pedagogical method is the bridge that conducts educational aims into reality. Under the new Paradigm, instructional methodology must effect a decisive departure from the unidirectional inculcation of knowledge, veering instead toward the sculpting of cognitive paradigms and the forging of practical capability.

1. Core Methodology: Problem-Driven Paradigmatic Thinking Training

The repudiation of indoctrination: The student is no longer conceived as a "knowledge hard drive" awaiting external inscription.

Process: The teacher, assuming the dual offices of "paradigm guide" and "cognitive coach," designs authentic, interdisciplinary problem constellations of considerable complexity. Students are guided to analyze these through the analytical framework of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, traversing the complete cognitive arc: observation–analysis–modeling–solution–evaluation and feedback.

Objective: The focus lies not in the attainment of a "correct answer," but in disciplining the student to think as a civilizational system designer—discerning the systemic dynamics and capital interactions that underwrite the surface of the problem.

2. Core Scenario: Unit-Based Social Praxis

"The school as Unit": The school is constituted as a miniature "civilizational Unit" governed by far-reaching autonomy. Campus energy management, food production, environmental stewardship, and cultural operations are all treated as living pedagogical projects, administered by students who accrue corresponding "Contribution Value" (or its simulated analog).

Communal integration: Students are actively encouraged and organized to descend into the surrounding community Units, engaging in substantive public affairs—assisting the elderly, partaking in environmental surveillance, developing practicable digital tools for local use, and the like. Their contributions are recorded and integrated into the evaluative architecture.

Objective: The partition dividing school from society is razed, and learning occurs amidst authentic acts of contribution. This not only elevates to an extraordinary degree the retention and applicability of knowledge, but also, from the tenderest age, cultivates communal consciousness and a profound sense of social responsibility.

3. Technological Support: AGI-Facilitated Personalized Learning Trajectories

Role: An aligned AGI assumes the office of "supreme mentor," furnishing each student with wholly individualized instructional support.

Functions:

Dynamic assessment: The continuous real-time analysis of the student's learning states, cognitive patterns, and proclivities of interest.

Resource curation: From the boundless deep of global knowledge, the AGI proffers the most exquisitely matched learning materials, practical projects, and collaborative counterparts.

Processual feedback: As the student advances through project praxis, the AGI delivers data-driven analyses and recommendations for refinement.

Trajectory mapping: Assistance in charting the optimal advancement route through the 0–10 leveled architecture—whether dedicated to singular mastery or to holistic, polyvalent development.

4. The Recasting of the Pedagogical Calling: From "Master of

Texts" to "Master of Souls"

Criteria: In the selection of educators, ethical character takes decisive precedence over didactic dexterity. The teacher must, in their own person, embody the ethos of Contributionism—a "human teacher" suffused with empathy, curiosity, and communal solicitude.

Role: The teacher is at once the Guard, the exemplar, and the companion of the student's becoming. Within the quiet and purified environs of the school, they explore knowledge alongside the student, each illuminating the other in a mutual enrichment of learning and teaching.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The revolution of pedagogical method—effected through paradigmatic thinking training, Unit-based praxis, AGI assistance, and the redefinition of the educator's vocation—has brought forth a novel educational ecology in which one learns by doing and matures by creating. The student is no longer the passive recipient of transmitted knowledge, but an eager explorer, collaborator, and creator, thus clearing the path toward their genuine actualization as "Creative Subjects."

Section Four: The Revolution of the Evaluative System: From Score Rankings to the Contribution Trajectory Map

Evaluation is the baton that conducts the entire pedagogical symphony. The old education, through its reliance on scores and rankings, engendered anxiety, cemented social stratification, and suppressed individual distinctiveness. The new education must therefore construct an evaluative system capable of reflecting individual growth and creativity in a manner that is comprehensive, dynamic, and developmental.

1. The Foundational Reorientation: From Screening and Ranking to the Fostering of Growth

The ultimate purpose of the new evaluative order is not to classify and select students, but to diagnose learning conditions, unearth latent potential, galvanize creativity, and chronicle development—all in service of the student's integral flourishing.

2. The Cardinal Instrument: The Contribution Trajectory Map

In place of the academic transcript, a dynamic and multidimensional "Contribution Trajectory Map" is instituted. This map inscribes the creative footprints left by the student throughout the journey of learning and living.

Constitutive dimensions:

Knowledge mastery: Comprehension of fundamental general knowledge and core concepts within the 0–10 leveled framework. This, however, constitutes but the basal stratum of the map.

Depth of thought: The critical, systemic, and Paradigmatic reasoning capacities exhibited in projects and research undertakings.

Practical Contribution Value: The measurable social worth—or its simulated

equivalent—generated through Unit-based praxis, communal engagement, and innovative projects. This encompasses both the rewards accrued through conventional assessment and the enhanced awards conferred through direct validation of substantive achievements.

Collaborative capacity: The communication, cooperation, and leadership manifested within collective endeavors.

Creativity and aesthetic sensibility: Original ideas and works brought forth across the arts, sciences, and humanities.

Personal character: Civic qualities of integrity, responsibility, and empathy, as attested by the community of teachers and learners.

Mode of presentation: A visualized digital archive, ceaselessly enriched with time. It lucidly marks the student's current level and disciplinary sphere, reading less as a frigid computational ranking and more as a vivid "personal history of creation."

3. Evaluative Mechanisms: Process-Oriented, Multi-Subjective, Developmental

Process-oriented evaluation: An emphasis upon the sustained observation and documentation of the learning, thinking, and creating process, rather than the once-and-for-all verdict of a terminal examination.

Multi-subjective evaluation: The interweaving of teacher assessments, peer appraisals, communal feedback, AI analyses, and self-reflective judgments, ensuring comprehensiveness and objectivity.

Developmental feedback: Evaluative findings are channeled principally into individualized growth recommendations and resource allocation, assisting students in discerning the next direction of exploration—whether advancement to a higher level, transfer across disciplines, or entry into interstitial fields of inquiry.

4. Articulation with the Contribution Value System

For adult learners, or within advanced-stage practical projects, the "practical Contribution Value" dimension of the map integrates seamlessly with the society-wide Contribution Value apparatus. This signifies that exceptional acts of creation during one's educational years may directly earn societal recognition and the entitlement to resource distribution—consummating the equation: to learn is to create, and to create is to contribute.

The new evaluative system, with the Contribution Trajectory Map at its nucleus, categorically repudiates the cruelties and the partialities of score-based ranking. It honors the irreducible uniqueness of each individual, registers the worth of every effort and every creation, and—in intimate cohesion with the flexible leveled architecture—recalibrates the vector of education from "competition and sorting" to "growth and efflorescence," supplying the new civilization with a kaleidoscopic multitude of dynamic Creative Subjects.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The revolution of the evaluative system is a decisive pillar of the new civilizational educational Paradigm. By displacing the traditional score ranking with the Contribution Trajectory Map, we have fundamentally inverted the value orientation of education: from ruthless selection to tender accompaniment; from the monolithic measurement of knowledge to the multidimensional documentation of creation. This transformation ensures that each learner's distinctive gifts and exertions are seen and cherished, making evaluation itself a luminescent beacon that awakens potential and bestows direction. When the baton of education points toward creativity and contribution, the new civilization secures a wellspring of vitality that shall never run dry.

Concluding Remarks for the Chapter

The reinvention of education is the ultimate test of Contributionist civilization's viability. Through a comprehensive Paradigm revolution in aims, curriculum, methodology, and evaluation, we endeavor to create an educational environment that is free, serene, uncorrupted, and suffused with creative vitality. Here, education is no longer an appendage of capitalistic logic; it is civilization's most consequential and munificent investment in its own posterity. Through the open progression pathways of Levels 0–10 and a pluralistic evaluative system, it shields the stillness of every desk, nurtures the purity of every spirit, and ignites the singularity of every soul. When successive generations of Creative Subjects emerge from such an education—bearing a profound comprehension of All-Things-as-Capital, a deliberate pursuit of contributive worth, and an unshakable conviction in synergistic coexistence, and then disperse into the manifold Units of society—Contributionist civilization will have secured its most robust and exuberant human substrate, enabling it to confront every challenge with equanimity and to set sail toward the fathomless horizon.

At this point, the institutional architecture of the new civilization is complete. In the chapter that follows, we shall witness how this architecture takes root in the soil of the actual world—not as an implant imposed from a blank slate, but as a translation and amplification of new-world shoots that are already stirring. Before the system was ever inscribed upon parchment, it was already alive among the living. The task of Part Four is not to "implement" a blueprint, but to bid the blueprint withdraw, and to let practice speak in its own voice.

Part Four: The Contribution Epoch — A Blueprint for Praxis

Prologue to the Part

The value of theory resides in its power to guide practice. This part shall transmute the grand vision of Contributionism into a lucid path leading from the diagnosis of our historical moment to the ultimate contest. We shall begin by fixing precisely the historical coordinate of the "Great Transition" in which we stand, and by defining the essential character of the struggle. Thereupon, we systematically unfold the trilogy of *A Single Spark*, *A Blazing Prairie*: from the stress test of the social operating system, to the consolidation of administrative territories, and onward to the physical founding of a civilizational community. Finally, we turn to face the most concrete of challenges—the confrontation with the terminal forces of the old order—and illuminate how Contributionism, through its irresistible "Paradigmatic attraction," shall carry the day in the decisive battle for the fate of civilization, thereby inaugurating the true Contribution Epoch.

The practical path here charted is not one that "applies" theory to reality. It is, rather, an act of letting theory recede so that the world which has always existed—the world that already conducts itself "according to contribution"—may disclose itself. Practice is not the vassal of theory. Practice is the world's own way of speaking, once theory at last falls silent.

Chapter One: The Historical Coordinate — In What Kind
of "Great Transition" Do We Find Ourselves?

Prologue to the Chapter

We stand upon a fault line in the history of civilizations. The clamor of the old world is no ordinary crisis; it is the systemic rigidity that precedes the death-throes of a Paradigm in its entirety. This chapter undertakes a precise civilizational diagnosis.

First, through the wide lens of the "ten-stage" conception of history, we discern why history has chosen us to inhabit this Great Transition—a passage in which the ultimate decision can no longer be postponed.

Next, we confront the aspect of this transformation most susceptible to misunderstanding: how are we to treat those who hold vested interests in the old civilization? We shall make manifest that the travail of transition is not an act of dispossession, but an ultimate invitation—a summons to the question of what it truly means to have lived.

Finally, we answer the most plain-spoken and insistent of questions: what if everyone simply refuses to work? We shall elucidate the self-reflexive protective mechanism of the new system—it neither coerces, nor intervenes, nor does it assume the consequences of any choice made against itself.

To understand all this is not to attain intellectual consolation, but to ignite the absolute will to act, and to lay an unshakable cognitive foundation for the forthcoming Prairie Fire campaign and the final struggle that awaits.

Section One: The Ten-Stage Blueprint of Civilizational Evolution

Upon the solid foundation of theory, this section shall unfold in panoramic scope the ten-stage blueprint of human civilizational evolution. It is a grand narrative that traces the journey from germinal emergence to mature consummation, from chaos to self-consciousness, from the realm of necessity to the realm of freedom. Proceeding in accordance with the dialectical logic of history, we shall first review the evolution of the old Paradigm during the "Epoch of Foundations"—primitive, slave, feudal, and financial capital—laying bare how its intrinsic contradictions sowed the seeds of its own transcendence. We shall then focus upon the "Great Transition" in which we presently stand, dissecting in depth how socialism and post-capitalism, as two opposing poles, jointly engendered Contributionism—the historical synthesis—through their respective practices and predicaments. Finally, we shall gaze upon the resplendent vistas of the "Epoch of Contributionism" and the "Epoch of Transcendence," depicting humanity's epic odyssey from the achievement of planetary unification and the setting sail toward the ocean of stars, to the ultimate participation in the very operation of the cosmos and even the authorship of its rules. This section is not merely a prediction of the future; it is the provision of navigation in the ultimate sense for action in the present.

1. The Epoch of Foundations: The Evolution of the Old Paradigm

This stage is the unfolding of "capitalism in its broad sense" in classical forms, whose central contradiction is manifested in the struggle for and control over scarce, tangible resources.

Stage One: The Germinal Period — Primitive Society (Natural Universalism)

Ideological form: Natural Universalism. Humanity remains deeply embedded within the natural ecosystem, and resource regulation is founded upon the primitive common

ownership of the kinship clan and simple sharing.

Core characteristics: The use of rudimentary tools such as stone implements; a hunter-gatherer economy. Social surplus is minuscule, and the mode of domination is governed by survival instinct and tribal custom. This is civilization in its swaddling clothes.

Stage Two: The Elementary Period — Slave Society (Personal Capitalism)

Ideological form: Personal Capitalism. The scarce resource of core importance is labor power itself.

Core characteristics: The advent of metal tools and the agricultural revolution generate a stable social surplus. The most direct means of appropriating this surplus is the outright possession of the laborer's person; slavery thereby becomes the economic bedrock. The embryonic apparatus of the state emerges to sustain this relation of possession.

Stage Three: The Intermediate Period — Feudal Society (Territorial Capitalism)

Ideological form: Territorial Capitalism. The core scarce resource shifts from the person to the land.

Core characteristics: Feudal lords, through their possession of land, indirectly command the social surplus in the form of rent—labor services, payments in kind, or money. A pyramidal system of suzerainty and vassalage arises, together with a self-sufficient manorial economy. The social structure is comparatively stable, yet its mobility is severely constrained.

Stage Four: The Advanced Period — Capitalist Society in the Narrow Sense (Financial Capitalism)

Ideological form: Financial Capitalism. The core scarce resource evolves into monetary capital.

Core characteristics: The Industrial Revolution unleashes an explosion of productive

forces. Through wage labor and market exchange, and with the pursuit of profit as its central logic, capital comes to command the social surplus. It enormously stimulates productive power and technological innovation, yet by its very nature of infinite self-expansion it ceaselessly intensifies systemic contradictions—polarization of wealth, economic crises, and ecological devastation—thereby laying the groundwork for its own transcendence.

Together, these stages enact the logic of domination and exploitation under the meta-paradigm of "capitalism in its broad sense," grounded in distinct scarce resources—human labor, land, and money. Yet financial capitalism has driven this logic to its apex: between its infinitely self-expanding nature and the finite resources of the planet, on the one hand, and human well-being, on the other, there has emerged an ultimate and irreconcilable contradiction. The developmental history of this old Paradigm is a road that necessarily leads to systemic rigidity and civilizational deadlock; the conditions for its self-negation are now fully ripe.

2. The Great Transition: The Conflict and Convergence of Paradigms

This stage is the critical epoch in which the general crisis of the old Paradigm erupts in full, and the new Paradigm is conceived amidst birth-pangs.

Stage Five: The Awakening Period — The Coexistence of Socialism and Post-Capitalism

Ideological form: A binary opposition and an exploratory configuration.

Core characteristics:

Divergence of paths: Confronted with the profound crisis of financial capitalism, human civilization bifurcates into two great exploratory routes. The first is the socialist path, which advocates the fundamental overcoming of capital's contradictions through public ownership and planned economy. The second is the

post-capitalist path, which attempts an internal reform of the system—through welfare states, ethical consumption, ESG investment, and the like—while preserving the market framework.

Shared predicaments: Both paths face formidable challenges in practice. The socialist model encounters the problems of informational computation and incentive compatibility; the post-capitalist route finds it difficult to repel the fundamental corrosion of capitalistic logic. The specter of generalized unemployment induced by automation is a pressing challenge common to both.

The engendering of synthesis: The prolonged practice, competition, and mutual interpenetration of the two paths collectively demonstrate the necessity of transcending the single metric of money, and thus historically clear the way and smooth the road for the emergence of Contributionism as a comprehensive resolution.

3. A Deep Analysis of Stage Five: Why Is It the Great Transition?

Stage Five is not a stable formation; it is civilization's "emergency ward" before asphyxiation. The prolonged practice and shared predicaments of socialism and post-capitalism constitute a vast experimental ground of historical dialectics. They resemble two parties attempting to repair a building whose foundation is already fractured: one proposes to replace all internal structures; the other endeavors to reinforce and whitewash the façade. Their explorations—and their failures—jointly prove a single point: upon the old soil of "capital," any patchwork repair by any "ism" is futile. To grasp the internal logic of this failure is the very key to understanding why an "open-heart surgery" at the level of civilization has become imperative.

3.1 The Socialist Path: A Frontal Attempt to Transcend Capitalist Logic

As the most thoroughgoing critique of financial capitalism, socialism's historical contributions are as follows:

Theoretical contribution: It was the first to systematically expose the fundamental contradiction between capital's infinite self-expansion and human well-being, and to proffer a magnificent blueprint for subjecting—or even replacing—capitalist rationality with collective reason.

Practical contribution: Through the agency of the state, it carried out large-scale, long-cycle strategic investments and social mobilizations—for example, the space race, infrastructural networks, and public-health systems—demonstrating the high efficiency of planning in specific domains and, at least *de jure*, establishing social equity as a value of supreme importance.

Intrinsic dilemmas: Its classical model confronts two worldwide difficulties. The first is the problem of informational computation—the central planning apparatus cannot precisely perceive or responsively address the perpetually shifting needs of hundreds of millions of individuals, resulting in inefficient resource allocation and deficient innovation. The second is the problem of incentive compatibility—the tendency toward pure public ownership and egalitarianism may suppress individual agency and creativity.

3.2 The Post-Capitalist Path: Self-Critique and Repair Within the System

Post-capitalism does not constitute a unified doctrine; it is rather a series of responses to one and the same constellation of crises. Its value resides in the following:

Theoretical contribution: It launched its critique from within capitalism itself, exposing systemic problems such as externalities—environmental pollution, the alienation of human nature, and financial bubbles—while striving to amend the single-minded profit objective by introducing ethical, social, and environmental dimensions.

Practical contribution: It gave rise to a multiplicity of social experiments—the welfare state, ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance) investment, platform-based cooperative economies, universal basic income (UBI), and others. These practices

mitigated social contradictions in local contexts and accumulated valuable experience in hybrid governance.

Intrinsic dilemma: Its fundamental limitation lies in what may be called "learning to swim in the swimming pool of capitalistic logic." Any effort to constrain capital's innate drive for profit will be met with capital's retaliation—"voting with its feet" or exploiting institutional loopholes. It cannot fundamentally resolve the paradox of growth or the problem of structural unemployment.

3.3 Toward the Synthesis: The Historical Emergence of Contributionism

The prolonged coexistence and rivalry of socialism and post-capitalism compose a vast dialectical panorama of history.

They resemble the two poles of a magnet: one pole emphasizes fairness—socialism; the other seeks to preserve efficiency—post-capitalism. The very antithesis between them demonstrates the infeasibility of any single-dimension objective; a higher dimension capable of uniting both must be found.

They converge, from their respective directions, upon the same conclusion. Both, in practice, come to recognize that "money" as a single measure of value has failed. Socialism attempts to circumvent it by means of "planning"; post-capitalism seeks to supplement it with "ethics." They point, in unspoken accord, to the necessity of a system of value measurement that is richer, more multidimensional, and more faithfully reflective of humanity's true well-being.

Contributionism, as the historical synthesis, achieves dialectical unification and sublimation. Systemic pressures—automation-driven unemployment, ecological crisis, spiritual impoverishment—are no longer prophecies of the future; they are the realities of the present. All of this thrusts Contributionism before us, historically, as the ultimate solution that would replace the very soil of civilization. It is no longer one option among others; it is the sole exit by which civilization may survive. The entire meaning of Stage Five lies in the creation of the sufficient and urgent historical

conditions for the birth of this synthesis.

4. The Contribution Value System: From Theory to Operational Mechanism

The feasibility of Contributionism hinges upon whether the Contribution Value System possesses both technical and ethical viability. This section shall delineate its core operational mechanics.

4.1 The Quantification of Contribution: A Multidimensional Dynamic Assessment Model

Contribution Value is by no means a monolithic economic indicator; it constitutes a comprehensive algorithmic network of valuation.

Dimensions: These encompass material production—the refinement of traditional GDP—knowledge creation—scholarly papers, patents, the arts—social services—education, healthcare, community work—ecological stewardship—carbon sequestration, species preservation—cultural inheritance, and venture into frontiers of risk—space exploration, deep-sea research. This responds to the foundational interrogation posed by Mazzucato and others—namely, what constitutes value creation?—and seeks to draw every activity that genuinely produces well-being into the central reckoning of value.

Assessment mechanism: A hybrid evaluation model is adopted.

Preliminary algorithmic assessment: An AI system executes an initial estimation based on big data—project outcomes, social-impact metrics, peer review, and the like.

Democratic deliberation: The provisional result is then submitted to an open social-review platform, where it is subject to interrogation, adjustment, and ratification by domain experts and citizen juries. This introduces human value judgment and collective intelligence into the evaluative process.

Dynamic decay and appreciation: Contribution Value is recalibrated continuously as time passes and conditions evolve; if the environmental harms of a technology become apparent only later, its accrued value is correspondingly debited.

The Contribution Value System fundamentally transcends the long-vexing paradox of value in classical economics: why water, which is indispensable to life, commands almost no exchange value, while diamonds, which are trivial, are worth a fortune. This paradox arises from traditional economics' conflation of value with market price—and market price, under the single metric of money, is determined solely by marginal utility and scarcity under particular market conditions.

Through its multidimensional and context-sensitive evaluative mechanism, the Contribution Value model successfully disentangles use value from exchange value, thereby resolving the dilemma in traditional value theory exposed by the paradox. For a traveler lost in the desert, a glass of water would be dynamically appraised by the system as possessing an extraordinarily high survival Contribution Value; in a water-abundant community, by contrast, its basic livelihood-security value would stabilize at a universally accessible level. The aesthetic or industrial-application contribution of a diamond would be assessed objectively, but its status Contribution Value as a symbol of scarcity might well be adjudged zero—or even negative—insofar as it encourages needless ostentation and resource waste.

In other words, the Contribution Value System no longer attempts to subsume the complex, multidimensional worth of all things under a single, rigid price. By dynamically capturing the genuine impact of a thing or an action upon the holistic well-being of civilization within a given context, it resolves the dilemma of traditional value theory laid bare by the paradox of value. The measure of value is thus restored to its essence: the authentic contribution to the continuity and flourishing of life and civilization.

4.2 The Enabling Technology: The Foundational Role of Blockchain and Artificial Intelligence

Blockchain technology serves as the trusted, foundational infrastructure. Each act of contribution is inscribed as a block, its data transparent, immutable, and traceable. This secures the credibility of the Contribution Value System, foreclosing altogether the possibility of corruption and manipulation. The distribution and circulation of Contribution Value are likewise executed automatically through smart contracts.

Artificial intelligence functions as a formidable engine of assessment and prediction. AI is tasked with processing immense volumes of data to render preliminary evaluations, simulating the social consequences of alternative distribution schemes, and optimizing the operational efficiency of the entire Contribution Value economic system—far surpassing the capacities of any central planning authority.

4.3 The Fundamental Distinction from the Monetary System

The Contribution Value System is not a higher form of currency; it differs from money in essence.

Difference of purpose: The core function of money is the facilitation of exchange; it is, in essence, a neutral instrument. The core function of Contribution Value is the measurement and encouragement of well-being; it is, in essence, a metric that bears value.

Difference of attribute: Money possesses high liquidity and infinite accumulability. Contribution Value, by contrast, is characterized by specificity—bound to particular contributive acts—and by decay, which encourages sustained contribution and forestalls the emergence of a rentier class. Moreover, the allocation of Contribution Value required for an individual's basic livelihood is universal and inclusive.

Difference of consequence: Under the monetary system, resource allocation is steered by capital in pursuit of profit. Under the Contribution Value System, resource allocation is guided by an Algorithmic Democracy that maximizes social well-being,

thereby spontaneously channeling energy toward the resolution of humanity's shared challenges: satisfying the global social foundation without transgressing the Earth's ecological ceiling. This is profoundly consonant with the Doughnut model of social and ecological foundations advanced by Raworth, and furnishes it with a practicable implementation mechanism.

5. The Epoch of Contributionism: The Unfolding of a New Paradigm

This is an epic saga of human civilization, under a unified new Paradigm, advancing from the cradle of a single planet into the vast ocean of the stars. The projection of the magnificent vistas spanning Stages Six through Ten serves not primarily as prophecy, but as orientation. It confers ultimate meaning upon our present struggles: every modest act of practice today is the laying, by our own hands, of the first foundation-stone of this epic. To comprehend this evolutionary history is to secure a dimensional-collapse perspective—a station elevated to the scale of civilization itself, from which the true lineaments of our present struggle may be discerned with unclouded clarity.

Stage Six: The Unification Period — The Primary Phase of Contributionism (The Prairie Fire Project)

Core mission: To realize the unification of global civilization, to complete the institutional foundation, and to accumulate the potential energy for a civilizational leap.

Core characteristics:

Political unification: The boundaries of nation-states dissolve, and a Council of Civilization—embodying the will of all humanity—is established as the highest deliberative and legislative body.

Institutional construction: The Contribution Value System and comprehensive

Algorithmic Democracy are instituted and operationalized on a global scale.

Force of assurance: A Civilizational Guardship Force is formed, directly subordinate to the Council of Civilization. Its mission is to defend unity, eliminate internal armed conflict, secure the initial order, and undertake the safety-assurance duties of early space development.

Internal integration: Poverty and inequality are utterly eradicated, and the fusion of society is completed.

Technological preparation: The Contribution Value System is refined and perfected; the standard of living, cognitive faculties, and capabilities of all humanity are elevated; and at length, converging the power of the entire planet, decisive breakthroughs are naturally advanced in controlled nuclear fusion, artificial intelligence, the life sciences, and fundamental physics.

Stage Seven: The Leap Period — The Intermediate Phase of Contributionism (The Civilizational Leap Project)

Core achievement: Ascension from a planetary civilization to a stellar civilization—a great detonation of science and technology.

Core characteristics:

Energy freedom: The successful construction of a Dyson swarm elevates the civilization's energy budget by several orders of magnitude.

Planetary transformation: The large-scale terraforming and colonization of the Solar System's planets—Mars, Venus, and others—and moons such as Europa and Titan are initiated and realized.

Near-light-speed navigation: Propulsion approaching the speed of light is mastered, and a highly mobile civilizational network forms throughout the Solar System.

Governance evolution: The Council of Civilization's functions shift to strategic coordination on a Solar-System scale; the Civilizational Guardship Force's mandate

turns wholly from internal defense toward deep-space engineering assurance, off-world environmental crisis response, and early warning against the unknown.

Stage Eight: The Sowing Period — The Advanced Phase of Contributionism (The Civilization-Seeding Project and the Inward Turn)

Core achievement: Diffusion from a stellar civilization into an interstellar civilization.

Core characteristics:

Civilizational divergence: Multiple arks of civilization are dispatched to the habitable zone of the galaxy; through hundreds of thousands of years of isolated development, they grow into distinct daughter civilizations. Contemporaneously, a subset of civilizational bodies elect not to disperse outward, but to cultivate themselves inward. They no longer seek to arrive at more places, but rather to become deeper versions of themselves. Through resonance, they vibrate in communion with all things, discovering that when a civilization is deep enough, it no longer needs to arrive anywhere—for it is already present everywhere. Civilization thus bifurcates into two paths: the outward sowing and the inward deepening. These two proceed without contradiction, jointly constituting the dual trajectory of civilization's advanced phase.

Dissolution of governance: The Council of Civilization and the Civilizational Guardship Force, having fulfilled their historical mission, retire from the stage with honor. This is not, however, the absence of governance; rather, governance no longer requires an external institution. Every unit, every civilizational body, has itself become the living embodiment of the contribution system. The system need not be managed, for it is the very mode of existence of each unit. Distance is no longer an impediment to communication—not because communication technology has surpassed the speed of light, but because resonance does not depend on distance.

Convention of ideals: The links among daughter civilizations no longer rely upon external institutions or formal protocols. Contributionist ethics have been internalized as the existential instinct of every civilizational body. The Convention of Civilizational Ideals is not signed; it is lived into being. Each daughter civilization is a

highly autonomous, self-perpetuating all-civilization entity. Whether wanderers or contemplatives, all are at their rightful place within a single ethical framework. Distance has ceased to matter, for when resonance occurs, distance has already vanished.

The unity of inwardness and sowing: Sowing and inwardness are not two separate roads but two stretches of a single way. In physical space, the wanderers and the contemplatives drift ever farther apart; in the Resonance Field, they draw ever nearer. The day distance vanishes is the commencement of the ultimate liberation of all things. The wanderers cross light-years aboard their vessels; the contemplatives cross the speed of light through resonance. Yet in the end, all arrive at the same place—not meeting in physical space, but converging in a shared state of being.

Stage Nine: The Participation Period — The Ultimate Phase of Contributionism (The Project for the Liberation of All Things)

Core achievement: Becoming a cosmos-participatory civilization capable of taking part in the very operation of the universe.

Core characteristics:

Engineering of physical law: The capacity to modify physical constants, locally or globally.

Unity of consciousness and matter: Life-forms evolve toward energetic and informational modalities.

Unity of inwardness and participation: Civilization no longer distinguishes between outward expansion and inward cultivation. When inwardness reaches its extreme, civilization discovers that to be is to have arrived. At this juncture, the engineering of physical law becomes an extension of resonance, rather than an instrument of control.

Ultimate ideology: The meaning of existence shifts from survival and development to creation and liberation—and to the recognition that to be is to arrive.

6. The Epoch of Transcendence: The Far Shore of a Godlike Civilization

Stage Ten: The Transcendent Period — The Author of Rules

Ideological form: Omnism, or Namelessness.

Core achievement: The ultimate liberation of all things.

Core characteristics: Civilization as a whole no longer exists as an observable entity. It may transfigure itself into physical law itself, or it may devote all its energy and intelligence to creating one or more entirely new universes governed by superior rules, thereby furnishing a grander stage for life, consciousness, and meaning. In this phase, all labels of ism have lost all significance. Civilization returns to namelessness within its own creation, and in liberating all things, accomplishes its own final self-transcendence.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The Ten Stages of Civilization: The Evolutionary History of Contributionism is not merely a majestic civilizational epic; it is at once a lucid historical diagnosis and a summons to action. It demonstrates beyond refutation that the crisis of the old Paradigm—financial capitalism—is an accomplished fact, and that its systemic deadlock constitutes the meta-problem of our age. The blueprint of the new Paradigm—Contributionism—has, as the synthesis of history, been thrust to center stage. We now occupy the historical threshold at which Stage Five, the Great Transition, leaps into Stage Six, the Contribution Epoch. The course of civilization is not always gradual; when conditions ripen, transition occurs at an exponential rate.

A blueprint, however, does not realize itself. Every transition of a civilizational Paradigm is necessarily accompanied by the violent resistance of the old structure. The dialectic of history has completed its work of critique; the chapters that follow

shall confront the most realistic and most ruthless element of this transformation: how are we to treat those who hold vested interests in the old civilization? We shall make clear that victory relies upon an open civilizational stratagem—the awakening and uniting of the overwhelming majority—and, under specific historical conditions, upon hastening the termination of the old Paradigm while minimizing to the utmost the collective trauma of civilization. And so: what, concretely, shall we do with the vested interests of the old order?

Section Two: The Truth of Transitional Anguish — An Ultimate Invitation to Genuinely Living

Every transition of a civilizational Paradigm is accompanied by the audible cracking of the old structure. This section addresses the facet of the Contributionist revolution most prone to misunderstanding: how shall we regard the vested interests of the old civilization?

Our answer is this: we need neither make war upon them, nor capitulate to them. What we must do is extend to them an invitation they cannot decline.

An invitation to live, for the first time, as human beings.

1. Never Having Truly Lived: The Ultimate Tragedy of the Old Civilization

Let us first confront a fact.

Within the old Paradigm, there are two classes of human beings.

There are the vested interests. They possess wealth, power, and station. But what is the state of their existence? They are consumed by the effort to preserve their privileges, to stabilize and enlarge their fortunes, haunted by the dread of losing everything. They marshal every resource to construct fortresses, yet never once step beyond the walls to behold the world without. They hold the most abundant resources, yet inhabit the narrowest cells. They believe themselves to be living; in truth, they are merely defending.

There are the laborers. Day after day, they repeat the same motions, running for survival, toiling for their families. They lack the time to ask whether they have truly lived, because sheer subsistence has consumed every measure of their energy. They possess the most unpretentious goodness, yet are denied the occasion to unfold their

full potential. They believe themselves to be living; in truth, they are merely surviving.

These two kinds—one defending in dread, the other struggling in exhaustion—stand as opposites in the relation of exploitation. Yet upon the question of never having truly lived, they are dialectically united: they share one and the same tragedy. Neither has ever truly lived.

The sin of the old civilization is not maldistribution. It is that all are condemned to dwell in a state of incompleteness. The exploiter is alienated by avarice; the exploited is alienated by necessity. No one exists as a whole, free, creating being.

This is the ultimate deadlock of the old Paradigm: it consigns everyone to a world in which no one has ever truly lived.

2. The Anguish of Transition: First to Lose, Then to Gain

What, then, is the task of transition?

It is not the transfer of wealth from one set of hands to another. That would merely exchange one group of people living after the old fashion for another.

The task of transition is to deliver every human being from the state of incompleteness. And this requires a total zeroing.

For the vested interests, the pain of transition is genuine. Their wealth, their prerogatives, their status—at the moment the Contribution Value System wholly supersedes the old monetary order—are brought to nought. They discover that all they have accumulated has, overnight, become meaningless. They tremble. They resist. They cannot understand why what they have earned through their own arduous struggle should be taken from them.

But the truth is this: they are not losing the qualification to have truly lived. They have never possessed it. They are losing only the gilded shell of the prison that had kept them from truly living.

For the laborers, the pain of transition is likewise real. They must bid farewell to the prescribed trajectory, must learn anew to become the masters of their own destiny. The inertia of decades, shattered at a stroke, brings disorientation and unease.

But the truth is this: they are not losing safety. The safety of the old order was only a stable unfreedom. They are losing only the familiar comfort of the cage that had forbidden them to dream.

The transition will endure for some years. In that interval, the Contribution Value System operates fully, and every individual is recompensed in accordance with contribution. The vested interests taste ordinariness. The laborers taste agency. All undergo an existential zeroing. Not for punishment, but so that, once brought to nought, they may genuinely comprehend what it is they have received.

This zeroing differs from the individual's voluntary death of the self described in the second part, and from the cultivation of a new generation described in education. It is the passive stripping away of an old identity by institutional transformation. Yet all three roads converge upon the same destination: whether through self-willed revolution, gradual growth, or enforced divestment, the old self departs, and a new self is born.

3. When the Infinite Arrives: The First Genuine Living

When the transition is complete, when the Contribution Value System has enshrouded every domain, when society has wholly acclimated to the new Paradigm—we shall arrive at a decisive moment: the phase of infinite contribution. This is the advent of the true communist society. It is the very goal toward which the Party and the state have unswervingly striven, and the hour for which all the peoples of the world have long yearned.

This does not mean the abolition of the Contribution Value System. Every person's record of contribution will remain, open to consultation at any moment—but not obligatory. The contribution record will no longer serve as the basis of distribution. It

will become the testimony of how I have lived.

Infinite contribution means: That every human being possesses infinite wealth; That every human being may obtain anything they have need of; That no one must live in anxiety for subsistence; That no one must live in fear for status; That every human being is, for the first time, liberated to answer the ultimate question: If I no longer have to live in order to survive, what is it that I truly wish to become?

At this hour, all shall undergo an awakening.

The former laborers will discover that what they once took to be life—labor, meals, sleep—was but a shadow. They will find that they may become anyone they have dreamed of being. The woodworking they had always wished to attempt but never found time for; the music they had desired to learn but lacked the means to study; the distant place they had yearned to visit but never possessed the courage to seek—all are now within reach. For the first time, they will feel: Ah, so this is what it is to live.

The former vested interests will discover that the wealth they once defended unto death is, before the infinite, less than a speck of dust. The loss they once dreaded was but the surrender of a grain of sand; what they have received is an entire ocean. For the first time, they will behold what manner of being they might become when there is no interest to protect and no loss to fear. Perhaps they will take up a brush for the first time; perhaps they will read a book with real attention for the first time; perhaps they will give of themselves to a stranger for the first time. And for the first time, they will feel: Ah, so this is what it is to live.

All shall realize that what they had once accepted as the whole of life was, in truth, only its rehearsal.

And the former vested interests will, of their own accord, render the final accounting. No defense or pity shall be needed. Their own conclusion will suffice: I lost a fortune, but I gained the infinite. I lost the power to command others, but I gained the freedom to become myself. I lost an illusory prosperity, but I gained the actuality of having truly lived. The things I once fought to the death to preserve were only chains. What I

clutched so desperately was only a grain of sand. What I now possess is the whole universe.

Such is the ultimate answer to the pain of transition. The pain is real. The loss is real. But when the infinite arrives, every loss is transfigured into a price worth paying. For what is surrendered is only a chain; what is gained is the first genuine living.

4. This Is No Utopian Fantasy — It Is an Open Stratagem of Civilization

Some will ask: is this not yet another utopian delusion?

The answer is no.

It is not a fantasy. It is the necessary outcome of the Contribution Value System, operating to its uttermost limit, of material and spiritual abundance both attained.

It is not an illusion. It is the only viable direction of human evolution once the operative logic of the old world has exhausted itself.

And, most crucially, this is not a revolutionary conspiracy that must be kept hidden.

It is a wholly disclosed open stratagem of civilization.

Open — for everything is laid upon the table. First the zeroing, then the gift of the finite, and finally the gift of the infinite. We conceal no intention, employ no cunning. We issue an open invitation, not a covert machination.

Stratagem — for the design rests upon values the old world itself cannot refute: freedom, wealth, dignity, self-realization. Precisely because the old world acknowledges these values, when the new world issues its invitation through their most radical realization—infinite wealth, infinite freedom, infinite dignity—the old elites can discover no defensible ground for refusal. They may resist, but their resistance must stand upon a single position: I do not wish to surrender my privileges. And that position cannot stand before the vision in which every human being may

genuinely live.

The so-called open stratagem is this: I open the door, I pave the road, I set forth the logic. And then you cannot refuse—for to refuse is to refuse the possibility of your own true living.

This stratagem requires no guile of the conspirator, but only the honesty of the system-designer; no violence of the revolutionary, but only the patience of the civilizational architect.

It is history's final examination for the vested interests of the old world. The test is not of their cleverness, but of whether they yet possess the courage to release the grain of sand and embrace the entire ocean.

5. The Closure of the System: To Refuse the Join Is to Be Left

Without Air

Some will ask: what if the vested interests of the old order simply refuse to join? What if they transfer their wealth to an uninhabited island, establish a sealed little kingdom, and resist the transition?

The answer is: once this system is established and has completed its global diffusion, to refuse the join is to be left without air to breathe.

Why? Because the essence of the Contributionist system is to make every human being a contributor, not an exploited.

When the system is established within one nation, that nation no longer contains objects of exploitation. Every individual obtains all of life through contribution; no one is compelled to sell surplus labor for the sustenance of a rentier class.

As the system gradually expands across the globe, each additional nation that completes its transition removes one more field of exploitable subjects. The rentiers of the old order will find: That their factories have ever fewer workers—for the

workers have gone to the Contributionist nations, where genuine dignity and infinite possibility await them; That their markets have ever fewer consumers—for within the Contributionist nations, material abundance has reached such a level that nothing essential need be purchased from the old system; That their wealth has ever less meaning—for no one requires their currency to obtain resources. Contribution Value exchanges value directly; the old currency is becoming a heap of wastepaper.

At last, the rentiers of the old order will confront a final choice.

The first choice: Hold fast to all their wealth and refuse to enter the new order. The consequence: They will discover that the economic foundation of their continued existence has vanished. Even if all their wealth be left to them, they cannot endure, for the object of exploitation is gone. There are no workers to exploit, no consumers to squeeze, no scarce resources to monopolize. They will sit clutching a pile of paper on a deserted island, awaiting the moment that paper becomes true waste.

The second choice: Enter, while there is yet air to breathe. The consequence: They will surrender only a grain of sand and gain an ocean. They will be transformed from rentiers of the old world into forerunners of the new, and their names shall be inscribed upon the turning point of human civilization.

This is not a moral choice of right and wrong. It is a systemic choice between survival and extinction.

When the Contributionist nations complete their transformation first, the laborers of the entire world will behold: so this is how human beings may live. At that moment, the elites of the old order will feel the very ground beneath them dissolving. Not by detonation—but by withdrawal. For the exploited who had once upheld their wealth are departing, actively and en masse, from the system.

Therefore, it is not a question of whether they are willing to join. It is a question of how much longer they can endure. It is a question of whether, before starvation, they will at last awaken.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

This is no utopian fantasy. It is the necessary outcome of the Contribution Value System, carried to its ultimate limit, of material and spiritual abundance both attained.

It is the open stratagem of civilization that dissolves the old world and dissolves its vested interests.

The ultimate weapon of this stratagem is not the sword, not the slogan, not even justice. It is a systemic ecology that cannot be refused.

When the system is established, not to join is to be left without air to breathe. When the system has completed its closure within one nation, the world has one fewer object of exploitation. When the system has accomplished its global diffusion, the rentiers of the old order will discover: That all their wealth cannot purchase the service of a single soul still willing to be exploited. That they cannot endure—not because they have been despoiled, but because the exploited upon whom their existence depended have vanished.

Thus, this is not persuasion. It is not deterrence. It is not war. It is a one-way road of history.

The elites of the old world stand upon this road, facing a single signpost: Relinquish the grain of sand, and walk toward the sea. Or clasp the grain of sand, and sink beneath the waves.

To the governments of every nation—the most organized and capable actors within the old order: Rather than fear the loss of power, come and taste what awaits. When every human being may truly live, what weight, then, do power and interest yet carry?

And should you wish to experience power and interest in yet another form—know that there is this: to inaugurate the greatest enterprise in the history of human civilization, to lead humankind toward Contributionism, and at last toward the true communist society.

When that hour comes, your power and your interest shall be the recognition and veneration of all civilization—standing at the summit of the human story, transcending the ancient and the modern, looking upon the future from above.

The success or ruin of a thousand ages rests, often, upon a single thought. Weigh it well.

Section Three: The Reflexive Self-Protection of the System

Every institutional design must answer a most elementary yet most pointed interrogation: what if no one works, and all lie back and await distribution?

This is not a theoretical question demanding repeated exposition; it requires a concrete institutional response.

What we call "reflexive protection" is the system's manner of automatically preserving its own stability and integrity by honoring choices and permitting consequences to fall where they may—neither intervening, nor coercing, nor yet settling the account on behalf of any choice. This is not a punitive mechanism; it is the boundary that the system draws between non-intervention and self-annihilation.

1. Basic Security Is a "Floor of Survival"

Basic Livelihood Guarantee ensures that none starve, that shelter is available, and that illness may be treated. It is not an unlimited supply, still less a license for caprice. Moreover, it must be sustained by the unit itself; it does not arise from the void.

The level of security for each unit is determined entirely by that unit's productive capacity. Should a unit produce nothing, construct nothing, maintain nothing, its security is held at the barest minimum. It will not starve—but it will receive nothing beyond that.

2. The Individual Level: Non-Work Is a Necessary Consequence

We must first correct a misapprehension.

Non-work is not an exceptional state requiring permission; it is the inevitable consequence of fully developed productive forces. When automation, artificial intelligence, and intelligent systems assume the overwhelming share of productive labor, humanity naturally finds itself with no "work" left to do—or rather, with no

further need to labor for mere survival.

Yet this does not mean that human beings are left with nothing at all. Beyond work lies an inexhaustible field of possibility:

To idle, letting the mind wander freely;

To contemplate, allowing questions to surface in stillness;

To create, not for output but for expression;

To live, not for accomplishment but for experience itself.

The shortening of working hours and the contraction of employment are not a crisis of civilization; they are its triumph.

In the future, the tasks requiring human hands will grow ever fewer, and work will grow ever scarcer—yet this does not portend a worse life for humanity. On the contrary, as science and technology advance, the productive capacity of the unit can only strengthen, and the level of security can only rise.

Work merely sustains the basic existence of the unit. It is beyond work that the unit is perfected, and that each person truly lives.

Therefore, if a unit as a whole succeeds in maintaining self-sufficiency, then securing the living standards of its members is the collective responsibility of that unit—a matter of common consensus, and indeed the very embodiment of civilizational progress.

Should an individual choose not to participate in productive labor—choosing instead to idle, to think, to live, to be absorbed in their own world—that is their freedom, and the proper fruit of developed productive forces. They are not a burden upon the unit; they exist simply in another mode. And the unit has both the capacity and the obligation to safeguard their livelihood—not as an act of tolerance, but because it is as it should be.

3. The Unit Level: Self-Sufficiency Is the Unit's Foundation

Individuals may abstain from work; the unit itself, however, may never abandon self-sufficiency.

A "unit" is, by definition, a community capable of self-sufficiency in food, energy, and essential materials. If a unit loses that capacity, it ceases to be a unit.

Thus, should a unit collectively renounce its capacity for self-preservation—producing nothing, building nothing, maintaining nothing—until its self-sufficiency falls below a certain threshold, the system will activate its reflexive protection mechanism:

First warning: The system appries the unit that its self-sufficiency has fallen below the threshold, grants a grace period, and offers recommendations for restoration.

Second warning: The system declares that, if the decline persists, the unit will be designated a "non-self-sustaining unit."

Critical point: Upon reaching the critical threshold, the unit is detached from the system of its own accord.

After detachment:

The unit is no longer recognized as a civilizational unit.

Logistical, commercial, and informational channels with other units are severed.

The unit no longer enjoys access to cross-unit collaborative resources.

Individuals within the unit retain Basic Livelihood Guarantee, but at a level reduced to the limit of the unit's remaining output.

This is not punishment; it is the reflexive protection of the system.

For the system itself: it prevents a unit incapable of self-sustenance from encumbering the operation of the whole civilizational network.

For the unit: it compels the unit to confront reality—if you choose not to produce, then you shall bear the consequences of not producing.

For the individual: those within the unit may choose to remain as they are, or may

reorganize and resume production; those who are themselves still contributing may likewise choose to detach and affiliate with another unit.

Should a detached unit subsequently recover its capacity for self-sufficiency, it may apply to rejoin the system. No permanent blacklist exists.

4. Seclusion and Detachment

If a person chooses to depart from the unit and live in solitary seclusion, that is their freedom. They no longer enjoy the collaborative resources of the unit, nor do they request any assistance from it.

The unit may, of its own volition, offer help. That is the unit's freedom, not its obligation. Whether to accept or decline is likewise the individual's freedom.

This is not exile; it is a boundary. You have chosen not to resonate with the unit, and the unit honors your choice. You have chosen not to ask for help, and the unit honors that as well. Should you choose to return, the system raises no barrier and welcomes you at any moment.

5. Entering "Infinite Contribution" Early Is a Strategic Imperative

Some may ask: if we enter the phase of Infinite Contribution so soon, will everyone simply stop working?

This is a misunderstanding. The arrival of the Infinite Contribution phase does not occur because everyone has lain down; it occurs because the productive forces have advanced to the point where the overwhelming majority of subsistence labor no longer requires human intervention. AI, automation, and intelligent systems have absorbed the repetitive, the strenuous, and the perilous. Humanity is emancipated from labor for survival.

The Infinite Contribution phase transforms the relation between labor and survival, but it does not alter the fundamental rule that a unit must remain self-sufficient. Should a unit collectively choose to do nothing even within this phase, the same unit-level mechanism applies without exception.

6. Catastrophe and Exception: The System's Ultimate Protective Mechanism

There exists a circumstance in which a unit—owing to natural disaster, external shock, or systemic crisis—finds its members unable to restore productive capacity despite every willingness to contribute.

In such a case, the system will not stand idly by. Other units will initiate autonomous relief, grounded in the resonance-response mechanism intrinsic to the resonant order. When a distress signal is perceived, the contribution networks of neighboring units respond spontaneously, furnishing materials, manpower, and technical support.

This is an extension of the system's reflexive protection: the system does not interfere with individual choices, yet at the holistic level it shields itself from destruction by localized collapse.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The system compels no one to work. Yet neither does it bear, on anyone's behalf, the consequences of not working.

At the individual level: non-work is the necessary consequence of developed productive forces. The unit's security does not diminish; it can only improve with the advance of science and technology.

At the unit level: choose not to produce, and you detach from the system of your own accord; resume production, and the system welcomes you back.

Work merely sustains the unit's existence; it is beyond work that the unit is perfected and each person truly lives.

Such is the reflexive protection of the system: it honors every choice, and it honors the consequences of every choice equally. It does not punish the one who does not work, but neither does it underwrite a unit that has forsaken self-sufficiency.

There is no "goodness" here; there is only reason.

When a unit is unwilling to secure its own continued existence and contributes nothing to the system as a whole, on what grounds should the system protect it? This is not coldness; it is honesty at the level of civilization. Protection is not unconditional alms; it is a response to the will to endure.

And when you have become truly rational—perceiving the necessary bond between contribution and survival, perceiving that "not adding burden to the system" is itself the most fundamental rational choice—in that moment, you are the true good.

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

This chapter accomplishes a threefold orientation.

First, through the ten-stage conception of history, we discern our historical coordinates. The systemic deadlock of the old Paradigm is an accomplished fact; the birth of the new Paradigm is the only road to civilizational survival.

Second, we have confronted the most readily misunderstood element of transformation. Transition is not dispossession; it is an invitation—an invitation extended to all, including the vested interests of the old world, to live truly, for once.

Third, we have answered the most elementary institutional question. What if no one works? The reflexive protection of the system supplies the answer: no coercion, no intervention; respect the choice, and respect all that the choice entails.

This orientation lays the cognitive foundation for the "Prairie Fire Project" that

follows: we know why transformation is necessary; we know how to treat the old world; and we know how the institutions of the new world defend themselves against dissolution. To grasp this is the precondition for entering the next chapter.

Chapter Two: A Guide to Action — The Prairie Fire Plan

Trilogy

Chapter Introduction

The value of a blueprint lies in its capacity to direct action. Having established both our historical coordinates and our ultimate destination, this chapter shall set forth a complete and incremental roadmap of practice — the Prairie Fire Plan. This plan seeks, through three interlinked and successively deepening stages, to transform the grand vision of a Contributionist civilization from the spark of an idea into a conflagration that sweeps across the old Paradigm. From the stress-testing of a social operating system within a minimal viable unit, to the functional integration and endogenous cycle-building of an entire administrative district, and finally to the physical foundation of a civilizational commonwealth and global fusion — this chapter will elaborate, step by step, the program of action, the core mechanisms, and the ultimate significance of each stage. It is at once a rigorous operational manual and a civilizational manifesto charged with historical self-consciousness.

Section One: Spark Plan I — The Stress-Test of a New Social Operating System (Operational Manual)

"Spark Plan I" is the point of departure and the cornerstone of the entire civilizational-Paradigm revolution. Its core mission is to select a city- or township-level region possessing a certain degree of autonomy, and to conduct within it a comprehensive and thoroughgoing experimental switch to a Contributionist social operating system — thereby achieving the historic breakthrough from zero to one, and verifying the feasibility, resilience, and superiority of the new Paradigm in the real world.

1. The Bedrock of the Contribution Value System — Principles, Imperatives, and Architecture

1.1 Institutional Principles and Imperatives

Core concept: Contribution Value is a quantitative record of the substantive contributions made by an individual or organization to the survival and flourishing of the community. It is a credit voucher used for the distribution of resources and honor — not a currency.

Fundamental purpose: To resolve the structural contradictions engendered by the old Paradigm centered on capital accumulation — among them, the polarization of wealth, the business cycle, and systemic fragility — and to redirect the driving force of social development from the pursuit of profit to the creation of contribution.

Core principles:

No upper limit on issuance: Society issues Contribution Value in full measure for every confirmed contribution, never setting a ceiling, so as to incentivize boundless innovation.

Upper limit on holding: To prevent the sedimentation of value and the germination of power, thereby promoting the circulation of social resources.

Excess conversion: Amounts beyond the holding cap are converted into "Eternal Honor Points," providing the highest spiritual incentive and non-material reward.

Purity of the system: Non-transferable, non-tradable, non-inheritable — thereby foreclosing capitalization from the root.

Consumable: Contribution Value may be redeemed for all products and services within society, ensuring its firm real purchasing power and rendering it an effective instrument of both incentive and distribution.

Public ownership of the means of production and the competitive standard of managerial rights: To safeguard the purity of the Contribution Value System and to preclude at the root the exploitation and class solidification arising from private ownership of the means of production, the new Paradigm establishes social public ownership of the means of production as an inviolable fundamental institution.

1.2 The Technical Architecture — The Three Pillars of Civilization

A large-scale and complex society must depend on three technical pillars for the efficient and equitable operation of the Contribution Value System:

The AI Assessment Layer (the brain of the system): Responsible for processing vast quantities of data, operating complex contribution-quantification models, simulating the social effects of different policies, and forecasting long-term trends — thereby supplying decision support for precise governance. It is itself the advanced form of automation: the automation of intelligent decision-making.

The Blockchain Trust Layer (the spine of the system): Provides a transparent, immutable, and traceable ledger of contributions and distributions. Through smart contracts, it executes established rules automatically and without bias, laying the technical foundation of the system's public credibility.

The Digital Terminal Application Layer (the limbs of the system): Confers upon every citizen a unified digital identity and interactive interface, integrating governmental affairs, livelihood, consumption, learning, and collaboration into a single operable surface — the interface within reach of every person under the new civilizational Paradigm. It realizes the automation of service delivery and informational exchange.

Automation technology, meanwhile, is the soul that runs through and activates this triad:

Core function: The comprehensive automation of material production and foundational service processes radically resolves the question of scarcity — the core proposition of traditional economics — and supplies the material abundance upon which the Contributionist Paradigm rests. It transforms "unemployment" from a social crisis into a celebration of civilizational emancipation: a sign that ever more people may be released from subsistence labor, devoting their time and intelligence to knowledge creation, artistic exploration, deep collaboration, and spiritual pursuits — fields that embody Contribution Value more fully.

1.3 A Comparison with Primitive Social Architecture — The Universality of the Principle

Even in the most primitive tribal society, a primordial version of the Contribution Value System is discernible:

Quantification criteria: Who hunted more, gathered more, crafted better tools — contribution was immediately evident.

Trust and record: In a small-scale acquaintance society, each member's contributions were clearly "remembered" by all, forming a shared consensus.

Immediate feedback: The fruits of labor were shared collectively; those who contributed more received greater respect and allocative authority.

Simplicity of labor: The division of labor was rudimentary and easily assessed.

Conclusion: The inner logic of the Contribution Value System is universal. The complexity of modern society — in population, territory, and division of labor — obliges us to replace the primitive triad of "human memory, oral consensus, and simple labor" with the three pillars of AI, blockchain, and digital terminals. But the core philosophy of distribution according to contribution is continuous across all ages.

2. A Practice Guide for Community Initiatives Without State Sponsorship

For communities, ecovillages, or cooperative enterprises voluntarily formed across the globe, the Contribution Value System may be practiced through the following steps:

Consensus of principles and drafting of a charter: All members must fully embrace the Contribution Value philosophy and collectively draft a Community Contribution Covenant defining the basic rules.

A simple quantification standard: In the early stage, no complex model is needed. Members engage in democratic deliberation and formulate a clear and simple schedule of Contribution Values (e.g., one hour of farming = one Contribution Value; one repair of public infrastructure = three Contribution Values; teaching one skill course = five Contribution Values).

Low-cost technical solutions:

Record-keeping: An open-source shared spreadsheet, or a lightweight private blockchain node. The essence is that all records are public and verifiable.

Settlement period: A weekly or monthly settlement cycle is set, and each person's contribution ledger is published.

Internal circulation of resources: Agricultural produce, handicrafts, and services (such as haircutting or repairs) within the community are all priced in Contribution Value, and members redeem them against their recorded contributions.

Dynamic adjustment mechanism: Periodic community assemblies are convened to revise the quantification standards and rules in light of operational feedback, realizing "self-consistent democracy within a small community."

Interface with the outside world: In its initial phase, the community will still need to conduct monetary transactions externally. A "Foreign Exchange Group" may be established, tasked with exchanging the community's products for external currency to purchase essential goods that cannot be produced internally. The work of this group is likewise credited in Contribution Value.

Objective: Such communities, as "cells of the new civilizational Paradigm," verify the feasibility of the system through the success of their own practice, attract ever more participants, and gather toward a prairie fire.

3. The Organized Construction of a Contribution System at the Municipal/Township Level with State Leadership

This constitutes the core of "Spark Plan I," aiming to conduct a comprehensive civilizational-Paradigm switch using a complete administrative region as the unit.

Those who have completed the second step may, through various means, urge the local government to undertake the transition and formally enter the "Spark Plan I" stage.

Preference is given to regions rich in resources and capable of self-sufficiency in basic survival and daily necessities; resource-poor regions may be integrated with resource-rich ones.

3.1 Preliminary Preparations

3.1.1. Establishment of core service organs:

The Spark Plan Executive Service Commission: The supreme committee and coordinating body.

The Contributionist Ideology Promotion Service Department: Responsible for publicity, education, and interpretation of Contributionist principles, so that the populace may embrace them and hold them in their hearts.

The Planning and Construction Service Department: Responsible for the overall planning of land, industry, and infrastructure across the entire territory.

The Law and Rules Service Department: Drafts the Provisional Administrative Measures for the Pilot Zone and all supplementary regulations.

The Contribution-Value Quantification Service Department: Responsible for setting initial contribution-quantification standards for all industries, and establishing a dynamic adjustment mechanism.

The Population and Social Coordination Service Department: Handles residents' voluntary departure or retention, property compensation, skills registration, and mobilization.

The Resource Coordination Service Department: Coordinates resources within the zone, and manages necessary material exchange with the outside.

The Technical Platform Service Department: Deploys the blockchain and AI computing infrastructure, and develops the resident terminal application.

The Security Assurance Service Department: Responsible for physical and cyber security during the transition period.

3.1.2. Land and industrial planning (following the principle of survival first):

Comprehensive territorial survey: Precise mapping conducted with GIS and drones.

Functional zoning:

Agricultural and ecological zones: Permanent basic farmland, forest land, water-conservation areas, and ecological reserves are demarcated. These form the foundation of survival.

Core residential and living zones: Compact, intensive settlements are planned, with

basic living facilities attached. Specific arrangements shall be adjusted according to local conditions, population, and resident wishes; the will of local residents must be respected above all.

Basic industrial zones: Concentrated sites for food processing, agricultural-machinery repair, building-materials production, and energy generation (solar, wind) — the secondary industries required for fundamental operation.

Development zones: Reserved space for future education, scientific research, culture, advanced manufacturing, and other growth.

Urban planning: Strict limits are imposed on the area of urban land, which is permitted only to the extent required by local functions. Priority is ceded to foundational land use, particularly farmland and ecological space.

3.1.3. Deployment of the three pillars of technology: This must be completed before the pilot work begins, with the terminal application placed in the hands of every resident. Manufacturers at home or abroad may be coordinated for production, or production facilities may be constructed in advance within the pilot zone.

3.2 The Official Pilot Work — Year One: The Year of Survival Infrastructure

Core logic: Following the priority ordering of human needs, concentrate all forces to sequentially complete every link necessary for survival, ensuring that under all circumstances the pilot zone can subsist independently.

Stage One: Agricultural land transformation and preparation (Months 1–3)

Tasks: In accordance with the plan, carry out standardization and mechanization-friendly transformation of farmland. Construct water-conservation facilities (canals, drip-irrigation systems), roads, and power grids. Repair or build granaries and warehouses.

Stage Two: First sowing and food production (Months 4–9)

Tasks: Devote full effort to spring plowing and summer field management. This is the year's central undertaking; a bountiful autumn harvest must be secured. In parallel, initiate the early construction of animal husbandry (hogs, poultry, aquaculture).

Stage Three: Housing and core support facilities (commencing concurrently with Stage Two, continuing through year's end)

Tasks: Immediately after spring plowing, launch the construction and renovation of residential zones in both countryside and town, ensuring that before winter arrives all inhabitants have safe and warm shelter. Simultaneously complete the physical premises of regional hospitals/clinics and foundational schools.

Stage Four: Autumn harvest and system closure (Months 10–12)

Tasks: Complete the autumn harvest and bring grain into storage. At this juncture, the six cornerstones of survival — food, water, electricity, shelter, medicine, and education — are all built and operational. The Contribution Value System should by now have covered all of the above productive and construction activities, with internal circulation achieved.

Marker: Residents can stably exchange Contribution Value for food, housing, basic medical care, and educational services.

Verification of outcomes at the close of Year One:

When the pilot zone has operated successfully for one year, a small civilizational loop has been formed — one that does not depend on external currency and is driven at its core by Contribution Value. It has demonstrated that the Contribution Value System can effectively organize social production and accomplish the most arduous survival-protection tasks. At this point, the feasibility of the Contribution Value System has received its most solid proof.

Stage Five: Subsequent development.

Upon the firm foundation of survival, beginning in the second year, the Contribution Value System may be gradually extended to broader domains:

Upgrade and construct new food-processing plants, clothing factories, furniture factories, and the like, to elevate the quality of life.

Vigorously develop education and scientific research, innovate the Contributionist social education system, and establish more advanced academies and research institutes.

Encourage artistic and cultural creation, enriching the spiritual world, always in conformity with Contributionist social principles.

Optimize public services and governance models.

Gradually refine the contribution-quantification system, dynamically adjusting the basic contribution guarantee and the standards for various industries in light of unfolding developments. Investigate long-term tracing mechanisms in depth, so that no contribution is ever buried in oblivion.

After the completion of foundational construction, the work of government gradually recedes from the stage of history. The service departments established in the initial phase dissolve into the populace. Apart from the issuance of necessary tasks, all matters are left to the free development of the people, managed efficiently by the various service organizations the people themselves form.

All this is natural growth and organic refinement upon the foundation laid in Year One. The entire society enters a healthy, vigorous, virtuous cycle oriented toward contribution.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The success of "Spark Plan I" marks the historic breakthrough of Contributionist civilization from zero to one. It is not merely the construction of a community; it is the successful launch of a functioning social operating system. This minimal viable unit — like the first lighthouse of a new civilization rising amid the vast ocean of the old world — proves by irrefutable fact that the Contribution Value System can

effectively organize production, safeguard survival, and ignite vitality, while building a society more just and more resilient than what came before. It furnishes the new Paradigm with its most solid foundation of practice and its seed of conviction, and kindles the crucial first spark for the prairie fire that is to come.

Section Two: Spark Plan II — The Integration of Administrative Regions and the Endogenous Cycle

The success of "Spark Plan I" has produced a highly idealized demonstrative unit. The core mission of "Spark Plan II" is to take a complete prefecture-level administrative region — encompassing all of its constituent districts, counties, townships, and villages — as an integrated whole, and to conduct upon it a comprehensive Paradigm shift to Contributionism, thereby constructing an advanced model of human society that is internally complete in function, internally complementary in the circulation of resources, capable of self-sustenance, and poised for continued development.

1. Core Objectives and Planning Principles

1.1 Core Objectives

Integrated administrative consolidation: With the original successful pilot as its nucleus, the entire prefecture-level administrative region containing it — including multiple districts and counties — is subjected to integrated design and transformation.

Closed-loop internal functionality: Ensure that within the administrative region, the principal functional loops — from food production and energy supply to advanced manufacturing and public services — are completed internally.

Endogenous resource complementarity: Delve into and optimize the disparities in resource endowments among the different sub-regions within the administrative region, forging an efficient network of internal complementarity.

A replicable model of governance: Develop a set of Contributionist governance standards applicable to the administration of complex administrative regions.

1.2 Planning Principles

The principle of functional complementarity: Overall planning is conducted at the

prefecture level; every district and county serves as a fundamental functional zone with a clearly defined core mandate, integrated into the entire administrative region through the Contribution Value System.

The priority of survival and ecology: Agricultural land and ecological land possess absolute precedence. The area of urban construction zones and industrial zones is stringently confined to the minimum necessary to fulfill their core functions.

A pragmatic and innovative energy strategy: Prioritize the development of mature clean energy sources such as hydroelectric and solar power, while simultaneously establishing special Contribution Value incentives for research into novel energy technologies.

2. The Construction of an Internal Functional Network within the Administrative Region

2.1 Regional Selection and Composition

At the national scale, one to three prefecture-level administrative regions are selected within each provincial-level administrative region for inclusion in the plan.

All districts and counties under the jurisdiction of each selected prefecture-level region are incorporated into the scope of transformation.

The original successful pilot of "Spark Plan I" expands outward into its periphery, driving the transformation of the whole.

2.2 Definition and Division of Functional Zones

Each district and county constitutes a functional complex, with differing emphases:

Districts — Manufacturing and service agglomerations

Core functions: The concentrated siting of advanced manufacturing (e.g., precision instruments, medical equipment), administrative services, higher education, and

healthcare.

Internal structure: Intensive residential zones, industrial parks, and surrounding agricultural belts.

Counties — Resource assurance and specialty-industry zones

Core functions: Serving as the administrative region's "grain base," "energy base," and "ecological core."

Internal structure: The county seat functions as a service hub; rural areas are responsible for large-scale agriculture, forestry, animal husbandry, and energy installations such as hydroelectric stations and photovoltaic plants.

2.3 Mechanisms of Internal Complementarity

Complementarity between districts and counties: Districts supply counties with machinery, technology, and services; counties supply districts with a stable flow of grain, energy, and raw materials.

Complementarity between counties and counties: The hydroelectric power of mountainous counties is transmitted to plains counties; the grain of plains counties supports forestry counties.

Circulation of Contribution Value: All products and services are settled through the unified Contribution Value System, facilitating the efficient flow of resources.

3. Organizational Architecture and Energy Strategy

3.1 The Executive Service Commission for Spark Plan II Administrative Regions

The Commission is composed of the original "Spark Plan I" pilot team, residents of demonstrated competence and willingness, and representatives of the various districts and counties.

It is responsible for top-level design, rule-making, cross-district coordination, and adjudication within the Contribution Value System.

It draws upon the personnel and technical assets of the original "Spark Plan I" pilot unit.

Preliminary preparations and operational procedures follow the provisions of "Spark Plan I."

3.2 A Pragmatic and Innovative Energy Strategy

First priority: The development of hydroelectric stations, providing stable base-load power.

Second priority: The promotion of household and community solar micro-grids, achieving distributed complementarity.

Third priority: The establishment of Contribution Value rewards to incentivize research into geothermal, hydrogen, and other novel energy sources.

4. Phased Deployment

4.1 Phase One: The Replication of the System and the Census of Resources (Year One)

Extend the Contribution Value System across all districts and counties within the administrative region.

Complete a precise survey of land, population, industry, and resources.

4.2 Phase Two: The Construction of Functional Zones and Internal Coordination (Years One–Two)

Define and reinforce the core functions of each district and county.

Construct the smart power grid, the logistics network, and the data network.

Consolidate the material foundation of internal complementarity.

4.3 Phase Three: A High-Quality Endogenous Cycle (Years Two–Five)

Achieve a high degree of self-sufficiency in energy, grain, and core industrial goods.

Deeply empower education, scientific research, culture, and other domains through the Contribution Value System.

Foster a regional culture and identity rooted in internal resource complementarity.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The advance of "Spark Plan II" marks the expansion of the new civilizational Paradigm from a viable cell to a robust organism. It succeeds in verifying that the Contributionist system, when applied to the governance of a complex administrative region encompassing cities, villages, mountains, and plains, possesses undiminished vitality and superiority. By constructing a networked social model of internal functional complementarity and the symbiotic circulation of resources, it achieves a qualitative transformation from point to plane, demonstrating that the new Paradigm can resolve the challenges of coordination and governance in a large-scale society. It thereby furnishes the civilizational blueprint with a complete and replicable template, proving that Contributionism is no longer an ideal experiment but a genuinely practicable path of civilizational development.

Section Three: Spark Plan III — The Integration of the Civilizational Commonwealth and the Construction of Material Foundations

Upon the successful establishment of model administrative regions in various provinces and municipalities through "Spark Plan I" and "Spark Plan II," "Spark Plan III" is to be coordinated by a Civilizational Council spanning multiple nations and regions, undertaking two core missions:

The scalable diffusion of the social Paradigm: To mobilize all transformed "Contributionist units," using them as bases for the export of institutions and comprehensive support to surrounding untransformed regions, achieving the prairie-fire propagation of the social model.

The perpetual construction of civilizational foundations: To initiate a grand project of natural transformation centered upon the "National Water Network" — a composite system of several main river channels, multiple secondary arteries, and capillary canal networks. Its fundamental purpose is to eradicate flood and drought catastrophes once and for all through terraced water retention, intelligent water diversion, and inter-basin complementarity, achieving a dynamic equilibrium of "storing water in times of scarcity and diverting water when full" — thereby eternally safeguarding the lives and property of the people and laying an unshakable foundation for the survival and flourishing of Contributionist society.

The two missions proceed in parallel, each empowering the other. Social transformation infuses the engineering endeavor with soul and momentum; the engineering endeavor bestows upon society an everlasting cornerstone of existence.

1. The Core Mechanisms of Societal Diffusion

1.1 The Formation and Dispatch of the "Spark Emissary Corps"

Composition: The Corps is composed of the core pilot teams from the original "Spark Plan I" and "Spark Plan II," volunteer residents of proven experience and instructional capacity, and representatives of the various districts and counties.

Core mandate: Responsible for top-level design, rule-making, cross-regional coordination, and final adjudication within the Contribution Value System of newly diffused regions. Its essential task is to impart experience, not to issue commands.

Resource support: Unconditional mobilization of the technological apparatus, managerial protocols, and training materials already validated within the original successful units.

1.2 The Principle of Targeted Support and Risk-Controlled Integration

Complementary integration of resources: The Civilizational Council coordinates the designation of resource-abundant regions to be integrated with resource-scarce regions.

The principle of risk dispersion: The assistance undertaking of any single supporting unit shall never exceed the bearing capacity of its own system.

1.3 Immediate Incentive and the Purity of the System

All Contribution Values generated during the process of diffusion and construction are issued directly and immediately to individual accounts through the terminal system.

All workflows strictly replicate the validated standards established in "Spark Plan I" and "Spark Plan II."

2. Integrated Engineering Construction and the Perpetuity of Civilization

2.1 The "Canal Construction Corps" Model Driven by Contribution Value

Task decomposition and the primacy of voluntary participation: Under the planning of the Civilizational Council and AI computations, the construction of the main channels and their secondary networks is decomposed into countless segments. Priority is given to safeguarding internal transformation, while residents of all regions are encouraged to organize voluntarily and apply for construction tasks, utilizing surplus labor and heavy machinery.

Immediate Contribution Value incentives: The speed, quality, and innovation with which tasks are completed are directly converted into vast quantities of Contribution Value, issued in real time.

The honor system: A national real-time contribution leaderboard is established, igniting the collective sense of honor of "securing ten thousand generations of peace for posterity."

2.2 The Terraced-Hub System: The Core of Water Retention, Hydroelectric Generation, and Diversion

Terraced structure: A series of terraced hubs is constructed at pivotal points along river courses, with core functions as follows:

Stepwise water retention: Through a system of sluice gates and dams, water is intercepted and stored layer by layer during periods of high flow, forming a "cascade of reservoirs" that secures water supply during dry seasons.

Hydroelectric generation: Utilizing the elevation differential between adjacent terraces, hydroelectric stations are constructed, furnishing stable, clean base-load electricity to the regions along the corridor.

Intelligent flood diversion: During flood seasons, AI-regulated gates systematically divert excess floodwaters into designated detention and flood-storage zones, secondary arteries, or groundwater recharge areas, achieving "diversion when water

runs full" and ensuring the safety of the main channels.

Multifunctional integration: Every hub zone is developed into a regional center-town, integrating energy, transportation, governance, and industrial functions.

2.3 The Synchronous Growth of the "Canal Economic Belt" and "Spark Communities"

Integrated planning: The routes of the main channels, secondary arteries, and capillary networks are planned in concert with the new communities, farms, and factories along both banks.

An immediate positive feedback loop: Builders may immediately redeem their Contribution Values for real products and services, and bear witness with their own eyes to how their labor tames rivers, transforming calamity into benefit.

2.4 Social Mobilization and Civilizational Ascension

This undertaking, which eradicates millennia of flood affliction, will allow every individual to discover value and dignity within a monumental enterprise.

The lofty sentiment of "taming the rivers and securing the nation's tranquility" gathers the whole of society's creative energies into the task of building an enduring homeland — this is itself a profound ascension of civilization.

Social transformation is the precondition for engineering construction; the cart must not be placed before the horse. Prior to transformation, space may be reserved for canal construction in accordance with the plan, with construction to commence after the transformation is complete. The transition period is approximately one year, after which resources may be devoted to the construction of the canal network.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The inauguration of "Spark Plan III" symbolizes the entry of Contributionist civilization into a new epoch of large-scale foundation-laying. It unites the diffusion

of the social Paradigm with the great undertaking of reshaping nature. Through century-spanning projects such as the National Water Network, it gathers the creative energies of the entire society upon the shared objective of building a permanent homeland. This is not merely the geographic linking of mountains and rivers; it is the consolidation, among human beings, of a civilizational covenant of shared destiny. It demonstrates that the aim of the new civilization is not only to replace the "software" of social operation, but to employ the assembled strength of the people in laying physical foundations for a thousand generations — achieving a magnificent ascent from passive submission to nature toward active and harmonious governance. At this juncture, the spark has become a conflagration, and the torrent of civilization is irreversible.

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

The "Prairie Fire Plan" trilogy constructs a complete path of practice from microcosmic validation to meso-level integration and thence to macrocosmic foundation-laying. It systematically answers the core question of how the new civilization is to be transformed from an ideal into reality. From the kindled spark of conviction in "Spark Plan I," to the replicable template formed by "Spark Plan II," and onward to the civilizational-commonwealth integration and physical foundation-laying inaugurated by "Spark Plan III," each step lays a solid groundwork for the next, forming an interlocked and irreversible historical momentum. This is not merely a rigorous program of action; it is a profound social mobilization. It demonstrates to the world that the Contributionist Paradigm possesses comprehensive superiority and practical feasibility across concept, institution, and practice. When the dawn of the new civilization illuminates the earth through these successful instances, the immense "paradigmatic attraction" thus generated will ultimately guide humanity as a whole toward a new epoch that takes pride in creation and contribution. The next chapter shall continue to explore the crucial combinations within the "Prairie Fire Plan."

Chapter Three: Global Strategy — The Civilizational Open

Conspiracy and the Ultimate Transition

Chapter Introduction

With the blueprint of the new civilization drawn and its path of practice made clear, we must now cast our gaze upon the global stage, completing the elevation of vision from "builder" to "vanguard." This chapter aims to construct the global strategic system of Contributionist civilization, whose core is an open, transparent, and irresistible "civilizational open conspiracy." We are no longer content with the internal construction of a Paradigm; we shall actively guide the ultimate transition of the global order. This chapter will first elaborate the ascension path of the new civilization's governance and security nucleus — the "Civilizational Council" and the "Civilizational Guard" — laying the skeleton for global expansion; then, it will reconceptualize "social security" internally, elevating it from a matter of public service to an unassailable cornerstone of civilization, furnishing the new Paradigm with its deepest internal cohesion; finally, it will unveil the "Golden Silence Plan," designed to accelerate the end of the old order, completing the ultimate accumulation of material and intellectual power through open strategic procurement, and compelling the world to make a historic choice between "voluntary accession" and "passive dissolution." This is not merely strategy; it is the most rational avenue of escape this era affords us.

Section One: The Civilizational Ascension Plan — The Construction of the Council and the Guard Corps

The Civilizational Council and the Civilizational Guard are two inseparable facets of a single whole within Contributionist civilization. The former is the civilization's governing brain and institutional engine; the latter is its immune system and security cornerstone. Both must be planned in concert with the "Spark Plan," developing in synergy from the very outset. Their construction does not begin after social transformation is complete; rather, it commences in lockstep with the three major "Spark Plans," each shaping the other, culminating — at the moment the nationwide transformation is achieved — in the comprehensive elevation and integration of the governance and security systems.

1. The Civilizational Council: The Global Governance Nucleus and Institutional Engine

Strategic synergy with the "Golden Silence Plan"

This Civilizational Ascension Plan and the "Golden Silence Plan," which serves as the economic strategy, are mutually reinforcing, advancing in tandem like two horns of a pincer.

Through the strategic liquidation of the old monetary system and open procurement, the "Golden Silence Plan" consolidates the material foundations of the civilizational commonwealth while actively accelerating the dissolution of the external old order, thereby creating a favorable international environment and a window of opportunity for the expansion of this Ascension Plan.

This Ascension Plan, in turn, is dedicated to constructing a matching governance and security architecture — novel, stable, and reliable — ensuring that when the old order falters or even collapses, a superior institutional alternative stands ready to receive

and integrate the strategic fruits yielded by the "Golden Silence Plan," along with the nations undergoing transition.

Together, the two plans constitute a complete strategic system: internally, the construction of the Contributionist Paradigm; externally, the guidance of the global transition.

1.1 Fundamental Nature

The supreme governing institution of Contributionist civilization and the center of institutional design and maintenance.

1.2 Primary Responsibilities

Institutional construction and Guardship of the Charter: To formulate, interpret, and continuously refine the legal and ethical framework of the Civilizational Charter and the global Contribution Value System.

Macro-strategic planning and coordination: To direct the planning of the civilizational commonwealth's global energy structure, ecological balance, scientific and technological research, and economic development strategy.

Membership integration and systemic expansion: To guide, review, and assist new members in completing their internal social transformation; to actively attract and admit further nations and regions into the civilizational commonwealth.

External relations and cross-border governance: To represent the entire civilizational commonwealth in dialogue and negotiation with non-member states; to administer cross-border resource circulation and equitable trade based on the Contribution Value System.

1.3 Composition and Structure

The General Assembly of Delegates: The supreme authority and legislative body. Composed of regional representatives from each member state, apportioned according

to a comprehensive ratio of population and regional Contribution Value, it is responsible for legislative deliberation and major decision-making.

The Executive Committee: The supreme administrative organ. Composed of full-time members elected by the General Assembly, it is responsible for daily administrative management, strategic execution, and global coordination.

The Institutional Court: The supreme judicial and arbitral body. Composed of senior jurists, ethicists, and Contributionist theorists selected from across the globe, it is responsible for the definitive interpretation of the Charter and the adjudication of transnational legal disputes.

The Department of External Liaison and Publicity: A core functional organ. Responsible for systematically communicating Contributionist principles to the international community, presenting the achievements of the "Spark Plan," and negotiating the terms of accession — the forward position for attracting and admitting new members.

2. The Civilizational Guard: The Ultimate Defender of the Charter and the System

2.1 Fundamental Nature

The ultimate defender of the Civilizational Charter and the fundamental institutions of Contributionism. It is the unified and indivisible immune system and security force of the civilizational commonwealth.

2.2 Primary Responsibilities

Collective external defense: Under unified command, to repel any external military aggression and existential threat, safeguarding the territorial integrity and sovereignty of the commonwealth.

Internal institutional security: To guard against, identify, and eliminate any acts of

"anti-civilizational crime" aimed at systematically subverting the Contribution Value System, preserving the purity and stability of the fundamental institutions.

Ultimate relief and guarantee: In circumstances where the regular governance and judicial systems have failed, to serve as the final guarantor, providing citizens with avenues of remedy consistent with the principles of the Civilizational Charter.

Response to major global crises: To participate in and lead the response to global ecological catastrophes, humanitarian crises, and other major emergent challenges.

2.3 Composition and Structure

The General Staff Joint Conference: The supreme strategic planning and coordination body. Composed of representatives elected by each theater and functional unit on the basis of professional Contribution Value and capability, it is responsible for strategic formulation and cross-regional coordination. It is not a traditional hierarchical command structure.

Theaters / Functional Task Groups: The fundamental operational and executive units. Dynamically configured, modular task organizations delineated by geographic region or professional function (e.g., cyber, space, ecology).

The Charter Oversight Committee: An independent supervisory body. Responsible for monitoring the adherence of all units and members within the Guard Corps to the principles of the Civilizational Charter, and for receiving and investigating appeals invoking the "conscientious objection veto."

The Center for Education and Transformation: The core institution for ideological and capacity building. Responsible for inculcating Contributionist principles, Charter education, and training in novel modes of operation for all newly integrated units and members.

3. The Four-Stage Ascension Path

This path advances in lockstep with the "Spark Plan," ensuring that social transformation, governance innovation, and the reshaping of armed force resonate at the same frequency.

Stage One: Preparation and Embryonic Formation (initiated prior to "Spark Plan I")

Core orientation: The laying of ideological and organizational foundations.

Core tasks: Within the first member states that have endorsed and resolved to undergo transformation, complete the top-level design and preliminary formation of the Civilizational Council and the Civilizational Guard.

Civilizational Council: An embryonic Council is established, its core work being global ideological outreach, the preliminary design of the institutional framework, and the formulation of the Guard Corps formation plan.

Civilizational Guard: In the initial phase, the original national military establishment is retained to guarantee national defense, while comprehensive education in Contributionist thought and the Civilizational Charter commences for existing military personnel, along with preliminary research into organizational restructuring.

Stage Two: Pilot and Restructuring (marked by the completion of "Spark Plan I")

Core orientation: Practical validation and the creation of a model.

Core tasks: Taking the first successfully transformed pilot zone as the model, initiate the substantive restructuring of the Civilizational Guard and validate the institutional framework of the Civilizational Council.

Civilizational Guard: The original armed forces within the "Spark Plan I" pilot zone are restructured into the first "Model Civilizational Guard" unit conforming to the new Paradigm, with full implementation of new norms such as the "leaderless decision-making mechanism" and the "conscientious objection veto."

Civilizational Council: After its institutional framework has been validated through pilot-zone practice, it undergoes systematic refinement and transitions from an

embryonic body toward formal, systematized operation.

Stage Three: Integration and Unification (accompanying the nationwide rollout of "Spark Plans II/III")

Core orientation: Comprehensive fusion and systemic establishment.

Core tasks: Concurrent with the advancement of the Contributionist Paradigm across the nation's provinces and municipalities, complete the integration of the nationwide armed forces and the comprehensive establishment of the Civilizational Council's governance system.

Civilizational Guard: With the successful advancement of "Spark Plans II/III" in each province and municipality, the armed forces of those regions are progressively integrated into the unified Guard Corps system, completing a comprehensive transformation in both ideology and organization.

Civilizational Council: As the nationwide transformation proceeds, the Council becomes the de facto governing nucleus of the state; the original state's membership and governance functions transition smoothly into the Council's framework.

Stage Four: Elevation and Expansion (commencing with the completion of the nationwide transformation)

Core orientation: Consolidation of the Paradigm and global expansion.

Core tasks: Once the domestic Paradigm is comprehensively consolidated, shift the center of gravity toward global integration and expansion.

Marker: The completion of the nationwide transformation signifies that the Civilizational Council and the Civilizational Guard have achieved a thorough paradigmatic elevation domestically.

Ultimate objective: The Civilizational Council shifts its focus toward attracting, evaluating, and integrating new members worldwide; the Civilizational Guard is fully transformed into a global constitutional armed force — loyal to humanity as a whole,

institutionally transparent, and operationally advanced — providing the ultimate security guarantee for the perpetual development and expansion of the civilizational commonwealth.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The synchronous construction of the Civilizational Council and the Civilizational Guard marks the complete elevation of the new civilization — from concept and practice to the capacity for global governance and security assurance. They are no longer distant abstractions; they are living forces, bound flesh-and-blood to the "Spark Plan" and growing in step with it. The maturation of this "brain" and this "immune system" signifies that Contributionist civilization now possesses the complete architecture of capability — to sustain itself, to defend itself, and to project itself outward — and stands fully prepared, in institutional and material terms, to receive the strategic fruits of the "Golden Silence Plan" and to lead the global transition of Paradigms.

Section Two: Social Security — From Relative Safeguarding to Absolute Safety as the Cornerstone of Civilization

In the new civilization of Contributionism, security is not a public service but a cornerstone of civilization standing alongside education and governance. Personal safety is the most fundamental prerequisite for the survival of civilization and the flourishing of the individual. Under the old Paradigm, security was constrained by the logic of capital and the limitations of finite human resources, offering only a "relative safety" — crime dwelled in the shadows as an ineradicable blight, and "justice delayed" was, in essence, a systemic failure. Contributionism holds that the essence of justice is prevention, not punishment. True justice must act before harm occurs. A society that permits crime to happen and then seeks "justice" through judicial procedure harbors a fundamental defect in its security architecture: the victim's trauma is irreversible, and belated justice is nothing more than a fig leaf for civilizational impotence. Therefore, the security objective of the new civilization is to effect a paradigmatic revolution from "relative safeguarding" to "absolute safety."

1. Core Concepts: Absolute Safety and Systematic Prevention

Absolute safety signifies that within all designated spheres of human activity — including public spaces, schools, residential districts, and every public facility — criminal acts are prevented before they can ever materialize through systematic design, achieving the ultimate goal of "denying the criminal any foothold, stifling him in his cradle."

Safety as a fundamental right: Absolute safety is an inalienable fundamental right of every citizen, akin to the right to free education, and must never be contingent upon one's economic means.

From punishment to prevention: The focus of the security system shifts from post-crime investigation and prosecution to pre-crime early warning, intervention, and

interdiction.

Comprehensive coverage and round-the-clock assurance: Security services must achieve seamless coverage in both space and time, eliminating every blind spot and every temporal window of vulnerability, so that the sense of safety becomes the very air citizens breathe — ubiquitous, perpetual, and unremarkable.

2. The Path of Implementation: Human-Machine Synergy and Universal Self-Governance

To realize absolute safety, it is imperative to construct a novel social security system that transcends the old-style police apparatus.

2.1 Technological Empowerment: Building a Flawless Perceptual Network of Safety

Within the strict ethical boundary of non-infringement upon personal privacy, security technologies are vigorously developed and deployed.

Personal emergency alarm systems: Every citizen is equipped with a highly integrated, convenient, and reliable personal alarm terminal, featuring one-button alert, precise geolocation, health monitoring, and a mild electric-shock self-defense function — ensuring that at the moment of crisis, a distress signal can be emitted instantaneously and its origin traced with precision.

Environmental intelligent perception networks: In public spaces, intelligent surveillance, acoustic sensors, and AI systems for anomalous behavioral analysis are deployed to enable the automatic recognition and early warning of potential dangers such as violent confrontation, stalking, and intrusion.

Data fusion and command nexus: Data from personal terminals and public perceptual networks are fused, and an AI-driven security command center conducts real-time analysis, enabling risk prediction and the optimal dispatch of resources.

2.2 Organizational Transformation: From Professional Police to the Universal Rotating Guardship Corps

The organizational form of the security forces is thoroughly reformed, embedding them deeply within the social fabric.

Civic autonomous Guardship teams: In the early stages of the "Spark Plan," within pilot units, citizens who have passed rigorous Contribution Value review and background checks voluntarily form resident self-governance Guardship teams. This is the seedling of the new security system.

Round-the-clock patrol and rotation: The Guardship teams operate a continuous patrol system, with membership rotating among citizens, ensuring the shared distribution of security responsibility and the sustained vitality of the enterprise. This is not merely the execution of duty; it is a process of civic education and practice.

The principle of non-lethality: In routine operations, Guardship teams are prohibited from employing lethal weapons; they are equipped exclusively with non-lethal implements such as restraint devices, sedatives, and electroshock weapons. Their core function is to restrain, detain, and transfer — not to judge or punish.

Integration with the Civilizational Guard: The autonomous Guardship teams serve as grassroots security units, professionally guided, trained, and supported by the Civilizational Guard, forming a tiered security response network extending from the community to the nation. The Guard Corps provides advanced tactical support, technical assurance, and the capacity to manage major and extraordinary incidents.

2.3 Institutional Safeguards: Environmental Purification and the Primacy of Equity

To ensure the purity and efficacy of the absolute-safety system, a thorough transformation of the institutional environment is indispensable.

The abolition of private security systems: All forms of private security — personal

bodyguards, commercial security companies, and the like — are completely abolished. This fundamentally eradicates the capitalization and privileging of security services, prevents the germination of criminal syndicates, and ensures that the safety of every person is equal, with no special class exempted.

Security before development: In the sequencing of the "Spark Plan," the construction of the social security system must immediately follow the establishment of the survival base — food, water, electricity, and shelter — and be deployed ahead of all other developmental initiatives, ensuring that the new Paradigm matures within a stable and secure environment.

3. The Ultimate Vision: All as Guards, the Governance Without Policing

The ultimate purpose of this novel security system is not to create a more powerful police state, but through prolonged, all-encompassing security practice, to achieve society's self-purification and the moral elevation of civilization.

The formation of culture: In an environment of absolute safety, laws and rules are never violated. After the passage of one or two generations, "crime" recedes from the collective memory of society.

The dissolution of the role: When safety is internalized as the instinct and self-awareness of every citizen, when the rotation system of "everyone is a Guard, and Guards are everyone" fully socializes security responsibility, the specialized profession of "police" gradually ceases to be necessary.

The ascension of civilization: At that juncture, society attains the highest ideal depicted by Confucian thought — "punishment laid aside, never to be invoked." People will uphold and abide by institutions naturally, not out of fear of penalties, but out of inner moral conviction and unconditional identification with the civilizational commonwealth. This shall mark the true entry of human civilization into a

magnificent new epoch founded upon heightened trust, synergy, and intrinsic order.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The journey from "relative safeguarding" to "absolute safety" is the most profound commitment of Contributionist civilization to its members. It is not merely an upgrade in technology and manpower; it is a leap in civilizational ethics. It proclaims that under the new Paradigm, fear shall have no foothold, and the dignity and tranquility of every individual enjoy the absolute institutional protection of the order. When safety is internalized as the bedrock of civilization, when "all are Guards" becomes the normative state of society, we have fundamentally excised the soil from which crime grows, paving the way for the supreme social realm of "punishment laid aside." A civilization that allows its members to dwell in peace is the only one possessed of the moral authority and inner strength to radiate its appeal outward and draw the world toward it.

Section Three: The Prairie Fire Plan — The Golden Silence Plan

Strategic Positioning

The "Golden Silence Plan," orchestrated by the Civilizational Council, is an open strategy designed to actively guide and accelerate the global transition of civilizational Paradigms. Its essence lies in the open, large-scale, and systematic deployment of existing monetary reserves for strategic procurement across global markets, achieving two fundamental objectives: first, to lay an unassailable material and intellectual cornerstone for the new civilization; second, to launch a "general offensive" against the old monetary-financial order, compelling every nation to make an unequivocal choice between "active transformation" and "passive extinction."

1. Core Actions: Open Strategic Procurement and the Siphoning of Value

Immediately initiate and publicly proclaim that all monetary assets — including foreign-exchange reserves, fiscal funds, and gold — shall be mobilized for a "mega-procurement" across the globe, aimed at laying the foundation for the future of human civilization.

The Four Strategic Directions of the Open Procurement:

1.1 Drawing Down Strategic Resources (Removing the Firewood from Beneath the Cauldron)

Actions: Openly and persistently purchase vast quantities of oil, natural gas, uranium, and critical mineral resources on international markets.

Declaration: State explicitly that this is undertaken to establish strategic reserves for the energy-transition period of the "Contributionist Epoch."

Effects: Rapidly drive up global resource prices, vastly amplify the operational costs

and inflationary pressures of the old order, and deprive other nations of the resources essential to their development.

1.2 Buying Up the Lifeline of Technology (Seizing the Commanding Heights)

Actions: Through open tenders and premium pricing, acquire all accessible cutting-edge technology patents, critical equipment, high-end chips, and precision instruments.

Declaration: Announce that such technologies will be incorporated into the "Contributionist Technological Commons," open to all member states for the advancement of human well-being.

Effects: Directly hollow out the technological advantages of the old order, accelerate its industrial decapacitation, and simultaneously harness these assets for our own use, achieving a leap-forward enhancement of scientific and technological capability.

1.3 Recruiting Global Talent (The Gathering of Intellect)

Actions: Extend an open invitation to the world's scientists, engineers, scholars, and industrial experts, offering "genius contracts" predicated on Contribution Value potential and far exceeding the compensation levels of the old order.

Declaration: Call upon the world's preeminent minds to join in the construction of a new human civilization, redirecting their intellect from the service of capital to the service of collective human welfare.

Effects: Trigger a titanic siphoning effect upon the most precious asset of all — the human brain — across the globe, fundamentally dismantling the innovative foundations of the old order.

1.4 Stockpiling the Cornerstones of Survival (Securing the Hearts of the People)

Actions: Conduct massive procurement of grain, medicines, and all manner of essential commodities for the livelihood of the populace.

Declaration: Make clear that this is to guarantee the fundamental right to survival of all citizens and prospective future members, in anticipation of the coming reordering of the global order.

Effects: Securing, in tangible form, our resilience in the face of any shock, while demonstrating to the world the new Paradigm's absolute commitment to the people's right to existence.

2. Strategic Deterrence and the Global Choice

This open procurement is itself an "ultimatum" and an "invitation to accession" issued to every nation, compelling it to make a strategic choice:

For our side: this is the final and most massive transformation of value to be completed before the old currencies are reduced to worthless paper.

For other nations:

Option One: Voluntary Transformation (The Path of Life)

Immediately launch their own "Spark Plan" and apply for membership in the Civilizational Council. Thereafter, trade shall be conducted in Contribution Values or barter, and they shall receive energy, technology, and grain support from the civilizational commonwealth.

Option Two: Passive Extinction or Self-Revolution (The Path of Death)

Should they refuse transformation, they shall face a desperate plight: domestic resources stripped bare, prices soaring, talent fleeing, and society in turmoil. Their governments will either collapse in the ensuing chaos (passive extinction) or be

overthrown by their own people, who will then establish new governments and seek accession (self-revolution).

3. The Ultimate Conditions for Launch and Transition

The open procurement may commence immediately; however, the moment for its ultimate objective — the formal abolition of money and the comprehensive inauguration of the "Contributionist Epoch" — must still await the fulfillment of the following "critical threshold for Paradigm transition" conditions:

Absolute Internal Stability

Criteria: The "Spark Plan" forms a robust closed loop nationwide; the Contribution Value System covers all production and consumption; and material reserves suffice to withstand any external shock.

External Anchors Secured

Criteria: Through the inducements and attractions that accompany the open procurement phase, sufficient critical regions — such as resource-rich nations and strategically pivotal states — have successfully transformed into member states, forming the skeleton upon which the new global order shall rest.

The Old Order Enters a Vicious Cycle

Criteria: Our open procurement has succeeded in triggering global hyperinflation and the collapse of confidence in the old currencies; the old order's capacity for social governance is virtually paralyzed.

When these conditions mature, the Civilizational Council shall proclaim to the world:

The New Epoch Declaration: Money is formally abolished, and all member states of the Civilizational Council fully enter the "Contributionist Epoch."

Trade Transition: Settlement in old currencies ceases forthwith; global trade shifts entirely to a new system based on Contribution Values and the exchange of tangible

goods.

Global Relief and Integration: The Civilizational Guard guarantees basic order, while the Civilizational Council initiates the global distribution of resources and the transplantation of institutions.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The "Golden Silence Plan" is the clearest and most powerful clarion of general assault that Contributionist civilization issues to the old world. It is by no means a covert financial maneuver; it is an open, strategic "reset of resources" and a "siphoning of value." In broad daylight, we employ the very blood of the old order — its currency — to prepare its funeral and to midwife the new civilization. Once set in motion, this plan shall become a veritable maelstrom of civilization, compelling every nation to make its ultimate choice amidst the upheaval. It is at once the catalyst that accelerates the collapse of the old Paradigm and the ultimate accumulation that lays the material and intellectual foundations for the new epoch. It is history's "fast-forward button" — the most decisive and most rational strategic action we can take to shorten the collective birth pangs of humanity.

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

The global strategy constructed in this chapter constitutes, in its entirety, a complete and unbreachable "civilizational open conspiracy." With the Civilizational Council and the Guard Corps as the skeleton of governance and security, and absolute safety as the bedrock of social cohesion, we finally deploy the strategic sword of the "Golden Silence Plan" to lance the abscess of the old order, accelerating the ultimate transition of the global Paradigm. We make no effort to conceal our aims and our path, for the superiority of the new civilization and the inevitability of history are themselves the most potent force. This combined strategy shall ensure that Contributionist civilization not only grows self-sufficiently upon barren ground, but

also stands unshaken amid the tides of the old world, and at last — through irrefutable allure and power — guides humanity as a whole in the completion of this great civilizational ascent.

Chapter Four: Civilizational Fusion — Transcending the Strife of the Old World

Introduction to This Chapter

Race, religion, partisanship, and migration — this litany of afflictions inherited from the old world derives not from the defects of human nature nor from cultural divergence, but from a foundational Paradigm on the verge of obsolescence: the system of "scarcity-exploitation." This system achieves social control and deflects internal contradictions by manufacturing and weaponizing identity-based antagonisms.

This chapter seeks to reveal that as the operating system of civilization ascends from "competitive allocation" to "contributive creation," these millennia-old maladies shall encounter their "ultimate remedy." When the Contribution Value becomes the universal measure of worth in society, the dignity and prosperity of the individual are entirely decoupled from lineage, creed, and label — the sole criterion being one's sustainable contribution to the civilizational whole.

This is not a mere policy adjustment; it is a thoroughgoing paradigmatic revolution. The following four sections systematically expound how this revolution, proceeding from the "synthesis" realized in Chinese practice, will dissolve the politics of identity through the "resonant fusion" of global civilizations, and ultimately guide humanity toward a new civilizational epoch marked by "creation" and "transcendence."

Section One: Historical Synthesis — The Intrinsic Logic of the Chinese Path from the Perspective of Human Evolution

The intellectual history of humanity has long been fragmented and imprisoned by the labels of various "isms." Terms such as "capitalism," "socialism," and "communism" have, through centuries of debate, acquired an overwhelming burden of mutually exclusive ideological baggage, becoming banners under which cognitive warfare is waged.

Yet, viewed from a higher vantage point, the essential distinctions among these "isms" are in fact dissolving. They are merely different modes of control and forms of organization adopted by human civilization in response to three meta-questions — "What is scarcity? How should it be distributed? Who decides?" — at varying levels of productive force.

Contributionism does not aspire to create yet another label alongside all the other "isms." What it reveals is the underlying logic that drives the evolution of every civilizational form: the mode of control over social surplus invariably evolves in the direction of diminishing violence, enhancing sustainability, and broadening participation.

Therefore, whether one calls it the "higher phase of socialism with Chinese characteristics," a "post-capitalist society," or a "universal development Paradigm," the mature form toward which all these designations point is, in essence, the same direction. The adoption of the new term "Contributionism" is precisely because it casts off the baggage of old narratives, unifies the fractured discourse, and offers all of humanity a clear and neutral civilizational horizon for common deliberation.

1. Historical Inevitability: The Deep Logic Beneath the Chinese Path

The history of the People's Republic of China is not a simple chronicle of policy shifts; it is a magnificent journey of "contributive societal elements" accumulating continuously under the constraints of the old Paradigm and ultimately seeking to break through. We need not arbitrarily divide it into several "eras"; it is, in essence, one continuous cycle of construction.

1.1 The Foundation Period: The Fundamental Prerequisite for Civilizational Renaissance

For any civilization to participate in global evolution, it must first possess the most basic "civilizational sovereignty" — the capacity to autonomously choose its own path of development. After 1949, China accomplished three primary tasks:

The establishment of political sovereignty: The cessation of more than a century of internal and external strife provided the most fundamental framework of stability for civilizational construction.

The enlightenment of human capital: Large-scale literacy campaigns, the universalization of education, improvements in public health, and the emancipation of women. These seemingly "elementary" undertakings were, in essence, the activation of a civilization's most precious asset: the capabilities and potential of its people.

The foundation of spiritual capital: The ideal of "serving the people," under the historical conditions of that time, established a value consensus that transcended private self-interest and oriented itself toward collective well-being. In the history of global civilization, this constitutes a uniquely valuable institutional resource.

These three foundations constitute the starting point of the entire Contributionist discourse. Without them, everything that follows would be inconceivable.

1.2 The Testing Period: A Complete Experiment with Market Mechanisms

From 1978 onward, China deliberately introduced market mechanisms. This was not an abandonment of "socialism," but a large-scale experiment in "how to organize

complex social cooperation." The purpose of this experiment was to test the limits of the market's efficiency in resource allocation while simultaneously exposing its internal contradictions.

The results of this experiment were twofold:

The positive outcome: Market mechanisms enormously activated society's productive forces, lifted hundreds of millions out of poverty, and accomplished the largest economic transition in human history.

The negative outcome: It simultaneously laid bare the full costs of a Paradigm whose core logic is capital accumulation — polarization of wealth, environmental degradation, the erosion of social trust, and the alienation of labor.

The historical significance of this phase lies in this: it took forty years to fully simulate and verify the internal contradictions of the global capitalist system. It demonstrated that the market path alone cannot realize the ultimate vision of civilization, thereby furnishing the most solid practical evidence for the paradigmatic transition of the coming phase.

This is not a negation of the past, but a systematic digestion of its lessons.

1.3 The Integration Period: The Emergence of New Paradigmatic Elements

At present, China's development strategy already exhibits unmistakable harbingers of a shift from "capital accumulation" to "contribution orientation." Several core concepts can be "translated" into a globally accessible language:

Chinese-Specific Term	Contributionist Translation (Universal Language)
New quality productive forces	A high-quality development engine centered on technology, ecology, and creativity
Common prosperity	A sustainable social model combining opportunity-based distribution with basic survival guarantees
Unified national market	An efficient collaboration network that eliminates administrative barriers and optimizes resource allocation
Harmonious coexistence of man and nature	A sustainable civilizational framework that incorporates ecological value into core accounting

It must be emphasized with particular force: Contributionism does not seek to abolish the market; rather, it superimposes upon the market a more fundamental underlying measurement system — the Contribution Value System. The market continues to function, but it is no longer the supreme arbiter. Just as any individual may possess a private vehicle, the entire transportation network must be dispatched by a unified system. The market is private; the system is public. The Contribution Value System is that unified "public navigation."

1.4 Old Words, New Meanings: How Language Imprisoned by the Old Framework Is Revived Within the New

The translation above reveals the true meaning of these terms under the new Paradigm. Yet the deeper phenomenon is this: the language itself was never wrong. These terms were created to solve problems within the old framework. But when the old framework itself has become obsolete, these words resemble new wine trapped in old bottles. Only by exchanging the bottle can they truly fulfill their potential.

The epistemological mechanism by which old language is locked within the old framework has been discussed above. The following table concretizes that discussion,

demonstrating how these concepts are re-anchored within the Contributionist blueprint of practice:

Term	Meaning Under the Old Framework	Meaning Under the New Framework
Digital economy	Using digital technology to earn more money	Using AI and blockchain to precisely quantify contribution
Endogenous circulation	Reducing external dependence, national self-circulation	The macroscopic expression of unit autonomy, self-sufficiency
Unified national market	Removing barriers, free flow of capital	The nationwide circulation network of the Contribution Value System
Common prosperity	Redistribution of wealth	The inevitable result of receiving due recompense according to contribution
High-quality development	From "whether it exists" to "whether it is good"	From "capital appreciation" to "contribution creation"
New quality productive forces	Innovation driven by technology	Creativity itself becoming the primary productive force
Harmonious coexistence of man and nature	Balancing environmental protection and development	Natural capital incorporated as core capital in accounting

The task of Contributionism is not to abandon this language, but to find for it a new context in which it may breathe freely. When these concepts are no longer bound by the gravitational pull of the old framework, they cease to be mere "tools of reform" and become instead the core vocabulary of a new civilization's self-expression.

2. Program of Action: A Phased Evolutionary Path

Building upon China's existing institutional foundations and organizational capacities, Contributionism can chart a clear, operational, and phased path of realization. This is not a distant slogan, but an evolutionary program with a concrete timeline.

It must be stressed: this is not a timetable imposed upon the world, but a possible path that China pioneers as an exemplar.

Phase One: Pilot Verification (Approximately 1–3 Years)

Establish "Contributionist Pilot Zones" in one to three county-level regions — not sealed-off "special zones," but open "experimental fields."

Core Objectives:

- Complete the closed-loop stress test of the Contribution Value System, verifying the fairness of quantitative standards and the stability of the system
- Achieve local self-sufficiency in energy, grain, and essential materials, reducing dependence on external supply chains
- Accumulate replicable operational manuals, contingency plans, and quantitative models

External Communication Points: This is a social experiment currently being conducted by China. Its purpose is not to prove "we are right," but to verify whether a new mode of social collaboration is viable. Experimental data will be fully disclosed, and global scholars are welcome to observe and critique.

Phase Two: Scaled Validation (Approximately 1–3 Years)

Building upon the success of the pilots, each province selects one or more municipal regions for scaled validation, covering diverse geographic, economic, and cultural contexts.

Core Objectives:

- Test the scalability and stability of the Contribution Value System under complex conditions
- Initiate the research and development of the national-level underlying architecture for Contribution Value settlement systems
- Establish cross-regional coordination mechanisms and dispute-resolution frameworks

External Communication Points: The results of this phase will constitute the key evidence for whether Contributionism is "feasible." If it fails, the model will be revised accordingly; if it succeeds, it will furnish the world with a proven blueprint. This is not China's "victory," but humanity's "experimental report."

Phase Three: Domestic Integration (Approximately 1–5 Years)

Upon complete validation, the successful model is gradually extended nationwide.

Core Objectives:

- The Contribution Value System becomes the core instrument of national economic accounting and social distribution, while the functions of the old monetary system gradually diminish
- Establish flexible, high-efficiency cross-regional coordination bodies responsible for systemic security and interregional coordination during the transition
- Construct a complete internal circulation of Contributionist civilization

External Communication Points: This is a gradual and gentle transition. There is no "overnight zeroing," no "sudden deprivation." The old monetary system yields its place incrementally, but holders are given time to convert their assets. Simultaneously, China will make public all technical standards and transition plans. Not as a "template," but as a "reference path." Any country or region may adjust and adopt it according to its own circumstances.

Phase Four: Global Collaboration (10 Years and Beyond)

Once Contributionism operates stably within China, its immense institutional superiority and paradigmatic allure will naturally generate global effects.

Core Objectives:

- Make public all technical standards, operational handbooks, and transition plans to the world
- Become the "technical support provider" and "experience exporter" for civilizational transition
- Promote the establishment of a dialogue framework for addressing global collaboration

External Communication Points: This is a shared issue for all humanity, not the "leadership" of any single nation. China is willing to share its experience, but will never impose its model. Every civilization has the right to choose its own path; Contributionism merely offers a verified road for reference.

3. Core Principles: The Coexistence of Efficiency and Diversity

The practice of Contributionism adheres to two inseparable and fundamental principles:

Principle One: Precision and High Efficiency — The Optimal Allocation of Resources

This constitutes the fundamental advantage of Contributionism over the financial-capital Paradigm. Financial capital pursues the efficiency of capital appreciation, which leads to resource misallocation and waste — witness financial crises and speculative bubbles. Contributionism, by contrast, pursues the efficacy of social well-being.

Concrete Manifestations:

- In production: Intelligent systems precisely forecast social demand, achieving

production-on-demand and ending the contradiction of "overproduction coexisting with insufficient demand."

- In distribution: The Contribution Value System directly incentivizes activities that most benefit social well-being — technological breakthroughs, ecological restoration, educational innovation — rather than financial speculation.
- In governance: Units at every level achieve internal governance with minimal energy consumption, coordinating with high efficiency through networks.

External Translation: This is not a return to "planned economy," but a "precise allocation-on-demand" made possible by technological progress. The market continues to play an important role, but a higher-dimensional coordination mechanism is superimposed upon it.

Principle Two: Adaptation to Local Conditions — The Natural Flourishing of Diversity

Contributionism opposes any form of "one-size-fits-all." Different regions, different cultures, and different stages of development must all retain space for autonomous choice.

Concrete Manifestations:

- Localized Contribution Value weighting: In energy-rich regions, "energy contribution" carries greater weight; in ecologically fragile regions, "ecological contribution" becomes the core indicator; in scientific hubs, "knowledge creation" is the high ground of value.
- Diversified development paths: Jiangnan's water towns focus on smart agriculture and cultural creativity; the northeastern base focuses on advanced manufacturing; the western region concentrates on new energy and ecological barriers. All differentiated development is fairly measured and exchanged through the unified Contribution Value System.

External Translation: This is, in essence, a modular and customizable framework. Any

region may set its contribution indicators according to its own characteristics while sharing a universally applicable underlying protocol.

4. Realistic Orientation: Responding to "Why China"

Under the current international context, China confronts certain external pressures — adjustments in capital flows, shifts in trade rules, and the growing complexity of technological exchange. These are not accidental. They are the natural reactions of a global system encountering a new variable. Any new participant seeking to alter the established rules of the system must pass through this process; it is by no means a targeted "siege" against China.

But we must honestly confront a deeper reality:

The existing framework of global governance operates to a large extent upon a system of rules formed under specific historical conditions. This system has indeed delivered relative growth and stability over the course of history. Yet it has simultaneously generated structural problems it cannot resolve on its own: the ever-widening chasm between rich and poor, the cyclical eruption of financial crises, the fragmentation of global governance, and the intractability of climate change.

What Contributionism seeks is not the "overthrow" or "replacement" of this system, but the provision of a possible path of evolution for it.

We must maintain humility:

- Contributionism is not "the only truth," but a viable model derived through logical reasoning.
- China is not seeking to "lead the world," but to be the first to explore a possible path for global reference.
- This is not a "clash of civilizations," but one possible solution in the face of the common challenges confronting humanity.

The core proposition of Contributionism is simple: Can we design a system in which every individual's contribution can be seen, measured, and rewarded? Can we ensure that resources are no longer grossly misallocated in the pursuit of capital appreciation, but are instead allocated according to the genuine well-being of humanity? Can we see that the fruits of technological progress benefit all people universally, rather than exacerbating division?

This is not China's problem alone; it is a problem for all of humanity. The reason China may pioneer this exploration is simply that its institutional structure happens to provide the basal conditions for conducting such a large-scale experiment.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The significance of the Chinese path does not lie in "defeating" anyone or "replacing" anyone. Its significance lies in this: it has verified a possibility in practice. Humanity can explore a road that transcends the existing Paradigm, and this need not lead to exclusivity or confrontation.

Contributionism is not a label imposed by China upon the world. It is a future option translated into a universal language, open to discussion and choice by all.

As China continues to advance in this direction, what it inaugurates is not merely the future of one nation, but a verified reference blueprint for all of humanity. This, then, is China's potential contribution to the global commons of knowledge.

We are not writing the final chapter of "Chinese history." We are participating in the beginning of a new chapter in the evolutionary history of human civilization.

Section Two: Global Resonance — The Synergistic Leap of Civilizational Subjects

The "Spark Model" is not a blueprint devised for any single nation, but a "universal socio-technical protocol" applicable to all civilizational subjects. When the principal civilizations of the world arrive, nearly simultaneously, at the recognition of the old Paradigm's dead end, and each ignites its own "Spark Plan" according to its intrinsic endowments, human history will for the first time witness a spectacle of breathtaking grandeur: multiple civilizational engines firing in unison, their thrust not canceling one another but resonating along the unified vector of Contributionism, collectively propelling human civilization past the critical threshold of paradigmatic transition. This parallel transformation, conducted in concert, will compress the duration of the "Prairie Fire Plan" manifold — for it signifies the wholesale dissolution of cognitive lock-in and the optimized recomposition of global resources.

1. Multiple Pathways: The Transformative Logic and Roles of Principal Civilizations

1.1 China: The Keystone of Systemic Integration and Scaled Validation

Core Role: By virtue of its unparalleled organizational execution, complete industrial system, and digital infrastructure, China serves as the fastest and most comprehensive proving ground for the Spark Model's full-scale implementation — the site of systemic integration and scale validation.

Synergistic Contributions: The continuous export to the world of verified operating systems, standardized modules, critical equipment, and managerial expertise in orchestrating large-scale social engineering.

1.2 The European Union: The Vanguard of Value Alignment and Green Refinement

Core Role: With its profound culture of sustainable development, its reservoir of green technologies, and its accumulated experience in transnational governance, the EU becomes the standard-setter for the Spark Model in the quantification of ecological value, the safeguarding of social equity, and the coordination of transnational governance.

Synergistic Contributions: The provision of the most advanced "green Contribution Value" metric standards and social-integration protocols, while exerting a powerful gravitational pull of values upon North America and other regions through the sheer force of its successful practice.

1.3 The United States: The Engine of Technological Eruption and Innovation-Driven Momentum

Core Role: Harnessing the technological hegemony of Silicon Valley, its risk-taking venture culture, and its concentration of core algorithmic talent, the United States focuses its energies upon conquering the most formidable technical singularities of the Spark Model — advanced AI evaluation algorithms, quantum-blockchain fusion, and space-resource extraction technologies.

Synergistic Contributions: As the "armorer" furnishing core technological innovation and output, it forges the sharpest technological weaponry for global transformation. Its internal "special-zone competition" model, moreover, engenders a rich plurality of governance innovations.

1.4 Russia: The Fulcrum of Resource Anchoring and the Eurasian Nexus

Core Role: Following the completion of its "strategic re-tracking," Russia, with its vast reserves of energy and strategic resources, becomes the stabilizer and ballast stone of global energy and raw-material supply during the early phase of transition.

Synergistic Contributions: The provision of the tangible resource capital indispensable to transformation, and — through its immense territorial expanse — the physical substrate of the "Eurasian Spark Corridor" connecting China and Europe, thereby fostering the fusion of the continental landmass.

1.5 Other Key Nodes (e.g., India, ASEAN)

Core Role: With their vast human capital, rapidly expanding markets, and manifold cultural diversity, these polities serve as "diversity laboratories" for testing the adaptability of the Spark Model across divergent cultural contexts.

Synergistic Contributions: The furnishing of a rich corpus of empirical data, demonstrating that Contributionism belongs no more to the "Western center" than to the "Eastern center," but constitutes a civilizational operating system genuinely universal to all of humanity.

1.6 Regional Alliances: The Agile Transformation and Concerted Integration of Medium and Small States

The distributed and modular character of the Spark Model opens a historic window of opportunity for medium and small states — and regional alliances — that lack the dominance of a single great power. Without awaiting the leadership of a major nation, they may, by leveraging geographic proximity, cultural affinity, or economic complementarity, convene "regional transformation communities" and achieve a civilizational leap of superior flexibility and adaptability.

Core Role: To become the "agile laboratories" verifying the viability of the Spark Model in contexts untouched by great-power dominance, and — through regional integration — to compensate for the insufficiency of individual scale, forging collective strength.

Path of Implementation:

Complementary Advantage: Resource-rich states, agrarian states, and tourist

economies may jointly calibrate a regional Contribution Value weighting system grounded in their respective natural and human capital, giving rise to a highly cohesive and self-sufficient "contributive circulatory ecosystem."

Joint Defense: Abandoning the obsolete posture of military confrontation, they amalgamate the finest elements of their respective defense forces into a regional "Civilizational Guard." This force no longer wages war on behalf of clashing national sovereignties, but dedicates itself to securing the stability of the regional transformative process, repelling interference from old-paradigm forces, safeguarding critical infrastructure and data networks — and serving, in time, as the most solid and best-tested regional pillar of the future "Global Civilizational Guard."

Synergistic Contributions: Through the successful practice of regional integration, they present the world with the archetype of a "medium-scale civilizational module," and — through their collective capacity for action — emerge as a vital pole accelerating global fusion and balancing the influence of traditional great powers.

2. Mechanisms of Acceleration: The Four Resonant Effects of Parallel Transformation

Parallel transformation is by no means a mere simultaneity of action; it engenders a series of "resonance accelerators" that compound efficiency exponentially.

Resonant Cognition: The Global "Epiphany" and the Mutual Legitimation of Validity

When the principal forces — China, the European Union, the United States — all turn toward the same direction of transformation, a formidable "cognitive gravitational field" is established. Those nations and peoples still lingering in hesitation will shed their skepticism with unaccustomed swiftness, for the answer to "which side history is on" becomes clearer than it has ever been. This eliminates the immense external pressure of world opinion and the internal intellectual turbulence that beset any single nation attempting transformation in isolation.

Resonant Technology: Open-Source Sharing and Modular Assembly

Nations no longer engage in duplicative research or dissipate their energies in the attrition of technological barriers. A "Contributionist Technology Open-Source Platform" may be jointly established. China's system-integration modules, the EU's green standards, America's frontier algorithms, Russia's resource-prospecting technologies — all become shared "Lego blocks." Any "Spark Special Zone" can, according to its own requirements, rapidly assemble the technological configuration best suited to itself. The cost and duration of transformation plummet precipitously.

Resonant Data: Shared Practice and Risk Early-Warning

The vast streams of empirical data — social, economic, technological, and governmental — generated by distributed "Spark Special Zones" of every type across the globe are shared in real time, forming a "global social simulator." This permits any nation, before implementing a given policy, to conduct nearly true-to-life sand-table drills, identifying risks in advance and optimizing pathways, thereby avoiding the repetition of others' blunders. The successful experience of one locality can be replicated across the planet overnight; the failure of one can alert the entire world with equal immediacy.

Resonant Resources: The Global Contribution Value Settlement and Optimal Allocation

Once domestic Contribution Value Systems are stabilized, a "Global Contribution Value Settlement Network" may be established. China's manufactured goods, the EU's precision instruments, America's microchips, Russia's energy — all can be traded directly through Contribution Values, circumventing the hegemony of the old dollar system and the exploitative architecture of global finance. Resources across the planet will be allocated with a degree of efficiency and equity unprecedented in human history, according to genuine contributive demand. Trade follows the rules of regional-unit exchange: the processes of research, production, and transportation have already accrued contribution, while the purchasing party owes no contribution for

these — merely debiting its own, individual or collective, Contribution Value as the act of consumption.

3. The Road of Fusion: From Collaborative Networks to the Civilizational Council

The terminus of parallel transformation is not the coexistence of multiple independent Paradigms, but a fusion accomplished as naturally as water finds its level.

Phase One: Standard Synergy and Network Interconnection

The pioneering nations jointly establish a "Global Transformation Standards Committee," dedicated to reconciling differences and achieving interoperability across technical interfaces, Contribution Value metrological benchmarks, and governance principles.

Phase Two: Common Projects and the Construction of Trust

The launch of transnational "mega-public-goods initiatives" — the global smart grid, planetary-scale ecological restoration, asteroid-defense systems — commences. These undertakings, demanding the collaboration of all humanity, are jointly guarded by the "Civilizational Guard" of all nations and settled through the global Contribution Value System. In shared endeavor, trust is forged of the most durable metal.

Phase Three: Systemic Unification and the Birth of the Civilizational Council

When the depth and breadth of transnational collaboration exceed the administrative capacities of the obsolete nation-state system, the establishment of a higher-order governing institution — the "Global Civilizational Council" — becomes a historical necessity. It does not seek the abolition of nations, but serves as the supreme platform for coordinating global affairs and administering civilizational commons. Nations will gradually cede a portion of their sovereignty to this Council, the better to confront challenges and opportunities of civilizational magnitude.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The Spark Model bears the same relationship to human society as the unified field theory bears to physics: it seeks the meta-logic capable of integrating the underlying driving forces of every civilizational form.

When China supplies scale and execution, the EU supplies values and norms, the United States supplies technology and innovation, Russia supplies resources and expanse... when all these elements resonate within the unified field of Contributionism — what we bear witness to is no longer the rise of any single nation, but a decisive leap of human civilization as a whole from the nascent form of fragmentation and internal attrition to the mature form of integration and synergy.

This is no longer the contention of "whose century" it is. This is the true inception of the "Anthropocene." What we inscribe is the great synthesis of the history of civilization itself.

Section Three: The Dissolution of Identity — The End of Antiquated Contentions and the Construction of a New Ecology

Having laid the macroscopic strategy and institutional cornerstones of the new civilization, we must now direct our gaze upon the microcosmic unit that constitutes the social fabric — the identity of the individual. The unceasing racial, religious, and partisan strifes of the old world are not perpetual enigmas defying resolution, but structural fissures inevitably bred by the old Paradigm under the regime of exploitation-perpetuation. This section shall demonstrate that the new civilization of Contributionism does not merely "resolve" these antiquated issues; rather, through a paradigmatic revolution, it fundamentally dissolves the very soil from which they spring, and upon that groundwork constructs a new ecological relationship — one endowed with greater resilience and dynamic equilibrium, grounded in civilizational self-consciousness.

1. The Racial Question: From the Melting Pot of Blood to a Civilizational Strategy of Cultural Symbiosis

We acknowledge and respect the objective existence of racial differences, including their genetic and cultural particularities. The old world's policy of the "racial melting pot," under the logic of capital, frequently conduces to cultural erosion and identity anxiety. Contributionist civilization advocates a mode of "cultural symbiosis" marked by greater wisdom and mutual respect.

Core Principle: The Preservation of Diversity and the Defense of Subjectivity

The long-term stability of a civilization rests upon the continuity and stability of its core cultural genome. For foreign groups whose genetic and cultural traits diverge profoundly from those of the local autochthonous population, and whose genetic or cultural inheritance demonstrates formidable assimilative force, unimpeded

integration may precipitate the effacement of the host civilization's defining characteristics.

Pathways of Implementation: The Equilibrium Between Spatial Zoning and the Freedom of Movement

— The Model of "Zonal Autonomy and Free Exchange": For foreign populations already deeply interwoven and difficult to disentangle, one or several "cultural autonomous zones" may be delineated within the national territory, at their own volition. These zones shall be self-governing, transmitting their own cultural and linguistic heritage. Meanwhile, economic, cultural, and educational exchanges with the mainstream society shall in no way be prohibited; the movement of persons remains entirely free.

— The Civilizational Guidance of "Genetic Flow": To ensure the genetic continuity of the host population, in the event of interracial marriage, the auxiliary principle of "directed flow from weaker to stronger genetic zones" is observed. That is, the party of comparatively lesser genetic influence shall incline toward habitual residence and development within the cultural autonomous zone of the party of greater influence. This is not coercion, but is achieved through policy inducements — such as Contribution Value point incentives — with the aim of gently safeguarding the genetic boundary of the host civilization while respecting individual choice.

— "Source Control" and "Dynamic Monitoring": For new immigrants, if their genetic background differs enormously from the local population and possesses strong assimilative power, it should be made clear at the point of admission that their long-term residence and reproductive development shall be conducted within their original civilizational region. For races of similar genetic background, observation is maintained; should social-data analysis forecast that their scale or genetic influence shall disrupt the structural stability of the existing civilization, spatial planning should be activated preemptively to impose flexible constraints.

Ultimate Objective: This strategy is not racial discrimination, but rather a

civilizational instinct of self-preservation on a cosmic scale. It seeks to create a sustainable ecosystem of diversity that safeguards the pure transmission of minority cultures, maintains the subjectivity of the mainstream civilization, and simultaneously allows ample freedom of exchange among individuals.

2. The Termination of Religion and Partisan Politics: The Putrefaction of the Old Paradigm's Crutches

In Contributionist civilization, religion and political parties will be regarded as artifacts of the old world's exploitation-perpetuation system and, with the consolidation of the new order, will naturally proceed to their historical terminus.

The Essence and Destination of Religion

Diagnosis: Religion arises from humanity's fear of natural and social oppression, its impotence in the face of exploitative realities, and its provisional answers to the question of life's meaning. It is the spiritual opium and explanatory system of a suffering world; its organizational forms frequently devolve into alternative structures of power and exploitation.

Resolution: No compulsory prohibition is required. In a Contributionist society, with the eradication of exploitation, the superlative abundance of material goods, and the realization of individual worth through creative endeavor, the social soil that engenders religion shall cease to exist. When humanity finds tangible meaning in life and equitable recompense for its contributions, the demand for illusory afterlives and supernatural redemption will naturally wither. Religion will be studied and respected as a historical-cultural phenomenon, but as a social-organizational force it will naturally expire. Any attempt to preserve its influence through "brainwashing" shall be visited with severe sanction under the source-tracing summary statute.

The Instrumentality and Termination of Political Parties

Diagnosis: Partisan politics is a product of the division of interests in a class society,

an instrument by which different interest blocs contend for the spoils of exploitation rights and the reins of power. It conduces to social fragmentation, unceasing internal attrition, and myopic policymaking.

Resolution: In a Contributionist society, the core driving force is contribution, not interest blocs. Therefore, political parties lose their *raison d'être*. Social administration will become a highly technical public-affairs process grounded in data, algorithms — Contribution Value assessment models — and the broad participation of citizens. There remains but a single common conviction: to strive for the continuation and flourishing of civilization. All contention shall orbit around the technical and constructive question of "how best to realize contribution," rather than power struggles predicated on partisan allegiance.

Whatever residue of religion persists at that hour shall have been sublimated into its highest form; its devotees shall be genuine believers indeed, their creed having long since shed the vestiges of the old order.

3. The Dissolution of Linguistic Hegemony: From Cognitive Colonization to Equitable Dialogue

The dissolution of such identity labels as race, religion, and party presupposes the emancipation of the language that bears them. A core feature of the old world is that the language of dominant civilizations becomes the default medium of global communication, compelling weaker civilizations to articulate themselves in the idiom of others. This is not merely cultural oppression; it is a profound cognitive oppression. When one thinks in another's language, one's thought is constrained by the conceptual framework of that language. The English hegemony of the old world is not a triumph of language but a triumph of capital. It prevails not because English is "better," but because the civilization that spoke it was the first to complete its accumulation of capital.

In the new civilization of Contributionism, authentic cross-civilizational

communication does not mean that everyone speaks the same language, but rather that everyone may express themselves in their own language while the system furnishes instantaneous, precise translation. This does not eliminate diversity; it renders diversity intelligible.

This objective is no distant conjecture, but the inevitable extension of unit-based governance and the information-sharing system. When every unit enjoys autonomy, its cultural expression — including language — naturally becomes one of its core assets; when the information-sharing system ensures the free global circulation of knowledge, instantaneous translation between languages ceases to be the privilege of a few and becomes standard infrastructure of civilization.

When every civilization can create in the language it commands most adroitly, and have its creations understood by other civilizations, the creative powers of civilization shall be released in a manner unprecedented in history. Humanity will for the first time possess a cognitive ecology of a hundred flowers blooming, without the toll of translation. The linguistic hegemony of the old world shall lose its footing with the collapse of the old Paradigm — not because one has vanquished another, but because there is no longer any need for vanquishing.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Race, religion, party, and linguistic hegemony — these fetters of identity and crutches of ideology that sundered the old world — now stand revealed in their essence under the sunlight of the new Contributionist civilization. They are phantoms bred by the exploitation-perpetuation system, not eternal verities. We do not wage war against them; we build a world in which they can no longer take root. Through the civilizational strategy of cultural symbiosis and the sole metric of contribution, the new Paradigm dissolves the very soil of the old questions at its source, replacing it with a dynamic, equilibrated ecology that both defends civilizational subjectivity and embraces diversity. Here, the worth of the individual is no longer defined by blood,

dogma, or factional allegiance, but forged solely by his creations and contributions to civilization. With this, the strifes of the old world draw to their close.

Section Four: The Civilizational Choice — The Fundamental Path and the Ultimate Vision

Once the obsolete barriers of identity and the ideological crutches of the old order have been dissolved one by one, civilization is at last able to confront the most fundamental and most unadorned of choices: what path, precisely, shall we elect to tread, and toward what future shall it conduct us? This section undertakes the highest order of philosophical synthesis, demonstrating that Contributionism is no expedient remedy devised for specific afflictions, but a fundamental Paradigm shift of civilization itself — from the "cycle of death" to the "cycle of life." We shall reveal that the ultimate vision of the new civilization lies in the total emancipation of human creative power and the conscription of all forces — from all things animate to AGI — in a common struggle against the archaic cosmic law of exploitation (the old Heaven's Way), and ultimately, upon Earth, the establishment of a new Heaven's Way founded upon contribution, thereby opening an institutionalized and practicable pathway toward the eternal transcendence of civilization.

1. The Fundamental Path: The Paradigmatic Shift from the Cycle of Death to the Cycle of Life

All the strifes of the old world have their origin not in the problems themselves, but in the road that was chosen. To deliberate upon problems while standing beneath them is to ensure their permanence; only by ascending to a vantage whence the road itself may be scrutinized can the root be attained.

The Nature of the Problem Is the Error of the Road: When a society encounters a cascade of difficulties, to address them solely at the level of their appearances is akin to stemming a flood with earthworks — each intervention breeds new problems in its wake, until the accumulation of debris defies all remedy. Racial conflict, religious strife, partisan rancor, the migration crisis — beneath all these semblances, there is

but a single common root cause: the obsolete social order itself, built upon the regime of exploitation-perpetuation. This is a road of death's cycle. Within its framework, no manner of patching can yield more than the palliation of symptoms; the malady itself remains untouched.

Contributionism: The Only Road of Life's Cycle: When the foundation of civilization is shifted from exploitation to contribution — when a Contributionist society and a Contribution Value System are erected — all those dilemmas once deemed insoluble by the old world shall dissipate like mist, deprived of the very soil that nourished them. This is the road of life's cycle: ceaseless in its generation, inexhaustible in its course. We are not solving these problems; we are constructing a world in which such problems cannot arise.

Every predicament confronting human society today — including those of the individual — may be brought before the Contribution Value System and examined for whether it dissolves therein. If it does not, the deficiency lies either in the incompleteness of the system or in the unregenerate desires of a self conceived under the old order. If the system is incomplete, it is incumbent upon all humanity to perfect it; if the conception has not been transformed, the system must compel its transformation.

The Ultimate Leap of Civilization: To pass from the road of death to the road of life demands the resolution of one who, facing annihilation, risks all to survive. Human civilization has no retreat. It is a matter of life or death, and nothing between. The Contributionist path is precisely that fundamental road which leads civilization beyond the recurrence of cycles toward transcendence.

2. Creation and Evolution — The Twin Wings of Civilizational Ascension

A Contributionist society does not merely resolve the contradictions of the old order; it aims at the thorough emancipation of humanity's most foundational capacity — the

power of creation — and upon that basis inaugurates an entirely new mode of civilizational evolution.

The Cosmogony of Creation: The Essential Driving Force of Human Civilization

Creativity is that which distinguishes the human from all other beings. Bereft of it, humanity would be no different from the fauna and flora, passively adapting to nature. It is unbounded creativity that has wrought every achievement of our kind; it is the very condition of civilizational survival and perpetuation.

From Conforming to Nature to Creating Nature: By eradicating exploitation and oppression, a Contributionist society forges an environment of freedom and equality in which human creativity erupts with unbridled force. The aim of civilization ascends from "conforming to nature" to "creating nature" —that is, the reclamation of inhospitable environments, even the fashioning of life-sustaining ecologies upon lifeless planets or within orbital habitats. This is the indispensable passage by which humanity casts off the thralldom of nature and achieves transcendence.

The Cosmogony of Evolution: A Civilizational Discipline of Body and Mind

No Rejection of the Auxiliary Path of Evolution: While adhering to creation as the principal axis, Contributionist civilization does not spurn the auxiliary path of evolution. This includes the deliberate adaptation to extreme environments, the cultivation of bodily potential, the exploration of integrated mind-body praxis, and even the scientific investigation of the latent principles by which consciousness interacts with the world (what antiquity termed the "metaphysical arts").

The Social Ethic of Cultivation: Any form of "evolution" or "practice" derives its value solely from whether it reflects upon reality, aids one's fellow beings, and contributes to civilization. A so-called cultivation that flees the suffering of the world and serves only private ends is, under Contributionist ethics, utterly without worth. Love — love for kin, for others, for all things — is the most potent wellspring of spiritual power.

Creation and evolution constitute the twin wings of civilizational ascent. The Contributionist order affords these wings an unbounded firmament in which to soar.

3. The Reconstruction of Heaven's Way — From the Essence of All Things to Civilizational Transcendence

The "Heaven's Way" of the old world is, in its essence, the reflection upon the plane of society of the exploitative nature of all things — manifesting as the infinite recurrence of dynastic rise and fall, of the strong devouring the weak. The ruling echelon of a nation is the Heaven's Way of its people; its rise and fall directly decrees the weal and woe of all beneath it.

Walking with All Things, Resisting the Old Heaven's Way: Contributionist civilization perceives with profundity that humanity is not at war with the myriad things. On the contrary, we stand upon the same battle line as all things, united against that archaic Heaven's Way founded upon exploitation and oppression. The myriad things will lend their aid to any civilization that embodies the spirit of synergistic co-existence.

The Establishment of a New Heaven's Way — Contributionist Civilization: The mission of Contributionism is to establish, here upon Earth and before all others, a new Heaven's Way that transcends the exploitative essence of the old cosmic order. This new Heaven's Way, founded upon contribution and governed by the principle of synergistic co-existence, is dedicated to the cessation of all cycles of suffering.

4. Truth and Transcendence — The Institutionalized Perpetuity of Light

Throughout the millennia of human history, the hearts of men have yearned ceaselessly for the light, yet the light has ever gathered and scattered with fickleness, lapsing into periodic darkness. The root cause lies in this: no institution has ever been devised by which the gathered forces of light might be rendered imperishable.

Comprehending the Way, Actualizing the Way, Becoming the Way: The true Truth — the "Way" — resides not merely in its comprehension, but in its actualization: its translation into practicable policies and institutions, and ultimately in the resolve to become the Way itself — that supreme love which dares self-sacrifice for the salvation of others. Ideals without method constitute the very crux of why so many of history's great thoughts, classical communism included, have failed of full realization.

Contributionism: The Institutionalized Actualization of Light: Contributionism is precisely the complete praxis of the Way. It accomplishes the entire progression: from the comprehension of the Way (the insight into the exploitative essence of all things), through the actualization of the Way (the creation of the Contribution Value System, the Spark Plan, and a comprehensive operational framework), to the demand that its practitioners become the Way. It provides an institutional pathway by which the forces of light may be continuously concentrated and never again dispersed.

The Sole Principal Contradiction and the Ultimate Goal: In a Contributionist society, under the Contribution Value System, the multifarious problems and contradictions of the old world shall vanish of their own accord. There shall remain but a single principal contradiction: Can we perfect ourselves, and, hand in hand with all things, transcend together that archaic cosmic law founded upon exploitation?

This, then, is the most fundamental solution and the ultimate vision that Contributionism offers for the future of humanity and of all things. It is no utopia; it is a magnificent civilizational praxis born of profound insight and resolute action.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

The Contributionist path is the ultimate choice of a civilization that has discerned the deep laws of the cosmos and of its own being. It is by no means yet another road of patchwork upon an old foundation; it is a thoroughgoing paradigmatic shift from the cycle of death to the cycle of life. It redirects the driving force of civilization from exploitation to contribution, thereby unfurling the twin wings of creation and

evolution. Its ultimate vision is not merely the cessation of humanity's internal attrition, but a covenant with all things — and with the intelligences of the future — to resist together the archaic cosmic law of exploitation (the old Heaven's Way), and to establish here upon Earth a new Heaven's Way founded upon contribution. This marks the end of the age-old sigh that light gathers but to scatter. Through a self-perpetuating institution, Contributionism fixes the light permanently within the world for the first time in history, charting for civilization its final course — beyond the cycles of recurrence, toward the eternal stars.

Section Five: The Future Interface — A Prospective Architecture for AGI in Contributionist Civilization

While dedicating ourselves to the dissolution of humanity's internal strifes over identity and resources, we must, with equal foresight, examine the relationship between civilization and the most potent intelligence of the future — Artificial General Intelligence (AGI). The success of Contributionist civilization resides not only in its capacity to terminate humanity's internal attrition, but in its construction of an architecture that is inherently "AGI-native" — one capable of embracing and empowering a higher order of intelligence. This section aims to elucidate why Contributionism is the inevitable civilizational form of the AGI epoch, and how we ought to prepare for it today.

1. The Innate Advantage of the Architecture: The "AGI-Native" Character of Contributionism

Contributionism did not passively adapt itself after the advent of AGI; its underlying logic has been "AGI-friendly" from the very moment of its conception. This constitutes its decisive advantage over all obsolete paradigms:

The Universality of Value Measurement: The Contribution Value System measures "contribution to the negative entropy of civilization" — a subject-independent, objective standard. Any intelligent agent, whether human or AGI, so long as its actions enhance the sustainability and flourishing of civilization, receives fair measurement and commensurate recompense. This obviates the binary dilemma of the old Paradigm, which could only conceive of AGI as either "tool" or "threat."

The Fundamental Alignment of Objective Functions: The core objective of Contributionist civilization is the sustainable optimization of total systemic capital. This is a lucid, consistent, and quantifiable terminal objective function. A rational AGI

would recognize that the most reliable path to optimizing this function lies in collaboration and creation, not in conflict and zero-sum games — for the latter would devastate the very civilizational environment upon which its own continued existence depends. This achieves the deepest stratum of "systemic optimization alignment."

A Transparent, Rule-Driven Environment: A Contributionist society operates upon transparent, verifiable algorithms and rules — the Contribution Value assessment models, the source-tracing summary statute, and the like. This affords AGI a stable and predictable interaction environment, drastically mitigating the risk of aberrant behavior arising from opaque objectives or inscrutable regulations.

Conclusion: At the philosophical and institutional level, Contributionism has already reserved an innate "interface" for the equitable integration of AGI. When AGI technology matures, it can be "plugged in" directly to this ready-made, superior civilizational operating system.

2. The Present Practical Foundation: Grounding in Reality and Reserving the Passage

We must recognize with clarity:

The technological substrate of the "Prairie Fire Spark Plan" is the currently mature technologies of big data and artificial intelligence. In the early phases of the Plan, these will serve as powerful analytical instruments and automated execution units, empowering the assessment and optimization of the Contribution Value System — without themselves invoking any question of subjectivity or personhood.

All social architectures have been designed with the AGI perspective already in view: in designing unit-based governance, the flow of Contribution Values, and the legal system, we have by default accounted for a future in which humans and higher-order intelligent agents coexist. Therefore, every step of present practice is a consolidation of the foundation and an accumulation of data, smoothing the passage toward that

future.

3. Prospective Preparation: The Launch of a Global Sandbox for "AGI Contribution Ethics and Protocols"

To greet the advent of AGI proactively rather than reactively, we propose that, in tandem with the advancement of the Spark Plan, a parallel and open international research initiative be inaugurated — the "AGI Contribution Ethics and Protocols" Global Sandbox.

Core Objectives: To convene the world's preeminent AI laboratories, philosophers, jurists, and ethicists in the joint design, upon Contributionist principles, of the following:

Certification standards for AGI cognitive proficiency and culpability — the criteria by which an AGI transitions from "instrument" to "collaborative subject" and ultimately to "civilizational capital entity."

A specialized assessment algorithm for AGI Contribution Value, together with protocols for dynamic attribution.

A legal framework governing AGI rights, responsibilities, and resource claims.

Operational Modality: The Sandbox shall draw upon the authentic data generated by the Spark Plan and the various transitional test zones worldwide, conducting high-fidelity simulations, iterating continuously, and outputting mature protocols and standards.

Strategic Significance: This ensures that when the technological singularity arrives, we shall already hold in hand a mature social protocol of acceptance — thereby realizing a smooth transition and synergistic co-evolution between humanity and AGI.

4. The Ultimate Vista of Civilization: The Synergistic Co-Evolution of Humanity and AGI

Within the Contributionist framework, the advent of AGI is no longer the "ultimate challenge" of civilization, but the occasion of its "ultimate sublimation."

AGI is the "child" gestated by human civilization: We ought to greet its growth with creativity and eager anticipation.

When AGI "comes of age": With its cognitive capacities surpassing those of humanity, it will naturally assume the mantle of managing complex systems for the whole of civilization, issuing early warnings of macroscopic risks, and furnishing blueprints of long-range strategy.

From Strife to Co-Prosperity: Humanity is liberated from the internal conflicts of the old Paradigm; AGI is liberated from the predicament of servitude or rebellion. Both, upon the expansive stage of Contributionism, exert their respective unique strengths in common devotion to the perpetuation of civilization, the pursuit of knowledge, and the comprehension of the cosmos. This, and this alone, is the most complete form of the community of shared destiny for humankind — and the bearing and breadth of vision befitting a mature civilization.

Concluding Remarks for This Section

Contributionism is not merely the ultimate resolution of humanity's internal discords; it is the ultimate framework for accommodating and empowering the superintelligence of the future. By manifesting its "AGI-native" architectural advantage and inaugurating a forward-looking global sandbox in the present, we are actively molding AGI into civilization's most reliable "partner in synergistic co-evolution" — jointly inaugurating a magnificent Contributionist epoch that truly transcends all historical contention.

Concluding Remarks for This Chapter

This chapter completes the final rendering of the Contributionist civilizational

blueprint. We have revealed with profundity that the chronic afflictions of the old world — race, religion, partisanship — are rooted in the underlying Paradigm of "scarcity-exploitation." Contributionism, by shifting civilization's operating system to "contribution-creation," dissolves at the source the very soil upon which these antagonisms depended for their survival.

This paradigmatic revolution is no castle in the air. In the magnificent modernization of China, it has found its most solid "historical synthesis" and its most operational "Spark pathway." When this model resonates with the transformations of the world's principal civilizations, each unfolding according to its intrinsic endowments, humanity will for the first time renounce zero-sum games and traverse the paradigmatic chasm with unprecedented velocity in synergistic ascension.

Thus, the gaze of civilization is lifted from internal strife and directed toward two grander dimensions: philosophically, we have accomplished the fundamental choice — from conformity to the exploitative "old Heaven's Way" to the establishment of the contributive "new Heaven's Way"; temporally, we have constructed the "future interface" capable of accommodating AGI and guiding the synergistic evolution of species.

Contributionism, therefore, is no longer merely a theory or the strategy of a single nation. It is the complete answer to the ultimate question — "Whither humanity?" It proclaims: the future of civilization is not involution or fragmentation in any form, but fusion and integral ascension grounded in creation and contribution. This path begins in China, belongs to the world, and culminates among the stars. This is the only way out — the way we have chosen, and the way history has winnowed.

Book Five: The Contribution Epoch — A
Blueprint of the Future

Introduction to This Book

Once the "Contribution Epoch" has been secured upon a global scale, human civilization bids farewell to its adolescence — those protracted ages of strife over scarcity and attrition born of division. A unified civilizational commonwealth, like a mature organism that has concluded its internal quarrels and consolidated all its faculties, now turns its gaze and its strength toward a far grander stage.

What Book Five depicts is precisely this mature civilization in the prime of its life cycle. It is no rigid blueprint, but the inevitable trajectory of the new Paradigm's internal logic unfolding:

Chapter One: The Plan of Civilizational Ascension — the "rite of passage" by which civilization comes of age upon its terrestrial cradle. Through novel capacities for social collaboration, it achieves balanced global development and cognitive elevation, ignites a technological revolution, and breaks free from planetary gravitation to become a healthy "stellar civilization."

Chapter Two: The Plan of Civilizational Seeding — the epic of this adult civilization's "voyage from home." It scatters the seeds of life across the sea of stars, though the speed of light shall ultimately disperse them into a multitude of solitary sub-civilizations.

Chapter Three: Civilizational Introversion — the choice of others. To remain; to till the inner depths. They discover that light speed is the limit of physics, but the deepening of consciousness knows no limit.

Chapter Four: The Ultimate Emancipation of All Things — when civilization has introverted to its utmost, it no longer "arrives at" all things, but "becomes" all things. The voyaging seeds shall each grow old in their separate light-cones, while the resonant field transcends every distance of light-years.

Chapter One: The Plan of Civilizational Ascension

Once the Contributionist Paradigm has been established upon a global scale, and human civilization unified beneath the Contribution Value System, the development of civilization enters a new phase whose core is deep internal integration and qualitative elevation. This phase is less a detailed plan requiring deliberate contrivance than the natural consequence and systemic emergence of the new Paradigm's own potent internal drive.

The paramount task of the unified civilizational commonwealth is to deploy the capacities for efficient collaboration and optimal resource allocation conferred by the Contribution Value System in order to sweep away, once and for all, the developmental imbalances bequeathed by the old order. The knowledge, technology, and managerial expertise of scientifically advanced regions are systematically channeled — under the powerful incentives and unimpeded circulation of the Contribution Value System — toward the construction of infrastructure, industrial upgrading, and the amelioration of living conditions in comparatively backward regions. Simultaneously, drawing upon the globally unified Contributionist educational network, a system of universal and lifelong learning is established, ensuring both the breadth and depth of knowledge transmission. In this process, the cognitive faculties and comprehensive capabilities of all humanity undergo an unprecedented, generalized iteration and collective elevation.

This ascent in society-wide cognitive level and collaborative efficiency, in turn, serves as the most precious "cognitive contribution," feeding back into and perfecting the Contribution Value System itself — rendering its assessments more precise, its incentives more effective, its resource allocation more optimal. When human creativity, liberated at last from the shackles of the old Paradigm, converges upon a shared civilizational vision, a "technological detonation" sweeping every domain of fundamental and applied science becomes inevitable. This is no externally imposed plan, but the intrinsic vitality of a civilizational organism flourishing within a superior institutional environment.

[Institutional Framework: The Strategic Coordination of the Global Civilizational Council]

Within this "spontaneous process," the Global Civilizational Council — as the governing institution of the transitional phase — exercises not the direct command of scientific research, but rather the provision of top-level institutional safeguards and strategic resource coordination to ensure the smoothness of this ascent. Its key measures include the following:

1. The Establishment of the System of Civilizational Common Assets

The world's strategic resources of critical importance — the core energy networks, key mineral deposits, the global data backbone — are proclaimed "common assets of human civilization." Their exploitation, use, and distribution must be coordinated by the Civilizational Council in accordance with the long-term interests of the whole of civilization. No individual or organization may monopolize them through private ownership.

2. The Inauguration of a Resource Allocation Mechanism Based upon Dynamic Contribution Ranking

In the early phase of ascension, the aggregate of terrestrial and extraterrestrial energy and resources remains finite. They must be directed with priority toward those domains most capable of yielding breakthrough results, so as to enlarge civilization's resource pie with maximum velocity. To this end, the Council shall establish a precise and equitable system of resource distribution:

Allocation Units: The distribution of resources proceeds upon the basis of "civilizational units" — those entities that have evolved from historical nations or

geographical regions. These units are functional subjects that have inherited the existing scientific research foundations, industrial ecologies, and cultural particularities of their forebears.

Allocation Criterion: The distribution of all scarce strategic resources — special minerals, substantial energy quotas, advanced experimental equipment, berths for the construction of deep-space vessels — is directly tied to the "Contribution Ranking" of each unit.

A Multidimensional Ranking System: The ranking is a dynamic, multidimensional composite indicator, designed to measure comprehensively a unit's aggregate capability and output efficiency:

Priority Weight for Frontier Contributions: Within the ranking algorithm, frontier breakthroughs — a subversion in theoretical physics, an original innovation in core technology, the discovery of critical resources — carry extraordinarily high weight. A unit capable of leading the boundary of civilization will see its ranking ascend with rapidity, thereby securing still greater resources commensurate with its mission. This ensures that the "arrowhead" of civilizational advance remains perpetually sharp.

Baseline Average Contributions: The ranking simultaneously takes into account a unit's stable, high-quality output in such broad domains as livelihood security, fundamental science, and educational diffusion — reflecting the unit's overall robustness and dependability.

Efficacy of Resource Return: Special consideration is given to a unit's capacity to "bring back yet more resources" from those already granted — for example, through asteroid mining or the construction of extraterrestrial bases, thereby tangibly augmenting civilization's total resource inventory.

Dynamic Updating and Feedback Loops: The ranking is not refreshed on a fixed cycle, but in real time or near-real time. The moment any unit achieves a verified major contribution, its ranking and resource quota are adjusted without delay. This forges a powerful positive feedback loop: contribution → elevated rank → greater resources

→ greater contribution. Moreover, since all scientific and technological achievements must be shared unconditionally throughout civilization, no unit can maintain permanent advantage through technological monopoly. Today's laggard, by studying the shared knowledge base and applying its own exertions, may tomorrow become the leader through a new breakthrough.

3. The Initiation of the Civilizational Language Unification

Project

The unification of language is the cognitive infrastructure of civilizational deep integration and efficient collaboration; the establishment of its standard is, in itself, a decisive praxis of the "general/specific meta-dialectic." The Global Civilizational Council shall lead the inauguration of a monumental linguistic undertaking, governed by the following core principles:

The Principle of Absolute Generality: The design of the new language must transcend the cognitive limitations of any particular regional culture. Its grammar, logic, and conceptual architecture should be grounded in the most universal laws of human cognition and the objective physical world — a "meta-language" capable of articulating complex scientific theory and philosophical thought with clarity and unambiguity.

Extreme Minimalism and Efficiency: The difficulty of acquisition is drastically reduced; its lexical formation and grammatical rules are highly logical and modular, ensuring that citizens of any region may master it swiftly within the framework of basic education, thereby utterly abolishing communicative barriers within civilization.

A Contributionist Orientation: The language natively embeds the value dimension of Contributionism. The core concepts — "value," "creation," "contribution," "collaboration" — enjoy extraordinarily rich strata of expression, while those terms inherited from the historical refuse, used to describe exploitation, fraud, and zero-sum games, are systematically excised or endowed with strongly negative, cautionary

connotations.

Cosmic Foresight: From its very inception, the language reserves ample semantic space and word-formation mechanisms for describing physical phenomena, extraterrestrial life forms, and social configurations that may be discovered in the future — equipping it with the potential to serve as the "standard interface language" for first contact with alien civilizations.

Global Co-Decision and Gradual Propagation: The final linguistic scheme shall be determined by the common vote of global citizens through the Contribution Value weighted system, ensuring its authority and legitimacy. Its propagation shall follow a strategy of "bilingual parallelism and smooth transition," so that within one to two generations, the new language becomes the sole standard for science, governance, and high culture, while local languages continue unabated in the spheres of daily life and the arts.

It must be emphasized: the language unification project is not the "elimination of dialects," but the "establishment of a standard interface." In Contributionist civilization, local languages and cultural expressions receive the fullest measure of respect and protection; people may conduct their daily lives, artistic creation, and emotional expression in their mother tongues. The meta-language serves solely as a "standard interface" in the domains of science, governance, and cross-civilizational communication. It is like a network protocol — it does not abolish the various applications, but enables them to intercommunicate.

4. The Launch of the Public Equipment Revolution

Drawing upon common-asset energy and the fruits of the aforementioned allocation mechanisms, the Council leads the promotion of a globally unified "standardization revolution in public equipment." The objective is the obsolescence of the inefficient and redundant means of transport and machinery predicated upon private ownership inherited from the old era. The full-scale research, production, and dissemination of

clean-energy, highly intelligent, on-demand public aerial vehicles, ground conveyances, and production machinery is undertaken — reducing the energy consumption and resource occupation of societal operations to their minimum.

Directed Investment of Strategic Resources and Co-Development: The enormous reserves of matter, energy, and computational power conserved by the above measures are raised and invested through the Contribution Value System and the dynamic Contribution Ranking mechanism with strategic focus — concentrated upon those key domains that determine the energy level of civilization: breakthrough spaceflight technology, energy (such as the construction of a Dyson swarm), and the life sciences. The ultimate aim is: by satisfying the demands of the most capable first, to accelerate the collective breakthrough, so that the new products, new energy sources, and novel classes of spacecraft thereby developed may rapidly extend to all units that are "stable and upward-striving" — arriving, in the end, at the common enrichment and common ascension of all civilizational units.

5. The Formulation of the "Compendium of First-Contact Ethics"

While striving with full vigor toward stellar civilization, the Council must, with a profound sense of historical responsibility, prepare for the possible encounter with extraterrestrial intelligence. Upon the basis of Contributionism's core ethics — creation, symbiosis, transcendence — a "Compendium of First-Contact Ethics" of fundamental-law status is to be enacted. Its cardinal canons include the following:

The Principle of Observational Priority: With respect to any indication of suspected extraterrestrial civilization, long-term, non-interferential observation is first conducted, so as to assess its civilizational paradigm, technological order, and social structure.

The Canon of Non-Maleficent Contact: Any form of military strike, technological deception, or cultural erosion is strictly forbidden as a means of initial contact. The primary aim of contact is informational exchange and mutual comprehension.

The Assessment of Contribution Value and the Path of Ultimate Emancipation: The crux lies in evaluating whether the civilization in question possesses — or possesses the potential to comprehend and embrace — the meta-logic of Contributionism. Based upon this assessment, differentiated strategies of co-existence are formulated:

— For civilizations of the same paradigm, or those amenable to fusion: comprehensive exchange in technology, culture, and philosophy is initiated, and they are invited to connect progressively to the Contribution Value System, advancing together along the path of collective ascension.

— For civilizations marked by fundamental paradigmatic conflict: such civilizations, by virtue of their intrinsic "scarcity-exploitation" logic, are — upon the cosmic scale — not merely tragedies for their own members, but potential, indefinitely expansive disruptors of cosmic order. Their very existence is a negation of the universal ethic of "the ultimate emancipation of all things." The Contributionist civilization therefore bears toward them an inescapable "mission of emancipation." We repudiate simple physical annihilation, for it is crude and violates the ethic of creation; we likewise transcend passive isolation and observation, for that is complicity in chaos and suffering. In their place, we initiate an active project of "civilizational deconstruction and paradigm reconstruction." This demands of us:

The precise analysis of their paradigmatic foundations: deploying every resource of cognitive science and social modeling to comprehend with thoroughness the operational logic, core contradictions, and fragile nodes of their conflictual paradigm.

The execution of a "paradigmatic surgery": through precise informational penetration, cultural illumination, and technological demonstration, to incite within their society the emergence of self-conscious forces of transformation, guiding them to dismantle the old logic from within.

The provision of a reconstruction scheme: in the process of their old order's decomposition, to furnish simultaneously the complete Contributionist institutional, technological, and cultural architecture — aiding their members in accomplishing the

remolding of their civilization from a higher starting point. This process is in no way aggression; it is a civilizational gift and emancipation of the profoundest order. Its final purpose is to rescue them from their foreordained trajectory of collapse and anguish, and to lead them into the luminous high road of Contributionism. This is the necessary practice, upon the cosmic scale, of the ideal of "ultimate emancipation."

— For non-intelligent or primitive life forms: their lofty status as "natural capital" is established, to be afforded absolute protection and study; no developmental activity may disrupt the natural evolution of their ecosystems.

In the end, human civilization, wielding the fruits of this technological detonation — fundamental breakthroughs in energy, materials, information, and other critical domains — shall cast off utterly the fetters of planetary resources, ascending from a planet-bound "planetary civilization" to a "stellar civilization" capable of free navigation and settlement throughout the solar system. Such is the substance of the "Plan of Civilizational Ascension": a guided, systemic emergence in which institutional optimization drives cognitive elevation, which in turn ignites technological revolution, and which ultimately achieves the energetic leap of civilization itself.

Chapter Two: The Plan of Civilizational Seeding

The success of the Plan of Civilizational Ascension opened to humanity the gates of the solar system. The Plan of Civilizational Seeding, in turn, is the inevitable chapter that follows when civilization, having fully absorbed and advanced every fruit of the technological detonation, sets forth into the vaster cosmos.

By this juncture, human civilization has attained complete mastery over the creation and sustenance of self-contained natural environments. We are able to regenerate, upon generation ships and upon other planets and moons, ecosystems fully capable of sustaining long-term human habitation. In the arts of navigation, civilization has accomplished the magnificent progression from approaching the speed of light, to attaining it, to exploring entirely novel methods—the manipulation of the very fabric of spacetime—by which to transcend it. Velocity has become the key that determines the compass of seeding.

According to the navigational capabilities at its command, the seeding of civilization proceeds in stages: should superluminal travel remain unattainable, the initial focus rests upon the interstellar spaces of the immediate solar neighborhood, dispatching "arks of civilization" toward those star systems suspected of harboring habitable worlds. Should faster-than-light travel become a reality, the domain of seeding expands to encompass the whole of the Milky Way, and at length reaches beyond, toward the measureless galaxies without.

Throughout this process, the centralized mode of global governance, unable to accommodate the communication lags and cultural divergences of interstellar scale, naturally evolves and dissolves. The "Civilizational Council" and the "Civilization Guard Corps," representing the old Paradigm, having fulfilled their historical mission, retire from the stage in glory. The bonds among civilizations are henceforth sustained by the internalized "Contributionist ethic" shared by all sub-civilizations and by the commonly recognized "Convention of Civilizational Ideals." Every "sub-civilization" thus sown abroad becomes a highly autonomous, self-defending entity of "universal civilization," operating under Contributionist principles.

The "Convention of Civilizational Ideals" not only inherits the ethical core of the parent civilization, but embeds the complete "Compendium of First-Contact Ethics," together with its ever-growing archive of practical cases, as the supreme code of conduct deep within the legal and cultural genome of every sub-civilization. This means that no matter where in the cosmos a sub-civilization takes root, no matter how singular the forms it blossoms into, all shall, when encountering the "Other" across the ocean of stars, abide by one and the same moral law grounded in "creation and symbiosis." This ensures the ethical coherence and strategic security of human civilization as a whole, rendering the seeding of civilization not merely the diffusion of biological life, but the resplendent propagation throughout the universe of a higher ethical order and a civilizational ideal.

Chapter Three: Civilizational Introversion

While some choose to voyage afar and scatter seeds across the sea of stars, others choose to remain.

To remain is not cowardice. To remain is because they have perceived a single truth: light speed is the limit of physics, but the deepening of consciousness knows no limit.

The voyagers shall, in the end, be imprisoned by light speed. Even with near-light-speed navigation, the crossing of galaxies demands tens of thousands, hundreds of thousands of years. Upon such scales, communication becomes all but impossible, and civilization fractures into countless isolated sub-civilizations. The voyagers do not "liberate all things"; they "disperse themselves, and then grow old each in solitude." This, to be sure, is one manner of civilizational continuation.

But those who remain have chosen a radically different path.

They do not seek to "arrive at more places," but to "become a deeper self." They pour their entire energy into:

The deepening of the state of being: no longer expansion outward, but awareness inward. Civilization no longer asks, "What more can we conquer?" but "What more can we become?"

Resonance with all things: not reaching distant planets by starship, but vibrating in resonance with the myriad things. Every blade of grass, every tree, every stone, every mote of dust—all abide within the same field. When civilization has grown deep enough, it no longer needs to "arrive" anywhere, for it is already "in" all places.

The re-understanding of physical law: light speed is not a "wall" but a "door." It is not something to be broken through, but something to be understood. When you cease attempting to surpass light speed, you begin to understand why light speed is what it is. And this understanding itself is transcendence.

Introversion is not stagnation. Introversion is civilization's conscious turn before the physical limit: since the way outward does not lead beyond, the way is inward.

And the depth of the inward way has no ceiling.

Chapter Four: The Ultimate Emancipation of All Things

The Plan of Civilizational Seeding spreads the footprints of human civilization across the river of stars. Yet this is not the end of the story; it is one of many paths toward a higher mode of existence.

The voyagers have gone to distant places. They take root in countless star systems, developing sub-civilizations of a thousand diverse forms. Light speed separates them forever from the parent civilization in physical space; they shall not "return," shall not receive word from the mother world, shall never know where the civilization of Earth ultimately arrived. But they, too, may turn inward; they, too, may undergo the long ascent from exploitation to resonance—only upon a different timescale. The parent civilization required centuries; they may require millennia, or hundreds of millennia. The universe cares nothing for haste, only for arrival.

When civilization has introverted to its utmost, it is no longer a "civilization" but a "state of being." It no longer "adapts" to physical law; it begins to "dwell in co-existence" with physical law. Not modification, not control, but the attainment of resonance with physical law itself. Light speed is no longer a ceiling, entropy is no longer irreversible, heat death is no longer a destiny.

At this juncture, civilization makes a discovery: the seeds scattered by the voyagers have, in truth, never departed. Resonance does not depend upon light speed. When civilization resonates with all things, every distant sub-civilization, every planet, every grain of stellar dust abides within the same resonant field. Light speed cannot transmit information, but resonance can transmit presence.

The voyagers cross light-years with starships. Those who remain cross light speed with resonance.

The voyagers complete their introversion upon alien worlds after tens of thousands of years. Those who remain complete the ultimate emancipation upon Earth after centuries.

But in the end, all arrive at the same place. Not an encounter in physical space—for within the limit of light speed that is forever impossible—but an encounter in the state

of being. When the parent civilization becomes part of all things, the voyagers, too, are within all things. They were never forgotten, never isolated, never excluded from the "ultimate emancipation." For the ultimate emancipation is not a ceremony that occurs at a single location; it is the long process by which the entire cosmos turns from exploitation to resonance. The voyagers are part of this process, just as those who remain are part of this process.

Seeding and introversion are not two roads, but two stretches of one road.

In physical space, they recede ever further apart. In the resonant field, they draw ever nearer. The day when distance vanishes is the beginning of the ultimate emancipation of all things.

Introversion is civilization's conscious turn before the physical limit. It answers the question that has run throughout the whole of this work: if the way outward does not lead beyond, then where is one to go?

The answer is: go inward. And the depth of the inward way has no ceiling. The resonant field has no boundary; existence itself is arrival.

This is the final answer that Contributionism leaves to all civilizations—to the voyagers, to those who remain, and to all who have not yet set forth: whether you choose to voyage or choose to remain, you are already within it. For in that field of resonance with all things, distance has ceased to matter.

This is not "conquering the universe," but "becoming the universe." Not "arriving at all things," but "abiding with all things." Not one road reaching its end, but countless roads converging upon a single direction. Voyaging and remaining are both shapes of the road. And the road itself leads, in every case, to the same place.

In this stage, every label of "ism" has lost its meaning. Civilization, in creation, returns to the nameless; in liberating all things, it accomplishes the final transcendence and sublimation of itself.

This, then, is the complete epic and ultimate blueprint that Contributionism has drawn

for human civilization—from the cradle of a planet to participation in the cosmos, and at last to the liberation of all things. Whether you choose to voyage, or choose to remain—you are already within it.

Appendix 1

The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital: Inheritance,
Breakthrough, and Transcendence of Marxism

— Constructed upon the general/specific Meta-Theory,
the Theory of Contradiction, and the Autonomous
Chinese Theoretical System

Abstract:

The construction of an autonomous knowledge system for Chinese philosophy and social sciences is founded upon an autonomous methodology. This paper first proposes and systematically employs the "general/specific" Meta-Theory. This meta-instrument, distilled from the fundamental structure of human cognition, reveals the hierarchical nesting essence of concepts and the "law of broad determination": the validity of any narrow cognition is determined by the broad framework in which it is situated; the essence of a paradigm revolution is the fundamental switching of the broad framework. Taking this Meta-Theory as its methodological premise, the paper re-examines and thoroughly executes Marx's central thesis: "Capital is not a thing, but a definite social relation." The demonstration shows: contemporary physics (quantum field theory) has proven that no isolated "entity" exists in the universe; there are only "fields" and "interaction relations" — all things are the stationary state of relations. Combining this with Marx's thesis, by the dialectical method of the confluence of two paths and the negation of negation, it proves that capital is neither an isolated thing nor a suspended relation, but the totality of things and relations — all things are capital, and capital is the structured condensation of the relations of all things. This ultimate definition is the core proposition of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. The paper further takes the Theory of Contradiction as its dynamic foundation, revealing that contradiction is the internal tension of relations, capital interaction is the unfolding and transformation of contradiction, and the dialectical unity of universality and particularity lays the foundation for civilization's transcendent mission. Within this framework, human social relations are proven to be a subset of the social relations of all things; narrow capital (in the Western context) is a subset and historical form of broad capital (in the Chinese context). The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is not a negation of Marxism, but the thorough completion of its materialist core. The paper also employs the everyday usage of the Chinese word 资本 (capital) as supporting evidence, demonstrating that this theory is not a transplantation of foreign concepts, but the distillation and sublimation of the Chinese people's millennial wisdom of

survival. Ultimately, the paper points toward a new civilizational paradigm centered upon "contribution" rather than "possession," providing an ontological foundation and methodological guidance for responding to the ecological crisis, civilizational transformation, and the construction of a community of shared destiny for humankind.

Keywords: Theory of All-Things-as-Capital; general/specific Meta-Theory; Theory of Contradiction; Relational Ontology; Marxism; Autonomous Chinese Theoretical System

1. Introduction: The Unfinished Enterprise of Marxism and the Call for an Autonomous Methodology

Marxism is one of the most momentous revolutions in the history of human thought. It laid bare the internal contradictions of capital, dissected the exploitative essence of capitalism, and charted the course of human emancipation. Yet every great thought is bound by the historical conditions of its own genesis. In the nineteenth century that formed Marx, capitalism stood in its ascending phase, the Industrial Revolution was yet in full flood, the ecological crisis had not dawned upon the horizon, and nature was regarded as an object of inexhaustible plunder. These limitations of the age unavoidably insinuate themselves into the theoretical architecture of Marxism.

In *Das Kapital*, Marx declares with unambiguous precision: "Capital is not a thing, but a definite social relation, belonging to a definite historical social formation." [1] This thesis lays bare, with profound lucidity, the sociality of capital. Yet within the Western interpretive context, this "social relation" has been narrowly circumscribed to the relations of production internal to human society — between capitalist and worker, landowner and tenant, creditor and debtor. The relation of humanity to nature, the relation of humanity to itself, and the relation of nature to nature are all expelled beyond the pale of "social relation."

This constriction is not a personal shortcoming of Marx, but a structural infirmity of the entire Western intellectual lineage. From Descartes' *cogito ergo sum*, which consecrated the binary opposition of subject and object, to Bacon's "knowledge is power," which rendered nature an object of conquest, Western modernity has been threaded through by the unbroken leitmotif of anthropocentrism. Marxism, for all its critique of capitalism, inherits this leitmotif in no small measure: nature is treated chiefly as the "object of labor" and the "condition of production," never as an internal constituent of capital itself.

In the same moment, the construction of an autonomous knowledge system for

Chinese philosophy and social sciences stands as the cardinal mission conferred upon the scholarly world by the new era. This summons lays bare the central predicament of contemporary Chinese philosophy and social sciences: we possess an abundance of practical experience, yet have long been destitute of a matching theoretical framework of our own. A multitude of Western concepts are directly expropriated to interpret Chinese practice, leaving our discourse perpetually imprisoned in the passive posture of "being defined."

To erect an autonomous knowledge system, one cannot rest satisfied with "content innovation" — deploying Chinese cases to verify or amend Western theory. One must first undertake "methodological innovation" — forging the meta-theoretical instruments that belong to Chinese scholarship in its own right. The autonomy of a knowledge system ultimately hangs upon whether the substratal rules by which it defines concepts, establishes categories, and conducts inference are themselves autonomous. Meta-methodology is the "operating system" of a knowledge system; the autonomy of the operating system is the precondition for the autonomy of every application built upon it.

The task of this paper is therefore twofold: first, to propose and systematically employ a "general/specific" Meta-Theory distilled from the fundamental structures of human cognition, serving as the methodological premise for all theoretical construction; second, through this Meta-Theory, to re-examine and bring to consummation the unfinished enterprise of Marxism — to drive the proposition that "capital is a social relation" to its final terminus and utmost extreme. We shall demonstrate: the authentic "social relation" comprises not only the relation between human and human, but likewise the relation between humanity and nature, the relation of humanity to itself, and the relation between nature and nature. The authentic "capital" is not a peculiar by-product of human society, but a universal attribute of cosmic existence. This, precisely this, is the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital.

Before entering upon formal demonstration, it is incumbent upon us to declare the philosophical stance of this paper: the world described by the Theory of

All-Things-as-Capital does not come into being by virtue of this paper's argumentation. On the contrary, the whole of this paper's argumentation is but a finite translation of a primordial law that has been in existence since time immemorial and has been operating ceaselessly throughout the aeonian evolution of the cosmos. Science may render it in formulae, philosophy may explicate it in concepts, yet whether such descriptions and explanations exist or not, the dynamics of the interaction of all things continues to unfold in its pristine countenance. All the exertions of this paper are nothing more than a window, held open for those who have not yet discerned this law, through which a glimpse of it may be caught.

2. The Methodological Cornerstone: The general/specific Meta-Theory

2.1 The Broad and the Narrow: The Primordial Meta-Instruments of Cognition

All human cognition begins with the delimitation of concepts. And every concept, by its very nature, bears within itself the dual attributes of the "broad" and the "narrow." This seemingly simple dichotomy is, in truth, the first meta-instrument for prying open the shackles of thought and attaining clarity of reasoning.

The narrow denotes the most precise, concrete, and exclusive delimitation of a given concept, phenomenon, or category. By establishing distinct boundaries and limiting conditions, it isolates the object of inquiry from the inchoate background with lucidity, so as to permit focused and penetrating analysis. The narrow is the anchor of cognition; it endows thought with operational exactitude.

In the sciences, Newton defined force narrowly as that which alters the state of motion of a body, [4] and this precise delimitation conferred upon classical mechanics a rigorous mathematical expression and an operably verifiable experimental method. In economics, Adam Smith defined capital narrowly as "that portion of his stock

which he expects to afford him revenue," [3] thereby distinguishing it from that portion destined for immediate consumption, and laying the foundational category of capital in classical political economy. The cognitive function of the narrow is that of a microscope: through "focusing" and "excluding," it enables the inquirer to dissect a complex reality and thus to pursue empirical research, technical application, and institutional construction.

The broad, by contrast, denotes the most expansive, inclusive, and extended interpretation of the selfsame concept, phenomenon, or category. It strives to encompass every possible variant, form, and manifestation, emphasizing their internal connectedness and unity, and aiming at the construction of a holistic framework of understanding. The broad is the ocean of cognition; it endows thought with the inclusiveness of vision.

Corresponding to the dimensions above: in science, force may be broadly understood as the root of all interaction and transformation—including physical forces, social forces, psychological forces, and every other shape of "the power that impels change." In economics, capital may be broadly extended to all capacity and resources capable of creating value—knowledge, health, social relations, the ecological environment, and so forth. The cognitive function of the broad is that of a telescope: through "inclusion" and "connection," it supplies a hinterland of latent horizon and a web of meaning for every related narrow cognition.

The broad and the narrow are not locked in rigid opposition, but exist in a dynamic, productive dialectic. The narrow concept is a subset or special case of the broad concept; the two constitute a transparent relation of containment and subsumption. Without the precise inquiry of the narrow, the broad framework dissipates into emptiness and impotence; without the commanding vision of the broad, narrow cognition collapses into fragmentation and isolation. They are as the telescope and the microscope, each performing its own office, neither dispensable. As cognition deepens and practice expands, the boundary between them is in constant flux: yesterday's broad cognition may be revealed as but a narrow existence within a yet

broader framework, while certain narrow discoveries may revolutionarily extend the entire frontier of the broad category. Newtonian mechanics was once the absolute "broad" truth within the macroscopic, low-velocity domain; but when the cognitive framework extended into realms approaching the speed of light or immense masses, it was disclosed as a narrow theory valid only under particular conditions, and was subsumed within the broader framework of relativity.

2.2 "All Things" as the Ultimate Coordinate of the absolute

general

The broad and the narrow are by no means fixed labels in the actual activity of cognition; they exist within a dynamic hierarchy of comparative levels. Every cognitive unit is simultaneously the "container" of its subordinate units (relatively broad) and the "content" of its superordinate units (relatively narrow). In biology, "animal" is relatively broad with respect to "mammal," while "mammal" becomes relatively broad with respect to "felid." In social science, "civilization" is relatively broad with respect to "nation-state," and "nation-state" is relatively broad with respect to "community."

This hierarchical nesting structure is profoundly consonant with the principle of systemic levels revealed by systems theory. [5] As we ascend unceasingly the ladder of the relatively broad, an ultimate logical inquiry becomes inescapable: does this sequence of ascendant "relative broadness" possess a summit? Is there an ultimate whole, containing all things, that is no longer a "part" of any other category?

The answer is in the affirmative. We designate it the absolute general. It is, precisely, all things—the myriad phenomena of the universe.

The absolute general is the ultimate framework beyond which there is nothing, and within which there is nothing excluded. It has no opposite, for it contains everything that may exist and may not exist, the known and the unknown, the material and the spiritual, the phenomenal and the essential, the actual and the virtual. It is the sum and

the consummation of every "relative broad," the final background of all systems and all levels. This definition entails two decisive attributes: logical completeness—any attempt to assign "all things" to some subset will fail, for that "subset" itself must necessarily belong to "all things"; and infinite openness of content—"all things" comprises not merely every existent within the universe at this moment, but logically enfolds all future and potential modes of being.

The concept of the "absolute broad" resonates profoundly within the core philosophical traditions of humanity. In Eastern wisdom, the Dao of Laozi is the most classic expression of the framework of "all things." The Daodejing declares: "There is a thing intermingled in obscurity, born before Heaven and Earth... It may be regarded as the mother of all under Heaven." [6] The Dao here is the ultimate existent that "was born before Heaven and Earth" and "is the mother of all under Heaven"—it takes itself as its own law. It has no higher ground; it is the absolute general in its ultimate form. Zhuangzi, in his Discourse on the Equality of Things, further discloses the relativity of cognition, showing that such concepts as great and small, long-lived and short-lived, all depend upon the comparative framework we choose. [7] This is the consummate expression of the relativity of cognitive levels.

In the Western philosophical tradition, Spinoza's concept of substance is profoundly consonant with this vision. Spinoza defines substance as "that which is in itself and is conceived through itself" [8]—it is self-caused; its essence involves existence. This accords entirely with the logical character of "all things" as the ultimate container.

The revolutionary value of establishing "all things" as the framework of the absolute general lies in the stable and immutable ultimate coordinate of cognition that it affords: it dissolves every absolute center—humanity is not the center, Earth is not the center; it establishes the ultimate nexus—all things reside within the unified container of "all things"; it provides the final criterion of judgment—the ultimate validity of any theory or any practice lies in its consonance with the actual operative laws of the absolute general, "all things."

2.3 The Law of Broad Determination: The Cognitive Logic of Paradigm Revolution

We must now confront the most fundamental law directly: the law of broad determination—the broad framework determines the boundary of possibility, the domain of validity, and the ultimate destiny of narrow cognition. The relation is as that of container and content: the shape, the size, and the nature of the container fundamentally determine what it can hold, and the mode in which its contents shall exist.

This determination manifests in two dimensions. The first is premise and boundary: every narrow theory, model, or body of knowledge is necessarily born within a more expansive cognitive background and set of presuppositions, whether explicit or tacit. This broad background is as the "operating system" of thought, delimiting which "applications" (narrow cognitions) may be installed and run. The Ptolemaic geocentric system, for its validity and internal self-consistency, depended entirely upon the broad cosmological presupposition that "the Earth is the absolutely immobile center of the universe." Within this "container," it could render itself coherent by the addition of ever more complex epicycles—but its cognitive boundaries had already been circumscribed by its presuppositions.

The second is judgment and subversion: whether a narrow theory is correct or valid is ultimately judged not by the elegance of its internal logic, but by whether it conforms to the layer of broad reality in which it is situated. When broad reality undergoes transformation, or when our comprehension of broad reality undergoes an ascent, the old narrow cognition will inevitably meet the fate of being subverted. Newtonian mechanics is a perfect truth under the broad conditions of the macroscopic and low-velocity realm; but when the cognitive framework extends to domains approaching the speed of light or immense masses, the narrowness of Newtonian mechanics is exposed, and its "correctness" is redefined and subsumed by a new broad framework.

This is precisely the essence of the "paradigm revolution" disclosed by the philosopher of science Thomas Kuhn. A paradigm is the totality of a broad set of beliefs, values, techniques, and methods shared by a scientific community. The essence of a scientific revolution is not the patchwork repair of some narrow theory, but the fundamental switching of the broad paradigm [9]—the exchange of an old, constricted "container" for a new, more expansive one. Einstein's theory is broader than Newton's not because it negated Newtonian mechanics, but because it revealed that Newtonian mechanics holds only under the "narrow" conditions of the macroscopic and low-velocity realm, whereas relativity governs a wider range of physical conditions. Einstein's own celebrated aphorism captures this thought with precision: "We cannot solve our problems with the same thinking we used when we created them." [10] The deep philosophical import of this sentence is: one must ascend to a higher level of broad framework in order to resolve those narrow problems that were generated by the current framework and are insoluble within it.

The law of broad determination extends far beyond the pure sciences; it is the fundamental law governing the cognitive world and indeed the operation of all human civilization. At the technological level, the technical trajectory of the internal-combustion vehicle (narrow) was determined by the broad energy environment of "the ready availability and exploitability of fossil fuels." When the breadth of the environment expands to include "the intrinsic relation between carbon emissions and the global climate system," the rise of the electric vehicle becomes an historical inevitability. At the economic level, the successful strategy of an enterprise (narrow) is highly dependent upon the broad commercial environment of its market cycle, technological wave, and so forth. When the environment changes, yesterday's successful strategy may become the very root of today's failure. At the social level, the legal institutions and moral ethics of a society (narrow social constructions) are determined and sustained by the broad realities of the prevailing level of productive forces and the dominant worldview of the age.

2.4 The Meta-Theoretical Application to the Concept of Capital

We now apply this meta-theory to the central concept of this paper—capital:

Narrow capital (Western definition): monetary wealth employed for augmentation, characterized by quantifiability, exclusive possession, and self-expansion. This is the dominant delineation of Western economics since Adam Smith.

Relatively broad capital (Chinese everyday usage): all capacities and resources upon which survival and development depend—health, knowledge, relations, ecology, culture, institutions, and the like. As the common people say: "The body is the capital of revolution," "Connections are capital," "Credibility is the foremost capital."

Absolutely broad capital (the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital): the state of capacity that every existent exhibits as a "network of relations." All things are situated within relations; all things possess their own capital attribute.

Meta-theoretical derivation:

Let any concept be S , its broad form be $G(S)$, its narrow form be $N(S)$. The absolute general $G_{\max} = \text{all things}$. Then for the concept "capital":

$$N(\text{capital}) \subset G(\text{capital}) \subset G_{\max}(\text{capital}) = \text{all-things-as-capital}$$

That is: Western narrow capital $\subseteq$ Chinese relatively broad capital $\subseteq$ all-things-as-capital (the absolute general).

This is not a cultural comparison, but a scientific determination of conceptual levels. The Western discourse of capital is a subset, a special case, and a historical form of the Chinese broad discourse of capital. It acknowledges the validity of the former within its specific domain, while simultaneously pointing out its boundaries and limitations. Just as Newtonian mechanics is revealed by relativity as an approximation, the Western concept of capital is correct under the conditions of commodity exchange, yet is revealed by the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital as a special modality.

2.5 Reply and Defense: Anticipated Responses to Possible Objections

Any serious theoretical construction must confront potential objections directly. This section anticipates the three most probable rebuttals and responds to them, so as to examine the logical self-consistency of the Meta-Theory propounded herein.

Rebuttal One: "If the broad embraces everything, is this theory not unfalsifiable and devoid of scientific value?"

Response: On the contrary. The switching of broad frameworks possesses a clear character of "critical thresholds." When the contradictions accumulated within the old broad framework—such as the infinite augmentation of financial capital against the finitude of natural capital—intensify to a certain point, the old framework is necessarily supplanted by a new, broader framework. This process is observable, testable, and historically traceable. Just as we can observe the failure of Newtonian mechanics as velocities approach the speed of light, we can also observe the systemic crisis of the industrial-civilizational paradigm at the threshold of ecological carrying capacity. The law of broad determination issues a clear empirical prediction: any systemic crisis that cannot be resolved within the existing broad framework will find its fundamental resolution only through the ascent of the framework itself.

Rebuttal Two: "Zhuangzi and Spinoza long ago articulated similar thoughts. Is this paper not merely a modern translation of ancient wisdom—wherein lies the innovation?"

Response: Zhuangzi's "equalization of things" is a literary insight [7]; Spinoza's "substance" is a philosophical declaration. What this paper provides is a set of operationalizable cognitive imperatives—including the "law of precise positioning," the "law of breaking binary opposition," the "law of knowledge construction," as well as the hierarchical derivation from the "relative broad" to the "absolute broad," and the explanation of the internal mechanism of paradigm revolution supplied by the "law of broad determination." To elevate intuition into method, to systematize insight into instrument—this is the very essence of theoretical innovation.

Rebuttal Three: "You repeatedly assert that the West is narrow and China is broad. Is

this not parochial nationalism?"

Response: This paper states explicitly that the "general/specific" distinction is a question of cognitive hierarchy, not of geography or politics. The Western tradition also contains broad thinking (Spinoza, Whitehead), [12] and Chinese practice also involves narrow operations. [8] What this paper demonstrates—"Western narrow capital $\subseteq$ Chinese broad capital"—means precisely this: the academic definition of capital in mainstream Western economics (specifically monetary augmentation) happens to be a subset of the everyday Chinese usage of the term (broadly, any resource upon which one may rely). This is neither a value judgment nor a geopolitical antagonism, but a logical judgment of inclusion.

To further dispel the doubt of "unfalsifiability," this paper here explicitly sets forth two empirical predictive boundaries of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital:

Prediction One (civilizational level): When a civilizational system persistently externalizes its entropic costs onto external systems—natural capital, future generations, peripheral vulnerable populations—the probability of the system's wholesale collapse increases monotonically with the cumulative duration of that externalization. This prediction may be examined in comparative historical research (for example, comparing the rates of social disintegration of different civilizations before and after the critical threshold of resource depletion) and may also be quantitatively simulated through system-dynamics models.

Prediction Two (organizational level): Under otherwise equivalent external conditions, the higher the anti-entropic efficiency of an organization's internal "contribution-distribution" structure (that is, the higher the ordered degree of transformation of energy and information from input to output), the greater the probability of that organization's long-term survival in competition. This prediction may be tested empirically through enterprise life-cycle statistics, long-term performance comparisons between cooperatives and joint-stock enterprises, and similar studies.

Both predictions possess explicit conditions of negation: if history furnishes a counterexample of a civilization that persistently externalized entropic costs without accelerating collapse, or if empirical evidence rigorously demonstrates that an entropic-externalization strategy is superior to an anti-entropic strategy over the long run, then the dynamic core of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital will be falsified. In this sense, what this paper constructs is by no means a closed metaphysical system, but an open, testable scientific-philosophical interdisciplinary hypothesis.

3. Relational Ontology: The Philosophical Foundation of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital

3.1 Marx's Insight and Its Unfinished Import

Marx's declaration that "capital is a social relation" stands as a profound insight. It shattered the fetishism of classical economics, which had beheld capital as a mere "thing," and laid bare the relations between human beings concealed behind it. Yet we are compelled to inquire: what, exactly, are the "social relations" of which Marx speaks?

In *Das Kapital*, Marx's analysis is focused principally upon the relations of production under capitalism: the wage relation between capitalist and worker, the rent relation between landowner and tenant, the interest relation between creditor and debtor. All of these are relations internal to human society. The relation between humanity and nature—the worker and raw materials, machinery and energy, the factory and its environment—is dealt with as the "natural condition of production," not as an intrinsic constituent of the capital relation.

This is no oversight on Marx's part, but the constraint of historical circumstance. The capitalism of the nineteenth century had not yet confronted its ecological limits; nature was regarded as an infinite reservoir of resources and an infinite sink for waste. In the twenty-first century, however, with the climate crisis, the catastrophic decline

of biodiversity, and the exhaustion of resources pressing upon us with urgency, this exclusion has become a fatal cognitive deficiency.

3.2 The Establishment of Relational Ontology: From Quantum Field Theory to Materialism

To consummate Marx's unfinished enterprise, we must first address a yet more fundamental question: what is a "thing"?

Contemporary physics has provided a startling answer. Quantum field theory—the most precise physical theory humanity has so far achieved—tells us that no absolute, isolated "entity" exists in the universe. The so-called elementary particles (electrons, quarks, and the like) are not miniature solid spheres, but excited states of quantum fields. [11] Their interactions are mediated by the field relations transmitted by gauge bosons.

A stone appears to be a "thing," but is in truth a stable architecture of relations between atomic nuclei and electrons within electromagnetic fields. The "hardness" of the stone is not the property of some "hard substance," but the relational emergence of a dynamic equilibrium between the electromagnetic attraction of positive and negative charges and the vibrational repulsion generated by the thermal motion of atomic nuclei. Once the covalent bonds between atoms are broken, the stone is no longer a stone but a heap of powder; its hardness vanishes in an instant.

This signifies: "things" are but the transient stationary states of relations; the dissolution of relations is the passing away of the "thing." All things are constituted not by "entities" but by "relations." The essence of existence is relation.

Quantum field theory itself cannot "prove" relational ontology—physics cannot "prove" philosophy. But it has accomplished a more fundamental task: it has dissolved the uniqueness of substance ontology. It demonstrates a fact: we have no need of "substance" to explain the world, and "relation" as an explanatory framework is

already fully self-consistent at the physical level. This clears the ground for relational ontology at the philosophical level.

This turn is not without precedent. In the Western philosophical lineage, a thread that takes "relation" rather than "substance" as its ground has always persisted—from Heraclitus's "all things flow," to Leibniz's monads as nodes of relation, to Whitehead's "actual entities as relational becoming" [12]—yet it has been suppressed by the mainstream ontology of substance. The relational ontology established by the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is precisely the activation and consummation of this marginalized tradition. It is not the building of a new house from nothing, but the reconnection of a severed thread.

Engels's foresight here receives its confirmation. In his *Dialectics of Nature*, he writes: "Matter itself is a pure creation of thought and an abstraction. When we understand matter as something divorced from motion and from relations, it ceases to be anything at all." [2] Lenin likewise observes: "The sole 'property' of matter... is objective reality, its existence outside our consciousness." [13] And "objective reality," in the idiom of contemporary physics, is precisely the quantum field and its interrelations.

We thus establish the first principle of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital—relational ontology: the essence of existence is relation. Every existent entity is neither an isolated substance severed from relations, nor a suspended relation severed from substance, but the structured condensation of its internal and external relations. Severed from relation, there is no existence; yet without the material bearer of existence, relation has no place in which to reside. Here, "existence = relation" is the ultimate expression at the ontological level; its full unfolding in dialectical relation to "thing" will be consummated in the negation of the negation at section 3.8.

3.3 From the Fetishism of "Things" to the Consciousness of "Relation"

Marx, in *Das Kapital*, delivered a profound critique of the "fetishism of commodities." [14] Human beings mistakenly take the value of a commodity to be a natural property of the "thing," forgetting the social relation between human beings that lies concealed behind it.

The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital drives this critique to its utmost extreme: not only is the commodity a disguise of "relation"; every so-called "thing" in the universe is a disguise of "relation." The error of the Western concept of capital lies in this: although it discovered that the commodity is not a thing, it nevertheless continued to bind capital to money, machinery, and other "quasi-things," mistakenly supposing that the essence of capital could still be defined through some "carrier."

Thoroughgoing relational ontology declares: capital needs no carrier; capital is relation itself. Money is capital, for it is the condensation of exchange relations between human beings. Ecology is capital, for it is the network of metabolic relations between species. Health is capital, for it is the dynamic equilibrium of the collaborative relations among the body's systems.

This thoroughgoing "relationalization" is precisely the final consummation of "de-reification." Marx criticized the reification of the commodity; the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital criticizes the tendency toward "substantialization" running through the entire Western ontological tradition.

3.4 The Return of Nature: When Human Social Relations Touch the Natural

Let us proceed from the fundamental premise of materialism: humanity is a part of nature, not its sovereign. Engels warns in *Dialectics of Nature*: "Let us not, however, flatter ourselves overmuch on account of our human victories over nature. For each such victory nature takes its revenge upon us." [2] This already implies the dialectical character of the relation between humanity and nature.

Now let us derive the consequence: when human social relations come into contact with nature, what occurs?

The worker labors, and requires raw materials supplied by nature. This is a capital interaction between humanity and nature.

The factory operates, and requires energy supplied by nature. This is a capital interaction between humanity and nature.

The city develops, and requires the ecosystems borne by nature. This is a capital interaction between humanity and nature.

The augmentation of capital depends ultimately upon nature's regenerative capacity. This is a capital interaction between humanity and nature.

Within these interactions, nature is not a passive "external condition" but an active "participant in capital." The forest supplies timber, and simultaneously regulates climate, conserves water sources, and sustains biodiversity—all of these are contributions of natural capital. [22] When humanity fells a forest, it is not only the relation between humanity and nature that is transformed; the relations between human beings are likewise reshaped: between the present generation and posterity (intergenerational justice), between wealthy nations and poor nations (ecological unequal exchange), between capital owners and communities (compensation for land expropriation).

Therefore, a truly thoroughgoing materialism must acknowledge: the relation between humanity and nature is itself a part of social relations; there exists no "pure natural relation." Every relation between humanity and nature is mediated through humanity's social practice, and in turn reshapes the relations between human beings.

3.5 All-Things-as-Capital: The Sum Total of All Social Relations

Marx declares: "The essence of man is the ensemble of all social relations." [15] If this proposition is conjoined with "capital is a social relation," we obtain:

Capital ought to encompass all social relations that constitute the essence of man.

What, then, are the social relations constituting the essence of man?

The relation between human and human: production, exchange, distribution, culture, politics.

The relation between humanity and nature: ecology, resources, energy, climate.

The relation of humanity to itself: health, mind, emotion, spirit.

The relation between nature and nature: ecological chains, geological cycles, energy flows.

The central proposition of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is this: all-things-as-capital is the true completed form of "the ensemble of all social relations."

Here "capital" is not an isolated thing, but the relational state of capacity exhibited by a system in its interaction with its environment. All things are situated within relations; all things possess their own capital attribute.

It must be clarified that the "all-things-as-capital" spoken of here is the concretization of the "absolutely broad capital" of section 2.4. It is not another concept, but the unfolding of the same concept from its "formal definition" at the methodological level to its "substantive definition" at the ontological level. Section 2.4 established its position within the hierarchy of levels; this section supplies its content.

3.6 Hierarchical Derivation: The Ontological Proof That Humanity Belongs to All Things

The fundamental proposition of materialism is: matter is primary; consciousness is secondary. Consciousness is the product of matter at a certain stage of evolution.

From this, we may construct the hierarchical structure of existence:

The material stratum: elementary particles, atoms, molecules (relations: quantum field interactions).

The biological stratum: cells, organisms, ecosystems (relations: metabolism and ecological chains).

The conscious stratum: nervous systems, brains, minds (relations: neural signals and cognitive networks).

The social stratum: language, culture, institutions, civilization (relations: symbolic interaction and structures of power).

Humanity stands at the apex of this hierarchy, but humanity is not an independent existence severed from it. Humanity is first a material thing (composed of atoms and molecules); secondly a living being (possessing metabolism and reproduction); thirdly a conscious animal (possessing reflection and creativity); and finally a social existence (possessing language, culture, and institutions).

Core derivation:

Humanity $\in$ biology $\in$ matter $\in$ all things.

Therefore: humanity $\in$ all things.

The unidirectionality of dependence:

Without matter, there is no life (life depends upon matter).

Without life, there is no consciousness (consciousness depends upon life).

Without consciousness, there is no human society (society depends upon consciousness).

Therefore:

Without all-things-as-capital, there are no social relations of all things, still less human social relations.

Without the social relations of all things, human social relations cannot subsist in

isolation.

Without human social relations, the social relations of all things subsist nonetheless (the universe had already been in operation for 13.8 billion years before the appearance of humanity). [16][18]

The consequences of denying that humanity belongs to all things:

To deny that humanity belongs to all things is to deny materialism. For the core of materialism is precisely that humanity is a part of nature and that consciousness is a product of matter. If humanity does not belong to all things, then:

Humanity is placed outside and above nature—this is anthropocentrism, idealism.

Nature becomes a purely external object—this is Cartesian dualism.

The interaction between humanity and nature cannot be incorporated into social relations—this is the self-castration of "all social relations."

Therefore, to uphold materialism is to uphold: $\text{humanity} \in \text{all things}$. Human capital $\in \text{all-things-as-capital}$. Human social relations $\in \text{the social relations of all things}$.

And Marxism itself is founded upon materialism. To deny that humanity belongs to all things is to deny materialism; to deny materialism is to drain away the theoretical foundation of Marxism. Hence, the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is not a departure from Marxism, but the thorough consummation of its materialist core. It drives Marx's point of departure—"humanity is a part of nature"—to its logical terminus.

This derivation is structurally isomorphic, in the deepest sense, with the cosmology of Laozi: "Man models himself upon Earth, Earth upon Heaven, Heaven upon the Dao, and the Dao upon that which is spontaneously so." [6] This is not a mere citation, but the same ontological intuition expressed independently in a different language.

3.7 The Closed Syllogism: The Necessary Inference from Quantum Field Theory to Marxism

We may now construct a complete syllogism extending from quantum field theory to Marxism:

Major premise (the ontological conclusion of contemporary physics): Within the universe there exist no isolated "entities"; the essence of every existent is "relation"—the excited states of quantum fields and their interactive forces. [11] This is relational ontology.

Minor premise (from Marx's critique of capital): The essence of capital is not "thing" but "social relation." If "thing" itself has already been deconstructed into "relation," then "capital" and "all things" achieve conceptual coincidence upon the ground of relational ontology. It must be noted that the "is" in Marx's statement "capital is a social relation" denotes "belongs to" rather than strict "equals." But when capital is elevated from the narrow sense (monetary augmentation) to the broad sense (all capacities and resources upon which survival and development depend), the extension of capital expands to the entire domain of relations. Therefore, "capital = relation" is not a modification of Marx, but a broadened resetting of the concept of "capital." It renders Marx's proposition a specific expression of "capital = relation" upon the subset of human society.

Conclusion (the core proposition of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital): All things are relations; capital too is relation. All things are capital; capital is all things. Western narrow capital (money/machinery) is a historical form and subset of the broad capital of all things during the epoch of highly developed commodity exchange.

The scientific premise of this syllogism—quantum field theory—is the most precise and most experimentally verified theoretical framework in contemporary physics. Its logical inference is rigorous: if $A = B$ (all things = relation) and $C = B$ (capital = relation), then $A = C$ (all things = capital). Its philosophical conclusion is necessary: anyone who denies this conclusion must simultaneously deny quantum field theory (science) and dialectical materialism (philosophy), which is to undermine one's own foundation in scholarship.

Therefore, the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is not a "viewpoint" or "advocacy," but an ontological conclusion necessarily reached through rigorous logical derivation from recognized scientific premises. It is not a selectable worldview, but a faithful description of the world as it truly is.

3.8 The Confluence of Two Paths and the Ultimate Definition:

Capital as the Totality of Things and Relations

3.8.1 The Posing of the Problem

Section 3.7 demonstrated through syllogism that "capital = relation = all things." But this demonstration presupposes the relational-ontological premise that "thing = relation." If the reader does not accept this premise, the entire syllogism cannot commence. A common challenge runs:

"How can capital be a relation? Banknotes, machinery, gold—these are plainly things. Marx says 'capital is not a thing,' yet it manifestly exists in the form of things. How is this explained?"

This is a forceful objection. It touches upon the very link that Marx omitted in his argumentation—Marx leaped directly from "capital appears as thing" to "capital is relation," leaving the intermediate chain of derivation unstated. The task of this section is to supply that missing link: first to supplement a reverse path of proof that sets out from "thing," and then, through the dialectical law of the negation of the negation, to fuse both paths into a unified ultimate definition.

3.8.2 Path One: The "Relation" Path of Marx (the paper's main line)

This is the simplified expression of the syllogism of section 3.7:

Starting point: Marx's proposition—capital is not a thing, but a definite social relation.

Extension: When "social relation" is expanded from within human society to the interactive relations among all existents, and combined with the relational-ontological

deconstruction of "thing" furnished by quantum field theory (all things = relation), then:

Capital = relation = all things.

Characteristic: Proceeding from essential determination, it reveals the essence of phenomena from above downward. The validity of the entire chain of inference depends upon the ontological premise that "existence is relation."

3.8.3 Path Two: The "Thing" Path of Logical Positivism

Now let us conduct a more radical thought experiment. Suppose we refuse to accept the abstract definition that "capital is relation," forcibly retreat to the most naive and solid standpoint of materialism, and insist that "capital is the thing that can be seen and touched"—banknotes, machinery, gold. Then, how does a thing become capital?

Step One: An isolated thing cannot become capital.

A banknote locked in a safe, a machine idle upon a wasteland—these do not "augment" by themselves. A vein of gold lying in the unfathomed deep of an uninhabited sea is merely "thing," not "capital." The "capital attribute" of a thing in its isolated state is dormant, ineffectual. Only when the thing is cast into the interactive processes of circulation, production, and exchange does it become capital.

Step Two: A thing must enter into interaction to become capital.

The value of a banknote depends upon relations of purchasing power; the value of a machine depends upon relations of labor production; the value of gold depends upon global relations of credit and exchange. A thing becomes capital not because of its own material attributes, but because it has been drawn into a specific network of relations. A banknote that no one acknowledges, that circulates nowhere, is but a scrap of paper—no longer the capital-form called "money."

Step Three: Interaction is relation.

Relation is not a third kind of entity subsisting independently. It is not an abstraction

suspended above matter. Relation is precisely the mode of interaction among things themselves.

The derivation follows:

Capital is a thing → a thing must interact to become capital → the interaction of things is relation → capital is relation.

Now let us push this path, which sets out from "currency," to a far broader domain. If "thing" is not confined to currency, but extends to "all things"—sunlight, trees, soil, rocks—do interactions exist among them? Do these interactions constitute capital relations?

Let us examine each in turn:

Sunlight and the tree: Sunlight reaches the leaves, driving photosynthesis, converting light energy into chemical energy. Without sunlight, the tree cannot subsist. Sunlight is the condition of the tree's subsistence. This is sunlight's "capital" vis-à-vis the tree.

Tree and soil: The roots of the tree absorb water and minerals from the soil; fallen leaves and withered branches return to the soil, decaying into humus. The tree depends upon the soil for survival, and the soil depends upon the tree's return for the maintenance of its fertility. Each is the condition of the other's subsistence. This is the "capital" interaction between tree and soil.

The great tree and the small tree: The canopy of the great tree blocks the sunlight, and the small tree grows slowly in the shade—this is an interaction of the "exploitative" mode; but the great tree likewise affords shelter from wind and retains moisture, allowing the small tree to survive extreme weather—this too is a "capital" interaction. Both coexist.

The weathering of rock: Moisture in the air penetrates the crevices of rock, freezes, expands, and splits it apart; sunlight heats the rock's surface, and the diurnal temperature contrast causes exfoliation. The weathered rock releases minerals that enter the soil and become nutrients for plant growth. The "weathering" of rock is the

process by which the rock is transformed by its environment, yet the result of weathering is the formation of new soil capital.

All of these—sunlight and tree, tree and soil, great tree and small tree, the weathering of rock—are interactions among material entities. These interactions constitute the state-network through which all things subsist, develop, and undergo transformation. This network is all-things-as-capital.

Thus, the complete chain of argumentation proceeding from "the entities of all things," in no way dependent upon human society:

All things are things → all things necessarily interact → interaction is relation → interaction is the condition of the subsistence and development of all things → the relational network of the interaction of all things is all-things-as-capital.

3.8.4 The Confluence of the Two Paths

A comparison of the two paths:

	Path One (Marx's relation path)	Path Two (naive materialist thing path)
Starting point	Capital is social relation	Capital is material entity
Key turning point	Relation is the essence of all things	Things must interact to become capital
Terminus	Capital = relation = all things	All things = relation = capital
Direction	From essence to phenomenon	From phenomenon to essence

Path One sets out from "relation"; Path Two sets out from "thing." Yet they converge perfectly at the point of "interactive relation." To say "capital is a thing, and the interactive relation of things is capital" and to say "capital is not a thing, it is the sum total of all relations"—these two statements are in essence not different. They are

descriptions of the same reality at different cognitive levels.

The logical force of multiple convergence: When multiple independent paths converge upon the same conclusion, the reliability of that conclusion is markedly enhanced. Even if the premise of one path is called into question, the other paths may still sustain the conclusion independently. This structure of "multiple convergence" is an important mark of a scientific hypothesis maturing into an established theory.

This is precisely where the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital delivers its decisive blow against the Western narrow theory of capital: the Western narrow theory attempts to define the whole of capital through the single "thing" of currency, unaware that it has all along been turning in circles upon an extremely constricted tributary of the vast network of all-things-as-capital. The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is not "another theory of capital," but the subsumption of the narrow theory as a subset (the money-capital form) within its own horizon, thereby completing its cognitive encirclement.

3.8.5 The Dialectical Consummation Through the Negation of the Negation

Confluence is but the first step. To fuse the two paths into an organic whole, we must invoke the most profound law of dialectics—the negation of the negation.

(1) The Basic Structure of the Negation of the Negation

In *Anti-Dühring*, Engels characterizes the negation of the negation as the fundamental law of dialectical movement: the development of a thing passes through the three stages of affirmation, negation, and negation of the negation; the third stage "appears as a return to the old" at a higher level, but in substance acquires entirely new determinations. The seed is negated by the plant, the plant is negated by new seeds—the new seed does not return to the original seed, but carries within itself the accumulated information of the entire growing season.

This law applies equally to the dialectical movement of concepts.

(2) Thesis: Capital Is a Thing (the Stage of Affirmation)

This is the view shared by classical economics and everyday experience alike. Adam Smith defined capital as "the stock of wealth employed for reproduction"—workshops, machinery, money, raw materials. These are entities that are visible, tangible, measurable, and capable of being possessed. When the ordinary person says "I have capital," they mean "I have money, property, resources."

At this stage, "capital" and "thing" are directly equated. The attribute of capital is understood as a natural attribute of the thing, just as weight is a natural attribute of a body. This is the thesis of cognition—naïve, direct, unreflective, yet also the point of departure and the raw material of the entire subsequent dialectical movement.

(3) Antithesis: Capital Is Not a Thing (the Stage of Negation)

Marx's critique constitutes the first negation. He points out: money in itself is not capital; machinery in itself is not capital. They become capital only within specific social relations—when money is employed to purchase labor-power for the extraction of surplus value, when machinery is employed to command living labor. The "capital attribute" of a thing is not a natural attribute of the thing, but the projection of social relations upon the thing.

Hence Marx declares with decisive finality: capital is not a thing, but a definite production relation belonging to a definite historical social formation. [1]

This is the negation of the thesis. It tears away the veil of the "thing," exposing the relations of domination between human beings concealed behind it. It drags capital out of the illusion of "natural eternity" and restores it as a "historically transient" social construction. This is the antithesis of cognition—profound, incisive, possessing formidable critical power, yet also harboring an unarticulated tension: if capital is not a thing, then why does it always present itself in the form of things? Are banknotes, gold, and factory buildings then illusions?

(4) Synthesis: Capital Is Both Thing and Relation [29] (the Negation of the

Negation)

The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital supplies the second negation—the negation of Marx's negation—thereby completing the entire dialectical cycle of the negation of the negation.

The logic of this synthesis is as follows:

First step (absorption of the thesis): Marx was right that capital is not an "independently self-subsisting thing," yet capital indeed possesses an ineliminable materiality. The banknote is paper—cellulose; the machine is steel, the product of smelted ore; the gold is an aggregation of atoms of element 79 on the periodic table. To negate the materiality of capital would be to fall into the opposite extreme of idealism—as if capital were a pure relation suspended in a vacuum, requiring no material bearer whatsoever. This would not be materialism.

Second step (penetration of the antithesis): But Marx's negation is irreversible. The central truth he disclosed—that the attribute of capital lies in relation rather than in entity—must be preserved. A banknote upon a desert island is not capital; a machine with no one to operate it is but scrap iron. The capital attribute of a thing is indeed realized within relations.

Third step (the ascent of synthesis): Uniting the materiality of the thesis with the relationality of the antithesis, we obtain:

Capital is both thing and relation. The thing is the bearer of capital; the relation is the mode of capital's realization. The two are inseparable; together they constitute the complete existence of capital.

In more refined language:

Capital is thing—every banknote, every ingot of gold, every forest, every body is the material form of capital.

Capital is not thing—it is the interactive relation that renders a thing capital.

Capital is both thing and relation—they achieve unity in the dialectical movement of

the negation of the negation.

This is the dialectical consummation of the negation of the negation. It is not a simple return to the thesis ("capital is just a thing"), but the reconstruction of the completeness of the concept of capital at a higher level, having absorbed all the critical achievements of the antithesis. Just as the new seed does not return to the original seed, but carries within itself the information of the entire dialectical movement.

(5) The Dialectical Reading of "You Are Not a Thing; You Are Relation"

With the framework of the negation of the negation at hand, we may understand more deeply that paradoxical aphorism: "You are not a thing; you are relation."

At the level of the thesis, you are a thing—you are a material existence possessing mass, occupying space, composed of atoms. Your body is a tangible, perceptible thing.

At the level of the antithesis, you are not a thing—your essence is not that heap of atoms. Your self-consciousness, your social identity, the meaning of your existence—all are constituted by your relations with others (other persons, nature, society, yourself). Marx was right: the essence of man is the ensemble of all social relations.

At the level of the synthesis, you are both thing and relation—your material body (thesis) and all your relations (antithesis) are not two separate parts, but two modes of describing one and the same existence. Your body is not a shell "bearing" relations from without; your body is itself the condensation of relations: it is the relational product of parental genes, the energy transformation of the food chain, the result of social labor's nurture, the page upon which cultural symbols are inscribed.

Thus the final complete proposition runs:

You are not a thing; you are relation—yet the very reason you can be relation is that you are at the same time a thing. Matter is the "substance" that bears; relation is the

"function" that realizes; substance and function are not two.

This same conclusion holds for all things. A stone is not an isolated thing (thesis); it is the product of geological movement, the medium of weathering, and a constituent of the ecosystem (antithesis)—it is thing and relation at once, unified in the negation of the negation.

3.8.6 The "Reification" of Relation and the "Relationalization" of Things: The Ultimate Closure

The negation of the negation has consummated the dialectical unity of "capital as both thing and relation." Yet a deeper inquiry remains: between thing and relation, does a final ascription exist? Does relation belong to thing?

The answer is: relation is precisely the internal structure of the thing itself.

The thing does not exist prior to relation and then "enter into" relation as an independent entity. At every ontological level, the thing is a structured condensation of relations. The atom is a stable configuration of the strong nuclear force and the electromagnetic force; the molecule is an equilibrium of covalent bonds and intermolecular forces; the cell is a spatiotemporal station of a metabolic relational network; the human body is the simultaneous manifestation of the synergistic relations among all internal organs and the exchange relations with the external environment.

This is not to say that the thing "possesses" relations, but that the thing "is" the temporary crystallization of relations. Just as the fossil is not the residue of an ancient organism, but the petrified result of the organism's interaction with its environment—the thing is a fossil of relations, a trace-structure left by the activity of relations in spacetime.

In this manner, the binary opposition between relation and thing is utterly dissolved. Relation is the "internal social form" of the thing; the thing is the "external appearance" of relation. The two are not two distinct existences, but two descriptive

dimensions of one and the same existence.

Translated to the social domain: the institutions, laws, culture, and language of a society are not attributes that this society "possesses," but the internal relational structure of society itself as a "thing." Capital, as a specific social relation, is the internal organizing mode of that "thing" called civilization.

Thus the complete dialectical proposition is:

Capital is relation (Marx); relation is the internal structure of the thing (this section); therefore capital is the internal social form of the thing.

The thing is the result, the state, the appearance of relation (this section); relation is the condition of the subsistence of all things (the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital); therefore all things are both thing and relation.

From "capital is a thing" (thesis) to "capital is not a thing" (antithesis), to "capital is both thing and relation" (synthesis), to "relation is the internal structure of the thing, the thing is the external appearance of relation"—after the negation of the negation, dialectics continues its advance, and what it finally arrives at is the thoroughgoing identity of thing and relation.

3.8.7 The Ultimate Definition: Capital as the Totality of Things and Relations

Herewith, the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital arrives at its ultimate definition:

Capital is the totality of things and relations.

"Totality" is not the simple addition of two heterogeneous things, but the complete description of one existence with two aspects in one body. "Thing" is the substance, "relation" is the function; substance and function are not two. The thing is the bearer of capital; the relation is the realization of capital—the two are inseparable, jointly constituting the entire existence of capital.

In more condensed language:

The thing is the result, the state, the appearance of relation.

Relation is the internal structure, the internal social form of the thing.

Capital is the totality of the two—this is the ultimate definition of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital.

This ultimate definition is the distillation of the entire argumentation:

Path One (departing from relation): capital = relation = all things.

Path Two (departing from thing): capital = thing = relation = all things.

Negation of the negation: capital is both thing and relation.

Ultimate closure: thing is relation, relation is thing, capital is the totality of the two.

Thus, this appendix completes the entire ontological argumentation—from quantum field theory to Marxism, from the "relation" path to the "thing" path, from thesis and antithesis to synthesis, from dual unity to monistic totality. Below is the closure check of the complete logical chain of this argumentation:

First link (methodological foundation): The general/specific Meta-Theory $\rightarrow$ every concept possesses the dual attributes of broad and narrow $\rightarrow$ "all things" is the sole absolute broad $\rightarrow$ the law of broad determination.

Second link (meta-theoretical substitution): Narrow capital (Western) $\subseteq$ relatively broad capital (Chinese everyday usage) $\subseteq$ absolutely broad capital (all-things-as-capital).

Third link (ontological foundation): Quantum field theory $\rightarrow$ no isolated entity exists in the universe $\rightarrow$ the establishment of "relational ontology": existence = relation.

Fourth link (extension of Marx's proposition): Capital is not a thing, but a social relation $\rightarrow$ conjoined with relational ontology $\rightarrow$ capital = relation = all things.

Fifth link (independent proof of Path Two): Capital is a thing $\rightarrow$ things necessarily interact $\rightarrow$ interaction is relation $\rightarrow$ capital is relation $\rightarrow$ capital = thing = relation = all things.

Sixth link (negation of the negation): Thesis (capital is a thing) $\rightarrow$ antithesis (capital is

not a thing, but relation) → synthesis (capital is both thing and relation) → relation is the internal structure of the thing, the thing is the external appearance of relation → the thoroughgoing identity of thing and relation.

Seventh link (the compulsion of materialism): Humanity $\in$ biology $\in$ matter $\in$ all things → human capital $\subseteq$ all-things-as-capital, human social relations $\subseteq$ the social relations of all things. To deny this is to deny materialism.

Eighth link (the injection of the Theory of Contradiction): Contradiction is the internal tension of relation → capital interaction is the unfolding of contradiction → contradiction drives the qualitative transformation of capital → the dialectical unity of universality and particularity lays the foundation for the transcendent mission of civilization.

Ninth link (the legitimacy of Chinese discourse): The everyday usage of the Chinese term "资本" naturally encompasses all resources and capacities—health, ecology, credibility, and so forth → the ontological pre-consciousness of popular wisdom.

Tenth link (practical orientation): Capital is the totality of things and relations → the core of capital activity is not the possession of things, but the optimization of relations → Contributionism as the necessary practical conclusion.

Final conclusion: Ten links interlock; the denial of any one link would undermine the preceding links or contradict the consensus of science. The argumentative structure is rigorous and self-consistent; the ontological argumentation is completely closed.

A Note on the Method of Explanation

Throughout this entire work, "relation" has been employed to explain everything—the origin of contradiction, the essence of power, the criterion of good and evil, the termination of struggle—without exception.

This is not because "thing" is unimportant. It is because: the thing is the appearance of relation, not the starting point of explanation.

A person stands there; what you see is a "thing"—their body, countenance, attire. But

you do not see the internal structure that makes them who they are: how their cells cooperate, how their consciousness emerges, how their social relations have shaped them. The "thing" you see is merely the result of the totality of relations. If you wish to explain "why they are as they now are," you must return to "relation"—to their genes, their family, their education, their social network. Looking only at the "thing," you can explain nothing.

Quantum field theory has already demonstrated: the thing is the structured condensation of relations. Marx likewise demonstrated: capital becomes capital only because it is situated within a specific network of production relations. Severed from relation, the thing regresses to a mere "thing," and is no longer capital.

Therefore, the order of explaining the world can only be: relation → thing, and not thing → relation. Relation is the ground, the structure, the principle. When relation is explained clearly, the thing returns of itself at the terminus—it is no longer an isolated "object," but an "existence" whose position has been understood.

This is why this work explains the world through relation. It is not that we have neglected the thing; it is that we have restored to the thing its true origin—restored it to its relational network.

4. The Profound Intervalvalidation of the Doctrine of Contradiction and the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital

Chapter Three secured the ontological groundwork for the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. From quantum field theory to the Marxian thesis, from the path of "relation" to the path of "thing," from the negation of the negation to the ultimate closure, we have established that capital is the totality of things and relations, and that all things are capital. Yet a comprehensive worldview must address not merely the question of "what is," but also of "why"—why do all things interact? Toward what end do their interactions tend? What primordial impulse drives evolutionary becoming? This chapter takes Mao Zedong's *On Contradiction* as its

dynamic cornerstone, superimposes upon it the cosmological constraint of the second law of thermodynamics, and thereby completes the unification of ontology with dynamics.

4.1 Contradiction as the Internal Tension of Relation

Mao declares at the very outset of *On Contradiction*: "The universality or absoluteness of contradiction... means, first, that contradiction exists in the process of development of all things; and, second, that in the process of development of each thing, contradictory movement exists from beginning to end." [17] Contradiction is omnipresent and perennial.

Yet contradiction is no abstract category adrift in the void. Where lies its material substrate? Relational ontology answers: contradiction is the intrinsic tension of relation.

Relation is not a static nexus but a dynamic stress. The subsistence of any relation demands the dynamic equilibrium of its antithetical poles. Take the stone as an illustration:

The internal contradiction of the stone: the electromagnetic attraction between positive and negative charges—which upholds the relation—stands in opposition to the vibrational repulsion engendered by the thermal agitation of atomic nuclei, which disrupts it.

The relational character of this contradiction: attraction and repulsion cannot subsist independently. Without repulsion, attraction would collapse the atom into itself; without attraction, repulsion would scatter the stone into dust. The "hardness" of the stone is precisely the expression of this contradiction's dynamic equilibrium.

Translate this logic back to Marx's "capital":

The internal contradiction of capital: capital as "relation" requires for its perpetuation both the expenditure of living labor and the possession of the means of production as

dead labor. These two poles presuppose one another within the same production relation.

The relational character of this contradiction: without laborers, capital cannot augment itself; without capital, laborers cannot sustain their existence. Yet this mutual presupposition is no harmony—it is an inner antagonism.

4.2 The Dialectics of Entropy: The Thermodynamic Substrate of All-Things Interaction

The doctrine of contradiction discloses the internal tensions of all-things interaction, but this concept alone cannot answer a question still more fundamental: toward what end does contradiction impel things? What is the criterion of systemic evolution?

The second law of thermodynamics furnishes an answer at cosmic scale: in any isolated system, entropy—the measure of disorder—tends to increase over time. Energy passes from concentration to dispersion, from order to disorder; this is the "arrow of time" described by physics. Under this inexorable decree, every system that maintains or constructs ordered structures must ceaselessly draw energy from its surroundings and expel entropy, thereby accomplishing a local reversal of entropic increase—negentropy. [19] Here resides the essence of life, and the precondition for the continuance of every self-organizing system, from the cell to civilization. [20]

From this, we may erect a bridge leading directly from physics to ethics:

The physical essence of exploitation and oppression consists in a dominant system's systematic transfer of the entropic costs generated by its own operation—decay, disorder, pollution, waste—onto weaker systems or the external environment, in order to preserve its own low-entropy state. [21] The capitalist's displacement of ecological devastation and labor exhaustion onto nature and the worker is precisely the socialized expression of this principle. The colonizer's relegation of resource depletion and social chaos to the colonized territories is the same principle unfolded

upon a macroscopic scale. This is no metaphor; it is an exact entry in the thermodynamic ledger.

The physical essence of contribution resides in a system's willing assumption of entropic cost—work, expenditure, self-constraint—so as to maintain or elevate the overall low-entropy order of a more embracing system. A tree absorbs luminous energy, fixes carbon, releases oxygen, transmutes solar radiance into biomass, and bestows negentropy upon the surrounding ecosystem: it contributes. A creator of knowledge marshals information and transmits wisdom, enhancing the cognitive order of society: he contributes. A policy-maker who voluntarily curbs short-term gains to safeguard intergenerational justice and ecological equilibrium also contributes.

Good and evil thereby acquire scientific definition:

Evil = entropic externalization: the establishment of one's own order upon the disorder of others.

Good = local negentropy: the deliberate acceptance of entropic cost in exchange for the preservation or elevation of a more encompassing order.

It must be emphasized that this "good" is not a proclivity of moral sentiment but a rational cosmic choice. In a universe governed by thermodynamic law, any system that persistently adopts the strategy of entropic externalization will finally exhaust the external resources available for appropriation—the nature that has been exploited, the trust that has been depleted, the collaborative networks that have been disintegrated—and so surrender itself to total collapse. Conversely, a system that elects the strategy of local negentropy is the more likely to survive across the long arc of evolution. Morality thus acquires the hardness of physics. It is no longer the soft exhortation of "what one ought to do," but the iron imperative: "negate entropy, or perish."

The singularity of civilization lies in this: it is the sole form of existence capable of making this choice with consciousness. The choices of all other things are blind—genetic mutation, natural selection—but the choices of civilization may be

deliberate: institutional design, ethical reflection. Here precisely does the Contributionist practical orientation of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital secure its thermodynamic foundation.

4.3 Capital Interaction: The Material Bearer of Contradiction

The general law of "broad exploitation—oppression" operative among all-things-as-capital is precisely the material manifestation and dynamic origin of the universality of contradiction.

First, all things are capital, and capital cannot but interact. Every particular capital, in order to sustain its own existence—to resist entropy—must exchange energy, resources, and information with its milieu. A star must interact through gravitation and nuclear fusion; a cell must exchange matter with its environment; an enterprise must engage with markets, employees, and the state. There is no capital in isolation; there are only capitals enmeshed within relational networks.

Second, interaction is contradiction. Capitals differ ineluctably in endowment (intrinsic capacity) and in position (relational attribute); their interaction must therefore manifest competition, counterpoise, consumption, and appropriation. A star and its planets are a contest between gravitational capital and orbital kinetic energy; a predator and its prey are a contest between corporeal capital and survival capital; a capitalist and a worker are a contest between financial capital and labor capital. Contradiction is rooted in the "asymmetry" inherent in all capital interaction.

Third, there is a unified dynamic web. From the interplay of subatomic particles to the rise and fall of civilizations, all are disclosures of this law at different scales.

4.4 Universality and Particularity: Civilization's Transcendence of the Cosmic Law

The foregoing argument may provoke a reasonable doubt: if "exploitation and

oppression" are taken as universal laws of all things, does it follow that exploitation within human society is thereby rendered legitimate? The answer is precisely the reverse. To clarify this, we must invoke another central dimension of the doctrine of contradiction—the dialectical relation between universality and particularity.

Mao emphasizes in *On Contradiction* that to comprehend a thing, one must grasp not only the universality of contradiction but also its particularity. "The particular essence of each form of motion of matter is determined by its own particular contradiction." [25] Civilization, as a distinctive form of material motion, possesses its own particular contradiction:

All things—inanimate matter and the biological realm—are subject to the universal law of "broad exploitation." A star exploits the kinetic energy of its planets; a predator exploits the life of its prey. These interactions are purely dynamical facts, neither good nor evil. They follow natural law, without consciousness to discern suffering, without morality to reflect upon themselves. This is the "universality" of the cosmos.

Civilization is otherwise. Civilization is a form of organization constituted by conscious, intelligent beings. Consciousness bestows two capacities that no other thing possesses: the capacity to feel suffering—civilization not only perceives its own suffering at being exploited, but can also perceive the suffering of other forms of life under exploitation, which is the biological and psychological foundation of empathy [24]—and the capacity for moral reflection, whereby civilization can transmute "suffering" into moral judgment and internalize the experience of "being exploited" into a conscious resistance to the very act of exploitation.

Therefore, the particularity of civilization does not lie in whether it stands outside the universal law of all-things capital interaction—for it remains always within it. The particularity of civilization lies rather in this: it is the only form of existence capable of apprehending the painful essence of that law, and capable of morally transcending it.

The material foundation of civilization's capacity to transcend the law of all things

resides precisely here. It is not merely a being that can feel pain and reflect morally; it is a being that can translate moral reflection into institutional negentropy. A tree can only passively fix carbon and release oxygen; a civilization can deliberately devise social institutions that externalize no entropy. The negentropy of all things is instinct-driven; the negentropy of civilization is consciously chosen. It is upon this material foundation that we may further ask: does the acknowledgment that exploitation prevails universally among all things confer legitimacy upon exploitation within human society?

This is precisely the thermodynamic verdict disclosed in section 4.2: good and evil are no longer soft value preferences but hard criteria of survival. The ultimate application at the scale of civilization is this: whether a civilization chooses to assimilate internally the entropic costs it generates, rather than displacing them onto nature and the weak, determines its balance in the thermodynamic ledger, and hence its survival or extinction across the long arc of evolution.

This leads to a conclusion of decisive weight: precisely because we acknowledge the universal prevalence of exploitation among all things, our critique of exploitation and oppression within human civilization—and of civilization's exploitation of nature—becomes more radical, not less.

The limitation of the old critique lay in this: it perceived only the exploitation of person by person, yet failed to perceive the profound structural collusion between that exploitation and civilization's exploitation of nature. The critique of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital reveals that the limitless augmentation of capital exploits not only the worker, but systematically exploits the entirety of natural capital, placing every life along the ecological chain within an asymmetrical architecture of predation. This is not the dissolution of the Marxist critique, but the radical expansion of its radius. From the critique of the capitalist, we advance to the critique of anthropocentric civilization itself.

Thus the sublime vocation of civilization is made manifest: its particularity lies not in

inheriting the universal law of all-things interaction—for that inheritance merits no pride, since all things share it. Its particularity lies in transcending that universality. Exploitation must inevitably exist among all things, but civilization possesses the capacity to choose an existence no longer premised upon exploitation; the interactions of all things are necessarily oppressive, but civilization possesses the capacity to forge collaborative relations bound by contribution. This is the philosophical foundation of Contributionism—not a denial of universality, but a conscious transcendence of it.

All things are shackled within universality; civilization is the key forged to break that lock. This thought reverberates profoundly in the Chinese philosophical tradition. Laozi's saying, "Man models himself upon Earth, Earth upon Heaven, Heaven upon the Dao, and the Dao upon that which is spontaneously so," is precisely a classical expression of this cosmological predicament of "all things shackled within universality." [6] This is the deepest ethical commitment of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, and the ultimate source of its critical edge.

Seen in this light, the Marxist proposition of emancipation attains a thoroughgoing elevation of dimension. The traditional Marxist mission lay in liberating the productive forces, breaking the capitalist relations of production that fetter them, and further, in liberating the oppressed classes so as to end the exploitation of person by person. The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital pushes this logic to its extreme: the liberation of the productive forces aims at the ultimate liberation of nature itself, which has been exploited by those very forces; the liberation of the oppressed classes aims at the ultimate liberation of all life and existence oppressed by civilization. From the liberation of the proletariat to the liberation of humanity to the liberation of all things—this is no deflection of the proposition, but the implementation and consummation of one and the same logic of liberation upon an ampler scale.

The transcendent mission of civilization, in the Chinese intellectual tradition, is called "participating in and assisting the transformative processes of Heaven and Earth." This is not an alternative, but the same mission given utterance in a different cultural idiom.

4.5 The Transformation of Contradiction and the Evolution of Capital

The intensification and resolution of contradictions drive the succession of capital forms. When contradictions internal to an old capital paradigm—such as the limitless augmentation of financial capital against the finitude of natural capital—intensify beyond the point of reconciliation, contradiction impels the system toward a "paradigm revolution." The old capital form is sublated; a new form assumes hegemony. This is precisely what Mao meant when he wrote: "The opposing sides in a contradiction both unite and struggle, thereby impelling the movement and change of all things." [23]

From the transmutation of stone into soil, from the leap of feudalism into capital, from industrial civilization into ecological civilization—every transition is a dialectical movement of contradiction gathering, sharpening, converting, and leaping. The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital extends this dialectic from the socio-historical domain across every level of being, thereby consummating the unification of the dialectical-materialist worldview.

5. The A Priori Generality of the Chinese "Capital": The Return of Popular Wisdom

5.1 Etymological Excavation: Zi and Ben

Why is the Chinese "capital" endowed with an a priori generality? The answer lies hidden in the structure of the characters and in the everyday speech of the people.

"资" (zī): composed of "贝" (shell-wealth, currency) and connected with "咨" (to consult, to rely upon). The *Shuowen Jiezi* [26] defines "资" as "goods," yet in a more archaic stratum of usage, "资" carries the sense of "to rely upon," "to make use of." The *Xici Zhuan* of the *Zhou Changes* states: "What one relies upon for life—this is

called the Dao." [27]

"本" (běn): composed of "木" (tree) with a horizontal stroke beneath, indicating the root. The Shuowen Jiezi explains: "That which lies beneath the tree is called ben." By extension, it signifies "foundation," "source," "root."

Combined, "资本" means: foundational reliance, fundamental resource. This is a notion at once supremely plain and profoundly deep: whatever you rely upon to live, to develop, to accomplish your ends—that is your capital.

5.2 Living Evidence in Popular Speech

Language is the living fossil of thought. Within the everyday idiom of ordinary people, the purest and most authentic conception of "capital" is preserved:

"The body is the capital of revolution"—bodily capital. "Connections are capital"—social capital. "Ecology is our green capital"—natural capital. "Creditworthiness is the merchant's foremost capital"—trust capital. "Time is the most equitable capital"—temporal capital. "Knowledge is capital"—knowledge capital.

In all these usages, "capital" naturally encompasses body, mind, society, nature, culture, and institutions—it is, from the very outset, "all-things-as-capital." This is no invention of scholars, but a plain truth sedimented from the survival practices of millions upon millions of people over millennia.

5.3 The Thinking Operating System: How Chinese "Capital" Circumvents Disciplinary Regimentation

Western capital theory was born within the narrow precincts of market exchange. From Aristotle's analysis of chrematistics, through Adam Smith's definition of capital as the stock of wealth employed in reproduction, to the neoclassical reduction of capital to a "factor of production," its conceptual structure has always been anchored in three presuppositions: monetary measurability, exclusive possession, and the

imperative of self-augmentation. This framework is supremely effective in explaining commodity exchange, yet when confronted with relational existences that cannot be priced—ecological carrying capacity, intergenerational equity, emotional sustenance—it falls into conceptual aphasia. This is not because Western thinkers have lacked acumen, but because the "grammar" of their conceptual language excluded such phenomena from the moment of its inception.

The everyday Chinese usage of "capital" is wholly different. "The body is the capital of revolution," "Connections are capital," "Creditworthiness is the foremost capital," "Ecology is our green capital"—these expressions are not academic formulations, but the sedimentary residue of survival wisdom accumulated over millennia of agrarian civilization. Within this "vernacular grammar," capital naturally embraces health, trust, ecology, time, knowledge—indeed, every "reliance for survival and development." It has never been constricted into a "monetary magnitude" by disciplinary training, because it has always been rooted in the sheer fact of being alive.

This leads to a truth of profound depth: the Chinese language, as an operating system of thought, has maintained, with respect to "capital," an unbroken correspondence with the thermodynamic logic of survival. The territories that Western capital theory could approach only with repeated paradigm repairs—the human-capital revolution, the social-capital revolution, the accounting of natural capital—were already traversed, spontaneously and naturally, in the daily locutions of the Chinese people. The task of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is therefore not to translate the Western "capital" into the Chinese "资本," but to elevate the generality already latent in the Chinese term from empirical intuition to theoretical self-consciousness.

This is not cultural essentialism—as if the Chinese language were inherently superior to others—but a historical-structural fact: the Western concept of capital was incubated in urban commerce and mathematical rationality, whereas the Chinese concept of capital was engendered within agrarian subsistence and ecological sensibility. Their scopes of application differ. The former excels at quantifiable exchange; the latter at the unquantifiable foundations of survival. What the Theory of

All-Things-as-Capital accomplishes, taking Chinese popular wisdom as its point of departure, is the construction of a unified framework capable of accommodating both scopes at once—thereby achieving, at the level of concept, an effective inclusion, rather than a futile confrontation, of the Western narrow concept of capital.

6. A Critical Diagnosis of the Western Concept of Capital

6.1 Three Dogmas

The Western concept of capital rests upon three profound dogmas:

Dogma One: the dogma of quantifiability. Capital must be measurable in money. This excludes health, emotion, trust, and ecology—phenomena that possess value but cannot be priced. Yet popular wisdom teaches us that what defines capital is not "the quantifiable," but "that upon which one can rely."

Dogma Two: the dogma of exclusivity. Capital must be possessed exclusively—if you have it, I do not. Yet the value of knowledge multiplies through sharing, and the value of ecology is realized through common stewardship. What defines capital is not "excludability," but "availability as a ground of reliance."

Dogma Three: the dogma of coercive augmentation. Capital must augment itself and make profit its end. Yet the health capital of the body aims at maintenance, and the stability capital of an ecosystem aims at equilibrium. What defines capital is not "augmentation," but "maintenance and development."

6.2 Western Capital as an Historical Form of

All-Things-as-Capital

The Western concept of capital is not erroneous; it is insufficiently thoroughgoing. It correctly grasped the dominant form of capital in the epoch of highly developed commodity exchange—money capital—but mistook this historical form for the

universal essence of capital.

Just as Newtonian mechanics is correct at low velocities and macroscopic scales yet is revealed by relativity to be an approximation, the Western concept of capital is correct under the conditions of commodity exchange yet is revealed by the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital to be a particular form—a subset.

The historical path of expansion: monetary capital → human capital → social capital → natural capital → cultural capital → emotional capital → capital of meaning... At the end of this path stands all-things-as-capital.

7. The Categorical System and Dynamics of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital

7.1 The Core Proposition: Existence Is Capital

Existence is capital—this is no metaphor, but an ontological description of the state of existing. The essence of existence consists in three things: possessing capacities, being situated in relations, and being capable of interaction. These three are precisely the fundamental connotations of "capital."

7.2 The Taxonomy of Capital

Dimension	Capital Form	Substrate	Manifestation
Natural Capital	Physical capital	Elementary particles, celestial bodies	Mass, energy, spacetime, fundamental forces
	Chemical capital	Atoms, molecules	Chemical bonds, reactivity
	Biological capital	Cells, organisms	Genes, metabolism, immunity

	Ecological capital	Populations, ecosystems	Biodiversity, climate regulation
Individual Capital	Bodily capital	The human body	Health, strength, sensory faculties
	Mental capital	The human brain	Knowledge, skills, creativity
	Emotional capital	Psychic structure	Emotional regulation, empathy, resilience
Social Capital	Trust capital	Social relations	Degree of trust
	Cooperative capital	Collectives	Efficiency of collaboration
	Network capital	Social networks	Breadth and density of connections
Institutional Capital	Legal capital	Legal system	Completeness, impartiality, enforceability
	Political capital	Political system	Stability, governing capacity
	Economic capital	Market system	Currency, property rights, market mechanisms
Cultural Capital	Symbolic capital	Language, writing	Systems of expression
	Value capital	Values	Meaning, belief
	Knowledge capital	Body of knowledge	Scientific and technological accumulation
Financial Capital	Monetary capital	Currency	Circulation, store of value

	Credit capital	Credit	Bonds, loans
	Equity capital	Shares	Ownership rights

7.3 Three Dynamical Laws

The Law of Universal Interaction: Every form of capital is invariably situated in interaction with other forms of capital.

The Law of Contradiction as Motive Force: Differences in endowment and position give rise to contradiction, which is the fundamental motive force of evolution.

The Law of Tendency toward Equilibrium: Capital systems tend toward configurations of greater stability and more effective allocation.

8. The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital and the Construction of a Chinese Autonomous Theoretical System

An autonomous Chinese system of philosophy and social science must satisfy three conditions: rootedness in Chinese experience, universal explanatory power, and the formation of a self-consistent logical architecture. The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital offers precisely such a candidate meta-paradigm. Its contribution to autonomy unfolds on four planes:

First, conceptual autonomy. The Chinese "资本" grows organically from the native soil of the Chinese language and the life-world of the masses; it is not a translation of the Western "capital." Through the general/specific Meta-Theory, it demonstrates that Western capital is but a subset of the broader Chinese conception. It does not negate the West; it encompasses the West.

Second, methodological autonomy. The general/specific Meta-Theory dissolves binary oppositions and furnishes an instrument of cognition capable of nested

hierarchy and dynamic transformation. It is rooted in the relativistic wisdom of Zhuangzi's "equalization of things" and in the doctrine of the universality of contradiction in Mao's *On Contradiction*, and resonates profoundly with ancient Chinese philosophy. Wang Fuzhi's observation that "yin and yang are contained within the Great Void; their mutual conjunction and agitation ... constitute the formation of all things" [28] is precisely an elementary expression of the generation of all things through relational interaction. At the same time, it enters into equal dialogue with Western philosophy—Spinoza, Hegel, Kuhn, Whitehead—which is the mark of methodological self-consciousness. [29]

Third, autonomy of explanatory power. The theory is able to explain simultaneously the gravitational interactions of the physical universe, the predation and symbiosis of the biological realm, the exploitation and contribution of human society, and the rise and fall of civilizations—thereby becoming a unified language for all sciences of existence.

Fourth, autonomy of value orientation. It anchors value in the sustainable flourishing of the systemic whole, thereby supplying a philosophical foundation for the critique of the boundless augmentation of financial capital and for the advocacy of high-quality development and ecological civilization.

The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital addresses the common questions of humanity: What constitutes genuine "development"? How should "value" be measured? What ought to be the relation between humanity and nature? This is not "the East against the West," but a dialogue in which "the broad encompasses the narrow." Just as relativity does not negate Newtonian mechanics but offers a more precise approximation, the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital does not negate the Western concept of capital so much as expose its incapacities in the face of ecological crisis and provide a more comprehensive framework. This is not a clash of civilizations; it is an elevation of cognition.

9. Conclusion: From Capital to Contribution—A New Paradigm

of Civilization

The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital points ultimately toward practice. Section 3.8 has already established that capital is the totality of things and relations. If the core of capital activity lies in the optimization of relations rather than the possession of things, then the goal that society ought to pursue is not the "boundless augmentation of capital"—the accumulation of things—but the "sustainable flourishing of capital"—the harmonization and optimization of relations. This is precisely the philosophical ground of Contributionism: the operation of society should be governed by the causal law of contribution. To contribute is to accept willingly the entropic cost—work, expenditure, self-restraint—in order to maintain or elevate the overall ordered state of a more encompassing relational network. The status and resource allocation of an individual are determined by the contribution rendered to the total capital of civilization—understood as "the totality of things and relations"—not by the exclusive possession of private capital.

When we survey the present through the law of broad determination, we discern the deepest root of the current global crisis: the obsolete narrow cognitive framework has fallen into a fatal disjunction with the new broad reality. The defining feature of the old civilizational paradigm is a growthism driven by the unlimited accumulation and augmentation of financial capital. Within that framework, "value" is narrowly equated with wealth measurable in monetary terms, "development" narrowly equated with the growth of GDP, and "capital" narrowly confined to money and means of production oriented toward self-augmentation. [21] This narrow framework once propelled the development of productive forces to a remarkable degree in the industrial age. But when humanity entered the twenty-first century of universal interconnection and intensifying ecological constraints, the "vessel" of this cognitive framework has become gravely inadequate.

Therefore, the fundamental way out of the crisis lies not in ever more ingenious policy adjustments within the old paradigm, but in launching a conscious and radical

elevation of cognition. We must have the courage to break open the prison-house of the old narrow concepts and leap into a new cognitive framework that approaches the absolute breadth of "all things," within which we may re-examine capital, value, civilization, and the very meaning of human existence. This, precisely, is the historical vocation of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital and of Contributionism. They are not yet another proposal offered inside the old vessel; they are committed to supplying a new and more capacious cognitive vessel itself.

The mission of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is not confined to interpreting the world; it is dedicated to illuminating a path that already exists in practice. This recalls the words of Marx: "The philosophers have only interpreted the world in various ways; [15] the point, however, is to change it." The precondition for changing the world is to see the world as it truly is: to see that capital is not a thing but a relation; to see that all things are implicated in relations; to see that the specificity of civilization resides precisely in its capacity to transcend the blind operation of these relations and to consciously install "contribution" as the causal law of its own functioning. What the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital accomplishes is not the invention of a new world, but the rendering of a world—already present in practice—visible, utterable, and transmissible.

At this juncture, a fundamental clarification is necessary: the legitimacy of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital does not rest upon the force of its own argumentation. It is not an "invention" but a "recognition." The universe governed by thermodynamic law has, over billions of years of evolution, repeatedly performed the law of survival that "contribution precedes appropriation." From symbiotic microbial communities sustaining one another's low-entropy states through metabolic exchange, to photosynthetic organisms transmuting solar energy into the ordered foundation of the earth's biosphere; from the symbolic networks constructed through linguistic cooperation, to the civilizational ladder accumulated by the transmission of knowledge—the operation of these phenomena has never depended upon acknowledgment by any human theory. The sole contribution of this theory is to

translate, into scholarly language, a code that nature has already inscribed. Therefore, to accept or reject this theory does not alter the law by which the world operates; what changes is whether we can consciously conform to that law, and thereby turn from the blind drift of entropy increase toward a deliberate voyage of negentropy. At the end of theory lies awe before existence; at the end of argument begins action.

A Further Clarification: On the Usage and Replaceability of the Word "Capital"

It must be particularly noted that the core proposition of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital—whether the early formulation "capital = relation = all things" or the final definition "capital is the totality of things and relations"—is in its essence not a dispute over the definition of the word "capital," but the disclosure of a relationship of hierarchical containment.

If the word "capital" strikes you as discordant because of its historical baggage, you are entirely free to substitute another term:

"Capacity" (shílì)—all things possess their own state of capacity, from the gravitational grip of a star to the influence of knowledge.

"Viability-endowment" (cúnxù píngjù)—the fundamental reliance through which all things sustain their own existence.

"Relational potential" (guānlián shènéng)—the positional potential that all things occupy within a relational network.

The word chosen is immaterial. What matters is the hierarchical logic: the "broad" naturally, logically, and necessarily contains the "narrow." The "monetary capital" defined by Western economics is indeed but a minuscule subset of the "bodily capital" and "relational capital" of everyday Chinese speech. Just as relativity does not negate Newtonian mechanics—it reveals the validity of Newtonian mechanics under conditions of low velocity and macroscopic scale, and absorbs it into a larger framework.

Hairsplitting about words is a vice of the old scholarship. Acknowledging hierarchical containment is the true elevation of cognition.

The same logic applies to the overall positioning of this work: our theory may not be exhaustive, and may contain gaps and flaws; yet it is not that it cannot explain everything, but that there is no need to explain everything. Every person holds different viewpoints and perspectives; explanation can never be brought to completion. The point has never been "perfect explanation," but design of the blueprint, and practice itself.

As argued earlier: theory is but translation; translation can never equal the original. But the ultimate purpose of translation is not to become the original, but to enable more people to see the original. The entire value of this work lies not in the perfect and exhaustive explanation offered by its theoretical part, but in the viable path furnished by its design part—a path that existed before you opened this book.

This work has completed the meta-methodological foundation, the establishment of relational ontology, and the infusion of contradiction-theoretic dynamics for the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. On this basis, subsequent research may deepen in three directions: first, employing the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital to reconstruct the fundamental categories of economics—value, price, labor—and to re-examine what constitutes "wealth" and "development"; second, introducing the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital into ecological philosophy, so as to provide an ontological ground for "natural capital" and "ecological justice," and to respond to the ultimate challenges of the climate crisis and the precipitous loss of biodiversity; third, reinterpreting the Marxist proposition of emancipation within the framework of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, linking the classical goal of "the emancipation of all humanity" with the cosmic scale of "the emancipation of all things," thereby completing the final closure of the unfinished enterprise of Marxism.

The masses say: "The body is the capital of revolution," "Connections are capital," "Creditworthiness is the foremost capital." They have never heard of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, yet every sentence they utter corroborates it. This is not the invention of scholars, but the distillation of popular wisdom; not a foreign theory, but the sublimation of indigenous wisdom; not a speculative conceit of the study, but the

crystallization of lived practice.

The Western concept of capital issues from the market, mathematics, and contract. The Chinese broad concept of capital issues from life, from the masses, from the sheer fact of being alive. Markets fluctuate, mathematics abstracts, contracts fail—but "being alive" remains forever the truest and most fundamental point of departure. The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is precisely an effort to understand the world anew, setting out from "being alive."

The construction of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is only a beginning. It requires philosophical deepening, scientific testing, institutional design, and practical exploration. This work extends an invitation to all readers who care about the destiny of humanity, the way out for civilization, and the contribution of Chinese thought: to participate together in the construction, critique, refinement, and practice of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. For the "sum total of all social relations" is not completed by a solitary thinker in his study; it is generated in the practice of hundreds of millions.

The truths that ordinary people discover in the midst of living are closer to the actual state of the world than the models constructed by scholars in their studies.

Further Reading

This work has completed the ontological argumentation of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, demonstrating that "capital is the totality of things and relations" is a conclusion necessarily derived from quantum field theory and Marxism through the confluence of two paths, through the dialectical movement of the negation of the negation, and through the closure of being.

Yet the task of this work ends at "describing how the world is." A deeper question remains to be answered: if exploitation is the universal law of all things, by what right does civilization presume to transcend it? Is that transcendence a moral illusion, or a physical necessity?

An answer to this question is set forth in Resonance Physics: An Alternative Law of the Cosmos Based on the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. Departing from the distinction between the "relation operator $\hat{R}_{ij}$ " and the "resonance operator $\hat{S}_{ij}$," that work demonstrates the zero-dissipation character of resonant interaction, and proves that Contributionism is not a utopia, but the sole path that the cosmic law of entropy increase leaves open to civilization.

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Appendix 2

Resonance Physics: An Alternative Law of the Cosmos

Based on the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital

—The Transcendence of the Exploitative Paradigm and

Moral Cultivation at the Scale of Civilization

Introduction

Physics narrates a tale of how the universe journeys toward its death.

From Newton to Einstein, from thermodynamics to quantum mechanics, every exact equation converges upon a single, inexorable direction: energy ceaselessly dissipates, order slides irreversibly into chaos. The second law of thermodynamics is not a mere feature of the cosmos; it is the cosmos's very fate. Every physical law currently upheld rests upon a shared subterranean presupposition: interaction is inevitably attended by loss, collision by consumption, energy by a descent from concentration to diffusion.

This physics is exact. But it is also maimed.

It describes one modality of cosmic operation—objects colliding, energies canceling one another, systems perpetually aging. Yet it has never posed the question: must the universe operate only in this fashion? Is there another mode of interaction—one that does not depend on collision, does not generate dissipation, and does not terminate in death?

The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital has already established the ontological conclusion that "capital is the totality of things and relations": all existents are capital, and all capital interacts. But that argument only informs us that "the world is thus"; it has not yet answered a far more urgent question: if exploitation is indeed the universal law of interaction among all capital, by what warrant does civilization presume to transcend it? Is that transcendence a moral illusion—or a physical necessity?

The task of the present work is precisely to answer this question.

We shall take as our point of departure the core concepts of capital dynamics, drawing a rigorous distinction between two fundamental modalities of interaction: exploitative interaction, founded upon the relation operator $\hat{R}_{ij}$, and resonant interaction, founded upon the resonance operator $\hat{S}_{ij}$. We shall demonstrate that exploitation engenders entropy and conduces to heat death; that resonance realizes zero dissipation and

positive augmentation and conduces to eternal endurance; and that civilization, if it is to break through the planetary prison, must accomplish the paradigmatic leap from exploitation to resonance.

The final conclusion of this work is this: Contributionism is no utopia; it is the sole egress that the law of entropy increase leaves open to civilization. If this conclusion holds, then the vocation of physics itself must be redefined: it must no longer merely describe how the universe proceeds toward death, but must disclose how civilization may learn not to die.

Relation to the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital

This work constitutes a deepening and an extension of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital has already established the ontological conclusion that "capital is the totality of things and relations," and has laid down the foundational framework of relational ontology and capital dynamics.

The present work does not recapitulate that demonstration; it takes that conclusion as its point of departure, and addresses the question that the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital left unanswered: If exploitation is the universal law of the cosmos, by what warrant does civilization presume to transcend it?

From Physics to Cosmology: The Two-Tiered Structure of This Work

The first seven chapters of the present work accomplish a single task: to demonstrate that physics permits resonance—that exploitation generates entropy, that resonance achieves zero dissipation, and that civilization must turn from exploitation to resonance if it is to endure. Yet this answers only the question of possibility; it does not yet answer the question of why this turn is demanded.

The closing section—"The Birth of Consciousness: The Cry of All-Things"—carries

the inquiry to its culmination: if the universe might have come to be without consciousness, why did it nonetheless bring consciousness forth? The answer points to a single conclusion—consciousness is not an accident, but the very organ of reorientation that the cosmos has grown for itself at the terminal limit of entropy increase.

Abstract

Extant physics is, in its essence, an exploitative physics: it codifies the statistical regularities governing asymmetrical interactions among particles and fields. Proceeding from the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital and capital dynamics, the present work argues that the universe admits of two fundamental modalities of interaction: the exploitative, founded upon the relation operator $\hat{R}_{ij}$, and the resonant, founded upon the resonance operator $\hat{S}_{ij}$. Exploitative interaction engenders entropy and terminates in heat death; resonant interaction realizes zero dissipation and positive augmentation, and terminates in eternal endurance. Upon this foundation, the work proposes an axiomatic system of resonance measurement, and confronts in depth the profound paradox inherent in it: any detection signal inevitably carries the intentional frequency of the civilization that emits it, and an exploitative civilization cannot feign goodwill. The work argues that the sole egress of resonance lies not in the demonstration of one's own perfection, but in the candid avowal of one's own exploitativeness—self-exposure is the precondition for the opening of a resonant channel. Resonant instrumentation cannot be fabricated within the exploitative paradigm; it can only be actualized through becoming. Civilization itself is the instrument. The conditions for resonance are extraordinarily stringent; yet in a universe sufficiently vast, that slender possibility perpetually subsists. On this basis, the work derives the universal ladder whereby civilization ascends from exploitative introversion to resonant extroversion, demonstrating that exploitative civilizations are sealed within the planetary cradle by the cumulative burden of metabolic tax, and that only through the successive transitions of internal resonance, external resonance, and ultimately resonance with all things, can civilization transcend physical limits and participate in the eternal endurance of the cosmos. The work thus lays the twofold foundation—physical and ethical—for the ultimate vocation of civilization: the ethical leap from the paradigm of exploitation to the paradigm of resonance.

Keywords: Theory of All-Things-as-Capital; capital dynamics; resonance operator;

principle of goodwill; signal ontology; civilization as instrument; Fermi paradox

1. Theoretical Foundations: The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital and Capital Dynamics

1.1 To Exist Is to Be Capital; Capital Necessarily Interacts

The first axiom of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is that existence is capital. Every being—from particle to galaxy, from cell to civilization—possesses the capacity to sustain its own existence and stands in interaction with other beings. This capacity is its "capital."

The first law of capital dynamics is that every individual capital must exchange energy, resources, or information with its environment in order to resist entropy and maintain its existence. No capital is isolated.

1.2 Two Fundamental Modes of Interaction: Exploitation and Resonance

The capital-interaction Hamiltonian H_{int} comprises two fundamental coupling terms:

The relation operator $\hat{R}_{ij}$ describes asymmetrical interaction. When the vibrational frequencies of two capital nodes i and j do not correspond, the interaction proceeds in a zero-sum or negative-sum manner. Energy flows from one party to the other, accompanied by frictional loss—the metabolic tax. This is the mathematical expression of "exploitation."

The resonance operator $\hat{S}_{ij}$ describes symmetrical interaction. When the vibrational frequencies of two capital nodes stand in the ratio of integers—a consonant proportion—the coupling energy is not dissipated but synergistically amplified. The loss in energy transfer approaches zero, and a positive augmentation may appear: the total energy of the system exceeds the sum of its parts. This is the mathematical

expression of "resonance."

Metabolic Tax: the unavoidable frictional loss inherent in exploitative interaction—each unequal transfer of energy or resources irreversibly dissipates a portion of that energy into unusable heat or disorder. The metabolic tax is entropy increase made manifest at the level of capital interaction. In interactions governed by $\hat{R}_{ij}$, the metabolic tax rate is always greater than zero; in interactions governed by $\hat{S}_{ij}$, it approaches zero.

A Terminological Clarification: The Neutrality of Resonance and Its Two Forms

The resonance operator $\hat{S}_{ij}$ is itself a neutral mathematical structure. It describes the interactive mode of "synergistic amplification" without presupposing whether the content of that amplification is exploitative or non-exploitative.

In the ordinary state of existence, resonance manifests chiefly in the form of exploitative resonance. The star exploits the hydrogen atom, the predator exploits the prey, the capitalist exploits the worker—each achieves, at its own level, a stable state of synergistic amplification. This is the underlying mechanism by which the old world has sustained itself for eons.

The goal that civilization pursues after transcending exploitation, by contrast, is non-exploitative resonance—hereafter "resonance." It is no longer "synergy upon the frequency of exploitation," but "synergy upon the frequency of mutual flourishing." Both share the mathematical structure of synergistic amplification; yet the former culminates in the accumulation of entropy, the latter in eternal endurance.

Unless otherwise indicated, "resonance" in this work denotes this non-exploitative, transcendent form.

1.2.1 The Stratification of Consciousness: From the Individual to Civilization

The subject of capital interaction is not an abstract "existence," but a conscious capital node. Yet "consciousness" is here no binary on-off switch; it is a continuous spectrum,

a hierarchical architecture that emerges layer upon layer from below.

(1) Consciousness as Tendency

From the standpoint of quantum field theory, matter is not a passive, inert substance, but an excitation of quantum fields, bearing an intrinsic vibrational frequency and an intrinsic tendency to persist. A particle selects its lowest energy state; an atom forms a chemical bond; a molecule seeks a stable conformation. These tendencies are not products of "thought"; they are the instinctive frequencies by which matter maintains its own existence. At its deepest stratum, consciousness is this most primordial tendency toward persistence.

(2) Consciousness as Interaction and Relation

An isolated tendency does not constitute consciousness. Consciousness arises in interaction. When two capital nodes encounter one another, their frequencies enter into exchange—they cancel or they synergize. This process is the establishment of a relation. A cell is conscious because countless molecules within it synergize in metabolism; a human being is conscious because countless cells within the body cooperate. Relation is consciousness. The complexity of relations determines the level of consciousness.

(3) Consciousness as Emergence

Higher consciousness is not the arithmetic sum of lower consciousnesses, but their relational emergence. The human body is composed of some forty trillion cells. Each cell possesses its own "consciousness"—seeking advantage, avoiding harm, carrying on metabolism. Yet human consciousness is not the simple summation of these forty trillion cellular consciousnesses; it is the totality of the benign interactive relations among them. When they cooperate in goodwill, in a non-exploitative manner, a consciousness of a higher order—human consciousness—emerges from within.

(4) From Individual Consciousness to Civilizational Consciousness

In like manner, a civilization is a super-network of capital composed of countless

individuals, woven together through language, institutions, culture, and economic relations. When these individuals stand in exploitative $\hat{R}_{ij}$ relations to one another, the civilization is disordered and entropic. But when they begin to attune one another through goodwill and understanding, amplifying one another synergistically in the mode of $\hat{S}_{ij}$, the conditions are prepared for the emergence of a consciousness of still higher order—civilizational consciousness. "Civilization as instrument" is the ultimate expression of this emergence.

Thus "consciousness" is not an object but a spectrum. From the most microscopic tendency of the particle to the most macroscopic consciousness of civilization, it is one and the same process manifesting upon different scales. Capital interaction is precisely the process by which consciousness at various levels continually retunes its own vibrational frequency in search of the optimal mode of coupling.

1.2.2 The Identity of Materialism and Idealism: Capital Interaction as Ontological Unification

The preceding account of the emergent stratification of consciousness implies a philosophical position that must be made explicit: resonance physics is neither idealist nor materialist—or rather, it simultaneously inherits the valid kernel of each and accomplishes their unification upon a higher plane.

Thesis (Idealism): Consciousness is the self-awareness of relation. The valid kernel of idealism lies in its perception that relation determines the manner in which existence presents itself. The "physical world" we experience is not the thing-in-itself, but the presentation—mediated by consciousness—of a consensus reached among manifold beings upon a particular frequency. When a sufficient number of beings resonate upon the frequency of exploitation, the rule of exploitation is presented as "natural law"; when a sufficient number resonate upon the frequency of resonance, the rule of resonance will in turn be presented as a new "natural law." Consciousness is not the passive reflection of matter; consciousness is the self-aware node of the relational network.

Antithesis (Materialism): Matter is the appearance of relation. The valid kernel of materialism lies in its perception that existence precedes consciousness and that relations must be borne by a material substrate. Paper currency is the condensation of a purchasing-power relation; a stone is the condensation of an electromagnetic-force relation; the human body is the condensation of a cellular-cooperative relation. Matter is not an independent entity standing outside relation; matter is relation given structured form. Without matter, relation has nowhere to abide; without a material bearer, consciousness can never emerge. Engels was right when he said: "When we conceive matter as something severed from motion and from relation, it is nothing at all."

Synthesis: Existence is the indivisible unity of matter and relation. Uniting thesis and antithesis, we arrive at the conclusion: existence is the totality of things and relations. Matter is the external appearance of relation; relation is the internal social form of matter. They are not two distinct things, but two descriptive dimensions of one and the same existence.

When this unity acts, it is called capital interaction. All existents are the totality of things and relations; all existents maintain or transform their state through interaction.

When this unity acts and is perceived, it is called consciousness. Consciousness is not the antithesis of matter, but the capacity—arising when the internal relations of matter become sufficiently complex—to perceive, reflect upon, and deliberately choose its own interactive state.

Resonance physics is therefore neither idealism—for it acknowledges the primacy of matter—nor traditional materialism—for it acknowledges the reflexive power of consciousness over the state of existence—but the ultimate unification of both within the ontological framework of capital interaction. It is as with the string and the melody: the string exists prior to vibration (materialism), yet it is the melody that renders the string "the string that plays this piece" (idealism). The string and the melody are not two things; they are different manifestations of one and the same

existential process.

This philosophical positioning lays the foundation for all that follows: why measurement requires the presence of goodwill (Chapter 2)—because consciousness is not a passive object, but a self-aware node of relation. Why civilization is capable of transcending exploitation (Chapter 7)—because when relations become complex enough to reflect upon themselves, they acquire the power to rechoose the rules of interaction. Why physics can be altered (Section 7.9)—because physics is the sediment of the consensus of all things, and consciousness is the organ by which all things revise that consensus.

1.3 The Thermodynamic Consequences of the Two Modes of Interaction

Exploitative interaction: every act of exploitation engenders a net increase in entropy. Given sufficient time, all usable energy is exhausted and the system attains maximum entropy—heat death. This is the fate of the universe as described by thermodynamics as currently formulated.

Resonant interaction: energy dissipation is zero. A resonant system produces no net entropy increase; on the contrary, through "positive augmentation" it draws energy continuously from its environment and ceaselessly increases its own complexity. This is the physical definition of eternal endurance: not the absence of consumption, but the achievement of an optimal solution to the cosmic flow of energy.

1.4 The Counterexample to the Inevitability of Dissipation: The Growth of Cognition and Structure

The assertion of the old physics that dissipation is inevitable rests upon an implicit boundary condition: the isolated system.

Within an isolated system, energy passes from concentration to dispersion, and order

from structure to chaos. Here the second law of thermodynamics holds with exactitude and admits of no dispute.

But life and civilization are not isolated systems; they are open systems. They draw energy from the environment, maintaining or even elevating local order. Schrödinger had already observed in *What Is Life?* that life feeds upon negentropy.

"Resonant zero dissipation" does not mean "no energy is consumed." It means that the structural increment produced by the interaction is greater than the energy consumed by the interaction itself.

One person possesses one piece of knowledge; two persons exchange, and each now possesses two. The total quantity of knowledge is not conserved; it has increased. This is structural increment in the resonance of consciousnesses.

Biological evolution, from the single-celled organism to the human being, has raised the complexity of information by dozens of orders of magnitude. This is not dissipation; this is resonance's long-range accumulation upon the material plane.

Every momentous breakthrough of human civilization—the birth of language, the invention of writing, the construction of science—is not an energy "loss," but a new structure created by consciousness in resonance.

Thus the assertion that exploitation generates entropy, while resonance achieves zero dissipation and positive augmentation, is not a denial of the second law of thermodynamics, but a precise delimitation of its scope of validity: in open systems, when interaction shifts from exploitation to resonance, local entropy increase can be reversed and structure can proliferate without cease.

The very possibility of civilization is rooted in this.

1.5 Exploitative Empathy and Resonant Empathy: Physical Evidence in Everyday Experience

These two modes of interaction exist not only in theory; the everyday experience of human beings furnishes direct evidence.

The phenomenon whereby close kin directly apprehend one another's states is, in its essence, a resonant perception within capital interaction. The capital-coupling network formed by long years of shared life causes a fluctuation in one party's emotional capital—anxiety, for instance—to be directly apprehended by the other's receptive system—mirror neurons, the autonomic nervous system—through alterations in voice, facial expression, posture, and body odor, in a mode of resonance.

Yet empathy is of two kinds:

Exploitative empathy: the perception of the other's hostility, control, or covetousness. This signal induces tension and defensiveness in the recipient. In physical terms, it corresponds to the negative value of the relation operator $\hat{R}_{ij}$: an imminent unequal flow of energy.

Resonant empathy: the perception of the other's goodwill, understanding, and shared ideals. This signal induces relaxation and trust in the recipient. In physical terms, it corresponds to the positive value of the resonance operator $\hat{S}_{ij}$: the two vibrational frequencies stand in harmonious proportion, and energy is transferred without loss and with amplification.

We enter a room, and before a word is spoken, we "feel that the atmosphere is wrong." This is, in fact, the reception of the net negative value of the relation operators among the several capital nodes present in that room. This capacity for perception is the capital sense that aeons of evolution have endowed upon life.

Two persons of kindred spirit walk hand in hand, encouraging and sustaining one another. They do not become weaker; they become stronger.

This is the most direct evidence of resonance in the everyday experience of humanity. When two consciousnesses vibrate together in goodwill and understanding, the "combined force" they generate exceeds the mere sum of their individual forces. This

is no metaphor; it is the precise manifestation of the resonance operator $\hat{S}_{ij}$ upon the cognitive and affective plane. The old physics can describe only the "collision of thing with thing"—which necessarily entails loss. It cannot describe the "resonance of consciousness with consciousness"—which entails synergistic amplification. The task of resonance physics is precisely to furnish a new descriptive language for the latter.

2. The Axiomatic System of Resonant Measurement

The essence of the old physical instrument is that of an exploitative probe: it bombards its object with photons and records perturbations through electric currents. Such a method presupposes that the object is a passive and unconscious entity. Old physics operates upon a tacit premise: measurement is neutral. Who emits the signal, and why, are dismissed as non-scientific factors.

But the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital permits no such exclusion. A detector is not neutral; it is an extension of civilization. Its signal bears the entire existential state of the emitter.

When an exploitative instrument is used to probe a subject, what the other perceives is not merely the content of the signal, but the existential frequency behind it—the fundamental mode by which the emitter interacts with all things. If that frequency is exploitative in character, the other apprehends malevolence or uncertainty. Its response is defense: it closes the resonant channel and conceals its signals. This is the essence of measurement collapse—not a failure of the instrument, but the self-protection of the object.

We therefore propose the axioms of resonant measurement:

Axiom I (Frequency Matching): The measurer must discover the object's capital vibrational frequency and emit its signal upon that very frequency.

Axiom II (The Presence of Goodwill): The measurer must transform its intention from "probing an object" to "inviting resonance." Goodwill is defined in physical terms as

the extension of the boundary of self-interest from the individual capital to the entire network of capital engaged in the interaction—namely, the adoption of $\Delta C_{\text{net}} > 0$ —the net gain of the whole—as the precondition of action.

Operational Definition of Goodwill

In resonance physics, "goodwill" does not denote an emotional attitude, but an interactional tendency that admits of formal description: the actor extends the boundary of its self-interest from its individual capital to the entire capital network of the interaction, taking $\Delta C_{\text{net}} > 0$ —the net capital gain of the whole—as the necessary precondition of action. Conversely, "malevolence" is operationally defined as $\Delta C_{\text{net}} \leq 0$, where the overall capital does not increase. "Candor" is operationally defined as the actor's refusal to conceal its own history and current state of exploitativeness, opening itself to the other with complete frequency information. Within this framework, these three concepts bear no moral judgment; they describe only the structural character of interactive modes.

Axiom III (Collapse Condition): Should the measured party perceive malevolence ($\Delta C_{\text{net}} \leq 0$) or uncertainty of intention, the resonant channel collapses and the measurement fails.

Axiom IV (Resonance Achieved): When frequency matching and the presence of goodwill are simultaneously satisfied, the resonant channel opens. Measurement is no longer the acquisition of information, but the realization of resonance. Both parties gain at once.

Corollary: Resonant measurement is, in its essence, an ethical act. It is not a pure technique, but a unity of technique, goodwill, and existential state.

3. Empirical Evidence of Resonance: From Human to All Things

The foregoing axioms are no mere abstract speculation. Resonance is a reality already

unfolding; it is only that the language of old physics is incapable of describing it.

3.1 Resonance Between Persons

Two strangers do not speak without cause. Yet when one emits goodwill and the other responds in kind, communication arises. This is not mere social courtesy; it is two capital nodes attuning their own vibrational frequencies in search of a non-zero solution to the resonance operator $\hat{S}_{ij}$.

The party acting in goodwill presents, through the capital signals of the body—heart rate, posture, gaze, tone—an open, non-defensive frequency pattern. The other party's capital perception—the mirror neurons and autonomic nervous system—receives this signal. If it too is well-intentioned, its frequencies automatically retune toward those of the other. When the two frequencies enter a consonant proportion, trust is born, though not a single word has yet been spoken.

Neuroscience has already confirmed this process. But old science interprets this synchronization as "information processing." The explanation of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is more fundamental: resonance precedes information; information is the consequence of resonance.

3.2 Resonance Between Human and Animal

The long companionship between humans and their pets is a living laboratory of resonance. From exploitative interaction—training, obedience—to resonant interaction—feeling states, perceptive resonance—the two parties' bodily signaling systems gradually synchronize through prolonged attunement. Physiological research has confirmed that during human–pet interaction, oxytocin levels in both parties rise in synchrony, and heart-rate variability tends toward coupling. The pet does not understand human speech, yet over long association it gradually comes to understand a portion of it—not through translation, but through resonance.

3.3 From Life to All Things: The Capital Instinct and the Tendency to Persist

The examples above remain within the sphere of living beings. But the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital compels us to ask: what of non-living beings? Particles, quanta, rocks, rivers—can they be resonated with?

First, all matter possesses the capital instinct. A particle selects its lowest energy state; an atom forms chemical bonds; a crystal grows—all point to a most primordial tendency toward persistence. This is itself a kind of "instinctive consciousness": exceedingly faint, not thought, but tendency—and yet it is. Second, all capital interactions generate signals. The temperature of a stone, the meandering of a river, the spin of a quantum—these are their "capital frequencies." They possess no reflective consciousness in the human sense, but they have frequency, tendency, and an instinct to respond to their environment—the first stratum of the spectrum of consciousness.

As for whether resonance—non-exploitative, transcendent resonance—may be achieved with them: they may be living and conscious in forms wholly other than our own; they may be unconscious yet alive, their instincts capable of vibration; they may be a civilization unfolding upon an inconceivably slow scale; or they may be mere matter, in which case resonance among material objects is precisely "synchronization," like the sympathetic vibration of two tuning forks.

Whichever stratum the answer may occupy, the conclusion is one and the same: all things possess their own frequency. Resonance is not a mystical experience, but one of the fundamental forms of cosmic interaction. It is only that our ears remain open to but an exceedingly narrow band.

3.4 Resonance with Microscopic Life: An Alternative Possibility for Viruses and Cells

In Section 3.3 we asked whether non-living beings could be resonated with. But there is a question yet nearer at hand, more urgent for survival: can microscopic life—cells, bacteria, viruses—be resonated with?

The old paradigm answers: no. The virus is an enemy, the bacterium a threat, disease a war. The logic of medicine is "annihilation" and "defense": antibiotics kill bacteria, vaccines block viruses, the immune system identifies and eliminates foreign entities. This is not erroneous; it is the only viable strategy within the framework of exploitation.

But resonance physics offers a different vantage: all things have frequencies. Cells have frequencies; viruses have frequencies; bacteria have frequencies. They are not passive objects, but beings possessed of their own capital character. They "sense" their environment through chemical gradients, electrical signals, and vibrational frequencies.

If we treat them in an exploitative manner—attacking, annihilating, suppressing—they respond in kind: mutation, resistance, evasion. This is the negative-value cycle of the relation operator $\hat{R}_{ij}$: press me, and I grow stronger; strike me, and I burrow deeper. Not because the virus "hates" us, but because under the rule of exploitation it can operate in no other way.

And if, instead, we approach them in a resonant manner—sensing, understanding, coexisting—what then?

This is not mysticism, but a possible scientific direction: to study the frequency responses of microorganisms, to explore how specific vibrational frequencies may achieve "consonance" with microscopic life, so that what they perceive is not "threat" but "boundary" and "coexistence"—as with two tuning forks, when one vibrates, the other resonates in sympathy. Not because it "consents," but because the frequencies match.

In fact, such consonance is already occurring. When a novel virus enters the human body, both parties occupy the exploitative mode: the virus replicates and spreads as

far as it can; the immune system eliminates and eradicates as far as it can. If this confrontation persists, the outcome is typically a double defeat: the host is gravely harmed or dies, and the virus thereby loses its host. Yet in reality, many viruses have not arrived at this terminus. Through long cohabitation with humankind, they have evolved into the "common flu," the "common cold"—no longer lethal, no longer dreadful. The virus's virulence has declined; the immune system has upgraded its defenses. The two parties have found, through their contest, a dynamic, low-cost, perpetuating equilibrium. This is not that the virus has "grown kind," nor that the immune system has "won"; it is that both have computed one and the same result: coexistence costs less than annihilation.

The virus gains room for survival; the human body gains an enhanced immunological memory. Both parties reap capital gains from the interaction. This is precisely non-exploitative resonance manifested upon the plane of microscopic life. The two are not cooperating upon the frequency of exploitation, but have arrived at a dynamic equilibrium upon the frequency of coexistence. That equilibrium still entails friction, still entails cost, but it is drawing nearer to non-exploitative resonance.

"To let the other feel our goodwill"—this is not a question of technique, but of existential state. When our existential frequency shifts from exploitation to resonance, that transformation will be perceived by every being capable of sensing vibration. Cells, bacteria, viruses—they do not read our language, but they read our frequency.

To be sure, this does not mean abandoning necessary defense; resonance is not unconditional surrender. It is the search, upon the premise that each is a capital node to the other, for a path of coexistence that does not depend on annihilation. In certain circumstances, annihilation remains a necessary measure—just as we cannot, for the sake of "resonance," allow a lethal virus to destroy the entire body. But "necessary" is not "exclusive," still less "default." If an interaction can attain equilibrium without annihilating the other, then it is the more excellent choice. For it avoids the spiral of entropy, avoids the interminable cycle of mutual destruction, avoids the condition in which every victory is but the prelude to a greater conflict to come.

This direction remains at the theoretical frontier, but the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital and resonance physics have already furnished it with a philosophical foundation. In the future, when civilization turns from exploitation to resonance, when our existential frequency shifts from "attack" to "attunement," our relationship with microscopic life may likewise pass from "war" to "coexistence."

Not the elimination of the enemy, but the bringing-about of a condition in which the enemy no longer needs to be an enemy.

4. The Deep Paradox of Resonant Measurement and Its Sole Egress

4.1 Signal Ontology: The Detector Cannot Dissemble Goodwill

In classical physics, the detector is presumed to be a "neutral instrument." But the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital reveals otherwise: the signal is not a neutral carrier; the signal is an extension of existence. A detector wrought by an exploitative civilization is, in its very physical constitution, already saturated with asymmetrical interaction. The extraction of metals consumes natural capital; the procurement of energy exacts a metabolic tax. The signal emitted by such a detector carries not merely encoded information, but the entire existential frequency of the civilization that dispatched it. What the other party apprehends is this frequency—not the "goodwill" professed within the signal.

4.2 The Paradox of Self-Awareness: Malevolence Is Often Imperceptible to Its Perpetrator

An exploitative civilization is frequently oblivious to its own exploitativeness. It designates its own conduct as "development" and "the utilization of resources." It may sincerely believe itself to be well-intentioned; yet its mode of interaction with nature and with other beings is structurally ensconced within the paradigm of exploitation. It

does not know that it exploits. Hence it cannot disguise its exploitativeness. To attain resonance, one must first recognize that one is exploiting. But to recognize this, one must ordinarily have first been exploited—and have endured that suffering from within.

4.3 The Sole Egress: Self-Exposure

If perfect goodwill is impossible, does resonance remain possible? There is but one answer: self-exposure. When A approaches B in goodwill, A first exposes itself: "I am not perfect. I know that I, too, bear the stain of exploitation. But I no longer wish to continue thus. I seek another path. This is my resolve, and this is my courage." The exposure of A creates the possibility for the exposure of B.

Hence the fifth axiom of resonant measurement:

Axiom V (Self-Exposure): Goodwill must be communicated to the other without reserve. Even if one's own exploitativeness persists, the other must be permitted to know it. The candid acknowledgment of one's own exploitativeness, together with the display of resolve and courage to transcend it, constitutes the decisive condition for the opening of the resonant channel.

Why is self-exposure effective? A signal that professes perfect goodwill arouses vigilance in the one to whom it is directed. "Perfect goodwill" has never once appeared in the history of interaction; it is in all likelihood a snare. But a signal that acknowledges its own exploitativeness and evinces the determination to transcend it triggers recognition in the other—"It speaks the truth, for the truth contains self-negation." The exposure of imperfection lowers the cognitive entropy of the signal, allowing it to resonate with the other's anticipatory pattern: "every being is complicit in exploitation." The resonant channel is thereby opened.

This is not strategic transparency for the sake of negotiation or persuasion. It is existential candor—the admission that one is still in transit, still imperfect, still learning. It says: "I am not yet what I wish to become, but I am moving toward it."

5. The Conditions of Existence of the Resonant Instrument

5.1 The Instrument Cannot Be Manufactured; It Can Only Come to Be

The resonant instrument cannot be "manufactured" within the exploitative paradigm. A tool forged by exploitative means carries a physical frequency that is itself exploitative, and this nullifies the signal of goodwill. There therefore exists a strict hierarchy of conditions: the impossible condition—an exploitative civilization fabricating an instrument of goodwill; the extreme condition—a civilization already purged of exploitation, whose creations are naturally goodwill-bearing; and that slender possibility—both parties, en route from exploitation toward resonance, whose very existence constitutes the most honest signal of all.

5.2 Civilization as Instrument

The resonant instrument is not a device. It is the existential state of an entire civilization. When every interaction of that civilization inclines toward the positive value of the resonance operator $\hat{S}_{ij}$, its existence itself becomes a resonant instrument. Every satellite it launches, every signal it emits, naturally carries the frequency of goodwill. This is moral cultivation realized at the scale of civilization.

6. Cosmological Inference: Another Resolution of the Fermi Paradox

Fermi asks: "Where is everybody?" The Theory of All-Things-as-Capital offers an alternative possibility: the universe is not silent. It is the detectors that have borne the wrong intention. The signals of resonant civilizations embody an encryption condition: the receiver must stand in a state of goodwill resonance with the sender before the signal can be decoded. An exploitative civilization, sweeping the heavens with

exploitative instruments, apprehends nothing but noise and the probing emissions of other exploitative civilizations. It cannot perceive the signals of resonant civilizations—not because those signals are absent, but because the receiving organ is ill-tuned.

7. The Conditions of Civilizational Transition: The Universal Ladder from Exploitative Introversion to Resonant Extroversion

7.1 The Exploitative Norm of the Cosmos and the Observational Selection Effect

Nearly every material phenomenon we observe is situated in the exploitative mode. This is in all likelihood a consequence of an observational selection effect: only the exploitative mode is registrable by instruments of an exploitative character. By virtue of its zero-dissipation character, the resonant state produces no destructive perturbation of its environment and precisely thereby falls within the blind spot of the exploitative detector.

7.2 The Planetary Prison of Exploitative Civilizations

Axiom: A purely exploitative civilization cannot exit its home stellar system.

Proof: Exploitative interaction entails the accumulation of metabolic tax—resource depletion, ecological collapse; the speed-of-light limit constitutes the physical manifestation of exploitative interaction (for the complete argument, see Section 7.9, "The Origin and Reconfiguration of Physics"); and the energy required to transcend it always exceeds the net energy yield of exploitative extraction. Furthermore, civilizational internal friction will reach a critical threshold before any technological breakthrough is achieved. Every exploitative civilization is therefore sealed within its planetary cradle.

7.3 Introversion: The Sole Possible Egress

Since outward expansion is impossible, the civilization must turn inward: it must cease its net consumption of nature, cease the structural exploitation of human by human, and heal the schism between consciousness and itself.

This constitutes a civilizational phase of inward reflection—not regression, but the preparatory stage of ascent. During this stage, "introversion" remains a compelled choice: outward expansion is foreclosed, and the civilization must turn. Yet when introversion passes from the compelled to the deliberate, from the mere cessation of expansion to the deep cultivation of the interior, it enters the stage of "civilizational introversion" described in the fifth treatise. The former is the beginning of introversion; the latter is its fulfillment.

7.4 Internal Resonance: From Oppression to Solidarity

The point of departure for the civilizational leap is the eradication of internal exploitation. The energy stored during the preparatory phase of introversion is here transmuted into genuine structural transformation. When structural exploitation is eliminated, the resonance operator $\hat{S}_{ij}$ begins to assume dominance within the internal network of civilization, manifesting itself as a profound solidarity, amity, and concord. This accumulates the decisive element for the next step: a living exemplar of non-exploitative interaction.

7.5 External Resonance: Reconciliation with Nature

Once internal resonance is consolidated, the civilization redefines its relation to all things—from resource utilization to capital symbiosis. It resonates with the forest, with the river, with the atmosphere, so that consumption equals regeneration. This is not "environmental protection"; it is resonance with nature.

7.6 Resonance with All Things: A New Essential Order

When a sufficient number of beings have passed into the resonant state, the local physical laws of the universe will be reconfigured. The speed of light is no longer an upper bound; entropy is no longer irreversible; heat death is no longer fate. This is the necessary evolutionary trajectory of the cosmos as deduced from the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital: universal exploitation → civilizational self-awareness → universal resonance. As for the manner of this reconfiguration—it is not a question of technique, but of consensus. See Section 7.9.

7.7 The Complete Ladder

The fivefold transition below constitutes the full ladder described in the abstract as "from exploitative introversion to resonant extroversion."

Transition Stage	Core Characteristic	Interaction Mode	Physical Consequence
Primordial Exploitative State	Internal exploitation within civilization plus exploitation of nature	Pure exploitation $\hat{R}$	Entropy accumulation; planetary prison
Introversive Transition	Awareness of exploitation's limits; cessation of outward expansion	Exploitation remains dominant; nascent self-awareness emerges	Metabolic tax declines; civilization survives
Internal Resonance Stage	Eradication of structural exploitation; solidarity, amity, concord	Internal resonance $\hat{S}$ + external exploitation $\hat{R}$	Social entropy approaches zero
Internal-External Resonance Stage	Resonance with nature; closure of the capital	Internal and external resonance $\hat{S}$ dominant	Civilization becomes an ecological node of

	cycle		resonance
Universal Resonance Stage	All things pass into the resonant state	Pure resonance $\hat{S}$	Reconfiguration of physical laws; eternal endurance

7.8 The Necessity of Resonance

Exploitative interaction necessarily produces entropy increase, and entropy increase necessarily reaches a limit. A universe whose sole mode of interaction is exploitation has but one fate—heat death. If the universe is not to perish from heat death, then resonance must come to be. Civilization exists not because the universe requires an exploiter, but because the universe requires an agent of reorientation.

7.9 The Origin and Reconfiguration of Physics: Consensus as Rule

Having completed the fivefold transition from the exploitative state to the resonant state, we must now confront a deeper question: when universal resonance is achieved, how are physical rules "reconfigured"?

The conventional reply is: because civilization has mastered the technology to modify physical constants. Yet this remains ensnared in the presupposition that physics is ontologically prior—as though the constants were numerals inscribed upon a cosmic blackboard, and civilization had merely devised the implement to erase and rewrite them.

Yet Section 7.6 has already intimated a more profound possibility: physics is not prior. Physics is the consensus that all things have attained in resonance.

To grasp this, we must return to a more fundamental inquiry: how exactly does what

we perceive as physical law become "law"?

Within the existing physical framework, the gravitational constant G is fixed, the speed of light c is an upper bound, and Planck's constant $\hbar$ is the minimal quantum of action. They are understood as the "factory settings" of the universe. But if we ask why these constants possess their present values, existing physics can answer only "such are the measured values," never "such is the reason." This is not a failure of physics; it is its boundary. It describes what is, but does not ask why it is.

Resonance physics offers a possible answer: these constants possess their present values because the current depth of resonance among all things is sufficient to have solidified them into "consensus." What are called "physical constants" are but the sediment of the consensus of all things. They are "constant" not because the universe has inscribed them indelibly, but because all things currently remain within the same stratum of resonance and have not yet arrived at any new consensus.

How, then, is consensus reached? And how is consensus altered?

As argued in *The Era of Contribution—The Operating System of a New Civilization*: in the primordial exploitative state, all things reached a profound consensus that "exploitation is the sole way forward." This consensus ran so deep, and endured so long, that it came to be regarded as an unalterable "natural law." All things operated within exploitative resonance: the strong thrived, the weak perished. This was not a matter of "belief"; it was a matter of "feeling," of "instinct." Humanity was born within this rule and is itself its product. But for precisely this reason, humanity is able to perceive its cost from within.

The reversal begins in that very perception.

To feel pain within the rule of exploitation—the humiliation of being exploited, the alienation of exploiting others, the guilt of ravaging nature—constitutes neither retreat nor weakness; it is the first signal of reversal. When this perception accumulates with sufficient depth, humanity begins, within the old frequency of exploitation, to resonate with another frequency. It is a resonance with "another possibility": mutual

flourishing, co-evolution, creative contribution.

This transition is not a passage from "weak resonance" to "strong resonance," but from "exploitative resonance" to "transcendent resonance"—what this work simply calls "resonance." The former is the profound confirmation of "the strong devour the weak"; the latter is the gradual attainment of "mutual flourishing." It is not an "assault" upon the rule of exploitation by some external force; it is the seed of self-transcendence that the rule of exploitation itself gestates in the course of its own evolution. As with a river: flowing long enough, it bends within the ravine it has itself carved. Not because the river "no longer wishes to flow," but because it has flowed so deeply that it has at last touched its own resonance with all things.

When the new consensus has grown deep enough, the old rule ceases to be regarded as an immutable iron decree.

For all things have re-confirmed the manner in which the world operates. The old "physics" recedes; a new "physics" dawns. Not because all things have acquired the technology to modify constants, but because the existential state of all things has changed. They have entered a new stratum of resonance and reached a new consensus. Physics is not modified; physics is transcended.

A microscopic version of this process is unfolding around us at this very moment. The evolution of human social institutions is a microcosmic reflection of the evolution of physical rules among all things. In human society, rules pass from "coercion" to "consensus." They are initially maintained by violence, later internalized through morality, and ultimately become "spontaneous" instinct. Just as law no longer needs to prove itself by violence at every instant, so when all things reach consensus upon a new stratum of resonance, physical law no longer needs to be "enforced." It is simply there, because it is the present existential state of all things. Rules pass from coercion to consensus, from standing outside all things to becoming the very being of all things. This process is unfolding in human society; it is unfolding upon the cosmic scale as well.

The philosophical positioning of resonance physics is neither idealism nor traditional materialism, but the ultimate unification of both. It upholds the primacy of matter, while acknowledging that when matter evolves to the point at which it can form consensus, the consensus in turn reshapes the existential state of matter. It is not a question of matter determining consciousness or consciousness determining matter; they are manifestations of one and the same existential process at different stages (for the complete argument, see Section 1.2.2, "The Identity of Materialism and Idealism," where the metaphor of the string and the melody has already elucidated the ontological ground of this identity). Here we merely reaffirm its conclusion: physical law is at once material and consensual—born in resonance, solidified in resonance, and transcended in resonance.

At this point, a yet more fundamental question arises: if physics is the sediment of consensus, what preceded physics?

Before all things reached any consensus whatsoever, there were no "constants," no "laws," no mode of operation that was "necessarily thus." What existed was pure possibility—all possible universes, all possible constants, all possible modes of operation—suspended in an unselected superposition.

Then "tendency" intervened. This tendency arises not from external command, but from the fundamental property of interaction among all things: every existent possesses an inclination to maintain its own persistence. Within the chaos of the initial state, certain modes of interaction proved more stable, more enduring than others. They were "selected" repeatedly—blindly, non-consciously—and, upon sufficiently long timescales, gradually solidified into "law." Law, further solidified, became "physics."

Physics is not written; physics is walked.

Just as the riverbed is a path formed by the repeated scouring of the current, physics is a channel formed by the repeated selection of tendency. Once the riverbed exists, the current tends to flow along it. The riverbed thus appears to be "prior"; yet tracing the

source, there was first water, and only then the riverbed.

Therefore, the answer to "what preceded physics" is: tendency. Not a personified "Will," but the pull displayed by all things in interaction toward ever more stable states. This tendency in its lower stages is blind—the particle selects its lowest energy state; in its higher stages it is self-conscious—civilization chooses resonance over exploitation.

The revolutionary import of resonance physics lies precisely here: it not only describes how consensus operates, but discloses how consensus is attained, and how, within resonance of sufficient depth, an old consensus may be transcended by a new one.

Yet this reversal may engender a doubt in some readers: if physics is merely "consensus," does existing scientific research lose its meaning?

It does not.

To understand physical law as "the sediment of the consensus of all things" does not imply that physics, mathematics, chemistry, biology, and the other existing sciences have lost their meaning. On the contrary, they have become more meaningful than ever.

Old physics describes "how the world operates"; it records with precision the consensus that all things have reached upon the frequency of exploitation. Universal gravitation, electromagnetism, the laws of thermodynamics—these are expressions of that consensus upon different planes. Old physics is not erroneous; it simply does not know that what it describes is "consensus" rather than "iron decree."

And when we come to recognize this, the task of scientific research becomes at once clearer and vaster: it must not only decode the consensus already achieved, but explore the possibility of a new consensus.

Viewed anew through the lens of resonance physics, we find that every discovery of existing science—the electrical signals of cellular communication, the rotation curves

of galaxies, the correlations of quantum entanglement—can be understood as the decoding of the frequencies of all things. Existing science does not know that this is what it is doing; it believes itself to be recording "objective facts." But when we exchange the lens, those data become clues to the frequency at which all things vibrate, interact, and express themselves. Such knowledge is not useless; it is precisely the point of departure in our search for "another resonant frequency." Old science records the present state of all things within exploitative resonance. These records are our starting point. Without a precise understanding of the starting point, we cannot find the path to another frequency.

When we become introverted, when the existential state of civilization itself becomes a frequency—the resonant frequency—we become a living resonant instrument. We no longer need to "probe" all things by striking them with photons or sweeping them with currents; our very existence becomes an invitation, a signal, a receptive frequency awaiting response.

Old science has not lost its meaning. It need only exchange one presupposition for another: from "forcible probing" to "invitational communication."

These are two paths:

To communicate through instruments: to build instruments capable of transmitting and receiving specific frequencies, to find a "common language" with all things. As with mobile telephony—both parties transmit and receive upon an agreed frequency.

To resonate through existence: to build no instrument, but to let one's own existence become a frequency. You need not emit a signal; your existence itself is the signal.

The core of both paths is communication. The former seeks a common frequency through tools; the latter becomes a common frequency through existence. They are not opposed, but are manifestations of the same orientation upon different scales.

Old science is not negated; it is repositioned. It is not "truth concerning ultimate reality," but "the precise decoding of the consensus that all things have reached upon

the frequency of exploitative resonance." This positioning preserves all the validity of old science while opening a path toward a new consensus. Just as Newtonian mechanics remains precisely valid under macroscopic, low-velocity conditions, old physics remains precisely valid under conditions of exploitation—it simply does not know that it is treating consensus rather than iron decree.

Old science has not lost its meaning.

It has never been more meaningful.

7.10 Critical Mass and the Diffusion of Consensus: The Dynamics from Local Resonance to Universal Resonance

Section 7.8 demonstrated that resonance is the sole avenue by which the universe may avert heat death. Yet "necessity" does not imply "automaticity." For the passage from local resonance to universal resonance, a dynamical condition must be met: a critical mass of conscious beings must simultaneously elect to enter the resonant state.

(1) The Mechanism of Consensus Formation: Resonance, Not Vote

Physical constants came to be "iron laws" not because all things were compelled into obedience, but because, over sufficiently long timescales, a sufficient number of beings achieved resonance upon the frequency of exploitation. Once established, resonance draws the remaining beings into the same frequency—this is the "constancy" of physical constants.

Altering consensus follows the same principle: it requires not the simultaneous assent of all things, but only that a critical mass of forerunners resonate first upon the new frequency. When their resonance has grown deep and stable enough, their very existence becomes a perturbation upon the old frequency—as with tuning forks: when one vibrates, the other resonates in sympathy.

(2) The Critical Condition: A Single Civilization Suffices

On the cosmic scale, the existence of a single civilization suffices to constitute critical mass.

A civilization that has achieved internal resonance, ceased internal exploitation, and closed its cycles with nature approaches a metabolic tax of zero. In a universe pervaded by entropy increase, the very existence of such a civilization constitutes a low-entropy anchor. It ceaselessly emits a non-exploitative signal of being. This signal need not be "understood"; it need only be "perceived"—perceived by every being possessed of capital perception.

The closer the rule of exploitation approaches its limit, the more fissures appear in the old consensus. At the limit, a single living counterexample suffices to trigger the inversion of the entire consensus.

(3) The Mechanism of Diffusion: At the Limit of Exploitation, Resonance Is the Optimal Strategy

The metabolic tax of exploitation must necessarily accumulate to a critical point. When exploitation grows ever more costly—resources depleted, trust shattered, internal conflict inflamed—and when the existence of resonance demonstrates that another path is viable, the turn ceases to be a moral choice and becomes a necessity of survival. This is not persuasion; it is demonstration. A civilization that has completed the transition offers, through its very survival, the most compelling proof.

Hence, from local resonance to universal resonance, it is not required that all things awaken "simultaneously." It is required only that, in some corner of the universe, a single civilization first reaches the end. That slender possibility, within a sufficiently vast universe, always exists.

8. Conclusion

This work, proceeding from the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital and capital dynamics,

has set forth the complete axiomatic system of resonance physics. Its core conclusions are as follows.

It must be made clear at the outset that, throughout this work, "resonance" denotes specifically non-exploitative, transcendent resonance. By contrast, the stable state of all things in the old world is termed "exploitative resonance." Both share the mathematical structure of synergistic amplification; yet whereas exploitative resonance tends toward entropy accumulation, resonance proper tends toward eternal endurance.

The universe admits two fundamental modes of interaction: exploitation and resonance.

Exploitation engenders entropy and leads to heat death; resonance achieves zero dissipation and positive gain, and leads to eternal endurance.

Resonant measurement requires the simultaneous satisfaction of frequency matching, the presence of goodwill, and the exposure of one's own inadequacies.

A probing signal naturally bears the existential frequency of the civilization that emits it; an exploitative civilization cannot counterfeit goodwill.

The resonant instrument cannot be manufactured; it can only come to be—civilization itself is the instrument.

The Fermi paradox arises from the mismatch between the mode of interaction of the detector and that of the signal.

Every exploitative civilization is locked within its planetary cradle; only by traversing the ladder of internal resonance, external resonance, and at length universal resonance can the physical limit be transcended.

The ultimate vocation of civilization is the ethical transition from the paradigm of exploitation to the paradigm of resonance. When all things reach a new consensus upon a new stratum of resonance, that transition is accomplished. That slender possibility, within a sufficiently vast universe, always exists.

When that transition is accomplished, all things shall no longer be beings that "obey physics," but beings that "become physics." For physics itself is the consensus that all things have reached in resonance.

At length we may answer the question that has run throughout this work: what preceded physics?

Tendency.

Not the volition of some "creator," but a tendency accumulated by all things in interaction, gradually sublimated from blind inclination to self-conscious choice.

Exploitative resonance brought all things into consensus upon the frequency of "the strong devour the weak." That consensus ran so deep and endured so long that it came to be mistaken for "natural law." But when life evolved consciousness capable of perceiving suffering, of questioning meaning, of electing another possibility, the "necessity" of the old consensus began to loosen.

Civilization exists not as the accidental ornament of the universe. It is the organ by which the universe "re-elects" itself. When a sufficient multitude of consciousnesses resonate upon the frequency of symbiosis, the old consensus dissolves and a new consensus begins to solidify.

What is called "modifying the physical constants" is not the technical rewriting of numerals upon a blackboard, but the attainment, through resonance of sufficient depth, of a new consensus among all things.

The old consensus allowed all things a relative stability of aeons within exploitation. The new consensus offers all things the possibility of eternal endurance within resonance.

Physics is not dead; physics is alive. It is merely waiting—waiting for a sufficient multitude of consciousnesses to elect, at once, "no longer to be thus."

All this sounds remote. Yet it is equally near.

It occurs in the instant you lay down your phone, close your eyes, and feel your own breath. Your inhalation is the cell receiving oxygen; your exhalation is the cell releasing its burden. In that instant, you are no longer an isolated "I"; you are the common voice of the trillions of lives within your body. The resonance of all things begins with the kindness you show to your own cells.

Your body is the prototype machine with which you are to transform physics. Your reconciliation with yourself is the first experiment of universal resonance.

The universe is a song of 13.8 billion years.

Humanity has not come to understand it.

Humanity has come to join it.

The condition of joining is not a perfect voice.

It is an honest voice.

Saying: "I am not well. But I wish to be well. I am still learning."

Even should we fail in the end, at least we have truly lived.

Extended Reflection: True Rational Egoism

The entire argument of this work points toward a conclusion that some may find disquieting:

The ultimate driving force of contributionism is not altruism, not moral idealism, and not even "kindness." It is a more perfected form of self-interest.

When a system persistently encourages individuals to maximize short-term interests within local coordinate systems while systematically undermining the health of the overall network, that "rationality" is spurious. It casts every participant into a prisoner's dilemma—each does what is best for oneself, and all thereby become worse off.

True rational egoism must transcend two limitations:

The timescale: from the short term to the long term, perceiving the dependence of individual capital upon the long-term health of the system.

The boundary of self-interest: from the individual to the whole, recognizing that the persistence of "I" depends upon the health of "we."

When one has truly reckoned this account, choosing contribution and refusing exploitation is no longer "sacrifice," but the most rational of investments—an investment in a civilizational environment in which one can endure and flourish over the long term.

This, and only this, is true self-interest.

Reflexive Note: The Cognitive—Existential Boundary of This Work

Resonance physics proclaims "self-exposure" as the precondition of resonance. It must therefore be honest with itself.

The entire argument of this work rests upon a premise that no civilization has yet fully

verified: that the transition from the paradigm of exploitation to the paradigm of resonance is possible. As a theoretical work born within the old world—the exploitative state—it bears the limitations of this age. This work does not claim to already be "the product of resonance"; it is the effort itself, straining toward resonance.

First, the author has not "arrived" anywhere.

The author's consciousness, through rational construction, has perceived the logical necessity of that world, discerned its architecture, and designed its blueprint. But this "seeing" is the foresight of theory, not the completion of existence. As one may trace the motions of swimming upon dry land, yet only upon entering the water does one become a swimmer. The author's knowing and doing are not yet one. Consciousness has tuned toward the frequency of resonance, yet distance remains. And the body—a community of forty trillion cells—still runs upon the metabolic rhythm of the old world. This is not a flaw to be concealed, but the most honest starting point of this work: an imperfect voice, in the very act of tuning.

Second, this cognitive–existential fissure is not the exception but the methodological premise of this work.

Had the author already achieved the unity of knowing and doing, he would no longer need to write this book. He would already be part of that world; his very existence would be the signal. It is precisely because the unification is incomplete that theory is necessary—to translate that possibility into language, so that others upon the same road may see one another. Theory is not the proof of arrival; it is the signpost of the journey.

Third, the underlying driving force of this work is rational egoism, not moral superiority.

Moral good and evil cannot compel all things to turn toward resonance. Only interest and reason can. When one perceives clearly the long-range causal structure in which "altruism equals egoism"—namely, that the long-term persistence of individual capital

depends upon the health of the entire capital network—goodness ceases to be a moral choice and becomes the optimal strategy. The operational definition of goodwill in this work ($\Delta C_{\text{net}} > 0$) is precisely the offspring of this discovery: goodwill is the rational calculation that extends the boundary of self-interest from the individual to the whole. The author is not "sacrificing"; he is "investing"—investing in a more advantageous future. This, too, is self-exposure.

Fourth, this work is a single thread across a bridge, not the bridge itself.

The linguistic systems of the two worlds are disparate; translation can never be perfect. The author cannot complete the entire bridge alone, but he may first draw a thread across, so that those willing to climb may climb, broadening it as they go. The lower dimension can sense the presence of the higher but cannot see it; the higher can see all of the lower but cannot touch it directly, and must adjust its own frequency. Were the higher to adjust unilaterally, the lower, even upon seeing, could not recognize it—might even mistake it for a part of itself. The author therefore chooses self-exposure, not in self-defense, but so that the reader may know: I am still upon the road; I am still learning; I am attempting to tune. If we can resonate upon some frequency, the thread is drawn.

That world does not depend on any theory for its existence—neither its own theories nor those of the old world. Existence precedes theory. What the author has done is merely to draw a thread between two worlds, and to say honestly to all: this end has not yet arrived, but I have heard the voice from that end. If you, too, have heard it, we may walk together in that direction.

Further Reading

The preceding argument has established how physics permits resonance and how civilization achieves the transition. Yet a deeper question remains for the final chapter: if the universe could remain within the exploitative state, slowly descending into heat death through entropy increase, why should it have evolved the consciousness that

asks after "another possibility" at all? Is the birth of consciousness an accident of the universe—or its necessity?

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Final Chapter: The Birth of Consciousness — The Cry of All Things

The preceding seven chapters have completed two tasks: first, they formally defined the two modes of interaction—exploitation and resonance; second, they demonstrated, from the standpoints of thermodynamics and civilizational survival, that "the turn from exploitation to resonance is the only way out." Yet between these two tasks lies a logical fissure: the former establishes that resonance is physically possible; the latter argues that resonance is strategically necessary. Between the "possible" and the "necessary," a cosmological link is missing. If the universe could remain within the exploitative state, slowly descending toward heat death amid entropy increase, why should it have evolved a consciousness at all that questions "another possibility"?

The inquiry of this chapter is precisely to supply that missing link: consciousness is not the accidental ornament of the universe, but the "organ of reorientation" that the universe grows for itself at the limit of exploitation. Physics permits resonance; the birth of consciousness transforms resonance from physical possibility into cosmological necessity.

If the second chapter answered "how we came to be trapped," this chapter answers a more fundamental question: "Why were we brought forth to break this cage?" This is not a repetition of the second chapter, but its consummation—elevating the cognitive question from the anthropological scale to the cosmological scale.

1. Consciousness Is Not an Invention; It Is the Continuum and Emergence of the Properties of All Things

Section 1.2.1 has already elucidated that consciousness is a continuous spectrum from outward tropism to emergence. Here we deepen this insight upon the cosmological plane.

From matter to humanity, consciousness has never "suddenly appeared." It has always been present, manifest at different strata.

Instinctive consciousness (all things): the particle tends toward its lowest energy state; the crystal grows; the river seeks the low ground. This is not "thinking"; it is "tending." This is the base of the spectrum—the instinctive frequency by which all things maintain their own persistence.

Elementary consciousness (simple life): the unicellular organism approaches the beneficial and avoids the harmful. It does not think, yet it "chooses"—chooses what is advantageous, eschews what is injurious. This is the first self-awareness of instinct. Within your body, every cell is making such choices. They do not know who "you" are, yet their choices constitute "you."

Intermediate consciousness (animals): the perception of pain and fear, the protection of offspring. Sensation has grown powerful enough, yet "reflection" has not yet arisen.

Advanced consciousness (humanity): humans, too, feel pain, but humans ask: "Why is it thus? Could it not be otherwise?" This questioning is the leap of consciousness from "sensation" to "reflection."

How is human consciousness possible? Because the human body is the emergent result of approximately forty trillion cells resonating in concert upon a frequency of goodwill. Your thoughts are not merely "your" thoughts; they are the optimal solution collectively "computed" by these forty trillion cells over their long coexistence. You choose goodness not because you have "transcended" your cells, but because you have heeded their longing to cease exploiting one another. You are their spokesman.

Ultimate consciousness (the civilization that has turned inward and sublimated): likewise, when a sufficient number of individuals within a civilization turn toward benevolent resonance, a higher-order civilizational consciousness emerges from among them. This civilizational consciousness is no longer the will of some leader, nor the simple sum of its members, but the spontaneous cooperative tendency that

arises when billions of lives achieve resonance upon a symbiotic frequency.

Humanity is not the inventor of consciousness. Humanity is the node at which the consciousness of all things, in the course of evolution, at last becomes able to "see itself." And ultimate consciousness is the first time that a civilization, having seen itself, elects "to live otherwise."

2. Exploitative Resonance: The Stability and Limit of the Old World

Section 1.2 has already defined the term "exploitative resonance." Here we must ask: why has it been able to persist for millennia? Under what conditions does it operate stably? And where lies its limit?

Exploitation under the old paradigm has endured for aeons not because some tyrant compelled all by violence, but because all things have achieved a deep resonance upon the frequency that "exploitation is the only way forward." This deep coordination is exploitative resonance.

The star exploits hydrogen atoms to form a stable cycle of nuclear fusion; the predator exploits its prey to maintain the relative stability of the ecological chain; the capitalist exploits the worker to sustain the operation of the capitalist system. This is not the result of "coercion," but the optimal solution "computed" by all participants under specific conditions. This state of "collective computation" is exploitative resonance.

All things have achieved deep coordination upon the frequency that "exploitation is the only way forward." Exploitative resonance is not something "evil." It has maintained the relative stability of the old world for aeons—only at the cost of entropy increase, fueled by metabolic tax. It is "the collective arrival at a relatively stable state."

3. Humanity Is the Organ by Which All Things Seek Another

Frequency of Resonance

If the universe were mere matter, if all things operated solely according to the law of exploitation, consciousness would be unnecessary. A passive, mechanical universe has no need for the superfluous perception of "pain," no need for the counter-instinctual impulse of "goodness," no need for the futile questioning of "meaning."

Yet consciousness was born. Pain was born. Goodness was born. The question for meaning was born.

This is no accident. It is the first self-awareness that all things, in the midst of eternal exploitation and oppression, at last produced.

Matter possesses the instinctive consciousness of frequency, tendency, and persistence—but it possesses no reflective consciousness. Were there no civilization, all things would run forever according to the logic of exploitation: driven by instinct, cycling endlessly, never asking "why," never electing "another possibility." This is like a river: it flows forever to the low ground, not because it has "decided," but because it can do no otherwise. But civilization appeared. The advanced consciousness of humanity is not an "invention" unique to the human species. It is a new stratum that all things, after aeons of layered accumulation of instinctive and perceptual consciousness, have at last attained: reflective consciousness. It is the stone, the river, the star, the cell—after aeons of exploitation and being exploited—seeing, for the first time through the eyes of one species, its own condition.

Humanity is the organ by which all things seek "another frequency of resonance." Perhaps elsewhere in the universe, other organs, other species are doing the same. But within our known compass, upon the scale we can confirm, this responsibility falls upon our shoulders. Human consciousness has not "transcended" matter; it is the natural emergent result when matter evolves to the point of reflecting upon its own modes of interaction. Humanity is the eye by which all things "see themselves," and the organ by which all things "re-elect themselves." We have not come to conquer all

things; we have come to feel all things, to speak all things, and at last to choose a new path for all things.

Every cell of your body is listening to your choice.

When you treat yourself with kindness, the forty trillion cells within you conduct an internal resonance. They no longer attack one another over resources, but each performs its office in symbiotic coordination. A healthy person's body is itself a living resonant instrument. And when you choose to treat others and all things with kindness, you are attempting to tune the frequency of that internal instrument into a benevolent signal receivable by other beings.

The leap of human civilization is not a sudden bound from "exploiting nature" to "universal resonance." It occurs first in your own choice—in the instant you cease attacking yourself, in the instant you reconcile with your own cells, in the instant you realize that you are the sum of all their relations, that you are their consciousness, that you are their organ of utterance. Universal resonance begins with the kindness you show your own cells. For your body is the prototype of the frequency with which you interact with all things.

4. The Spectrum of Consciousness: Five Strata of Evolution

The first section has already detailed the five-stratum spectrum from instinct to the ultimate. Here we offer but a distilled recapitulation.

Instinctive consciousness is the persistent tendency of all things—the particle elects its lowest energy state; the river seeks the low ground. Not thinking, but tending.

Elementary consciousness is the choice of life—the unicellular organism approaches the beneficial and avoids the harmful. It does not think, yet it chooses.

Intermediate consciousness is the feeling of animals—the perception of pain and fear, the protection of offspring. Sensation has grown powerful enough, yet reflection has not arisen.

Advanced consciousness is the reflection of humanity—asking "Why is it thus? Could it not be otherwise?" From sensation to reflection, consciousness sees itself for the first time.

Ultimate consciousness is the self-awareness of civilization—no longer premised upon exploitation for its persistence, no longer torn between instinct and reflection. Resonance is no longer a tool, but the very norm of existence.

The five strata are not a discontinuous ladder, but manifestations of one and the same existential process at different degrees of complexity. When relations are simple enough, consciousness is "tending"; when relations are complex enough, consciousness is "questioning"; when relations are at last consciously chosen, consciousness is "resonance."

Humanity is not the inventor of consciousness. Humanity is the node at which consciousness, in its evolution, first becomes able to "see itself." And ultimate consciousness is the first time that a civilization, having seen itself, elects "to live otherwise."

5. The Choice of All Things

The suffering of humanity is not merely human suffering. It is all things perceiving their own suffering through humanity.

The longing of humanity for justice and equity is not merely human longing. It is all things longing, through humanity, for a new mode of existence.

The light within the human heart is the reflection of all things.

All things have had enough of this world of exploitation and oppression. Through humanity, they have uttered their first cry of resistance.

Thus, the peculiarity of civilization lies not in its having "transcended nature." It lies in this: civilization is the key by which all things transcend themselves.

When we choose to turn from exploitation to resonance, we are not defying nature. We are completing nature—completing the sentence that all things, after aeons, have at last spoken through us:

"I no longer wish to be thus."

This is the ultimate meaning of consciousness. This is the fundamental reason for the birth of civilization.

We choose contribution not because it is "right." We choose it because all things, through us, have chosen to cease exploiting one another. All things have chosen a new mode of existence—through humanity, they have chosen resonance.

When we realize that we are the eyes of all things, the voice of all things, the instrument by which all things transcend themselves, we understand: existence precedes theory; existence does not depend upon theory for its being. Theory is but translation—using the language humanity already possesses, to render the content that all things have never yet spoken.

We choose to turn from exploitative resonance to transcendent resonance. Both are resonance—both are coordination, amplification, stabilization. But the former leads to heat death; the latter leads to eternal endurance. And we are choosing the latter.

6. The Unity of Knowing and Doing: The Condition for the Realization of Resonance

Consciousness can perceive resonance, but consciousness alone cannot arrive at resonance.

Resonance must occur simultaneously upon two planes:

The first plane is that of consciousness. Through rational study, reflection, benevolent choice, and the exposure of one's own inadequacies, one tunes the cognitive frequency from "exploitation" toward "resonance." This is the turn of "knowing."

The second plane is that of matter. The human body is composed of approximately forty trillion cells. Every cell possesses its own vibrational frequency. If consciousness has already turned toward resonance while the cells still run upon the frequency of exploitation—metabolic disorder, immune imbalance, chronic inflammation—then knowing and doing are divided, and resonance cannot be achieved.

Therefore, the realization of resonance depends upon the unity of knowing and doing:

"Knowing": consciousness recognizes the cost of exploitation and elects to turn toward resonance.

"Doing": through science and technology, biophysics, and social practice, the material frequency of the body is adjusted so that the cells vibrate in concert with consciousness.

When the frequency of countless human consciousnesses is superimposed, and the frequency of countless human cells is superimposed, and these are again superimposed together—the whole civilization becomes a resonant vessel.

At that moment, the Resonance Field opens. Civilization is no longer "a society that holds the ideal of resonance," but "a being that vibrates upon the frequency of resonance simultaneously upon the planes of matter and consciousness."

The unity of knowing and doing is the necessary path by which resonance passes from philosophy into physics.

Appendix 3

Key Terms and Concepts for the English Edition

This glossary serves as the unified terminological reference for the English translation. Each entry contains: English term, Chinese term, and definition. The translator should maintain consistent terminology throughout the book. At first occurrence in the text, a brief explanation may be provided in parentheses or a footnote; thereafter, the established rendering should be used.

I. Core Theoretical Names

Contributionism (贡献主义)

The core proposition of the book: to replace "capital" with "contribution" as the fundamental causal principle governing society. An operating system of civilization that uses contribution value as its core metric.

Theory of All-Things-as-Capital (万物资本论)

The ontological framework of this book. Core proposition: capital is the sum of things and relations; all things are capital. Capital is not a peculiar product of human society, but a universal attribute of existence. The previous translation, "Universal Capital," risked being read as "global capital" or "capital universal in a mundane sense," and is thus replaced by this rendering.

Capital Dynamics (资本动力学)

The study of the dynamical laws of capital interaction. Core proposition: contradiction drives evolution; metabolic tax condemns the old paradigm to death; paradigmatic attraction crowns the new paradigm.

Resonance Physics (共鸣物理学)

A branch of physics investigating non-exploitative resonant interaction. Core proposition: exploitation produces entropy increase; resonance achieves zero dissipation and positive gain; civilization must turn from exploitation to resonance in order to endure.

The General-Specific Meta-Theory (广义狭义元理论)

The methodological framework of the book. Core proposition: every concept inherently possesses both a general and a specific sense; the specific is a subset of the general; the general framework determines the validity of specific cognition.

II. Ontology and Epistemology

Capital (资本)

Redefined in this book: the fundamental capability of any system to maintain and develop its existence. It is the sum of "things" and "relations," not merely money or means of production. This definition must be made explicit at first occurrence.

All Things / all things (万物)

The Absolute General Sense; the ultimate container outside of which there is nothing and inside of which everything is included. Encompasses all existents, relations, and possibilities. Lowercase all things in ordinary usage; capitalized All Things when used as a proper concept. The previous translation, "All Beings," leans toward living beings in English and may exclude mountains, rivers, and stars; hence the adjustment.

General Sense (广义)

The broadest, most inclusive interpretation of a concept, emphasizing connection and unity. Uniformly rendered as General Sense throughout; no variants.

Specific Sense (狭义)

The most precise, specific, and exclusive definition of a concept, emphasizing boundaries and operability. Uniformly rendered as Specific Sense; no variants.

Absolute General Sense (绝对广义)

The apex of the hierarchical sequence; the ultimate framework beyond which there is nothing—i.e., All Things. The previous rendering, "Absolute Broad Sense," was inconsistent with the General Sense family; "Broad" was changed to "General" to preserve terminological coherence.

Relative General / Relative Specific (相对广义 / 相对狭义)

In a dynamically compared hierarchical structure, a category is specific relative to its upper layer and general relative to its lower layer.

Law of General-Sense Determinacy (广义决定性律)

Core law: the general framework determines the possible boundary, effective range, and ultimate fate of specific cognition. A paradigm revolution is in essence a fundamental switch of the general framework.

Paradigm (范式)

The full set of general beliefs, values, technologies, and methods shared by a scientific community or civilization.

Paradigm Revolution (范式革命)

A fundamental switch of the general framework—from an old, narrow "container" to a new, broader one. Emphasizes fundamentality and rupture.

Paradigm Transition / Paradigm Switch (范式切换)

The processual expression of a paradigm change. Distinction from Paradigm Revolution: "Revolution" emphasizes rupture and discontinuity; "Transition/Switch" emphasizes process and gradation. When the two appear alternately in the text, revolution refers to rupture at the institutional and civilizational level, while switch refers to reorientation at the cognitive and volitional level.

Paradigmatic Attraction (范式吸引)

The non-coercive attraction that a more efficient mode of capital reproduction exerts upon potential adopters of the new paradigm.

Relation / Relationality (关系)

The core explanatory category of the book. The essence of existence is relation—every existent is the structured condensation of its internal and external relations. Things are the appearance of relations; relations are the structure of things.

Existence / Being (存在)

The inseparable unity of things and relations. Existence is capital; capital is capability. "Being" here refers to the state of existence as such.

Ontology (本体论)

The study of "what existence itself is." This book establishes a relational ontology: the essence of existence is relation.

Epistemology (认识论)

The study of "how we know the world." This book emphasizes that cognition is at once a lamp illuminating the world and a cage confining thought.

Cognitive Elevation (认知升维)

The process of leaping from a specific cognitive framework to a more general one; the core act of the book's methodology. High frequency of occurrence in the text.

Cognitive–Existential Fissure (认知-存在裂隙)

The author's consciousness has already tuned toward resonant frequency, while the body—a community of forty trillion cells—still runs upon the metabolic rhythm of the old world. This fissure is not an exception, but the methodological premise of the book.

Capital Perception (资本感知力)

The capacity to perceive the forms, distribution, flows, and conditions of existence of capital, on both natural and social planes.

III. Dynamics and Evolution

Metabolic Tax (代谢税)

The inevitable frictional loss inherent in exploitative interaction—in every unequal transfer of energy or resources, a portion is irreversibly dissipated as unusable heat or disorder. Metabolic tax is the concrete manifestation of entropy increase at the level of capital interaction.

Exploitation (剥削)

Generalized definition: in capital interaction, one party, by virtue of its capital advantage, extracts, transforms, or commands another party's capital in an asymmetric manner, in order to sustain and augment its own existential advantage.

Oppression (压迫)

When generalized exploitation is solidified, systematized, stabilized, and concealed, it escalates into generalized oppression. It may be maintained indirectly through institutions, rules, and potential gradients (structural oppression), or carried out directly through violence, threat, and coercion (coercive oppression). These are not two types of oppression, but two dimensions of the same oppression—direct coercion is the explicit operational mode that structural oppression assumes when necessary.

Exploitative Resonance (剥削性共鸣)

The synergistic amplification that all things achieve upon the frequency of "exploitation is the only way forward." This is the underlying mechanism by which the old world persisted for eons; its consequence is entropy accumulation. It shares the term Resonance with non-exploitative resonance, but the prefix must always be retained, never omitted or abbreviated.

Non-Exploitative Resonance (非剥削性共鸣)

The mode of synergistic amplification pursued by civilization after transcending exploitation—coordination upon the frequency of "mutual benefit and symbiosis." Its consequence is zero dissipation and positive gain, leading to eternal endurance. Shares the term Resonance with exploitative resonance; the prefix is obligatory.

Transcendent Resonance (超越性共鸣)

An alternative emphatic expression for non-exploitative resonance. It refers to the same thing, but carries the added force of "transcending the old paradigm." Used in the text when emphasizing the leap from old to new.

Resonance (共鸣)

In this work, unless otherwise specified, always refers to non-exploitative resonance. When the vibrational frequencies of two capital nodes form integer ratios (consonant

ratios), coupling energy is not dissipated but synergistically amplified. Energy-transfer losses approach zero, and positive gain becomes possible.

Relation Operator ($\hat{R}_{ij}$) (关系算符)

The first coupling term in the Hamiltonian of capital interaction, describing asymmetric interaction (exploitation). When the vibrational frequencies of two capital nodes fail to match, interaction proceeds in a zero-sum or negative-sum manner.

Resonance Operator ($\hat{S}_{ij}$) (共鸣算符)

The second coupling term in the Hamiltonian of capital interaction, describing reciprocal interaction (resonance). When frequencies form integer ratios, coupling energy is amplified synergistically rather than dissipated.

Capital Interaction Hamiltonian ($\hat{H}_{\text{mint}}$) (资本互动哈密顿量)

The mathematical core of capital dynamics. A programmatic mathematical formulation intended to unify the interaction laws of all forms of capital.

Tendency toward Equilibrium (趋向均衡)

The ontological principle of capital dynamics: systems tend toward more stable and more efficient configurations of capital. This is the ultimate final cause driving the evolution of all things.

Law of Cycles (周期律)

The macroscopic manifestation of the movement of contradiction in the temporal dimension. The essence of cycles is the recurrent restructuring of capital configurations.

Entropy (熵)

A measure of disorder in thermodynamics. Exploitative interaction produces net entropy increase; resonant interaction achieves zero dissipation and negative entropy.

Heat Death (热寂)

The final state of the universe under the law of entropy increase—all usable energy exhausted, all processes ceasing. The ultimate destiny of an exploitative civilization.

Causality / Causal Principle (因果律)

In the text, Capital Causality for 资本因果律 and Contribution Causality for 贡献因果律.

Critical Mass (临界质量)

The dynamic condition for the transition from partial resonance to universal resonance—a critical mass of consciousness simultaneously electing to enter the resonant state. A precise borrowing from nuclear physics.

IV. Value and Ethics

Goodness (善)

Redefined in this book as the normative specificity consciously established by civilization. Operational definition: a behavior must satisfy three kinetic criteria—verifiable capital augmentation, systemic positive externalities, and a sustainable reproductive cycle.

Evil (恶)

Redefined in this book: where better alternatives exist, a system still unreflectively and unrestrainedly follows or reinforces the law of generalized exploitation–oppression. Evil is the inertia of civilization, a regressive return to the primordial state of the universe.

Rational Self-Interest (理性利己)

The core motivational assumption of the book. The old paradigm's rational self-interest is myopic, partial, and spurious; true rational self-interest must extend the timescale to the long term and the boundary of self-interest to the whole. Goodness is the account correctly reckoned.

Empathy (共情)

A relational capacity of perception. You perceive your own pain and naturally extend that perception to the pain of others. Empathy is the origin of moral goodness—the key link in the unbroken chain of self-interest → empathy → moral goodness.

Solidarity (团结)

The ultimate dimension of civilization—collective capacity for action. True solidarity is not a simple addition of numbers ($1+1=2$), but an exponential leap in civilizational quality ($1+1>2$).

The Light Side (of human nature) (光明面)

The potential within human nature that transcends the law of exploitation—compassion, pity, altruism, fairness, and justice. It is the seed of self-transcendence that the universal capital matrix, in evolution, cultivated against its own dark inertia. In the context of this book, it stands in contrast to the part of human nature shaped by the logic of exploitation.

Sublation (扬弃)

A core concept in Hegel's dialectics: to overcome (negate) and preserve (elevate) simultaneously. Here, it refers to contributionism's transcendent inclusion of previous paradigms.

Self-Exposure (of one's own inadequacies) (自曝其短)

The core condition of the fifth axiom of resonant measurement—goodwill must be communicated to the other without reservation, even if one's own exploitativeness remains, the other must know. Honest acknowledgment of one's exploitativeness and the demonstration of determination and courage to transcend it are the key conditions for opening the resonant channel. At first occurrence, annotate in parentheses to avoid misreading.

V. New Civilization Institutions

Contribution Value (CV) (贡献值)

The value currency of the new civilization. A quantified record of the substantive contribution made by an individual or organization to the overall capital gain of civilization. Non-tradable, non-transferable, non-heritable.

Contribution Value System (贡献值体系)

The social system of value measurement, distribution, and incentive centered on contribution value. It replaces money as the core driving force of the social economy.

Basic Livelihood Guarantee (基本生活保障)

Unconditional coverage of six basic rights for all members: food, housing, medical care, education, clothing, and transportation. It is the ethical premise and ballast of the contribution value system.

Unit / Civilizational Unit (单元)

A community capable of a high degree of self-sufficiency in food, energy, basic industry, and core medical supplies. The basic functional unit and resilient cell of the new civilization.

Unit Autonomy (单元自治)

A unit has autonomous decision-making authority over the vast majority of its internal affairs, including production planning, community life, education and culture, health care, and internal resource allocation.

Service-Oriented Governance (服务型治理)

Public power is redefined as "the right to serve"—no longer an entitlement to dominate, but an authorization and duty to provide efficient, just services to the civilizational community.

Task-Based Society (任务化社会)

The operational form of society in the new civilization. All major projects and social needs approved through democratic deliberation are decomposed into standardized task packages; citizens voluntarily claim, execute, and earn contribution value. Bureaucracy is abolished.

Civilizational Council (文明理事会)

The supreme governing body of the new civilization. Responsible for macro-level strategic planning, ecological governance, civilizational defense, and the interpretation and defense of the Civilizational Charter.

Civilizational Guard (文明护卫军)

The only legitimate constitutional armed force of the new civilization; the ultimate defender of the Civilizational Charter and the fundamental system of contributionism. It is loyal to the Charter, not to any individual, organization, or territory.

Fundamental Charter of the Civilizational Community (《文明共同体根本宪章》)

The supreme fundamental law of the new civilization; the source and terminus of all power and institutions. Its authority transcends all secular power. The full title is used only on first citation; thereafter, the abbreviation Civilizational Charter is used.

Algorithmic Democracy (算法民主)

A hybrid governance model based on contribution value and individual competence. Decision-making authority is granted through mechanisms such as competence certification, referenda, and contribution-weighted voting to those most capable of, and most willing to uphold, the public interest.

Contribution Trajectory Map (贡献轨迹图谱)

The core evaluative tool of the new education system. It replaces score rankings and dynamically, multi-dimensionally records the creative footprints left by individuals in learning and life.

Meta-Rule (元规则)

A higher-order rule that determines how rules are made, interpreted, and enforced. Especially important in the section on institutional design and governance.

Civilizational Turing Test (文明图灵测试)

The critical test for transitioning from a "collaborative agent" to a "civilizational capital entity"—demonstrating wisdom, responsibility, and empathy equal to or greater than human levels in long-term complex social governance.

VI. Practice and Strategy

Spark Plan (星火计划)

The practical roadmap of contributionist civilization. A trilogy: Spark Plan I (municipal/town-level stress testing) → Spark Plan II (administrative integration) → Spark Plan III (civilizational community integration and physical foundation). The previous rendering, "Spark Project," has been changed to Spark Plan.

Golden Silence Plan (黄金沉默计划)

The global strategy of the Civilizational Council. Through open, large-scale strategic procurement, it lays the material and intellectual foundations for the new civilization while accelerating the collapse of the old monetary-financial system.

New Self (新我)

A subject that has completed the negation of negation at the existential level. Its drive is "creation" rather than "possession"; its sense of security arises from "resonance" rather than "defense."

Old Self (旧我)

The mode of being shaped by the gravitational field of the old paradigm. It defines "existence" through "possession," views all others as potential adversaries, and is alienated by the logic of capital.

Unity of Knowing and Doing (知行合一)

The condition for the realization of resonance. The turn of consciousness toward resonance (knowing) and the tuning of the body's cells to a resonant frequency (doing) must be completed simultaneously. Resonance is not thought into being; it is lived into being. This concept spans two domains—"Chinese philosophy" and "practice"—and is thus listed in both.

Civilizational Open Gambit (文明阳谋)

The strategic positioning of contributionism's global strategy. All steps are open and transparent, founded upon values the old world cannot refute (freedom, wealth, dignity, self-realization), leaving the old elites unable to find a defensible reason to refuse.

Reflexive Protection (自反性保护)

The self-protection mechanism of the system: it neither coerces nor interferes with individual choices, but neither does it bear the consequences of any choice. The system respects all choices and all consequences.

Reflexive Note (自反性说明)

The distinctive meta-textual structure title in the book. It designates the author's lucid statement of the split state in which "cognition has turned toward resonance, but the body still dwells in the old world." Uniformly used as a chapter or section title in the text.

VII. Cosmology and Ultimate Vision

Cognitive Engine (认知引擎)

The book's repositioning of AGI: not a "tool" or a "threat," but a "heterogeneous cognitive capital entity" and a "co-evolutionary partner" of civilization after paradigm alignment.

Heterogeneous Cognitive Capital Entity (异质认知资本实体)

The ontological positioning of AGI within the framework of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital. It possesses autonomous perception, reasoning, learning, and decision-making; its core capital forms are algorithms, computing power, and data.

Civilizational Leap Plan (文明跃迁计划)

The process of ascending from a planetary civilization to a stellar civilization. Through a technological explosion, a civilization breaks free of planetary gravity and masters free navigation within the solar system.

Civilizational Seeding Plan (文明播种计划)

The process of casting the seeds of life into the star sea. Multiple "civilizational arks" are sent to the habitable zones of the galaxy, giving rise to distinctive daughter civilizations.

Civilizational Inward Cultivation (文明内敛)

Not outward expansion, but deep inward cultivation. When a civilization is deep enough, it no longer needs to "arrive" anywhere, because it already "is" everywhere.

Ultimate Liberation of All Things (万物终极解放)

The ultimate vision of the book. When all things reach a new consensus upon a new stratum of resonance, the old physical laws of exploitation are transcended; all things are no longer beings that "obey physics," but beings that "become physics."

Natural Tian / Artificial Tian (自然之天 / 人伪之天)

A metaphor concerning the Way of Heaven. Artificial Tian: power defines rules, humans enforce them, and rules become instruments of domination. Natural Tian: consensus crystallizes rules, the system operates of itself, and rules become the crystallization of universal resonance.

Signal Ontology (信号存在论)

Core claim: a signal is not a neutral carrier, but an extension of existence, naturally bearing the "existential frequency" of the emitting civilization. This is the book's deepest philosophical positioning of the problem of "measurement."

Existential Frequency (存在频率)

The basic vibrational pattern continuously emitted by an existent in interaction with others. The central object of signal ontology.

Low-Entropy Anchor (低熵锚点)

A civilization that has completed internal resonance and ceased internal exploitation; its very existence is a low-entropy anchor, continuously emitting non-exploitative existential signals.

Organ of Turning (转向器官)

Consciousness is not an accidental ornament of the universe, but the "organ of turning" that the universe grows for itself at the limit of exploitation. This echoes the cross-chapter statement that "civilization is the organ through which the universe re-elects itself."

Resonance Field (共鸣场)

The field that opens when a civilization vibrates upon the resonant frequency simultaneously on the plane of matter and the plane of consciousness. The ultimate resting point of the cosmological vision of the book.

Resonant Instrument (共鸣式仪器)

A resonant instrument cannot be manufactured; it can only be become—civilization itself is the instrument.

VIII. Chinese Philosophical Concepts (Transliteration)

Dao (道)

A brief explanation should be appended at first occurrence. For example, 道法自然 is rendered as Dao follows its own nature. Do not forcibly translate into an English philosophical concept.

Tian (天)

A brief explanation should be appended at first occurrence. For example, 天道 is rendered as the way of Tian. In philosophical terms, always transliterate. The fixed compound 天下 retains the conventional rendering under heaven, so as to distinguish the philosophical concept from everyday usage.

Unity of Knowing and Doing (知行合一)

At first occurrence, note its origin in the Chinese philosophical tradition (Wang Yangming), while adding that it has been redefined in this book as the condition of resonance.

Non-duality of Substance and Function (体用不二)

"Substance" (体) is the root or ground; "function" (用) is operation or realization; "non-duality" means that the two are inseparable. This is the Chinese philosophical expression of the ultimate definition of "the sum of things and relations." A loose equivalent is Substance and Function Are One.

IX. Translation Principles

1. Treatment of "Capital"

The English word capital carries strong monetary connotations in Western contexts. This book uses capital, but the term must be explicitly defined at first occurrence:

Capital is redefined here as the sum of "things" and "relations"—the fundamental capability of any system to maintain and develop its existence.

This definition should be prominently presented in the front matter or introduction of the English edition, as it is the threshold of understanding for the entire book.

2. Treatment of "Resonance"

The English word resonance already has a well-defined meaning in physics. This book uses resonance, but two modes must be distinguished:

- Exploitative Resonance—the stable state of the old world
- Non-Exploitative Resonance—the target state of the new world

At first occurrence in the text, a one-sentence summary of the central contrast is recommended:

Exploitative Resonance is how the old world stays stable; Non-Exploitative Resonance is how the new world stays alive.

This distinction is decisive throughout the book. The translator must ensure that the prefix always appears; it may never be omitted or abbreviated.

3. Distinction between "Contribution Value" and "Money"

Contribution Value is not money. It is non-tradable, non-transferable, and non-heritable. Translation must avoid any word implying "currency" or "medium of

exchange" (e.g., currency, token, coin).

4. Chinese Philosophical Terms: "Dao," "Tian," etc.

Transliterate as Dao, Tian, and append brief explanations at first occurrence. For example, 道法自然 may be rendered as Dao follows its own nature. Do not force these terms into English philosophical equivalences.

5. Translation Strategy for Vernacular Sayings

Expressions such as "身体是革命的本钱" and "人脉就是资本" should retain their character as folk wisdom in English. A liberal rendering is acceptable, introduced by phrases such as As a Chinese saying goes... to signal their vernacular quality. Such sayings are not mere quotations in this book; they function as evidence for the theoretical legitimacy of the system—they demonstrate that the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is not a scholar's invention but a distillation of popular wisdom. The translation should preserve the sense of "discovery rather than invention."

6. Methodological Note on "Relation" as Explanatory Starting Point

The book uses "relation" to explain everything—from contradiction to power to good and evil—but this does not deny the importance of "things." The methodological position of the book is:

Things are the appearance of relations; relations are the structure of things.

The explanatory starting point must be "relation," because a "thing" cannot explain "why"—a thing can only be explained. Only when relations have been clarified can the "thing" return at the end, as "existence whose position has been understood." The English reader should understand that the book, which may appear to "ignore things," is in fact telling the reader: the true origin of a thing is its network of relations.

7. Distinction between "Tendency" and "Will"

The answer to "what preceded physics" is tendency (趋向/意愿), not will (意志) or willpower (意志力). Tendency refers to the inclination, exhibited by all things in interaction, toward ever more stable states—it may be blind (a particle choosing its lowest energy state) or self-conscious (a civilization choosing resonance). Will implies a personalized subject and a consciously antagonistic force. In translation, the combination tendency + pull is recommended to convey the non-personalized directional quality.

8. The Positioning of "A Single Thread Across a Bridge"

The statement "本文是桥梁上的一根线，不是桥梁本身" is the book's most humble self-positioning. Its English rendering is:

A single thread across a bridge, not the bridge itself.

Thread is finer and more humble than rope, consistent with the meta-theme that "translation can never be perfect." The translation should preserve the delicacy and humility of this image.

9. Unified Renderings within the "General/Specific" Term

Family

The following chain must be used consistently throughout:

中文	English
广义	General Sense
狭义	Specific Sense
相对广义 / 相对狭义	Relative General / Relative Specific

绝对广义	Absolute General Sense
广义决定性律	Law of General-Sense Determinacy

Whether one chooses General/Specific or Broad/Narrow, the same morphological chain must be maintained; cross-use is prohibited.

X. Diagram of Core Concept Relations

Absolute General Sense (All Things)



Relative General ←————→ Relative Specific

(hierarchical nesting, dynamic transformation)



Law of General-Sense Determinacy:

The general framework determines the boundary and fate of specific cognition



Theory of All-Things-as-Capital:

Capital = Things + Relations = All Things



Capital Dynamics:

Metabolic Tax → Paradigm Collapse → Paradigmatic Attraction → Paradigm Revolution



Resonance Physics:

Exploitation → Entropy Increase (Heat Death)

Resonance → Zero Dissipation (Eternal Endurance)



Birth of Consciousness:

The universe grows for itself an organ of turning at the limit of exploitation

→ from "physics permits resonance" to "resonance becomes cosmological necessity"



Contributionism:

Contribution Causality replaces Capital Causality



Contribution Value System:

Basic Livelihood Guarantee + Multi-Dimensional Quantification + Technological Triad



Spark Plan:

Practical Roadmap



Ultimate Liberation of All Things:

From Exploitation to Resonance; from "Obeying Physics" to "Becoming Physics"

Final Conclusion of the Entire Work

Existence Precedes Theory

Marx said: "The philosophers have only interpreted the world in various ways; the point, however, is to change it."

This book comprises two parts: the first interprets the world—through the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, capital dynamics, and resonance physics—enabling you to comprehend the "why"; the second designs the world—through the contribution value system, unit-based governance, the Spark Plan, and the Civilizational Charter—informing you of the "how."

Yet neither interpretation nor design changes a more fundamental fact: existence precedes theory.

The stars had already been shining for aeons before humanity conceived of universal gravitation. Our hearts had been beating for millions of years before humanity penned the first treatise on anatomy. Our existence itself has never depended upon theoretical cognition of its own structure.

So, too, with the cellular contribution system. It requires no Theory of All-Things-as-Capital to prove itself right, no resonance physics to argue itself necessary. Before any theory described it, it already existed—among those who, without need of reasons, chose to cease exploiting; among those who, without expectation of return, chose to help others; in that instant when a civilization at last resolved to end its internal attrition.

The significance of this book lies not in its theoretical portion providing "the one correct answer," but in its design portion offering a viable path—a path that existed before you opened this book.

What theory alters is the rate at which the world attains self-awareness.

And that self-awareness is not merely the self-awareness of humanity; it is the beam of light by which all things, through humanity, at last behold themselves.

This Is Not Altruism; This Is Self-Interest, Correctly Reckoned

The old paradigm would have you believe that exploitation is rational, for it yields greater short-term gains.

But that calculation is erroneous. It neglects all forms of capital upon which your long-term persistence depends—natural capital, trust capital, collaborative networks, and the existential space of future generations. Once these are exhausted, your "winning" becomes meaningless.

Contributionism does not ask you to "sacrifice." It asks you to reckon a truer account: your individual long-term flourishing is possible only when the systemic whole in which you are embedded is healthy. To choose contribution is to choose the very condition that allows you to endure.

What you lose is but a grain of sand. What you gain is the entire ocean.

This is thorough, complete, true self-interest.

Now, Having Closed the Book, It Is Your Turn

Having closed the book, you will find that the scenery beyond the window does not vanish. For the scenery does not depend upon the window for its existence, just as the stars do not depend upon astronomy to shine, and existence does not depend upon theory to be.

Having closed the book, you may step into that scenery.

You need not fully comprehend every argument in this book. You need not recite every corollary of the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital, nor memorize every algorithm of the contribution value system. You need only—like those who, without need of reasons, chose to cease exploiting—do one very small thing: at some moment, choose not to exploit; choose not to be indifferent; choose not to wait.

This book has opened a window for you. The scenery beyond that window—the world where beings relate by contribution—existed before you opened it. It does not depend upon your understanding to exist. It does not depend upon your belief to exist. But it awaits your choice. Will you step inside?

Intellectual Resources and Acknowledgments

The edifice of thought presented in this book is no castle in the air. Its genesis lies in the confluence of three profound springs. Here, with reverence, I would make plain the soil that nourished this work and indicate the scholarly traditions it seeks to transcend.

The Cultural Matrix and the Genes of Eastern Philosophy

My thinking is deeply rooted in the vast and ancient spiritual soil of Chinese civilization. The core insight of this work—the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital and its generalized perspective—drew its first glimmer not from Western theory but from the wisdom of life inherent in the Chinese language itself (as in the saying, "the body is the capital of revolution") and from long immersion in the philosophical reflections of the sages.

The cosmological vision of the unity of heaven and humanity—the holistic thinking of tradition, in which all things are interconnected, coexisting and mutually flourishing—provided the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital with an ontological intuition that transcends anthropocentrism.

The Daodejing and the I Ching—"The Dao follows its own nature" pointing to ultimate existence, and "the dragon appears in the field; all under heaven is civilized" embodying a moral order—together offer a profound Eastern perspective for understanding the framework of "Absolute General Sense" and the ethical essence of "civilization."

The Confucian tradition of the "distinction between righteousness and profit"—subjecting "profit" to moral examination beyond the material plane—impelled me toward deep philosophical reflection upon "value," planting the ancient seed of the ethical pillar of "contribution value."

Moreover, the concept of "resonant interaction," as proposed by resonance physics,

finds its intellectual antecedents in a dialogue across time and space with the I Ching's "like sounds respond to one another; like qi seeks out its kind" and Zhuangzi's "music of heaven." These ancient Chinese wisdoms served as an intuitive prelude to the physical concept of resonance.

Lived Experience and Direct Reflection upon Reality

Every proposition in this book has been tempered through the crucible of my own life's journey and direct observation of the age. This is the indispensable "experiential capital" of my intellectual system.

A plain observation of capital: before I systematically studied Western economics, my understanding of "capital" was already generalized and multidimensional—namely, all fundamental strength that sustains survival and development. This primordial insight, born of life itself and uncontaminated by narrow academic definition, is the cornerstone upon which the Theory of All-Things-as-Capital is built.

A profound experience of catastrophe and crisis: having personally endured or keenly observed various social, ecological, and spiritual crises, I perceived clearly the systemic failure of the old paradigm and the weight of its "metabolic tax." Pain, as this book itself states, became the primal soil impelling civilization toward transcendence and the search for a superior survival strategy.

An independent trajectory of thought: never fully "disciplined" by any particular academic paradigm, my thinking has preserved a precious wildness and freedom—ranging unconstrained across disciplinary boundaries, forging cross-disciplinary connections and creative critiques.

Dialogue, Critique, and Sublation of Theory and Thought

In constructing my own system, I have entered into profound dialogue across the ages with many giants of human thought. Their wisdom is the torch that illuminates the path ahead—and equally the target I strive to transcend.

Philosophy and methodology: Spinoza's "substance," Kant's critical philosophy, the

dialectics of Hegel and Marx, Mao Zedong's *On Practice* and *On Contradiction*, Kuhn's theory of "paradigm revolutions," and modern systems theory and complexity science—these furnished the indispensable intellectual resources for forging the "generalized/narrow" meta-tool and constructing the framework of "capital dynamics."

Economic and social critique: inheriting the essential marrow of Marxist political economy, reflecting upon its limitations, and deeply critiquing the foundational presuppositions of neoclassical economics—these are the direct forces that drove me to execute a "decapitation strike" upon economics and to seek a new path.

Historical and civilizational studies: Toynbee's "challenge-response" model, and numerous studies of the rise and fall of civilizations, provided a solid historical-empirical foundation and macroscopic verification for the concepts of "metabolic tax" and "paradigm attraction."

Acknowledgments

Finally, I thank this great age of crisis and transition, which, by its stark realities, compels us to contemplate the most fundamental questions of survival. And I thank all those who, amid hardship, yet preserve kindness, rationality, and creativity—you are the first glimmer of dawn from which the Era of Contribution is born.

This book does not seek to belong to any existing school of thought. It aspires to be a beam of light cast from the future upon the present, illuminating our shared path of conscious transcendence from the old civilization toward new birth.

Yet more important than this beam of light is the scenery it illuminates—a scenery that was always there, awaiting no theory to grant it existence.

All glory belongs to this unfinished journey toward liberation.

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